CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY

Photography

Complete Course Materials — Instructor & Learner Edition

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING PROGRAMME

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PART 1

Course Design & Curriculum

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY (SHORT COURSE)

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY (SHORT COURSE)

COURSE DESIGN DOCUMENT (Version 1.0)

0. INSTITUTION HEADER

Item	Detail
Institution	Cyber Elias Academy (CEA)
Address	24/26 Ebony Road, Port Harcourt, Rivers State, Nigeria
Motto	"From Zero to Expert, Together"
Course title	Photography (Short Course)
Course category	Creative & Media
Delivery mode	In-person primary (online/hybrid option where available)
Session length	105 minutes
Frequency	3 sessions per week
Duration	2 weeks
Total sessions	6 (S1–S6)
Modules	Week 1 — Module 1: "See and Shoot" (Foundations); Week 2 — Module 2: "Process and Deliver"
Course fee	₦30,000
Certificate awarded	CEA Certificate in Photography — issued on successful completion of a themed shoot planned, shot, edited and presented as a mini portfolio
Primary toolset	A smartphone with a camera (primary), academy computers for editing, free Snapseed / Lightroom Mobile / Canva. Optional DSLR/mirrorless demonstrated if available. No paid subscription required
Document status	Approved for delivery — Version 1.0, October 2026
Companion documents	Part 2 — Session Materials (S1–S6)

About this document.
This is the master design document for the CEA Photography short course. It explains *why* the course exists, *who* it is for, *what* a graduate can do, *how* the six sessions are organised, *how* learners are assessed, and *what* they must produce to earn the certificate. Session notes live in `Part2_Session_Materials`. Instructors should read this document in full before teaching Session 1.

1. COURSE OVERVIEW AND RATIONALE

What this course is.

event, a personal brand or a first paying client. It is built around doing, not listening. From the first session, learners handle a camera, make lighting decisions, photograph real subjects and edit their own images in free software.

Why the course exists.

Almost everyone in Port Harcourt and across Nigeria owns a smartphone that can take photographs, yet very few people know how to use it well. Shops, food vendors, tailors, salons, traders on Jiji and WhatsApp Business, churches and schools all need photographs — product shots, event coverage, portraits. Dark, crooked, blurry photos make a business look untrustworthy; clear, bright, well-framed photos make it look worth buying from. There is a real gap between "I have a phone" and "I can make a photograph that works."

Traditional photography training is often built around expensive DSLR bodies, studio strobes and subscriptions a beginner does not own. This course starts with the phone in the learner's pocket and the free apps they can download today, and builds professional *habits* — observing light, composing with intention, focusing correctly, editing honestly, delivering professionally — that transfer to any camera later.

The philosophy behind the course.

CEA's motto is "From Zero to Expert, Together." Here, "zero" means no assumed knowledge of cameras, exposure or editing; "together" means learners work in pairs and groups, model for each other and learn in a supportive, in-person classroom; "expert" means a confident *entry-level photographer* who can complete a small photo job from brief to delivery — not a professional with a studio after two weeks. (See Sections 12–13.)

The course's real product.

Every learner builds a **mini portfolio**: a themed set of five or more finished photographs — a product set for a small business or a portrait set for a client — planned with a brief and shot list, shot deliberately, edited consistently and presented with an explanation of the decisions behind it. That portfolio *is* their proof of skill.

What this course is NOT:

not a professional studio course, not a DSLR technical deep dive (camera bodies are demonstrated, never required), and not a shortcut to becoming a professional photographer in two weeks. It requires **no** paid software or subscription; we say this honestly because honesty about skill is what keeps clients.

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2. TARGET LEARNERS

This course is designed for absolute beginners and near-beginners. The typical learner is one or more of the following:

- **Small-business owners and staff** — food vendors, tailors, salons, barbers, traders — who need product and business photographs but cannot pay an agency.
- **Aspiring freelance photographers** who want a practical foundation and a first portfolio to show.
- **Content creators and social media managers** whose still images are let down by poor light and framing.
- **Church, school and NGO media volunteers** who photograph services, programmes and announcements.
- **NYSC corps members and students** who want a practical, income-earning skill they can use immediately.
- **Event assistants** who want to support a photographer at birthdays, weddings and naming ceremonies with confidence.
- **Parents and hobbyists** who want sharp, clear photos of family, food and milestones.

What learners bring.

Most learners have a smartphone with a working camera. No DSLR, laptop or prior photography knowledge is needed. Basic phone ability (opening apps, taking a photo, typing) is assumed and not taught. All teaching is in simple, natural English a Nigerian beginner can follow, using familiar contexts — a vendor's WhatsApp Business catalogue, a tailor's fabric shots, a church programme, a birthday party, a Jiji listing — and all prices in naira (₦). The course works best with 8–16 learners; larger groups should add a teaching assistant for S2, S3 and S6.

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3. ENTRY REQUIREMENTS

There is no formal academic entry requirement. To join and benefit fully, a learner needs:

2. **Reasonable free storage** (about 2–4 GB is comfortable for two weeks), or regular access to an academy computer for editing and file handling.
3. **Free Snapseed and/or Lightroom Mobile** installed before S4 (the instructor helps in S1/S3 if needed). Either one is enough.
4. **A free Canva account** (email sign-up) for building the mini portfolio in S5/S6.
5. **Willingness to be photographed and to photograph classmates** during practice, or to act as photographer/director instead.
6. **Willingness to follow the consent and privacy rules** in Section 15 without exception — a condition of joining, not a suggestion.
7. **Any camera the learner already owns** is welcome but never required.

Learners who lack a capable phone may still complete the course by pairing with a classmate or using academy equipment, but they must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

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4. GRADUATE COMPETENCY PROFILE

A learner who completes this course and passes the capstone can demonstrably do the following:

See.
Describe in plain English what makes a photograph good — clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose — and critique an image with those five words; explain the exposure triangle in simplified form and diagnose an image as dark, bright, blurry or flat; explain phone vs dedicated camera, what megapixels really tell you, and how to control focus (tap, lock, focus check) on a phone.

Shoot.
Set up a phone camera sensibly (grid on, resolution high, HDR deliberate, no beauty filter); compose using the rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry and perspective; use natural light (golden hour, window light, open shade) and avoid harsh shadows and backlight; photograph people, products and events to a usable standard; apply a repeatable sharpness routine (steady, focus check, clean background, several frames).

Process.
Edit in Snapseed or Lightroom Mobile (crop, straighten, correct exposure, colour temperature, saturation); retouch and remove blemishes without destroying natural skin texture; batch-edit a set for consistency; state clearly what editing can fix, what it cannot, and what must never be faked.

Deliver.
Select the strongest images honestly and assemble a small, cohesive portfolio that flows as a set; price a simple photography job in naira using packages; run a basic client workflow (brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up); obtain written consent and use a release form before photographing people commercially.

Honest limit of this competence.
This profile describes a capable **entry-level, phone-first photographer**, not a professional studio photographer, photojournalist or commercial retoucher. Graduate work will be good enough for small-business catalogues, social media, event coverage support and a first set of paid or volunteer jobs — a genuine foundation for deeper study. (See Section 13.)

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5. MEASURED LEARNING OUTCOMES (LO1–LO8)

Each outcome is written so it can be observed and assessed. The bracketed line shows where it is mainly measured.

LO1 — Explain photographic fundamentals.
Explain what makes a good photograph; describe the exposure triangle in simplified terms and diagnose an image as dark, bright, blurry or flat; explain phone vs dedicated camera; explain megapixels, focus and basic camera settings. *(S1 knowledge check, Practical 1, Assignment 1.)*

LO2 — Control the camera for a sharp, correct exposure.

LO3 — Compose with intention.
Apply the rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry and perspective to a live subject, and explain why one composition is stronger than another. *(S2 practical, Practical 2, Assignment 2.)*

LO4 — Use natural light well.
Identify and use golden hour, window light and open shade; position a subject to avoid harsh shadows and backlight; choose a time or spot that flatters the subject. *(S2 practical, Practical 2, Assignment 2.)*

LO5 — Photograph people, products and events.
Direct a simple portrait pose for a sharp, well-lit portrait; build a clean product scene for a usable listing image; work an event or simulated event to capture key moments sharply. *(S3 practical, Practical 3, Assignment 3, Simulation.)*

LO6 — Edit photographs honestly and consistently.
Import and crop/straighten, correct exposure and colour, perform basic retouching and blemish removal, batch-edit a set for consistency, and state the limits of honest editing. *(S4 practical, Practical 4, Assignment 4, capstone.)*

LO7 — Build a portfolio, price work and work with clients.
Select the best images, assemble a cohesive mini portfolio, build a package price in naira, describe a client workflow from brief to delivery, and use consent and release forms correctly. *(S5 practical, Practical 5, Assignment 5, capstone.)*

LO8 — Deliver a complete themed photo job.
Take a brief, write a shot plan, shoot a themed set, edit it consistently, assemble it as a mini portfolio and present and defend the choices. *(S6, Capstone, Viva/Demo.)*

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6. TOOLS, RESOURCES AND THE "NO PAID SUBSCRIPTION" RULE

A central promise of this course is that

no learner has to pay for a subscription to complete it.
Everything needed is either already owned or free.

Hardware
— a learner-owned **smartphone with camera** (primary tool); **academy computers** for editing, large-screen review and Canva portfolio building; the **instructor's phone/computer on a projector** for live demonstrations; **free natural light** (a window, open shade, golden-hour sun) plus an academy reflector or improvised white card and a phone tripod/stand for class (learners improvise at home with books, a wall or a selfie stick); and, *if available*, a **DSLR/mirrorless demonstration body** and simple props, used only to show that the same rules apply on every camera. None of the optional items is required.

Software (all free)
— **Snapseed** (primary editor) or **Lightroom Mobile** (free tier; also used for the batch demo); **Canva** (free tier, for assembling the portfolio); and the **phone's built-in camera app** (default shooting tool). No paid app is required.

Accounts and internet
— a free email account for Canva; **academy Wi-Fi** for installing apps and building the portfolio. Editing works offline once apps are installed.

Sample files
— the instructor prepares a sample photo set (product, portrait, event), before/after edit examples and a fictional client brief for the simulation, using only academy-owned or free/royalty-free images.

Deliberately *not* required
— no professional camera, paid camera app, Adobe Photoshop or paid subscription, preset packs, stock-photo subscription, studio lighting kit or paid Canva plan. A learner may later pay for advanced tools as a personal upgrade, but never as a course requirement.

Safety, consent and privacy note.
Learners must get consent before photographing people (and parent/guardian consent for under-18s), respect public places and privacy, and never misrepresent their skill or their edits. This is reinforced in every shooting session and stated fully in

7. FULL CURRICULUM MAP (2 WEEKS × 3 SESSIONS)

WEEK 1 — MODULE 1: "See and Shoot" (Foundations)

Session	Title	Core skills	Primary LOs
S1	Photography Foundations	What makes a good photograph; the exposure triangle (simplified); phone vs camera; megapixels, focus; camera settings	LO1, LO2
S2	Composition and Lighting	Rule of thirds, framing, lines, perspective; natural light, golden hour, window light, avoiding harsh shadows	LO3, LO4
S3	Shooting People, Products and Events	Portraits and posing basics; product photography for small business; events; getting sharp, usable shots	LO5
Week 1 mini-project	**12-image "foundations folder" — 4 composition, 4 light, 4 subject shots**		

WEEK 2 — MODULE 2: "Process and Deliver"

Session	Title	Core skills	Primary LOs
S4	Basic Photo Editing	Snapseed/Lightroom Mobile: cropping, straightening, exposure, colour, retouching, blemish removal, batch editing, honest editing limits	LO6
S5	Building a Portfolio and Pricing Photography	Choosing best work; building a portfolio; packages and pricing in naira; client workflow; consent and releases	LO7
S6	Capstone: Photo Shoot and Portfolio	Themed shoot planned, shot, edited and presented as a mini portfolio	LO8
Week 2 mini-project	**A consistent 5-image edited set + first draft portfolio page**		

8. WEEK-BY-WEEK PROGRAMME

WEEK 1 — Module 1: "See and Shoot" (Foundations)

Central question:
What am I actually looking at — and how do I make this phone produce a good photograph of it?

Skills:
what makes a good photograph; the exposure triangle simplified; phone vs camera; megapixels; focus control; camera settings (grid, resolution, HDR, no filters); the rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry, perspective; natural light, golden hour, window light, open shade, backlight and harsh shadows; portrait posing basics; product scene building; event shooting; sharpness routines.

Sessions:
S1 Photography Foundations, S2 Composition and Lighting, S3 Shooting People, Products and Events.

Mini-project:

Assignment:
Assignment 1 — "Focus and Exposure Drills" (S1) and Assignment 2 — "Composition and Light Series" (S2), plus a small S3 task feeding the foundations folder.

Deliverables:
the 12-image foundations folder; a short written note beside each group explaining what was done; a completed consent form for any person photographed.

Quality standards:
images are sharp on the subject and correctly exposed *in camera*; each composition image visibly uses the named technique (not a random shot labelled afterwards); light studies show a clear difference between good and bad light; every photograph of a person has consent recorded.

Assessment focus:
Practical 1 (camera control), Practical 2 (composition and light), Practical 3 (subjects), Assignments 1–2, and short class knowledge checks.

Capstone contribution:
the foundations folder is the raw material of the capstone; learners begin to sense which images are strong, and their person/product shots give a first feel for their preferred track.

WEEK 2 — Module 2: "Process and Deliver"

Central question:
How do I turn raw shots into a set a client would pay for — and how do I charge fairly for it?

Skills:
importing and organising files; cropping and straightening; exposure correction; colour temperature and saturation; subtle retouching and blemish removal; batch editing; honest editing limits; selecting the best work; portfolio structure and flow; package pricing in naira; client workflow (brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up); consent and model releases; brief reading; presentation.

Sessions:
S4 Basic Photo Editing, S5 Building a Portfolio and Pricing Photography, S6 Capstone: Photo Shoot and Portfolio.

Mini-project:
a consistent 5-image edited set plus the first draft portfolio page.

Assignment:
Assignment 4 — "Edit a Set, Not a Single" (S4) and Assignment 5 — "My Price List and Client Workflow Sheet" (S5).

Deliverables:
a matched, consistently edited 5-image set; a draft portfolio page; a one-page price list with at least three packages in naira; a signed consent/release template; the complete capstone mini portfolio.

Quality standards:
the 5-image set looks like one shoot (matching white balance, contrast and colour); straight lines are straight; edits are believable — no sky replaced, no body reshaped, no fake background; prices are written as packages with what is included, described as examples, not promises of income.

Assessment focus:
Practical 4 (editing), Practical 5 (portfolio and pricing), Assignments 4–5, the Simulation, the Capstone (30%) and the Viva/Demo (5%).

Capstone contribution:
Week 2 *is* the capstone: editing skill, portfolio judgement, pricing and consent practice all feed the final themed shoot and mini portfolio presented in S6.

S1 — Photography Foundations (Week 1, Module 1).
The opening session asks what makes a good photograph, and learners compare strong and weak images to name the difference: clarity, light, composition, moment, purpose. They learn the exposure triangle in simplified form (why an image comes out dark, bright or blurry), phone vs dedicated camera, what megapixels mean, and how focus works. Practically, they set up the camera (grid, resolution, no beauty filter), tap to focus, lock focus and exposure, and shoot sharp, correctly exposed frames. It ends with a drill assignment and the ethics reminder: ask before you photograph a person.

S2 — Composition and Lighting (Week 1, Module 1).
This session trains the eye. Learners apply the rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry and perspective, shooting each technique as they learn it so every rule has a picture behind it. They then study light — the difference between a snapshot and a photograph — including golden hour, window light and open shade, why harsh midday sun is unflattering, and how backlighting ruins a subject, comparing good and bad light on the same subject. The assignment is a four-image composition series and a four-image light study.

S3 — Shooting People, Products and Events (Week 1, Module 1).
Learners apply foundations and composition to the three subjects that earn money. In portraits they put a subject at ease, use simple posing basics and get a sharp, flattering frame. In products they build a clean scene, manage reflections, and produce an image fit for a WhatsApp Business catalogue or Jiji listing. In events they work changing light, capture key moments and stay sharp. Consent is confirmed for every person photographed, and the session closes Week 1's foundations folder.

S4 — Basic Photo Editing (Week 2, Module 2).
Learners open Snapseed or Lightroom Mobile and learn an edit discipline: do less, but do it well. They crop and straighten first, correct exposure, adjust colour temperature and saturation, then make local touch-ups — blemish removal that keeps natural skin texture. They batch-edit so a whole set gets the same look, and see a deliberately over-edited image to understand the line. The session ends honestly: editing can fix light, colour and small distractions, not a blurry subject or poor composition, and must never mislead.

S5 — Building a Portfolio and Pricing Photography (Week 2, Module 2).
Learners learn that a portfolio is the right photos in the right order, not "all my best photos." They select ruthlessly, sequence a set that flows, and assemble a first portfolio page in Canva. They then learn to charge: per hour versus package, how to build three simple packages in naira with clear deliverables, and how to write a client workflow sheet (brief → quote → shoot → edit → deliver → follow-up). Consent and releases are covered, including parent/guardian consent for under-18s. A timed simulation from a short client brief closes the session.

S6 — Capstone: Photo Shoot and Portfolio (Week 2, Module 2).
The final session is a working photo day. Learners take their chosen brief — a product set for a fictional Port Harcourt small business or a portrait set for a fictional client — plan the shoot with a shot list, shoot it, select the strongest frames, edit the set consistently, and assemble a mini portfolio. Each learner presents in a short talk: the brief, light, compositions, edits, consent obtained and what they would do differently. Peers and the instructor give structured feedback, and the course closes.

10. ASSIGNMENT AND ASSESSMENT SCHEDULE

10.1 Weighting (total = 100%)

Component	Weight	What it measures
Practicals	15%	Hands-on camera, composition, lighting, shooting and editing skill, observed in class
Assignments	15%	Take-home tasks (focus and exposure drills, composition and light series, edited set, price list)
Knowledge checks	15%	Short quizzes confirming understanding of fundamentals, light, editing and ethics
Simulation	15%	A realistic brief under mild time pressure: plan → shoot → edit → present a delivery-ready set
Capstone	30%	The full themed shoot and mini portfolio (planned, shot, edited, consented, assembled)

Viva / demo	5%	The short spoken presentation defending the portfolio
Attendance	5%	Being present and engaged across the 6 sessions
Total	**100%**	

10.2 Grading Scale

Grade	Score	Meaning
A	80% and above	Excellent — strong, consistent, client-ready work
B	65%–79%	Good — solid work with minor gaps
C	50%–64%	Satisfactory — meets the minimum standard
D	40%–49%	Weak — significant gaps; needs remedial work
F	Below 40%	Fail — does not meet the standard

10.3 Passing Rule

To pass and be recommended for certification, a learner must achieve

at least 50% overall AND pass the capstone
. A high score in quizzes or attendance can **never** replace demonstrated camera competence: if the capstone is not passed, the learner does not pass, regardless of other marks. Attendance is recorded (5%) but is **not** a substitute for competence. The simulation runs in S5 and the capstone is marked against the rubric in `Part6_Capstone_Project`.

11. MINI-PROJECT SEQUENCE

The mini-projects are session-sized deliverables that build piece by piece into the capstone: every mini-project is a component of the final portfolio or of the judgement needed to produce it.

Source	Mini-project	Feeds capstone as...
S1	Focus and exposure drill set	The technical floor — every capstone image must pass this standard
S2	Composition series (4 images) + light study (4 images)	Composition and lighting decisions visible in the final set
S3	Foundations folder: person, product and scene shots (12 images total)	First selects — the start of the chosen capstone track
S4	Consistent 5-image edited set	The editing style applied to the capstone portfolio
S5	First portfolio page (Canva) + price list + workflow sheet	The portfolio format and the commercial framing of the work
S6	Themed shoot + full mini portfolio + presentation	The final deliverable

Each learner keeps a working folder, e.g.

`CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname`
, containing raw shots, selects, edits, consent forms and the final portfolio. By the end of S5 a learner who completed every mini-project already owns most of the capstone, removing the "big scary final project" feeling and replacing it with steady, visible progress.

Title:
Mini Portfolio: A Themed Photo Set for a Port Harcourt Client.

Context (two tracks — learner chooses one):

- **Track A — Product.** *Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices* is an authorised **fictional** small food business in Port Harcourt needing a clean, appetising, consistent set of product images for its WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram, shot on a simple surface in natural light.
- **Track B — Portrait.** *Ms. Amaka* is an authorised **fictional** Port Harcourt entrepreneur needing a small set of professional, natural portraits for her business profile and social pages. She is an adult; for any real person under 18 photographed for practice instead, written parent/guardian consent is mandatory before the shutter is pressed.

Learners may substitute a real or fictional client (a salon, tailor, church, shop or personal brand) with instructor approval — the same brief, consent and delivery rules apply. All capstone businesses and documents are invented for the course.

Required components:
(1) a one-page brief and shot plan (client need, concept, shot list, light plan, location); (2) a themed set of at least 5 finished images (up to 8), edited consistently; (3) a contact sheet of selects; (4) consent/release evidence — signed consent for every identifiable person in the final set (parent/guardian for under-18s), or a note that no identifiable third parties appear; (5) a mini portfolio assembled in Canva as a PDF or grid with a title page (name, course, date, client); (6) a short presentation and viva defending the work.

Checkpoints:

Checkpoint	When	What is checked
Checkpoint 1	End of Week 1 (S3)	Brief chosen; shot plan drafted; consent arrangements confirmed; test shots started
Checkpoint 2	S5	Selects chosen; first consistent edits; portfolio format decided; price list drafted
Checkpoint 3	S6	Full set shot, edited and assembled; presentation ready

Marking:
the capstone (30%) is marked against the rubric in `Part6_Capstone_Project/01_Capstone_Assessment_Rubric.md`; the viva/demo adds 5%. Criteria: technical quality (sharp, correctly exposed), composition, lighting, consistency of edit, completeness of brief and consent evidence, and the ability to explain choices.

What success looks like:
the set is sharp, well-lit, honestly edited and clearly usable by the client; the images hang together as one body of work; every consent requirement is met; and the learner can explain every decision — where they stood, where the light came from, what they cropped, what they refused to fake. It need not be studio-perfect, only honest, complete, entry-level professional work.

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13. CERTIFICATION AND COMPETENCE REQUIREMENTS

Certificate issued:
CEA Certificate in Photography, issued on completion of the **themed shoot and mini portfolio**.

Requirements to be recommended for certification:
(1) **attendance** of at least **5 of the 6 sessions** (5% of the score and a gate to certification, but not a replacement for competence); (2) all **assignments** submitted and judged satisfactory; (3) a **pass** on the capstone themed shoot and mini portfolio; (4) an **overall score** of at least **50%**; and (5) a **presentation** of the portfolio in the viva/demo.

Verification:
the certificate can be verified at **cea.ng/certificates/verify** (quote your certificate reference when sharing it).

Honest statement of what the certificate means.
The CEA Photography certificate certifies that the holder is a competent **entry-level photographer**. It means they can plan a simple shoot, control a phone camera, compose and light a subject with natural light, photograph people, products and events

It does NOT mean

the holder is a professional studio photographer, photojournalist, commercial retoucher, or an expert in advanced lighting and high-end gear — deeper, longer specialisations. This course is an honest first step that prepares a graduate for small real-world work (a shop's product images, a church's event photos, a first portrait client) while knowing there is more to learn. CEA will not over-claim, and graduates should not either: honesty about skill is part of the competency profile (Section 4).

Continuing the journey ("From Zero to Expert, Together").

Graduates can pursue advanced CEA courses (advanced editing, studio and flash lighting, or event photography) and grow their portfolio from the capstone set, which is designed to be the first real item in it.

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14. QUALITY ASSURANCE AND COURSE MAINTENANCE

- **Instructor readiness:** read this document and the relevant session note before each class, and prepare the sample images, props and fictional briefs listed in each session.
- **Consistency:** the running capstone example, the ₦30,000 fee, the "no paid subscription" rule, the consent rule and the honest-editing line must be applied across all six sessions.
- **Outcomes alignment:** this document and the session materials are checked against LO1–LO8 so every outcome is taught, practised and assessed; a self-check QA pass confirms outcomes aligned, ethics present, all learning modes covered, and assessment weights summing to 100%.
- **Evidence retention:** consent forms, marked practicals and capstone rubrics are retained for the run and available for verification queries; no learner is excluded by equipment — pairing and academy devices are the standard fallback, never a lower standard of work.
- **Review cycle:** reviewed after each full run and updated from instructor and learner feedback (phone models, app changes, pricing realism, client examples). Version 1.0 was approved in October 2026.
- **Companion documents:** `Part2_Session_Materials` (six session notes), `Part3_Learner_Workbook`, `Part5_Practical_Lab_Pack` (briefs and templates), `Part6_Capstone_Project` (rubric and instructor guide), and `Part7_QA_Audit`.

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15. ETHICS, CONSENT AND HONEST PRACTICE (read this carefully)

Photography is a profession built on trust — trust that you will not embarrass, exploit or mislead anyone. Every learner must follow these rules at all times, in class and outside it:

1. **Consent before every photograph of a person.** Ask first, every time. If someone says no, put the camera down — no argument, no exceptions. Class practice uses classmates who have agreed to participate.
2. **Parent or guardian consent for anyone under 18.** A signature from a parent or guardian is required before a person under 18 is photographed for practice, portfolio or client use. Without it, do not shoot.
3. **Respect public places and privacy.** In markets, churches, streets and events, be unobtrusive, follow the rules of the location, and never photograph people in private moments or in ways that could humiliate them.
4. **No misleading edits.** Do not change a product's true appearance, fake a background, reshape a body beyond normal correction, or edit in a way that lies to a client or viewer. Editing cleans up a photograph; it does not manufacture a false one.
5. **Honesty about skills and work.** Never claim to be more experienced than you are, never present stock or someone else's image as your own, and never promise results you cannot deliver. If unsure, say so and check with the instructor.
6. **Releases and ownership.** Get written permission before using a person's image commercially, and deliver a client's product or brand images as agreed — do not reuse them in your portfolio without permission.
7. **Report, don't exploit.** If you take an image that harms or embarrasses someone, stop using it and tell the person or the instructor. Do not spread it.
8. **Consequences.** Breaking these rules is a serious breach of academy conduct and may end your participation in the course.

Ask first. Edit honestly. Claim only what you can do.

END OF COURSE DESIGN DOCUMENT

Document version:
Version 1.0 — October 2026. Approved for delivery. **Next document:** Part 2 — Session Materials, beginning with Session 1: Photography Foundations.

Next: Session 1 — Photography Foundations.

PART 2

Session Materials

SESSION 1 â€" PHOTOGRAPHY FOUNDATIONS

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" PHOTOGRAPHY

SESSION 1 â€" PHOTOGRAPHY FOUNDATIONS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	1 of 6
Session title	Photography Foundations
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: "See and Shoot" (Foundations)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with photography)
Prerequisite knowledge	Basic smartphone use â€" opening apps, taking a photo, typing. No prior photography knowledge assumed. If a learner struggles with the phone basics, pair them with a confident learner for the first practical.
Connection to previous work	This is the first session of the course. There is no previous photography session. It connects to everyday life: almost every learner has a phone camera and has taken photos that came out dark, blurry or crooked.
Preparation before class	Print the three "same subject, three results" comparison sets (Section D); a projector connected to the instructor's phone for live camera demonstration; a whiteboard for the exposure triangle diagram; the "Camera Setup Checklist" (Section H) printed per learner; learners' phones fully charged with at least 1 GB free storage; confirm the class understands this is a practical, hands-on course with a consent rule for photographing people.

Instructor note on tone:
This session must feel *empowering*, not technical. Learners should leave feeling "I understand what my phone camera is doing and I can control it," not "photography is too complicated." Keep the mood practical, encouraging and connected to their real lives â€" their shops, their churches, their families.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** in their own words what makes a good photograph, using five key words: clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose.
2. **Describe** the exposure triangle in simplified terms â€" aperture, shutter speed and ISO â€" and explain why an image comes out dark, bright or blurry.
3. **Distinguish** between a phone camera and a dedicated camera, explaining what each is good for and what megapixels actually tell you.
4. **Explain** how focus works on a phone and demonstrate tap-to-focus, focus lock and focus check.
5. **Set up** a phone camera sensibly: grid lines on, high resolution, HDR deliberate, beauty filters off.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a working camera (Android or iPhone; any phone made in the last several years is capable).
- Instructor's phone connected to a projector or large screen for live camera demonstration.
- A phone tripod or improvised stand (stack of books, selfie stick) for the instructor demonstration.
- An academy reflector or improvised white card (A4 paper works) for bouncing light.

Software

- The phone's built-in camera app (default shooting tool â€" no special app needed for this session).
- No editing software needed today; editing begins in Session 4.

Accounts

- None required this session.

Sample files

- **Three comparison sets** printed or projected (Section D): each set shows the same subject photographed three ways â€" well, poorly and acceptably â€" so learners can name the difference.
- **Camera Setup Checklist** (Section H) â€" one printed page per learner.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 1.1 â€" "What Makes a Good Photo?" (a table with the five quality words and room for learners to write their own definition).
- Worksheet 1.2 â€" "Diagnose the Image" (four sample images; learners label each as dark, bright, blurry or flat and explain why).

Tools

- A whiteboard and markers for drawing the exposure triangle.
- A ruler or straight edge for drawing the triangle neatly.

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a capable phone

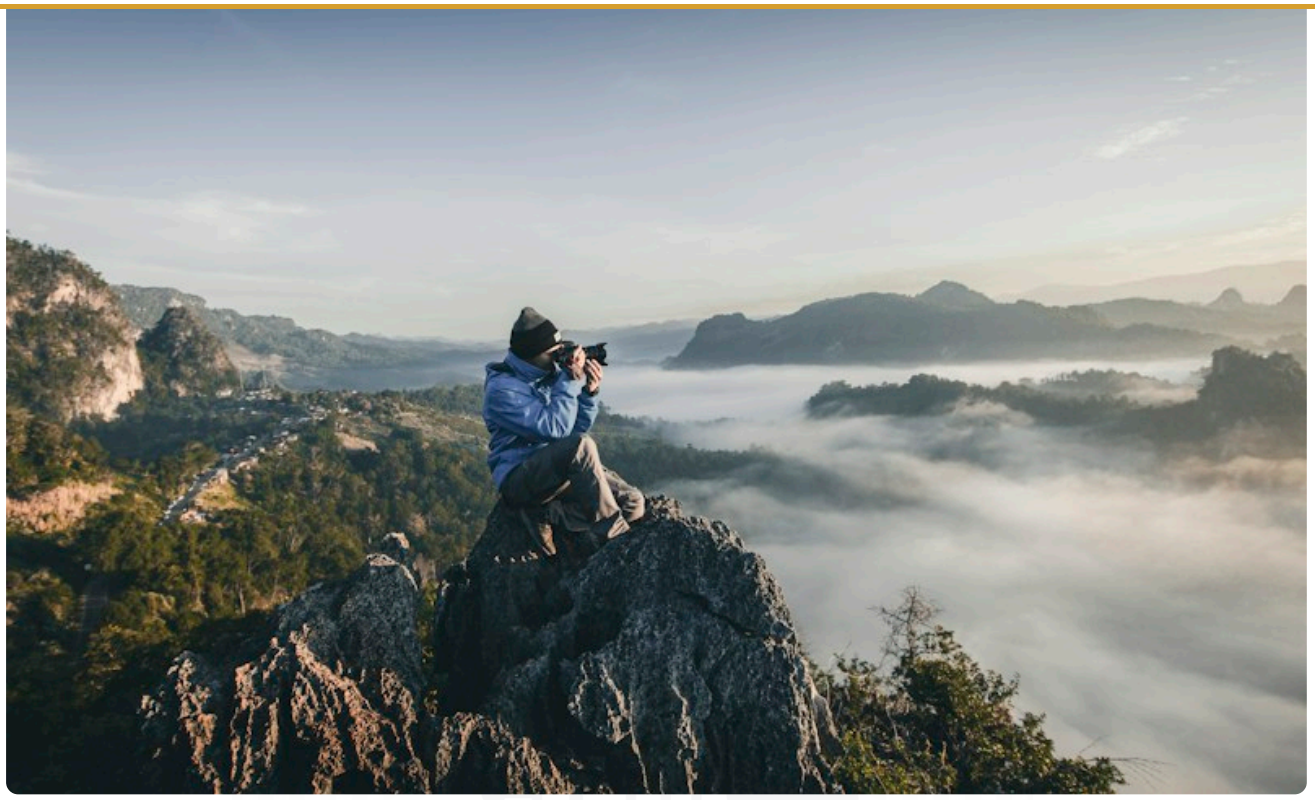
- Any phone with a working camera works. A learner without a phone may pair with a classmate, use an academy phone or use an academy computer with a webcam for the focus and exposure exercises. They must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

Safety note for the instructor (read aloud at the start):
Before we photograph any person in this class â€" including classmates â€" we ask for their permission first. If someone says no, we put the camera down. No exceptions. This is a rule of the academy, not a suggestion.

Suggested visuals:



- â€" the tool of the trade

- 

â€" seeing light and moment

- 

â€" reviewing shots after a shoot



- â€" camera in hand on location



- â€" planning a shoot before you go

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup:
On the projector, show the same subject â€" a bottle of water on a table â€" photographed three ways:

- **Photo A (good):** Sharp, well-lit, clean background, subject centred with space around it.

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What the instructor says:

> *"Good morning. Look at these three photos. Same bottle, same table, same room. But one looks like it could be in a shop's advert, one looks like a mistake, and one is somewhere in between. Hands up â€" which one would you use for your business? â€¦ Photo A, almost everyone agrees. Now, turn to the person next to you and tell them: what is different about Photo A? You have 90 seconds."*

Expected learner response:
Learners will say things like "it is brighter," "you can see it clearly," "the background is clean," "it is not blurry," "it looks professional." Accept all answers and write the key words on the board: **bright, sharp, clean, clear, professional.**

Then reveal the lesson:
Say clearly:

> *"Those words â€" bright, sharp, clean, clear â€" are not luck. They are choices a photographer makes. Today you will learn to make those choices on your own phone. By the end of this session, you will be able to look at a photo and say exactly what is wrong with it, and then fix it."*

Why this opener works:
It uses a subject every learner can recognise, it produces instant opinions ("I would never use Photo B"), and it introduces the five quality words before any technical explanation, so the lecture has a hook to hang on.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1:
"What happens when you press the shutter button on your phone camera? What does the camera actually do?"

- Expected answer: It opens a hole (the lens), lets light in for a moment, and records what it sees. If a learner says "it takes a picture," press gently: "Yes, but *how*? What has to happen for the picture to look right?"
- Common gap: Learners treat the camera as a black box. Clarify: "The camera is a light-capturing machine. Light comes in through the lens, and the camera decides how much light to let in and for how long. Those decisions determine whether your photo is bright, dark or blurry."

Question 2:
"Have you ever taken a photo that came out too dark or too bright? What do you think went wrong?"

- Expected answer: Learners will describe real experiences â€" a night photo that was black, a photo of a person against a window where the face was dark, a photo in bright sun that looked washed out.
- Common gap: Learners blame the phone. Clarify: "The phone did exactly what it was told â€" but it was told the wrong thing. Today you learn to tell it the right thing."

Question 3:
"What is the difference between a smartphone camera and a 'proper' camera â€" like a DSLR?"

- Expected answer: Learners may say the proper camera is better, or bigger, or more expensive. Accept this and refine: "A dedicated camera has a bigger lens and more manual control. But the phone in your pocket can produce excellent photographs when you understand the same principles. The principles matter more than the price tag."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *button, so you can control it. Think of it like driving a car. Right now most of us are pressing the accelerator and hoping. Today you learn what the brakes and steering wheel do."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 5 extra minutes opening the camera app on the projector and pointing out the shutter button, the viewfinder and the settings icon before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What makes a good photograph

The idea.
A good photograph is not an accident. It is the result of a photographer making deliberate choices about five things: what the photo is for, how the subject is arranged, how light falls on the subject, whether the subject is sharp, and whether the right moment was captured.

The five quality words (teach these and return to them all session):

Quality word	Plain-English meaning	How to recognise it
Clarity	The subject is sharp â€" you can see the details, not a blurry mess	Zoom in on the subject: can you see texture, edges, fine details?
Light	The subject is correctly exposed â€" not too dark, not too bright	Look at the subject's face or the product: can you see it clearly without squinting or losing detail?
Composition	The subject is arranged in the frame in a way that is pleasing and intentional	Does the photo look like someone *chose* where everything goes, or did they just point and shoot?
Moment	The photo captures the right instant â€" the smile, the action, the expression	Does the photo feel alive, or does it feel like a stiff, awkward snapshot?
Purpose	The photo does the job it was meant to do â€" sell a product, tell a story, capture a memory	If someone asked you to take this photo, would they be happy with the result?

Why these five words matter.
They are the vocabulary you will use for the rest of the course. In Session 2 you will learn composition techniques. In Session 3 you will learn to capture the right moment. Today you focus on the first two â€" clarity and light â€" because without those, nothing else matters. A beautifully composed photo that is blurry is still a bad photo.

Real-life comparison.
Think of a plate of food at a restaurant. If the food is beautifully arranged on the plate (composition), the chef is skilled (moment), and the dish is exactly what you ordered (purpose) â€" but the lights are so dim you cannot see the food (light), and the plate is spinning so fast everything is a smear (clarity) â€" you would send it back. A photograph works the same way. Light and clarity are the foundation; everything else is built on top.

Important limitation / misconception.
Learners often think good photographs require expensive cameras or professional lighting. This is false. The phone in your pocket, used well, can produce photographs that are sharp, well-lit and usable for a business. The difference between a snapshot and a photograph is not the camera â€" it is the photographer's choices.

How a learner recognises a good photograph.
Show any photo and ask five questions: Is the subject sharp? Is the light right? Is the composition intentional? Did it capture the right moment? Does it serve its purpose? If the answer is yes to all five, it is a good photograph.

F.2 The exposure triangle â€" simplified

decisions determine how bright or dark your photo is. Photographers call these three decisions the **exposure triangle**.

Plain-English definition.

The exposure triangle is a way of understanding three camera settings that control how much light reaches the sensor:

Setting	What it does	Simple analogy	What happens when it is wrong
Aperture	How wide the lens opening is â€" how much light comes in	Like a window: a big window lets in more light than a small window	If the aperture is too small (or the light is low), the photo comes out dark
Shutter speed	How long the shutter stays open â€" how long light is collected	Like blinking: a slow blink collects more light than a fast blink	If the shutter is too fast in low light, the photo comes out dark; if the subject moves during a slow shutter, the photo comes out blurry
ISO	How sensitive the camera's sensor is to light	Like turning up the volume on a quiet radio	A high ISO brightens a dark scene but adds grain (noise); a low ISO gives a cleaner image but needs more light

The key insight (say this slowly):

> *"These three settings work together. If you make one of them let in less light, you must compensate with one of the others. A photographer's job is to balance them so the photo is correctly exposed â€" not too dark, not too bright."*

How this works on a phone (the crucial bridge):

On a professional camera, the photographer controls aperture, shutter speed and ISO directly. On a phone, the camera app makes these decisions automatically â€" but you can influence them:

- **Tap to focus:** Tapping the screen tells the camera where to focus *and* how much light to let in for that spot. Tapping a dark area brightens the photo; tapping a bright area darkens it.
- **Exposure adjustment slider:** On most phone cameras, after you tap, a small sun icon or slider appears. Slide it up to brighten, down to darken.
- **HDR (High Dynamic Range):** The camera takes several photos at different brightness levels and combines them. Useful for high-contrast scenes (a person against a bright window). Can be turned on or off in camera settings.

Why photos come out dark (the three usual reasons):

1. **Not enough light in the scene** â€" the room is dim, it is evening, the subject is in shadow.
2. **The camera exposed for the wrong part of the scene** â€" you photographed a person against a bright window; the camera exposed for the window (bright) and the face went dark.
3. **The shutter was too fast** â€" in low light, the camera used a fast shutter to avoid blur, which collected too little light.

Why photos come out bright (washed out):

1. **Too much light** â€" shooting in bright sun without adjusting exposure.
2. **The camera exposed for a dark area** â€" tapping a dark shadow makes the camera brighten everything, and the rest of the photo becomes overexposed.

Why photos come out blurry (the two usual reasons):

1. **Camera shake** â€" the photographer's hands moved during the exposure. Most common in low light when the shutter is slower.
2. **Subject movement** â€" the subject moved during the exposure. Common with children, pets, people walking, or anything that is not still.
3. **Focus error** â€" the camera focused on the wrong thing (the background instead of the subject, or nothing at all in very low light).

Real-life comparison.

from high ISO). A good cook balances all three, a good photographer does the same.

Misconception to correct.
"If my photo is dark, I can just brighten it later in editing." Partially true â€" but brightening a very dark photo in editing also brightens the noise and grain, making it look rough. It is always better to get the exposure right in the camera. Editing can fix small problems; it cannot fix a badly exposed photo completely.

F.3 Phone camera vs dedicated camera

The idea.
A phone camera and a dedicated camera (DSLR or mirrorless) are different tools with different strengths. Understanding the differences helps you choose the right tool and understand what your phone can and cannot do.

Feature	Phone camera	Dedicated camera (DSLR / mirrorless)
Lens size	Small â€" limited by the phone's thin body	Large â€" interchangeable lenses for different purposes
Sensor size	Small â€" collects less light, more noise in dark scenes	Large â€" collects more light, cleaner images in dark scenes
Manual control	Limited â€" most settings are automatic or semi-automatic	Full â€" the photographer controls aperture, shutter speed and ISO directly
Zoom	Digital zoom (cropping the image â€" loses quality)	Optical zoom (the lens magnifies â€" keeps quality)
Portability	Always with you â€" you never miss a moment	Bulky â€" you must carry it deliberately
Cost	Already owned	â‚¦300,000â€"â‚¦1,500,000+ for a body and lens
Best for	Everyday photography, social media, quick business shots, learning	Professional work, low light, sports, wildlife, studio work

What megapixels actually tell you (and what they do not):

A megapixel is one million pixels â€" tiny dots of colour that make up a digital image. A 12-megapixel camera produces images made of 12 million dots. A 48-megapixel camera produces images made of 48 million dots.

- **What megapixels tell you:** How large you can print the photo or how much you can crop it and still have a usable image. A 12-megapixel image can be printed at A4 size and look sharp. A 48-megapixel image can be cropped to a small portion and still print sharply.
- **What megapixels do NOT tell you:** How good the photo looks. A 12-megapixel photo from a large sensor with a good lens will look better than a 48-megapixel photo from a small sensor with a poor lens, especially in low light. Megapixels are about *quantity of detail*, not *quality of light*.

Why this matters for this course:
Learners sometimes feel their phone is inferior because it has "only" 12 megapixels. Reassure them: for WhatsApp Business catalogues, Instagram, Facebook and most small-business uses, 12 megapixels is more than enough. The sensor size and lens quality matter more for image quality, and the photographer's choices matter most of all.

Real-life comparison.
A phone camera is like a bicycle: it is always available, it gets you where you need to go, and it costs nothing extra. A dedicated camera is like a car: it is faster, more comfortable on long journeys, and more capable â€" but you have to plan to bring it, it costs money, and it does not help you if it is at home. For most everyday photography, the bicycle is exactly what you need.

F.4 How focus works on a phone

The idea.

The three focus skills every photographer needs:

1. Tap to focus.

- Open the camera app.
- Look at the screen. Tap the subject you want to be sharp.
- A focus square or circle appears around where you tapped. The camera now focuses on that spot.
- On most phones, tapping also sets the exposure (brightness) for that spot â€” this is why tapping a bright window makes the rest of the photo dark, and tapping a dark face brightens the photo.

2. Lock focus and exposure.

- After tapping, press and hold the focus square for 2â€“3 seconds (on iPhone) or tap the lock icon (on many Android phones).
- The focus and exposure are now locked. You can move the camera slightly without the focus changing.
- This is useful when you want to focus on a subject but compose the photo differently â€” focus first, then reframe.

3. Focus check.

- After taking the photo, zoom in on it (pinch to zoom in the gallery).
- Look at the subject's eyes (for a person) or the key detail (for a product). Are they sharp?
- If they are blurry, the photo is not usable â€” no amount of editing will fix a blurry subject.

Common focus mistakes and how to avoid them:

- **Not tapping:** Letting the camera choose the focus point automatically. The camera may focus on the background, a distracting object, or nothing in particular. Always tap your subject.
- **Tapping too late:** Tapping and immediately shooting. The camera needs a moment to adjust focus. Tap, wait half a second, then shoot.
- **Moving after tapping:** Tapping to focus, then moving the camera significantly before shooting. The focus may shift. Lock focus if you need to move.

Real-life comparison.
Focus is like using a magnifying glass to look at something small. You move the glass until the subject is sharp. If you move your hand, the subject blurs. Tap-to-focus is you placing the magnifying glass exactly where you need it.

F.5 Setting up your phone camera

The idea.
Before you take a serious photograph, set up your camera so it behaves predictably. Four settings matter for beginners:

1. Grid lines on.

- Grid lines are two horizontal and two vertical lines that divide the screen into nine equal rectangles (a 3Ã—3 grid).
- They help you compose photos using the rule of thirds (taught in Session 2).
- How to turn on: iPhone â€” Settings > Camera > Grid. Android â€” open the camera app, tap the settings icon (usually a gear), look for "Grid" or "Grid lines," turn it on.

2. High resolution.

- Make sure your camera is set to take photos at the full resolution of the sensor.
- iPhone: Settings > Camera > Formats â€” choose "High Efficiency" (default) or "Most Compatible."
- Android: Open camera app > Settings > Photo size or Resolution â€” choose the highest number of megapixels available.
- Why this matters: if you accidentally set a low resolution, your photos will look soft when printed or viewed on a larger screen.

3. HDR â€” know what it does, use it deliberately.

and dark foreground).

- Turn it off when: photographing moving subjects (HDR can create ghosting or blur) or when you want a specific artistic effect.
- iPhone: Settings > Camera â€" turn HDR on or off. Android: HDR setting is usually in the camera app itself.

4. Beauty filters off.

- Many phone cameras and social media apps apply automatic "beauty" filters that smooth skin, enlarge eyes, or alter facial features.
- For this course: turn them off. We want photographs that look like the real person, not a filtered version.
- Why: beauty filters create unrealistic expectations and can make a person look unnatural. In business photography, they can be misleading.
- How to turn off: Look for "Beauty," "Smooth," "Face," or "Filters" in your camera app settings and turn them off.

The Camera Setup Checklist (Worksheet 1.3):
Before every photo shoot in this course, run through this checklist:

- ☐ Grid lines are ON
- ☐ Resolution is set to the highest available
- ☐ HDR is set appropriately for the scene (on for high contrast, off for movement)
- ☐ Beauty filters are OFF
- ☐ Lens is clean (wipe with a soft cloth)
- ☐ Storage has at least 500 MB free

Real-life comparison.
Setting up your camera is like preparing a kitchen before cooking. You wash your hands, check you have the right ingredients, and make sure the stove is working. If you skip preparation, the meal may still be edible â€" but it will not be as good as it could be.

F.6 The sharpness routine â€" getting sharp photos every time

The idea.
Sharpness is the foundation of a good photograph. A blurry photo is unusable, no matter how good the composition or light. Here is a repeatable routine for getting sharp photos:

The 5-Step Sharpness Routine:

Step 1: Hold the phone steady.

- Hold the phone with both hands.
- Tuck your elbows into your sides.
- If possible, lean against a wall or rest the phone on a solid surface.
- If using a tripod or improvised stand (books, selfie stick), lock it in place.

Step 2: Tap to focus on the subject.

- Tap the subject on the screen.
- Wait half a second for the camera to adjust.
- Check the focus square â€" is it on the right spot?

Step 3: Check the exposure.

- Is the subject correctly exposed (not too dark, not too bright)?
- If not, use the exposure slider (slide up to brighten, down to darken).

Step 4: Check the background.

- If so, move the camera or the subject.

Step 5: Take several frames.

- Take at least 3 photos of the same scene.
- Do not delete any until you have reviewed them on a larger screen.
- Why: one frame may be slightly blurry, one may have the subject blinking, one may be perfect. Taking several frames increases your chances of getting a sharp, usable image.

Why taking several frames matters:
Even professional photographers take multiple frames. The difference between a professional and an amateur is not that the professional always gets it right on the first try â€" it is that the professional takes enough tries to guarantee a good result.

Real-life comparison.
The sharpness routine is like checking your work before submitting it. A student who writes an exam answer and hands it in without checking will make silly mistakes. A student who checks their work catches those mistakes. The sharpness routine is checking your work before you commit to it.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- A good photograph has five qualities: clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose.
- The exposure triangle â€" aperture, shutter speed and ISO â€" controls how bright or dark your photo is.
- On a phone, you influence the exposure through tap-to-focus and the exposure slider.
- A phone camera is a legitimate tool for business and everyday photography; megapixels measure detail quantity, not quality.
- Tap to focus, lock focus and focus check are the three focus skills every photographer needs.
- Set up your camera: grid on, high resolution, HDR deliberate, beauty filters off.
- The 5-step sharpness routine â€" steady, focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames â€" produces sharp photos reliably.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Aperture] --> D[Exposure]
    B[Shutter Speed] --> D
    C[ISO] --> D
    D --> E[Good photo]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A phone connected to the projector, camera app open.
- A simple subject on a table: a bottle of water, a notebook, or a piece of fruit.
- A second subject in a different location: a person (a willing colleague or a mannequin/photograph of a person) against a bright window.
- A stack of books or a phone tripod for the steady-hold demonstration.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" the exposure triangle in action (5 minutes)

Say:
"Watch the screen. I am going to take three photos of this bottle. Same bottle, same position. But I will change one thing each time â€" and you will see the result."

level, the colours.

Take Photo 2:
Tap the background (the wall behind the bottle). "Now I tapped the wall. The camera exposed for the wall, which is bright. What happens to the bottle?" Show the result. "The bottle is darker â€” almost a silhouette. The camera let in less light because I tapped something bright."

Take Photo 3:
Tap the bottle, then use the exposure slider to brighten. "Now I tapped the bottle and slid the exposure up. What happens?" Show the result. "The bottle is brighter â€” maybe too bright. This is what happens when you over-expose."

Say:
"One tap, one slider â€” that is how you control exposure on a phone. The camera does the maths; you make the decisions."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€” focus control (4 minutes)

Say:
"Now watch focus. I am going to focus on the bottle, then on the background."

Focus on the bottle:
Tap the bottle. Show the focus square. "The square is on the bottle. The bottle is sharp."

Focus on the background:
Tap the wall behind the bottle. "Now the square is on the wall. What happened to the bottle?" Show the result. "The bottle is blurry â€” out of focus. The camera focused on what I tapped, not on the bottle."

Lock focus:
Tap and hold the focus square. "Now I locked the focus. Watch â€” I can move the camera slightly and the focus stays on the bottle." Move the camera a little, take a photo. Show it. "Sharp. Lock focus is useful when you want to compose the photo differently after focusing."

Say:
"Focus is not automatic in the way most people think. The camera focuses where you tell it. If you do not tell it, it guesses â€” and it guesses wrong often enough to ruin photos."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€” the sharpness routine (4 minutes)

Say:
"Now I will run the 5-step sharpness routine on a real subject. Watch and count the steps."

Step 1:
Hold the phone with both hands, elbows tucked. "Steady hold."

Step 2:
Tap the subject on screen. "Tap to focus."

Step 3:
Check the exposure, adjust the slider. "Check exposure."

Step 4:
Check the background â€” move the camera slightly to remove a distracting object. "Check background."

Step 5:
Take three photos in a row. "Take several frames."

Say:
"Five steps, every time. It becomes a habit â€” like brushing your teeth. You do not think about it after a while, but your photos are sharp because you do it."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€” before and after (2 minutes)

Show a sharp, well-exposed photo
(taken using the routine). "This is what happens with the routine. Same phone, same room, same subject. The difference is the photographer, not the camera."

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "What happened when I tapped the bright wall?" (The subject went dark.)
- "What is the difference between tapping the subject and tapping the background?" (The camera focuses and exposes for wherever you tap.)
- "Why take three photos instead of one?" (One might be blurry, one might have the subject blinking, one will be good.)
- "Can you fix a blurry photo in editing?" (No â€" editing cannot create detail that was not captured. Prevention is the only cure.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective:
With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner sets up their phone camera, applies the sharpness routine and produces three sharp, correctly exposed photographs of a real subject.

Starting materials:
Learner's own phone; the printed Camera Setup Checklist; a subject in the classroom (a classmate who has agreed, a bag, a plant, a book, a water bottle, or any object).

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Open your camera app. Turn on **grid lines** in your settings. (Instructor waits while learners find the setting; help those who cannot.)
2. Set **resolution to the highest available**. Check that **beauty filters are off**.
3. Choose your subject. It can be a classmate (ask their permission first â€" this is the consent rule), your bag, a plant, or any object on your desk.
4. **Step 1 â€" Steady hold:** Hold the phone with both hands, elbows tucked. If you have a surface nearby, rest your hands on it.
5. **Step 2 â€" Tap to focus:** Tap your subject on the screen. Wait half a second.
6. **Step 3 â€" Check exposure:** Is the subject too dark or too bright? Use the exposure slider to adjust.
7. **Step 4 â€" Check background:** Is anything distracting in the background? Move slightly to remove it.
8. **Step 5 â€" Take three frames:** Take three photos of the same scene without moving.
9. **Focus check:** Open each photo in your gallery and pinch to zoom in on the subject. Is it sharp? If not, repeat steps 4â€"8.
10. Repeat steps 4â€"9 for a second subject and a third subject.

Expected result:
Nine sharp, correctly exposed photographs (three per subject, three subjects) in the learner's gallery.

Points to pause and predict:

- After step 5: "Look at the focus square â€" is it on your subject? If it is on the background, what will happen?" (The subject will be blurry.)
- After step 8: "Why three frames? What might be wrong with frame one that is not wrong with frame three?" (Frame one might be slightly blurry from movement; the subject might blink in frame two; frame three is perfect.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner cannot find the grid setting â†' Show them on their phone. The location differs between iPhone and Android; walk to each learner and help.
- Learner's photos are consistently dark â†' Check if they are tapping a bright part of the scene. Have them tap the subject directly.

- Learner has a beauty filter on and cannot turn it off â†' Check the camera app settings; some phones have a separate "Beauty" mode in the camera app. Turn it off or switch to "Photo" mode.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Grid lines are ON
- ☐ Resolution is set to highest
- ☐ Beauty filters are OFF
- ☐ Three photos taken of subject 1, all sharp and correctly exposed
- ☐ Three photos taken of subject 2, all sharp and correctly exposed
- ☐ Three photos taken of subject 3, all sharp and correctly exposed
- ☐ Every photo has been focus-checked by zooming in

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task:
Photograph the same subject in three different lighting situations and diagnose the result.

Setup:
Choose one subject â€" a classmate, your bag, a bottle, or a plant. You will photograph it in three places:

1. **Near a window or in open shade** (good light).
2. **In a dim corner or against a bright background** (challenging light).
3. **In direct bright sun** (harsh light).

Requirements:

1. For each lighting situation, take at least one photo using the 5-step sharpness routine.
2. After each photo, use Worksheet 1.2 ("Diagnose the Image") to label the photo: is it **dark, bright, blurry or flat**?
3. Write one sentence explaining *why* you think it came out that way.

Constraints:

- Use only the built-in camera app â€" no filters, no editing.
- Photograph a classmate only if they have agreed. If not, use an object.
- Do not leave the building â€" find the three lighting situations inside or near the classroom.

Time allowance:
15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Three photos taken in three different lighting situations.
- Each photo is labelled with a diagnosis (dark / bright / blurry / flat) and a one-sentence reason.
- At least one photo is sharp and correctly exposed (the good-light photo).

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: "Good light" means the subject is clearly visible without squinting or being in shadow. A window with indirect light is good light.
- Hint 2: "Challenging light" means the subject is darker than the background, or the background is much brighter than the subject.
- Hint 3: If your photo is blurry, go back to Step 1 of the sharpness routine â€" hold the phone steadier.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Photo 2 â€" dim corner against bright background: Subject is dark, almost a silhouette. Diagnosis: **dark.** Reason: "The background is bright and the subject is in shadow. The camera exposed for the background, not the subject. I should have tapped the subject and brightened the exposure."

Photo 3 â€" direct bright sun: Harsh shadows on the subject's face or the object. Diagnosis: **flat or overly bright.** Reason: "Direct sun creates hard shadows and bright highlights. The photo looks contrasty and unflattering. Open shade or indirect light would be better."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Three photos taken in three different lighting situations (3)
- Each photo correctly diagnosed (3)
- At least one photo sharp and correctly exposed (2)
- Reason given is accurate (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation.
Chinedu runs a small phone accessory shop in Port Harcourt. He wants to post photos of his products â€" phone cases, earbuds, chargers â€" on his WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram. He takes photos on his phone during the day, in his shop, and posts them directly. His photos are dark, blurry and have cluttered backgrounds (other products, his hands, the counter). Customers rarely order from the photos; they prefer to come to the shop to see the products in person.

Relevant facts.

- Chinedu's phone is a recent model with a good 12-megapixel camera.
- He takes photos standing in his shop, holding the phone in one hand, the product in the other.
- He does not tap to focus â€" he just points and shoots.
- He has never changed any camera settings.
- His shop has a window that lets in good natural light, but he usually photographs under the fluorescent ceiling lights.

Decision point.
What is the main reason Chinedu's photos are not helping his business?

Possible approaches.

1. Buy a better phone with more megapixels.
2. Learn to use the camera he already has â€" tap to focus, expose correctly, use natural light, hold steady.
3. Hire a professional photographer once to take all his product photos.

Recommended solution.
Approach 2. Chinedu's phone is already capable of good photographs. His problem is not the camera â€" it is the photographer's choices. By learning to tap to focus, expose correctly, use the natural light from his window and hold the phone steady, he can produce photos that look professional and help sell his products.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 costs money (a new phone costs â‚¦150,000â€"â‚¦400,000) and does not solve the problem â€" a better phone used badly still produces bad photos.
- Approach 2 is free, takes a few hours to learn, and the skill stays with Chinedu forever. He can photograph new products himself whenever he needs to.
- Approach 3 works but costs money every time (a product photographer in Port Harcourt may charge â‚¦5,000â€"â‚¦20,000 for a small set). Chinedu has many products; hiring a photographer for all of them is expensive.

Professional connection.
Small business owners across Nigeria lose sales every day because of poor product photographs. A business that can produce its own clean, sharp product photos saves money and looks more professional. This is a skill that pays for itself many times over.

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide.

K.1 Not tapping to focus

Symptoms:
Photos where the subject is blurry but the background is sharp, or where everything looks slightly soft. **Likely cause:** The photographer let the camera choose the focus point automatically. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner to open a photo and zoom in on the subject. Is the subject sharp, or is something else sharp? **Corrective steps:** Tap the subject on the screen before every photo. Wait half a second before shooting. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is sharp when zoomed in. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make tapping a habit â€" tap before every single photo.

K.2 Photos consistently too dark

Symptoms:
Every photo looks dim, the subject is hard to see, details are lost in shadow. **Likely cause:** The photographer is tapping a bright part of the scene (or not tapping at all), so the camera exposes for the bright area and the subject goes dark. **How to investigate:** Check if the learner is tapping the subject or the background. Check if the exposure slider is being used. **Corrective steps:** Tap the subject directly. If it is still dark, slide the exposure slider up. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is clearly visible with detail. **How to prevent recurrence:** Always tap the subject; adjust exposure after tapping.

K.3 Photos consistently too bright (washed out)

Symptoms:
The photo looks pale, colours are faded, bright areas are pure white with no detail. **Likely cause:** Over-exposure â€" too much light reaching the sensor, often from tapping a dark area and not adjusting, or from shooting in very bright conditions without reducing exposure. **How to investigate:** Check the exposure slider â€" is it set too high? Check if the scene is very bright. **Corrective steps:** Tap the subject. If it is too bright, slide the exposure slider down. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject has natural colour and visible detail in both highlights and shadows. **How to prevent recurrence:** Check the photo immediately after taking it. If it looks washed out, adjust and retake.

K.4 Blurry photos from camera shake

Symptoms:
The whole photo is blurred, as if smeared slightly. **Likely cause:** The photographer's hands moved during the exposure, especially in low light when the shutter is slower. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner how they were holding the phone. Were they using one hand? Were they standing still or moving? **Corrective steps:** Hold the phone with both hands, elbows tucked. Rest on a solid surface if possible. Take the photo gently â€" do not jab the shutter button. **How to confirm resolved:** The photo is sharp, not smeared. **How to prevent recurrence:** Always use the two-handed hold. In low light, use a surface or a tripod.

K.5 Blurry photos from subject movement

Symptoms:
The subject is blurry but the background is sharp. **Likely cause:** The subject moved during the exposure â€" a person turned their head, a child moved, a hand shifted. **How to investigate:** Is the background sharp but the subject blurry? If so, the camera was steady but the subject moved. **Corrective steps:** Ask the subject to hold still. Take the photo quickly after focusing. Take several frames and pick the sharpest. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is sharp. **How to prevent recurrence:** For moving subjects, take many frames and choose the best. For portraits, ask the person to hold still and breathe out before you shoot.

K.6 Leaving beauty filters on

Symptoms:
People in photos look unnatural â€" skin is too smooth, eyes are too large, facial features are distorted. **Likely cause:** A beauty or smooth filter is active in the camera app or social media app. **How to investigate:** Look at a portrait photo â€" does the person's skin look like skin, or like plastic? **Corrective steps:** Turn off all beauty, smooth and face filters in the camera app settings. Turn off any "beauty mode" in the social media app before posting. **How to confirm resolved:** People in photos look

K.7 Not taking several frames

Symptoms:
The photographer takes one photo, it is slightly blurry or the subject blinked, and they have no alternative. **Likely cause:** The habit of taking a single frame and moving on. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner how many photos they took of their last subject. If the answer is one, this is the problem. **Corrective steps:** Take at least three frames of every scene. Review them and pick the best. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner always has a sharp, usable photo. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make "take three" a rule. It costs nothing â€” storage is cheap.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed:
A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€” look at the actual photo, ask the learner what they did, and confirm the cause before correcting. Teaching learners to diagnose before fixing is part of becoming a photographer.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title:
"Focus and Exposure Drills â€” My First Nine"

Purpose:
To practise the sharpness routine and exposure control on real subjects, producing a set of nine sharp, correctly exposed photographs that form the technical foundation of the capstone portfolio.

Realistic scenario.
You are a new photographer building your skill. Your client â€” a friend with a small business, or your own business â€” needs clear, professional-looking product photos. Before you can take those photos, you need to prove to yourself that you can consistently produce sharp, correctly exposed images on your phone.

Detailed instructions:

1. Find **three different subjects** in your home or neighbourhood: one person (with their permission), one product (a shoe, a bag, a plate of food, a phone accessory), and one scene (a street view, a garden, a room).
2. For each subject, use the **5-step sharpness routine** and take **at least three photos**.
3. Review all photos. Delete the blurry or poorly exposed ones. Keep only the sharp, correctly exposed ones.
4. From your keeps, select the **best three photos** (one per subject).
5. For each of the three, write one sentence: "*This photo is sharp and correctly exposed because I _____.*" (e.g., "â€¦because I tapped to focus on the subject and held the phone steady with both hands.")
6. Organise your nine photos (three per subject) in a folder named `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname`.

Required deliverables:

- A folder with at least nine photos (three per subject, three subjects).
- A short written note (three sentences) explaining why your three best photos are sharp and correctly exposed.

Submission format:
Share the folder with the instructor (via WhatsApp, Google Drive or a USB stick) or bring your phone to Session 2 and show the folder.

Deadline:
Before Session 2.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Sharpness	3	All nine photos are sharp on the subject (verified by zooming in)

Correct exposure	3	All nine photos are correctly exposed â€“ not too dark, not too bright
Variety of subjects	2	Three different subjects (person, product, scene)
Written explanation	2	Three accurate sentences explaining why the best photos work

Common mistakes to avoid:
submitting blurry photos; submitting photos where the subject is too dark to see; using beauty filters; photographing a person without their permission; taking only one photo per subject.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner submission contains:

- **Person:** A portrait of a classmate or family member, sharply focused on the eyes, correctly exposed (face is clearly visible, not a silhouette against a window).
- **Product:** A clean product shot â€” for example, a shoe on a plain surface, sharp, well-lit, background uncluttered.
- **Scene:** A street or room view that is sharp throughout and correctly exposed (not a dark interior with blown-out windows).
- Written note: "This photo is sharp and correctly exposed because I tapped to focus on the subject, held the phone steady with both hands, and checked the photo by zooming in before I moved on."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€” answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer.
In your own words, what makes a good photograph? Name the five quality words and explain one of them.

Q2. Multiple choice.
Your photo of a person against a bright window comes out with the person very dark and almost invisible. What is the most likely reason? a) The phone's camera is broken. b) The camera exposed for the bright window, not for the person. c) The photo needs a beauty filter. d) The person was standing too close to the window.

Q3. Explain in your own words.
What is the exposure triangle? Name the three parts and explain what happens when one of them is set wrong.

Q4. Practical identification.
A classmate's photo is blurry â€” the whole image looks smeared. What are the two most likely causes, and how would you fix each one?

Q5. Matching.
Match each term to its plain-English meaning: **aperture, shutter speed, ISO.** a) How sensitive the sensor is to light b) How wide the lens opening is c) How long the shutter stays open

Q6. Scenario.
You are photographing a friend's product (a handbag) for her WhatsApp Business. The photo comes out sharp but the handbag is too dark to see the details. What are two things you could do to fix this?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q6)

A1.
A good photograph has five qualities: clarity (sharpness), light (correct exposure), composition (intentional arrangement), moment (right instant) and purpose (does the job it was meant to do). Explanation of any one: e.g., clarity means the subject is sharp and you can see the details when you zoom in. (Accept any answer that names the five words and explains one correctly.)

A2.

A3.

The exposure triangle is the three camera settings that control how bright or dark a photo is: aperture (how wide the lens opening is), shutter speed (how long the shutter stays open) and ISO (how sensitive the sensor is to light). If aperture is too small or shutter is too fast in low light, the photo comes out dark. If ISO is too high, the photo comes out grainy. If the shutter is too slow and the subject moves, the photo comes out blurry. (Accept any answer that names all three parts and explains at least one consequence correctly.)

A4.

The two most likely causes: (1) camera shake â€" the photographer's hands moved during the exposure. Fix: hold the phone with both hands, elbows tucked, and rest on a solid surface. (2) subject movement â€" the subject moved during the exposure. Fix: ask the subject to hold still and take several frames. (Accept both causes with correct fixes.)

A5.

aperture = (b); shutter speed = (c); ISO = (a).

A6.

Two things: (1) Tap the handbag on the screen to set focus and exposure on it â€" this tells the camera to expose for the handbag, not the bright background. (2) Use the exposure slider to brighten the photo after tapping. (3) Alternatively, move the handbag away from the bright background into more even light. (Accept any two correct actions.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary.

Today you learned that a good photograph is not luck â€" it is the result of deliberate choices. You learned the five quality words: clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose. You learned the exposure triangle in simple terms â€" aperture, shutter speed and ISO â€" and how they control whether your photo is bright, dark or blurry. You learned that a phone camera is a legitimate tool, what megapixels really mean, and how to control focus by tapping, locking and checking. You set up your camera properly â€" grid on, high resolution, beauty filters off â€" and you practised the 5-step sharpness routine: steady, focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames. You took nine photos and diagnosed why some worked and some did not.

Five important takeaways:

1. A good photograph has five qualities: clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose.
2. The exposure triangle â€" aperture, shutter speed and ISO â€" controls brightness; on a phone you influence it through tap-to-focus and the exposure slider.
3. Megapixels measure detail quantity, not quality â€" a 12-megapixel phone photo is more than enough for business use.
4. Tap to focus, lock focus and focus check â€" focus is a choice, not an accident.
5. The 5-step sharpness routine produces sharp photos reliably: steady, focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I name the five quality words and explain what each means?
- Can I explain the exposure triangle in simple terms and diagnose why a photo is dark, bright or blurry?
- Can I set up my phone camera: grid on, high resolution, beauty filters off?
- Can I tap to focus, lock focus and focus check?
- Can I run the 5-step sharpness routine without looking at my notes?
- Can I take three photos of the same subject and pick the sharpest one?

Connection to the next session.

You now know how to make a photo sharp and correctly exposed. But a sharp, well-lit photo can still be boring â€" if the composition is poor. Next session we train the eye. You will learn the rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry and perspective, and you will learn to use natural light â€" golden hour, window light and open shade â€" to make your photographs look beautiful, not just usable. You will take a four-image composition series and a four-image light study.

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner taps the subject before every photo without being reminded.
- Learner holds the phone with both hands and checks the background before shooting.
- Learner diagnoses their own photos accurately ("this one is dark because I tapped the bright wall").
- Learner can explain the exposure triangle in their own words, even if imperfectly.
- Learner takes multiple frames and selects the best.
- Learner asks permission before photographing a person.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "A better phone will fix my photos." â†' No â€" the photographer's choices matter more than the camera.
- "I can fix everything in editing." â†' Editing can improve a good photo; it cannot rescue a badly exposed or blurry one.
- "Focus is automatic â€" I do not need to think about it." â†' The camera focuses where you tap; if you do not tap, it guesses.
- "Beauty filters make photos look better." â†' They create unrealistic images that can mislead clients.
- "One photo is enough." â†' Always take several frames; one might be blurry or the subject might blink.
- "Megapixels are the most important spec." â†' Megapixels measure detail quantity; sensor quality and the photographer's choices matter more.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Tap-and-focus drill:** Place three objects at different distances. The learner taps each one in turn and takes a photo. Review all three â€" each subject should be sharp.
2. **Exposure slider drill:** Photograph the same subject with the slider at minimum, middle and maximum. Review all three â€" the middle or slightly above should be correctly exposed.
3. **Diagnosis drill:** Show five photos (dark, bright, blurry, good, flat). The learner labels each and explains why. Review together.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a printed step-by-step card with the 5-step sharpness routine and the camera setup checklist. Pair the learner with a confident learner for the practical.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full lecture, demonstration, guided practical and independent exercise.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to photograph the same subject using all three exposure triangle variables deliberately â€" tap to change aperture effect (by tapping different brightness areas), use a slower shutter (by photographing a moving subject like a fan or flowing water), and explain what happened in each case. They should also research and present one additional camera setting not covered in the session (e.g., white balance or scene modes).

Timing guidance.

The priority is learners taking photos with the sharpness routine (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the exposure triangle lecture (F.2) to the key points â€" the three settings and how to influence them on a phone â€" and protect the practical time. A learner who leaves without taking nine sharp photos has no foundation for Session 2.

END OF SESSION 1

Next: Session 2 â€" Composition and Lighting.

SESSION 2 â€" COMPOSITION AND LIGHTING

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" PHOTOGRAPHY

SESSION 2 â€" COMPOSITION AND LIGHTING

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	2 of 6
Session title	Composition and Lighting
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: "See and Shoot" (Foundations)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (practical, eye-training focus)
Prerequisite knowledge	Session 1 â€" the learner should be able to tap to focus, adjust exposure and produce a sharp, correctly exposed photo. The 5-step sharpness routine is assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Session 1 you made photos sharp and correctly exposed. Today you learn to make them beautiful â€" by composing with intention and using light deliberately. A sharp, well-lit photo with poor composition is still a weak photo.
Preparation before class	Print the four-technique composition cards (rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry/perspective) as visual examples for the opening; a projector connected to the instructor's phone for live composition demonstration; two identical small objects (two cups, two bottles) for the good-light/bad-light comparison; a window with natural light and a shaded outdoor area (or two very different indoor lighting spots) for the light study; the "Composition Technique Log" (Section H) printed per learner.

Instructor note on tone:
This session is about training the eye. Keep it visual â€" show more than you tell. Learners should feel the difference between good and bad light physically (squinting, leaning in) before they can name it. Celebrate every "I see it now" moment.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Apply the rule of thirds** to a live subject, placing the subject on the grid intersection rather than dead centre, and explain why this is stronger.
2. **Use framing** â€" shooting through a natural frame (a doorway, window, tree branches) to add depth and focus attention on the subject.
3. **Identify and use leading lines** â€" paths, edges, walls, railings that draw the viewer's eye toward the subject.
4. **Recognise and use symmetry and perspective** â€" balanced compositions for formal effect, and converging lines to create depth.
5. **Identify golden hour, window light and open shade** as flattering natural light, and explain why harsh midday sun and backlight are unflattering.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a working camera.
- Instructor's phone connected to a projector or large screen for live demonstration.
- A phone tripod or improvised stand for the instructor demonstration.
- Two identical small objects (two cups, two bottles, two fruits) for the light comparison.
- A window with natural light and a shaded spot (or two contrasting indoor lighting areas) for the light study.

Software

- The phone's built-in camera app (default shooting tool).
- No editing software needed today; editing begins in Session 4.

Accounts

- None required this session.

Sample files

- **Four composition technique cards** (Section F) â€" each card shows a photograph demonstrating one technique with a brief explanation.
- **Good light / bad light comparison** â€" two photos of the same subject in flattering and unflattering light, printed or projected.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 2.1 â€" "Composition Technique Log" (a table: technique name, description, my photo description, why it works).
- Worksheet 2.2 â€" "Light Study Record" (a table: lighting condition, time/place, description of light, result).

Tools

- A whiteboard and markers for drawing composition diagrams.
- A ruler or straight edge for drawing grid lines.

Internet

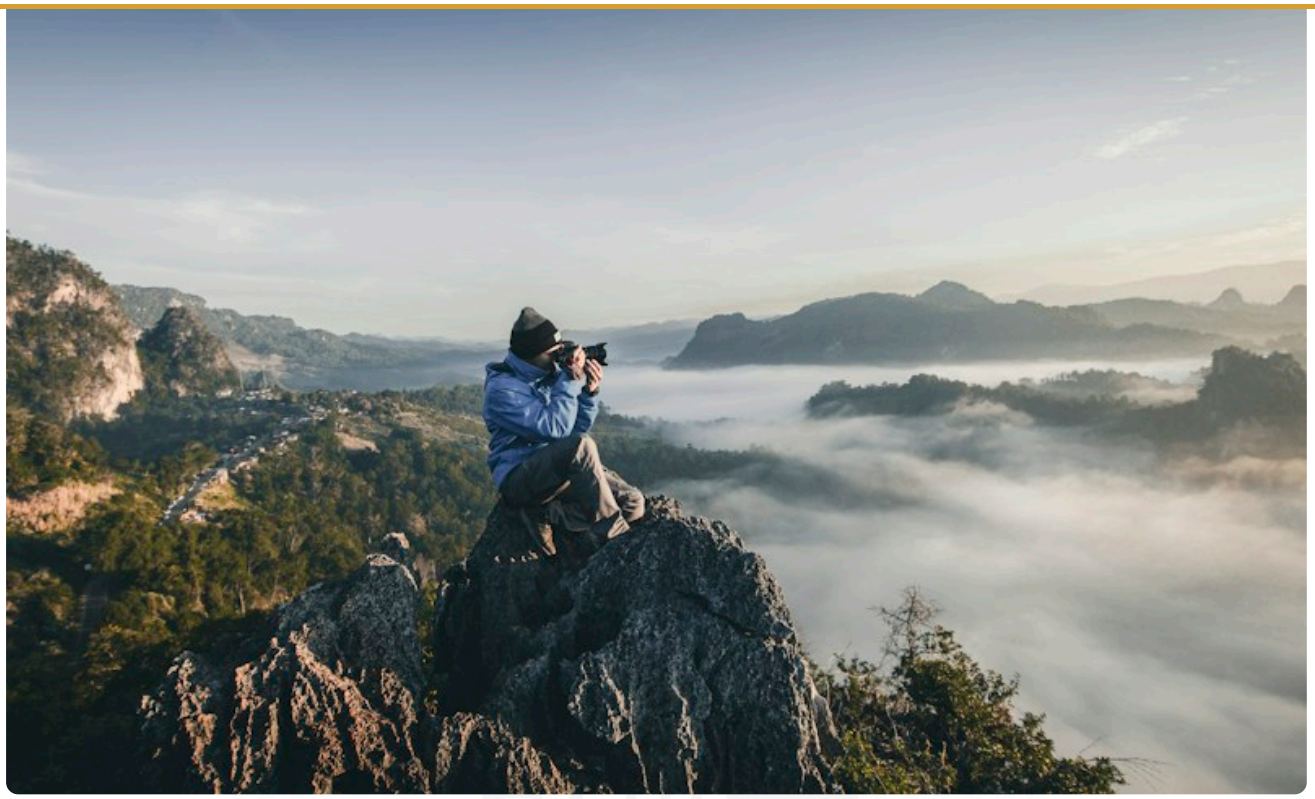
- Not required. The session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a capable phone

- Any phone with a working camera works. A learner without a phone may pair with a classmate, use an academy phone or use an academy computer with a webcam. They must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

Safety note:
When photographing outdoors or near windows, be aware of surroundings. Do not stand in roads, do not lean out of windows, and do not photograph anyone without their consent.

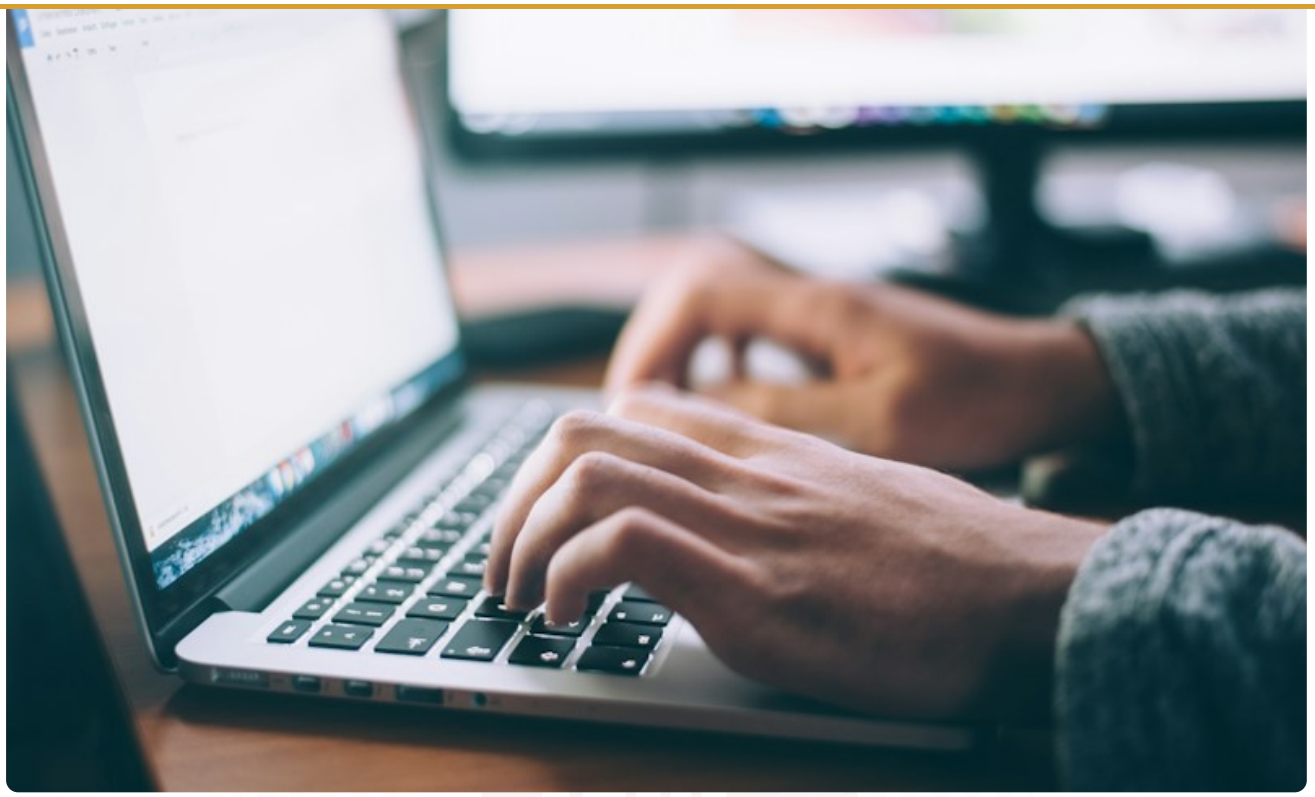
Suggested visuals:



- â€" framing a strong composition



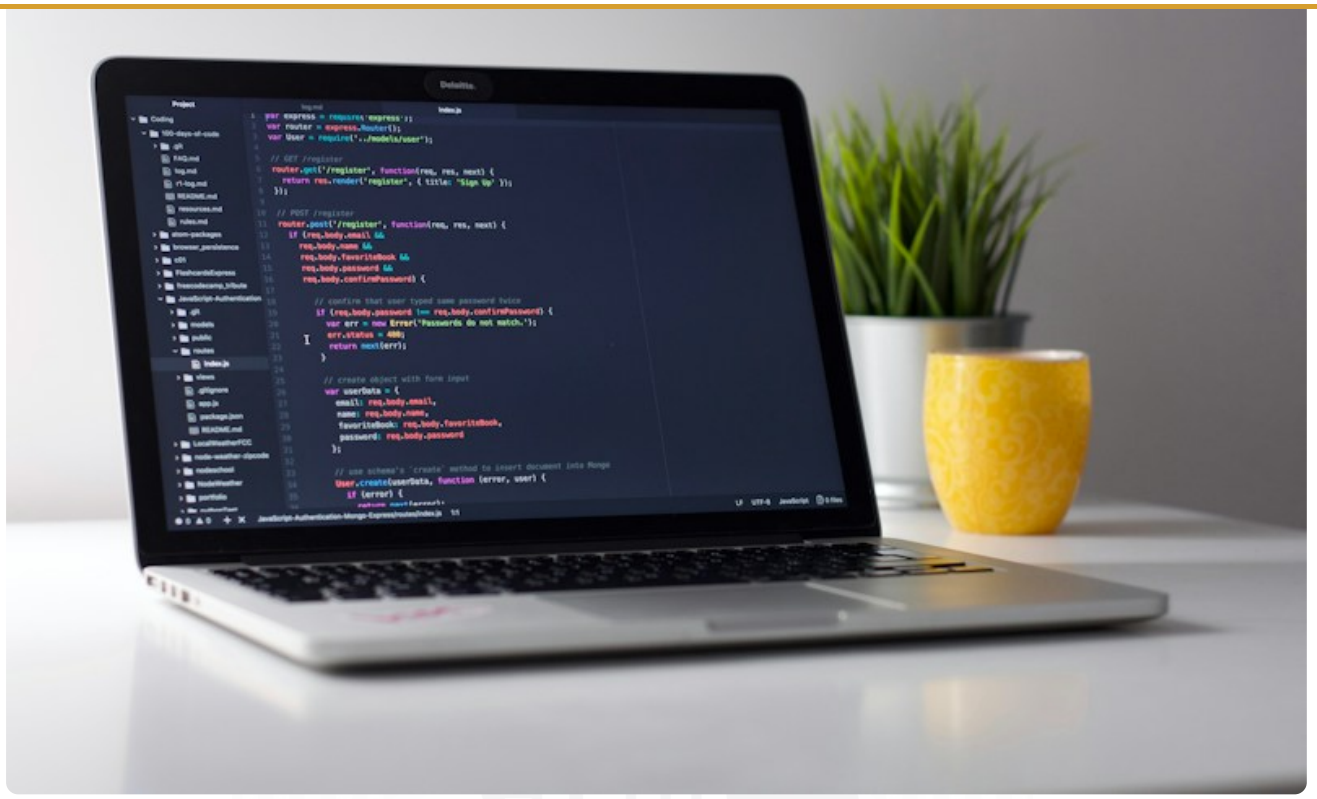
- â€" working with available light



- â€" reviewing shots for balance



- â€" composing through the viewfinder



- â€" checking light and balance on screen

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup:
On the projector, show the same subject â€" a chair in a room â€" photographed three ways:

- **Photo A (centred, flat):** The chair is dead centre in the frame, shot from standing height, with a cluttered background. It looks like a random snapshot.
- **Photo B (rule of thirds, intentional):** The chair is placed on the right third of the frame, shot from a slightly lower angle, with a clean background. It looks deliberate and pleasing.
- **Photo C (with leading lines):** The chair is framed by a doorway or at the end of a corridor, with lines drawing the eye toward it. It looks like a designed image.

What the instructor says:

> *"Same chair, same room. But Photo B and Photo C look like someone made them â€" they look like they belong in a magazine or a shop advert. Photo A looks like something you would delete. Hands up â€" which photo would you use for a furniture business? â€¦ B and C, almost everyone. Now tell me: what is different about them?"*

Expected learner response:
Learners will say things like "the chair is not in the middle," "it looks nicer," "the background is cleaner," "it looks professional," "it has depth." Accept all answers and write the key phrases on the board: **off-centre, clean background, depth, intentional, pleasing.**

Then reveal the lesson:
Say clearly:

> *"Composition is not a mystery â€" it is a set of choices. Where do you put the subject in the frame? What do you include around it? What angle do you shoot from? Today you learn four composition techniques that professionals use every day.*

Why this opener works:
It uses a subject every learner can recognise, it produces instant visual recognition of quality, and it introduces the four techniques and the light concept before any technical explanation.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1:
"What are the five quality words for a good photograph? Which two did we focus on in Session 1?"

- Expected answer: Clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose. Session 1 focused on clarity (sharpness) and light (correct exposure).
- Common gap: Learners may forget the five words. Clarify: "Clarity means sharp. Light means correctly exposed. Today we add composition â€" how the subject is arranged â€" and we go deeper into light."

Question 2:
"What is the 5-step sharpness routine? Name the steps."

- Expected answer: Steady hold, tap to focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames.
- Common gap: Learners may remember the steps but not the order. Clarify: "The order matters. Steady first, then focus, then exposure, then background, then frames."

Question 3:
"What happens when you tap a bright part of the scene instead of the subject?"

- Expected answer: The camera exposes for the bright area, so the subject goes dark.
- Common gap: Learners may say "the photo gets brighter." Clarify: "The *background* gets correctly exposed, but the *subject* goes dark. The camera exposes for wherever you tap."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"In Session 1 you learned to make photos sharp and correctly exposed. That is the foundation. But a sharp, well-lit photo of a chair in the middle of the frame is still not a great photo. Today you learn to arrange the photo â€" composition â€" and to choose the light. These are the two skills that turn a snapshot into a photograph."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the 5-step routine, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing it on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What composition is and why it matters

The idea.
Composition is how you arrange everything inside the frame â€" the subject, the background, the empty space, the lines, the shapes. It is the difference between pointing a camera and *making* a photograph.

Plain-English definition.
Composition is deciding what goes in the photo, where everything sits in the frame, and what angle you shoot from. It is the photographer's way of guiding the viewer's eye to what matters.

Why it matters.

the product look more valuable. For a portrait, a well-composed photo makes the person look more confident and appealing.

The key insight (say this slowly):

> *"Composition is not about following rules blindly. It is about understanding a few principles and then making deliberate choices. Today you learn four techniques. After this session, you will see them everywhere â€" in adverts, in magazines, in Instagram posts. And you will start using them yourself."*

Real-life comparison.
Composition is like arranging a shop display. You can throw everything on the shelf randomly, or you can place the most important item at eye level, give it space around it, and remove anything distracting. Both are displays, but one makes people stop and look, and the other makes them walk past. Composition is arranging the photo so people stop and look.

Misconception to correct.
"Composition rules are rigid â€" you must always follow them exactly." No. The rules are starting points. Once you understand them, you can break them deliberately for creative effect. But you must first learn the rules before you can break them with intention.

F.2 Technique 1 â€" The rule of thirds

The idea.
The rule of thirds is the most fundamental composition technique. It says: do not put the subject in the centre of the frame. Instead, place it on one of the grid intersections â€" the points where the horizontal and vertical grid lines cross.

How it works:

1. Turn on grid lines in your camera settings (you did this in Session 1).
2. The grid divides the screen into nine equal rectangles.
3. The four points where the grid lines intersect are the "power points."
4. Place your subject â€" or the most important part of the subject (usually the eyes in a portrait) â€" on or near one of these four points.

Why it works:

- A centred subject feels static and balanced â€" but also boring. The eye has nowhere to travel.
- An off-centred subject creates tension and movement. The eye moves around the frame, exploring.
- The empty space around the subject (called "negative space") gives the subject room to breathe and makes it feel important.

How to use it in practice:

- For a portrait: place the subject's eyes on the top horizontal line, on one of the vertical lines. Leave space in the direction the person is looking.
- For a product: place the product on one of the four intersections, with the label facing the camera.
- For a landscape: place the horizon on the top or bottom horizontal line â€" not in the middle.

Worked example:

- Weak: A photo of a person, dead centre, looking at the camera, with equal space on both sides. The photo feels flat and stiff.
- Strong: The same person, placed on the right vertical line, with their eyes on the top horizontal line, looking toward the left side of the frame (into the empty space). The photo feels dynamic and intentional.

Real-life comparison.
The rule of thirds is like seating at a dinner table. If you sit exactly in the middle of the table, you are the centre of attention but the table feels stiff. If you sit slightly to one side, the table feels more natural and conversational, and people can still see you

Placing the subject on the grid intersection but leaving no space in the direction they are looking. If a person is looking left, place them on the right side of the frame so they have space to "look into."

F.3 Technique 2 â€" Framing

The idea.
Framing means using elements in the scene to create a frame *within* the frame â€" a natural border around the subject that draws the eye inward.

What can be used as a frame:

- A doorway or window
- Tree branches or leaves
- An archway or gate
- A corridor or tunnel
- Two walls creating a natural frame
- A person's arms or hands (in creative portraits)

How it works:

1. Find a natural frame in the environment â€" a doorway, a window, branches.
2. Position yourself so the frame surrounds your subject.
3. Shoot through the frame, keeping both the frame and the subject in focus (if possible).
4. The frame draws the viewer's eye toward the subject and adds depth to the photo.

Why it works:

- The frame creates a sense of depth â€" the photo feels like you are looking *into* a scene, not just *at* it.
- The frame focuses attention â€" the viewer's eye is guided to the subject, not distracted by the surroundings.
- The frame adds context â€" a doorway tells you the person is inside, branches tell you the person is outdoors.

Worked example:

- Weak: A photo of a person standing in an open field, with nothing around them. The photo is flat â€" there is no sense of place.
- Strong: The same person, photographed through a doorway or an archway. The door frame creates a natural border, the person is framed within it, and the photo feels like a window into a moment.

Real-life comparison.
Framing is like hanging a picture on a wall. The wall is the background, the frame is the border around the picture, and the picture is the subject. Without a frame, the picture blends into the wall. With a frame, the picture stands out. In photography, you use the environment to create that frame.

Common mistake.
Using a frame that is too busy or distracting â€" the frame competes with the subject for attention. The frame should enhance the subject, not overpower it.

F.4 Technique 3 â€" Leading lines

The idea.
Leading lines are lines in the scene â€" paths, roads, walls, railings, fences, rivers, shadows â€" that lead the viewer's eye toward the subject.

What can be leading lines:

- A road or path leading to a building

- A river or stream leading to a bridge
- Shadows created by light
- Railway lines, power lines, staircases

How it works:

1. Look at the scene and identify any lines â€" straight or curved.
2. Position yourself so the lines lead from the foreground (near the camera) toward the subject (in the distance).
3. The lines act as arrows, guiding the viewer's eye through the photo to the subject.

Why it works:

- Lines create a sense of journey â€" the viewer's eye travels from the foreground to the subject.
- Lines add depth â€" they make the photo feel three-dimensional.
- Lines create interest â€" a photo with leading lines feels more dynamic than a photo without them.

Worked example:

- Weak: A photo of a market stall, shot straight on, with no lines. The photo is flat â€" everything is at the same distance.
- Strong: The same market stall, shot from the end of the aisle, with the aisle lines leading the eye toward the stall. The photo feels like you are walking toward the stall.

Real-life comparison.
Leading lines are like the yellow line on a road. The line guides your eyes forward, toward where you are going. In a photograph, leading lines guide the viewer's eyes toward the subject.

Common mistake.
Lines that lead the eye *away* from the subject or out of the frame. Always check: do the lines lead toward the subject, or do they lead somewhere else? If they lead away, reposition yourself.

F.5 Technique 4 â€" Symmetry and perspective

The idea.
Symmetry means balance â€" both sides of the photo are similar or identical. Perspective means using depth and distance to create a three-dimensional feeling. Together, they create formal, structured compositions.

Symmetry:

- When to use it: architecture, reflections, formal portraits, anything with a clear centre line.
- How to use it: place the subject in the centre of the frame, with both sides of the photo mirroring each other as closely as possible.
- Why it works: symmetry feels stable, formal and pleasing. It works well for buildings, doorways, faces and reflections.
- Example: A building photographed straight on, with both sides equal. Or a reflection in a lake or a puddle â€" the top half and bottom half are mirror images.

Perspective:

- When to use it: any scene with depth â€" corridors, roads, hallways, rows of objects.
- How to use it: place the camera at the start of the depth, with the subject at the far end. The converging lines (the sides of the corridor, the edges of the road) create a strong sense of depth.
- Why it works: perspective makes the photo feel immersive â€" like you could step into it.
- Example: A photo down a long corridor, with the walls converging toward a door at the far end. The viewer feels like they are standing at the start of the corridor.

Worked example:

- Weak: A photo of a corridor, shot from the side, with no sense of depth. The photo is flat.

Real-life comparison.
Symmetry is like a face â€" both eyes, both ears, both sides roughly the same. A symmetrical face feels balanced and pleasing. Perspective is like looking down a long road â€" the road narrows in the distance, and you feel the depth. Both are powerful composition tools.

Common mistake.
For symmetry, even a small tilt ruins the effect. Use the grid lines to make sure the centre line is truly centred. For perspective, if the camera is too far from the start of the depth, the effect is weak â€" get close to the beginning of the lines.

F.6 What light is and why it matters

The idea.
Light is the raw material of photography. Without light, there is no photograph. But not all light is equal. The quality, direction and colour of light can make a subject look beautiful, dramatic, flat, harsh or unflattering.

The three qualities of light (teach these and return to them all session):

Quality	Plain-English meaning	Effect on the subject
Direction	Where the light comes from â€" front, side, top, behind	Front light is flat and safe; side light is dramatic and dimensional; top light (midday sun) is harsh and unflattering; backlight (behind the subject) creates silhouettes
Softness	How spread out the light is â€" soft or hard	Soft light (cloudy day, window light) is flattering and even; hard light (direct sun) creates strong shadows and bright highlights
Colour	The warmth or coolness of the light â€" measured in Kelvin	Warm light (sunrise, sunset, indoor bulbs) feels cozy and golden; cool light (shade, overcast sky) feels clean and blue; neutral light (overcast day, open shade) is balanced and true

Why light matters more than the camera.
A â‚¦500,000 camera in bad light produces a bad photo. A â‚¦50,000 phone in good light produces a beautiful photo. The camera records the light; the photographer chooses the light. This is why professional photographers talk about light constantly â€" it is the most important variable.

Real-life comparison.
Think of a person's face. In the soft light of a window, their face looks smooth, warm and pleasing. In the harsh midday sun, their face has dark shadows under the eyes and nose, and they are squinting. Same person, same face â€" completely different light, completely different result. Light is the difference.

Misconception to correct.
"More light is always better." No. Too much light (direct midday sun) is harsh and unflattering. The best light is often soft and indirect â€" the light of a cloudy day, a window, or open shade. Quality matters more than quantity.

F.7 The four natural light conditions every photographer must know

1. Golden hour (the best light of the day).

- When: The hour after sunrise and the hour before sunset.
- What it looks like: Warm, golden, soft, directional light with long shadows.
- Why it is beautiful: The low angle of the sun creates soft, flattering light with a warm glow. Skin looks smooth, colours look rich, and everything feels magical.
- How to use it: Shoot during golden hour whenever possible. Place the subject facing the sun (front-lit) for a warm glow, or at an angle to the sun (side-lit) for dramatic shadows.
- Nigerian context: In Port Harcourt, golden hour is roughly 6:00â€"7:00 AM and 5:30â€"6:30 PM (varies by season). The light is consistent year-round near the equator.

- What it looks like: Soft, directional light coming from one side.
- Why it is beautiful: The window acts as a large, soft light source. The light is even and flattering, especially for portraits and products.
- How to use it: Place the subject near the window, facing the window (or at a 45-degree angle to it). Do not place the subject with their back to the window â€" this creates a silhouette.
- Nigerian context: Almost every home and shop in Port Harcourt has a window. This is the most accessible good light.

3. Open shade (the safest outdoor light).

- When: Any time during the day, in a shaded area.
- What it looks like: Soft, even, cool light â€" no direct sun on the subject.
- Why it is beautiful: The shade eliminates harsh shadows and squinting. The light is even and flattering, especially for portraits.
- How to use it: Place the subject in the shade of a tree, a building, or an umbrella â€" but with a bright, open area in front of them (not a dark wall). The subject should be in shade, but the light in front of them should be bright.
- Nigerian context: Open shade is everywhere in Port Harcourt â€" under trees, under awnings, in covered walkways. It is the easiest good light to find.

4. Harsh midday sun (the worst light â€" avoid when possible).

- When: Roughly 11:00 AM to 2:00 PM.
- What it looks like: Hard, overhead light with strong shadows under the eyes, nose and chin. Subjects squint. Colours look washed out.
- Why it is unflattering: The light comes from directly above, creating shadows in the worst places. It is too harsh for portraits and can create washed-out colours.
- How to handle it if you must shoot in it: Move the subject into open shade. If you cannot, use a reflector or white card to bounce light into the shadow areas. Or embrace the harsh light for creative effect (strong shadows can be dramatic).
- Nigerian context: The midday sun in Port Harcourt is extremely strong. Avoid shooting portraits or products in direct midday sun unless you have no choice.

Backlight â€" the most common mistake:

- What it is: Light coming from behind the subject, toward the camera.
- What happens: The subject becomes a silhouette â€" dark, with no detail. The background is bright.
- Why it happens: The camera exposes for the bright background, not the dark subject.
- How to fix it: Move the subject so the light is coming from the front or side, not behind. Or tap the subject on the screen and brighten the exposure. Or use a reflector to bounce light onto the subject's face.
- Golden hour exception: Backlight during golden hour can be beautiful â€" it creates a warm glow around the subject (called "rim light"). This is intentional backlight, not accidental backlight.

Real-life comparison.

The four light conditions are like four different shirts:

- Golden hour is a beautiful traditional outfit â€" rich, warm, special.
- Window light is a clean white shirt â€" simple, professional, always works.
- Open shade is a casual polo â€" relaxed, comfortable, safe.
- Harsh midday sun is a fluorescent vest â€" bright, harsh, unflattering, best avoided.

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- Composition is how you arrange the subject, background and space within the frame.
- The rule of thirds: place the subject on a grid intersection, not dead centre.
- Framing: use a natural frame (doorway, window, branches) to draw the eye to the subject.

- Light has three qualities: direction, softness and colour.
- The four natural light conditions: golden hour (best), window light (easy), open shade (safe), harsh midday sun (avoid).
- Backlight is the most common mistake â€” fix it by repositioning or adjusting exposure.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Rule of Thirds] --> D[Balanced composition]
    B[Leading Lines] --> D
    C[Framing] --> D
    D --> E[Interesting photo]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A phone connected to the projector, camera app open, grid lines on.
- A subject: a bottle, a cup, or a piece of fruit on a table.
- A second subject for the light study: two identical objects (two cups or two bottles).
- A window with natural light.
- A shaded area (indoor corner or under a tree/awning outside).
- A white card or reflector (A4 paper works).

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” rule of thirds (3 minutes)

Say:
"Watch the screen. Grid lines are on. I am going to place the bottle on one of the four grid intersections."

Step 1:
Move the phone so the bottle is on the right vertical line, on the top horizontal line. "The bottle is on a power point. It is off-centre."

Step 2:
Take the photo. Show the result. "See how the bottle has space on the left? It feels intentional, not accidental."

Step 3:
Move the bottle to the centre. Take the photo. Show the result. "Now it is centred. Compare â€” which one feels more dynamic?" The class should say the off-centre one.

Say:
"The rule of thirds is not magic â€” it is simply about not putting everything in the middle. The eye likes to move around the frame. Off-centre gives it somewhere to go."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€” framing (2 minutes)

Say:
"Now I will use a doorway to frame the bottle. Watch."

Step 1:
Position the camera so the bottle is visible through a doorway. The door frame surrounds the bottle.

Step 2:
Tap the bottle to focus. Take the photo. Show the result.

Say:

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" leading lines (2 minutes)

Say:
"Now I will use leading lines. I am going to place the bottle at the end of a row of books, so the edges of the books lead the eye toward it."

Step 1:
Arrange a row of books leading toward the bottle. Position the camera at the start of the row.

Step 2:
Tap the bottle to focus. Take the photo. Show the result.

Say:
"The edges of the books are lines. They lead your eye from the foreground â€" near the camera â€" to the bottle in the distance. Without the lines, the bottle is just there. With the lines, your eye travels to it."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" light study (6 minutes)

Say:
"Now the most important part â€" light. I have two identical cups. I am going to photograph the same cup in four different lights and you will see the difference."

Light 1 â€" Window light:
Place the cup near a window. Photograph it. Show the result. "Soft, even, flattering. You can see the colour and texture of the cup clearly."

Light 2 â€" Open shade:
Place the cup in a shaded area (under a tree, in a covered walkway). Photograph it. Show the result. "Even, cool, safe. No harsh shadows. This is the easiest good outdoor light."

Light 3 â€" Direct sun (if available) or a bright indoor spot with harsh overhead light:
Place the cup in direct bright light. Photograph it. Show the result. "Harsh shadows, bright highlights, the cup looks washed out and unflattering. This is the light to avoid."

Light 4 â€" Backlight:
Place the cup with a bright window behind it. Photograph it without adjusting. Show the result. "The cup is dark â€" a silhouette. The camera exposed for the bright window." Then tap the cup, brighten the exposure, retake. Show the result. "Now the cup is visible. Same cup, same position â€" the only thing I changed was the exposure."

Say:
"Same cup, same camera. The only thing that changed was the light. That is why light matters more than the camera. A photographer's job is to find good light â€" or fix bad light."

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Which photo feels more dynamic â€" the centred one or the off-centre one?" (Off-centre â€" rule of thirds.)
- "What does the doorway do for the bottle?" (It frames it â€" draws the eye in.)
- "What do the edges of the books do?" (They lead the eye to the bottle â€" leading lines.)
- "Which light made the cup look best?" (Window light or open shade.)
- "Why was the cup dark when the window was behind it?" (Backlight â€" the camera exposed for the bright window, not the cup.)
- "Can you fix backlight?" (Yes â€" tap the subject and brighten the exposure, or move the subject.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective:

Starting materials:

Learner's own phone with grid lines on; a subject in the classroom (a bottle, a cup, a bag, a plant, or a classmate who has agreed); the printed Composition Technique Log.

Procedure â€" Part 1: Composition Series (12 minutes)

The instructor calls out each technique. Learners find a subject and apply the technique. Instructor walks the room.

1. **Rule of thirds:** Find a subject. Turn on grid lines. Place the subject on one of the four grid intersections. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
2. **Framing:** Find a natural frame â€" a doorway, a window, a gap between two objects. Shoot through the frame so the subject is framed. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
3. **Leading lines:** Find or create leading lines â€" the edge of a table, a row of books, a corridor. Position yourself so the lines lead to the subject. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
4. **Symmetry or perspective:** Find a symmetrical scene (a door, a face, a reflection) or a perspective scene (a corridor, a row of objects). Compose for symmetry or depth. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.

For each photo, the learner writes one line in the Composition Technique Log: "Technique: _____. What I did: _____."

Procedure â€" Part 2: Light Study (6 minutes)

5. Choose one subject (a bottle, a cup, or a classmate's hand â€" something that can stay still).
6. Photograph it in two different lighting situations available in or near the classroom:
    - Near a window (soft light).
    - In a shaded area or a dim corner (different light).
7. For each photo, write one line in the Light Study Record: "Light: _____. What I see: _____."

Expected result:

Four composition photos (one per technique) and two light study photos, each with a written description.

Points to pause and predict:

- After the rule of thirds photo: "Is your subject on a grid intersection, or is it still in the middle? Check the grid."
- After the framing photo: "Does the frame surround your subject, or is it just something in the background? If it does not surround, it is not a frame."
- After the light study: "Compare your two light photos. Which one looks better? Why?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner cannot find a natural frame â†' Suggest a doorway, a window, or even the gap between two chairs.
- Subject is centred despite trying â†' Have them look at the grid lines on the screen, not just the subject. Move the camera, not the subject.
- Leading lines are not leading anywhere â†' Ask: "Where do the lines go? Do they go to the subject or somewhere else? Reposition."
- Light study photos look the same â†' The learner may have photographed in the same light twice. Have them move to a genuinely different lighting situation.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Rule of thirds photo â€" subject on a grid intersection
- ☐ Framing photo â€" subject framed by a natural frame
- ☐ Leading lines photo â€" lines lead to the subject
- ☐ Symmetry or perspective photo â€" balanced or deep
- ☐ Light study photo 1 â€" near a window
- ☐ Light study photo 2 â€" in shade or a different light
- ☐ Composition Technique Log completed for all four techniques

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task:
Complete the light study â€" photograph the same subject in four different lighting conditions and diagnose the light.

Setup:
Choose one subject â€" a bottle, a cup, a fruit, or a classmate's hand (with permission). The subject must stay in the same position; only the light changes.

You will photograph it in four places (find these in or near the classroom):

1. **Near a window** (soft, directional light).
2. **In open shade** (soft, even light â€" under a tree, in a covered area, or in a shaded corner).
3. **In direct bright light** (harsh light â€" in a sunny spot or under a bright overhead light).
4. **With a bright background behind it** (backlight â€" place the subject in front of a window or bright opening).

Requirements:

1. For each lighting condition, take at least one photo using the 5-step sharpness routine (from Session 1).
2. After each photo, label it in the Light Study Record: is the light **soft or hard**, **warm or cool**, **flattering or unflattering**?
3. Write one sentence explaining what you see in each photo.

Constraints:

- Use only the built-in camera app â€" no filters, no editing.
- The subject must be the same in all four photos (same position, same angle if possible).
- Do not leave the building â€" find the four lighting situations inside or immediately outside.

Time allowance:
15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Four photos taken in four different lighting conditions.
- Each photo is labelled with a light diagnosis (soft/hard, warm/cool, flattering/unflattering).
- At least one photo is clearly flattering (the window or shade photo).
- The backlight photo shows a visible difference from the others.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: "Soft light" means no harsh shadows â€" the light is spread out. "Hard light" means strong, defined shadows.
- Hint 2: If you cannot find open shade, a shaded corner of a room works â€" anywhere the subject is not in direct light.
- Hint 3: For backlight, place the subject between the camera and a bright window. The subject will look dark â€" that is the point.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Photo 1 â€" near a window: Soft, directional, flattering light. The subject is clearly visible with gentle shadows. Diagnosis: **soft, neutral-warm, flattering.** Reason: "The window acts as a large, soft light source."

Photo 2 â€" open shade: Soft, even, cool light. The subject is evenly lit with no harsh shadows. Diagnosis: **soft, cool, flattering.** Reason: "The shade eliminates direct sun, creating even light."

Photo 3 â€" direct bright light: Hard, harsh, unflattering light. Strong shadows, bright highlights, the subject may look washed out. Diagnosis: **hard, warm, unflattering.** Reason: "Direct light creates harsh shadows and bright spots."

Photo 4 â€" backlight: The subject is dark (silhouette) against a bright background. Diagnosis: **hard, unflattering (as shot).** Reason: "The camera exposed for the bright background, not the subject. Fix: tap the subject and brighten."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- At least one photo clearly flattering (1)
- Written reasons are accurate (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation.

Adaeze is a tailor in Port Harcourt. She makes beautiful ankara dresses and sells them through WhatsApp and Instagram. She takes photos of her dresses on a mannequin in her shop, usually in the afternoon, and posts them. Her photos have the dresses looking flat, washed out, and unflattering â€” the colours look dull, and the fabric texture is hard to see. Customers often say the dresses look better in person than in the photos.

Relevant facts.

- Adaeze's phone is a recent model with a good camera.
- She photographs the mannequin in the middle of her shop, under fluorescent ceiling lights.
- She does not think about composition â€” she just points and shoots.
- Her shop has a large window with beautiful natural light, but she never uses it.
- The background of her photos is cluttered â€” fabric rolls, scissors, other dresses, her sewing machine.

Decision point.

What is the main reason Adaeze's photos are not showing her dresses at their best?

Possible approaches.

1. Buy a better phone with a bigger camera sensor.
2. Learn to use natural light (her window), improve her composition, and clean up her background.
3. Hire a professional fashion photographer for every new dress.

Recommended solution.

Approach 2. Adaeze's phone is already capable of good photographs. Her problem is threefold: poor light (fluorescent ceiling lights instead of natural window light), poor composition (centred, cluttered, no intention), and no attention to the background. By moving the mannequin near her window, using the rule of thirds, and cleaning up the background, she can produce photos that show her dresses beautifully â€” for free.

Specific fixes for Adaeze:

- Move the mannequin near the window (soft, natural light).
- Place the mannequin on a grid intersection, not dead centre (rule of thirds).
- Remove everything from the background except a plain wall or a clean surface (clean background).
- Photograph in the morning or late afternoon when the light is softest (avoid harsh midday sun).
- Take several frames and pick the sharpest.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 costs money (â‚¦150,000â€“â‚¦400,000) and does not solve the problem â€” a better phone used in bad light with poor composition still produces bad photos.
- Approach 2 is free, takes a few hours to learn, and the skill stays with Adaeze forever. She can photograph every new dress herself.
- Approach 3 works but costs money every time. Adaeze makes many dresses; hiring a photographer for each one is not sustainable for a small business.

Professional connection.

Across Nigeria, small businesses lose sales because their product photos do not show the products at their best. A tailor, a food vendor, a hair stylist, a jeweller â€” all need good photographs. The difference between a photo that sells and a photo that does not is often not the product or the camera â€” it is the light and the composition.

K.1 Centring every subject

Symptoms:
Every photo has the subject dead centre in the frame, with equal space on both sides. **Likely cause:** The photographer is pointing at the subject without thinking about placement. **How to investigate:** Look at the grid lines on the screen. Is the subject on the vertical centre line? **Corrective steps:** Move the subject to one of the four grid intersections. Leave more space on the side the subject is facing or looking toward. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is on a grid intersection, not the centre line. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make "off-centre" a habit. Before every photo, ask: "Is my subject in the middle? If so, where should it go?"

K.2 Cluttered backgrounds

Symptoms:
The subject is lost in a busy background â€" objects, people, patterns competing for attention. **Likely cause:** The photographer is focusing on the subject and ignoring everything else in the frame. **How to investigate:** Look at the photo â€" can you identify the subject immediately, or does your eye wander? **Corrective steps:** Move the camera to change the background. Or move the subject. Or use a wider aperture (on phones, use portrait mode if available) to blur the background. Or simply clean up the background before shooting. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is the clear focus of the photo; the background is clean and uncluttered. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before every photo, scan the entire frame â€" not just the subject. Ask: "What else is in this photo? Does it help or distract?"

K.3 Harsh midday sun for portraits

Symptoms:
The subject is squinting, with dark shadows under the eyes, nose and chin. Colours look washed out. **Likely cause:** Photographing in direct midday sun (roughly 11 AMâ€"2 PM). **How to investigate:** Check the time of day and the direction of the shadows. If shadows are directly under the subject, the sun is overhead. **Corrective steps:** Move the subject into open shade (under a tree, in a covered area). Or wait for a better time (morning or late afternoon). Or use a reflector to bounce light into the shadows. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is not squinting, shadows are soft or absent, colours are natural. **How to prevent recurrence:** Plan outdoor shoots for morning or late afternoon. If you must shoot at midday, find shade.

K.4 Backlight â€" subject is a silhouette

Symptoms:
The subject is very dark, almost a silhouette, against a bright background. **Likely cause:** The light is coming from behind the subject, toward the camera. The camera exposes for the bright background. **How to investigate:** Is there a bright area (window, sky, light source) behind the subject? **Corrective steps:** Move the subject so the light comes from the front or side. Or tap the subject on the screen and brighten the exposure. Or use a reflector to bounce light onto the subject. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject is clearly visible with detail, not a dark silhouette. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before every photo, check where the light is coming from. If it is behind the subject, reposition.

K.5 Lines that lead nowhere

Symptoms:
Leading lines in the photo lead the eye to the edge of the frame or to a distracting object, not the subject. **Likely cause:** The photographer saw lines but did not check where they lead. **How to investigate:** Trace the lines with your finger. Where do they go? To the subject or somewhere else? **Corrective steps:** Reposition yourself so the lines lead to the subject. If they cannot lead to the subject, find different lines or a different angle. **How to confirm resolved:** The lines lead the viewer's eye directly to the subject. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before taking the photo, trace the lines and confirm they lead where you want the eye to go.

K.6 Using a frame that distracts

Symptoms:

interesting than the subject? **Corrective steps:** Find a simpler frame. Or change the angle so the frame is less prominent. Or use a wider aperture (portrait mode) to blur the frame slightly. **How to confirm resolved:** The frame enhances the subject, not competes with it. **How to prevent recurrence:** Choose frames that are simple and complementary to the subject.

K.7 Symmetry that is not symmetrical

Symptoms:
A supposedly symmetrical photo where one side is slightly different from the other â€" a door frame is tilted, one side has an object the other does not. **Likely cause:** The camera is not perfectly aligned with the centre line of the subject. **How to investigate:** Look at the grid lines. Is the centre of the subject exactly on the vertical centre line? **Corrective steps:** Adjust the camera position until the subject is perfectly centred. Use the grid lines as a guide. Take the photo from directly in front of the subject, not at an angle. **How to confirm resolved:** Both sides of the photo are as identical as possible. **How to prevent recurrence:** For symmetry, take time to align carefully. Small tilts ruin the effect.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed:
A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" look at the actual photo, trace the lines, check the light direction, and confirm the cause before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title:
"Composition and Light Series â€" My Eight"

Purpose:
To practise the four composition techniques and produce a light study that shows clear understanding of how light affects a subject. This assignment forms the raw material for the Week 1 mini-project (the foundations folder) and the capstone portfolio.

Realistic scenario.
You are building your photography skill. Your client â€" a friend with a small business, your own business, or a fictional client â€" needs a set of photos that look intentional and professional. Before you can deliver that, you need to prove to yourself that you can compose deliberately and use light well.

Detailed instructions:

1. Find **one subject** that can stay still for several photos: a bottle, a cup, a bag, a plant, or a classmate who has agreed.
2. **Composition series (4 photos):** Photograph the subject using each of the four techniques:
    - Rule of thirds (subject on a grid intersection)
    - Framing (subject framed by a natural frame)
    - Leading lines (lines lead to the subject)
    - Symmetry or perspective (balanced or deep)
3. **Light study (4 photos):** Photograph the same subject in four different lighting conditions:
    - Near a window (soft light)
    - In open shade (soft, even light)
    - In direct bright light (harsh light)
    - With a bright background behind it (backlight)
4. For each of the eight photos, write one sentence in your workbook: "*Technique/Light:* _____. *What I did:* _____."
5. Organise all eight photos in your `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname` folder in a subfolder named `Week1-Composition-Light`.

Required deliverables:

- A folder with eight photos (four composition, four light study).
- Eight written sentences (one per photo) explaining the technique or light used.

folder.

Deadline:
Before Session 3.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Rule of thirds	1	Subject clearly on a grid intersection, not centred
Framing	1	Subject clearly framed by a natural frame
Leading lines	1	Lines clearly lead to the subject
Symmetry or perspective	1	Balanced or deep composition, clearly intentional
Light study â€" variety	2	Four genuinely different lighting conditions
Light study â€" quality	2	At least two photos clearly flattering (window or shade)
Written explanations	2	Accurate descriptions of technique/light for all eight photos

Common mistakes to avoid:
centring every subject; cluttered backgrounds; photographing in harsh midday sun for portraits; backlight silhouettes; lines that lead nowhere; labelling a photo as "rule of thirds" when the subject is actually centred.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner submission contains:

- **Rule of thirds:** A subject placed on a grid intersection, with space in the direction the subject is facing.
- **Framing:** A subject photographed through a doorway, window or natural arch, with the frame clearly surrounding the subject.
- **Leading lines:** A subject at the end of a line or row (books, table edge, corridor), with the lines clearly leading the eye inward.
- **Symmetry or perspective:** A symmetrical scene (a door, a face) or a perspective scene (a corridor, a row of objects) with clear depth.
- **Light study:** Four photos showing genuinely different light â€" soft window light, even shade, harsh direct light, and backlight (with the backlight photo showing the subject as a silhouette or corrected with exposure).

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer.
What is composition, and why does it matter?

Q2. Multiple choice.
You are photographing a person who is looking toward the left side of the frame. According to the rule of thirds, where should you place the person in the frame? a) Dead centre, looking left b) On the right vertical line, looking left into the empty space c) On the left vertical line, looking left out of the frame d) On the bottom horizontal line, looking left

Q3. Explain in your own words.
What is framing in photography? Give one example of a natural frame.

Q4. Practical identification.
A photo has a bright window behind the subject, and the subject is very dark â€" almost a silhouette. What is this problem called, and what are two ways to fix it?

light from a window â€“ best for indoor portraits and products b) The hour after sunrise or before sunset â€“ warm, golden, flattering light c) Direct overhead sun â€” harsh shadows, squinting, washed-out colours d) Soft, even light in a shaded area â€” safe and flattering for outdoor portraits

Q6. Scenario.
You are photographing a product for a WhatsApp Business catalogue. The product is on a cluttered table, under a fluorescent light, in the middle of the afternoon. What are three things you could do to make the photo look better?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q6)

A1.
Composition is how you arrange the subject, background and space within the frame. It matters because a well-composed photo looks intentional and pleasing â€” it guides the viewer's eye to the subject. A poorly composed photo looks accidental and unprofessional.

A2.
(b) On the right vertical line, looking left into the empty space. The person should have space in the direction they are looking.

A3.
Framing is using elements in the scene to create a natural border around the subject â€” a doorway, window, tree branches, an archway. It draws the eye to the subject and adds depth. Example: photographing a person through a doorway.

A4.
This is called backlight (or silhouette). Two fixes: (1) Move the subject so the light comes from the front or side, not behind. (2) Tap the subject on the screen and brighten the exposure.

A5.
golden hour = (b); window light = (a); open shade = (d); harsh midday sun = (c).

A6.
Three things: (1) Move the product to a window or shaded area with better light. (2) Clean up the background â€” remove clutter and use a plain surface. (3) Use the rule of thirds â€” place the product on a grid intersection, not dead centre. (Also acceptable: tap to focus on the product, take several frames, use the 5-step sharpness routine.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary.
Today you learned that composition is how you arrange the photo â€” where the subject sits, what is around it, and what angle you shoot from. You learned four techniques: the rule of thirds (off-centre is stronger than centred), framing (use a natural frame to draw the eye in), leading lines (use lines to guide the viewer to the subject), and symmetry and perspective (balance and depth). Then you learned about light â€” the raw material of photography. You learned the four natural light conditions: golden hour (best), window light (easiest), open shade (safest) and harsh midday sun (avoid). You learned that backlight is the most common mistake and how to fix it. You took a four-image composition series and a four-image light study.

Five important takeaways:

1. Composition is a set of choices â€” the rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry and perspective.
2. Off-centre is stronger than centred â€” place the subject on a grid intersection.
3. Light matters more than the camera â€” a phone in good light beats an expensive camera in bad light.
4. Golden hour, window light and open shade are your friends; harsh midday sun is not.
5. Backlight turns your subject into a silhouette â€” fix it by repositioning or adjusting exposure.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I place a subject on a grid intersection without thinking about it?
- Can I find a natural frame in any environment?

- Can I choose a flattering time and place to shoot a portrait?
- Can I take a four-photo light study and explain why each photo looks the way it does?

Connection to the next session.
You now know how to make a photo sharp, correctly exposed, well-composed and beautifully lit. Next session you apply all of that to the three subjects that earn money: people, products and events. You will learn to direct a simple portrait pose, build a clean product scene, and work an event to capture key moments sharply. Consent is confirmed for every person photographed. This is where your foundations folder comes together.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner places the subject off-centre without being reminded.
- Learner scans the background before taking a photo and removes distractions.
- Learner identifies the direction and quality of light before shooting.
- Learner moves the subject or themselves to find better light.
- Learner produces photos where the technique is visible â€" you can look at the photo and name the technique used.
- Learner diagnoses their own photos accurately.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Composition rules are too restrictive â€" I want to be creative." â†' Learn the rules first, then break them deliberately.
- "I can fix the light in editing." â†' Editing can improve exposure slightly; it cannot fix harsh shadows or a silhouette.
- "More light is better." â†' Soft, indirect light is often better than bright, direct light.
- "The background does not matter." â†' A cluttered background ruins an otherwise good photo.
- "Backlight is always bad." â†' Intentional backlight (e.g., golden hour rim light) can be beautiful. The problem is *accidental* backlight that creates a silhouette.
- "I need to shoot at midday because that is when I am free." â†' Choose the light, then fit your schedule around it.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Grid drill:** Take 10 photos of any subject, each with the subject on a different grid intersection. Review â€" all should be off-centre.
2. **Frame hunt:** Walk around the building and find five natural frames (doorways, windows, gaps between objects). Photograph a subject through each one.
3. **Light comparison:** Photograph the same subject in four different lights. Label each photo with the light condition and why it looks the way it does.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a printed sheet with the four techniques illustrated with simple diagrams. Pair the learner with a confident learner for the practical.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full lecture, demonstration, guided practical and assignment.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to combine two techniques in one photo (e.g., rule of thirds + leading lines, or framing + symmetry) and explain why the combination works. They should also research and present one additional composition technique not covered in the session (e.g., negative space, filling the frame, or the golden ratio).

Timing guidance.
The priority is learners taking photos with good composition and good light (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the lecture's composition techniques to the key demonstrations (rule of thirds and framing) and protect the practical time. A learner who leaves without taking a four-photo composition series and a light study has no material for the Week 1 mini-project.

CYBER
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SESSION 3 â€" SHOOTING PEOPLE, PRODUCTS AND EVENTS

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" PHOTOGRAPHY

SESSION 3 â€" SHOOTING PEOPLE, PRODUCTS AND EVENTS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	3 of 6
Session title	Shooting People, Products and Events
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: "See and Shoot" (Foundations)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (practical, subject-focused)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"2 â€" the learner should be able to produce a sharp, correctly exposed photo, apply the rule of thirds, and identify good and bad light. The 5-step sharpness routine and the four composition techniques are assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Sessions 1 and 2 you learned the technical and artistic foundations. Today you apply them to the three subjects that earn money: people (portraits), products (business images) and events (moments). This session closes Week 1's foundations folder.
Preparation before class	A willing colleague or mannequin for the portrait demonstration; a simple product (a shoe, a bag, a plate of food, a phone accessory) for the product demonstration; a plain surface (a table, a bedsheet, a piece of cardboard) and a white card or reflector for the product scene; printed consent forms for any person photographed; the "Foundations Folder Checklist" (Section H) printed per learner; a simulated event setup (a person pouring a drink, cutting a cake, or handing over an item) for the event demonstration.

Instructor note on tone:
This session is about confidence with subjects. Many learners are nervous about photographing people â€" they fear being intrusive or getting it wrong. Create a supportive atmosphere. Emphasise consent, kindness and clear communication. Celebrate every good portrait, even imperfect ones.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Put a subject at ease** before photographing them, using simple communication and direction.
2. **Direct a simple portrait pose** â€" position the subject's body, hands and face for a natural, flattering result.
3. **Produce a sharp, well-lit portrait** using natural light, the rule of thirds and the 5-step sharpness routine.
4. **Build a clean product scene** â€" choose a surface, manage the background, control reflections and light the product flatteringly.
5. **Produce a usable product image** suitable for a WhatsApp Business catalogue or Jiji listing.
6. **Work a simulated event** â€" capture key moments sharply, adapt to changing light and stay unobtrusive.
7. **Confirm consent** for every person photographed, using a printed consent form.

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a working camera.
- Instructor's phone connected to a projector or large screen.
- A phone tripod or improvised stand.
- A white card, reflector or A4 paper for bouncing light.
- A plain surface for the product scene: a table, a white bedsheet, a piece of cardboard or a clean floor.

Software

- The phone's built-in camera app (default shooting tool).
- No editing software needed today; editing begins in Session 4.

Accounts

- None required this session.

Sample files

- **Three portrait examples** (printed or projected): one poorly posed (stiff, awkward, bad light), one acceptably posed, one well-posed and well-lit.
- **Three product examples** (printed or projected): one cluttered, poorly lit product shot; one acceptable; one clean, professional product shot.
- **Consent form** (printed per learner) â€” a simple one-page form with the subject's name, signature, date and a statement that they agree to be photographed.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 3.1 â€” "Portrait Checklist" (a table: light, pose, focus, background, expression â€” each with a tick box).
- Worksheet 3.2 â€— "Product Scene Planner" (a table: surface, background, light direction, angle, props).
- Worksheet 3.3 â€— "Event Moment Log" (a table: moment, light condition, sharpness, result).

Tools

- A whiteboard and markers.
- A ruler for drawing the product scene diagram.

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a capable phone

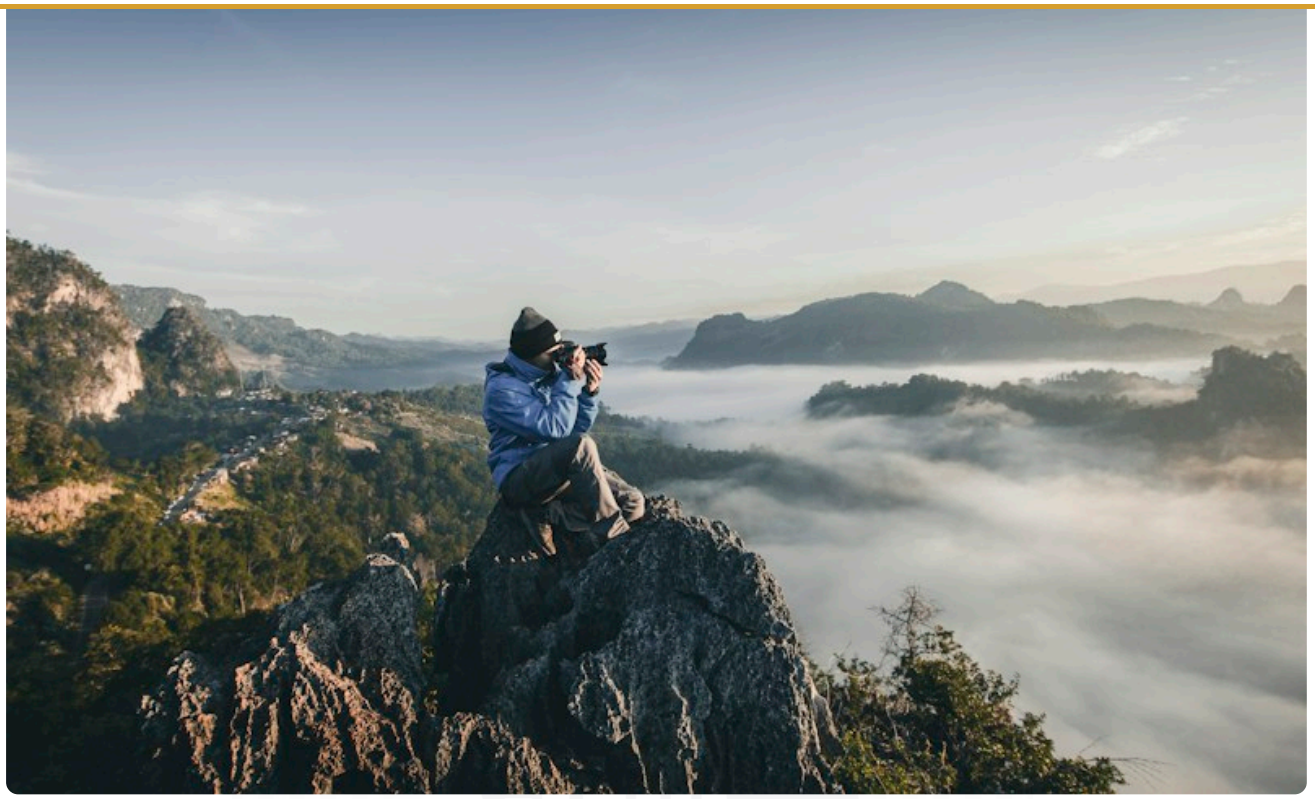
- Any phone with a working camera works. A learner without a phone may pair with a classmate, use an academy phone or use an academy computer with a webcam. They must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

Consent and safety note:
Before photographing any person in this class â€— including classmates â€— ask for their permission first and have them sign the consent form. If someone says no, put the camera down. No exceptions. For the simulated event, use classmates who have agreed to participate.

Suggested visuals:



- â€" shooting people and products

- 

â€" covering an event

- 

â€" quick phone product shots



- â€" photographing people and products



- â€" covering an event or client shoot

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup:

On the projector, show three portraits of the same person:

- **Portrait B (acceptable):** The person is in open shade, looking at the camera, arms relaxed, but the pose is stiff and the expression is awkward â€" like a passport photo.
- **Portrait C (strong):** The person is near a window (soft light on their face), body turned slightly, hands doing something natural (holding a cup, resting on a table), a genuine smile, clean background, sharp focus on the eyes.

What the instructor says:

> *"Same person. Three photos. One looks like a mistake, one looks like an ID card, and one looks like a professional portrait. Hands up â€" which one would you use for a business profile? â€¦ Photo C, almost everyone. Now tell me: what is different about Photo C?"*

Expected learner response:
Learners will say things like "the light is better," "she is smiling," "she looks comfortable," "the background is clean," "you can see her face," "she looks natural." Accept all answers and write the key phrases on the board: **light, pose, expression, background, comfort.**

Then reveal the lesson:
Say clearly:

> *"A good portrait is not about the person being beautiful â€" it is about the photographer making them look their best. The light, the pose, the background, the moment â€" all of those are the photographer's choices. Today you learn to make those choices for people, products and events. By the end of this session, you will have a portrait, a product shot and an event shot in your foundations folder."*

Why this opener works:
It uses the same person in all three photos, proving that the photographer â€" not the subject â€" makes the difference. It introduces the three subjects (people, products, events) before any technical explanation.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1:
"What are the four composition techniques we learned in Session 2?"

- Expected answer: Rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry/perspective.
- Common gap: Learners may remember rule of thirds but forget the others. Clarify: "Off-centre placement, using a natural frame, using lines to lead the eye, and using symmetry or depth."

Question 2:
"What are the four natural light conditions, and which ones are flattering for portraits?"

- Expected answer: Golden hour (flattering), window light (flattering), open shade (flattering), harsh midday sun (unflattering â€" avoid).
- Common gap: Learners may say "more light is better." Clarify: "Soft, indirect light is flattering. Direct, harsh light creates shadows and squinting. The best light is often the gentlest light."

Question 3:
"What is the 5-step sharpness routine?"

- Expected answer: Steady hold, tap to focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames.
- Common gap: Learners may remember the steps but not the order. Clarify: "Steady, focus, exposure, background, frames â€" in that order."

> *"You have the tools: sharpness, composition and light. Today we point those tools at the three things that pay: people, products and events. These are the subjects clients pay for. A business owner pays for product photos. A family pays for portraits. A church or school pays for event coverage. Today you prove you can deliver all three."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the four composition techniques, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing them on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Photographing people â€” the portrait

The idea.
A portrait is a photograph of a person that shows who they are â€” their character, their mood, their professionalism. A good portrait makes the subject look their best: comfortable, confident and well-lit. A good portrait is not about the subject being naturally photogenic â€ it is about the photographer creating the conditions for a good photo.

The three things that make a good portrait (teach these and return to them all session):

Element	What it means	How to get it right
Light	The light on the subject's face	Use soft, directional light â€ window light or open shade. Never harsh midday sun. Never backlight (unless intentional).
Pose	How the subject's body is positioned	Give the subject something to do with their hands. Turn the body slightly. Ask them to relax. Avoid stiff, straight-on poses.
Expression	The subject's face and emotion	Talk to the subject. Make them laugh. Capture a genuine moment, not a forced smile. Take many frames â€ the best expression is often between poses.

Putting the subject at ease (the most important portrait skill):

Many learners are nervous about photographing people. This is normal. The solution is communication:

1. **Introduce yourself.** Tell the person your name and what you are doing. "Hello, I'm Chinedu, I'm learning photography and I'd like to take your portrait. Is that okay?"
2. **Explain what you need.** "I'm going to ask you to stand near this window and just be yourself. I'll take a few photos and we'll check them together."
3. **Give direction, not orders.** Instead of "stand there and smile," say "why don't you lean against the wall and look out the window for a moment?" Direction gives the subject something to do; orders make them stiff.
4. **Talk while you shoot.** Do not shoot in silence. Ask about their day, their work, their family. The best expressions happen when the subject is relaxed and engaged.
5. **Show them the result.** After taking a few photos, show the subject the screen. "Look â€ that one is beautiful. See how the light catches your face?" This builds trust and makes them more comfortable.

Simple posing basics (for beginners):

Do not overcomplicate posing. These four steps work for almost everyone:

1. **Turn the body slightly.** Ask the subject to turn their body about 30â€"45 degrees away from the camera. This is more flattering than standing straight on â€ it creates a natural line and avoids the "passport photo" look.
2. **Give the hands something to do.** Stiff arms at the sides look awkward. Ask the subject to hold something (a cup, a phone, a book), rest their hands on a surface, or cross their arms loosely. Hands that are doing something look natural.
3. **Angle the face.** Ask the subject to turn their face slightly toward the light. If the light is coming from the left, they should turn their face left. This ensures the face is well-lit.

Light for portraits â€” the two best options:

- **Window light:** Place the subject near a window, facing the window or at a 45-degree angle to it. The window provides soft, directional light that is flattering on the face. Never place the subject with their back to the window (backlight â€” the face goes dark).
- **Open shade:** Place the subject in the shade of a tree or building, with a bright, open area in front of them. The shade eliminates harsh shadows and squinting. The subject should be in shade, but the light in front of them should be bright.

Background for portraits:

- Clean and uncluttered. A plain wall, a blurred background, or a simple outdoor setting.
- Nothing growing out of the subject's head â€” no poles, no branches, no distracting objects.
- Use the rule of thirds â€” place the subject's eyes on the top horizontal line, on one of the vertical lines.

Worked example:

- Weak: A person standing straight on, arms at their sides, in harsh midday sun, against a cluttered background, with a forced smile. The photo looks like a mugshot.
- Strong: The same person, turned slightly, holding a cup, near a window with soft light on their face, against a clean wall, with a genuine laugh. The photo looks like a professional portrait.

Real-life comparison.
A good portrait is like a good conversation. If you stand stiffly and say nothing, the conversation is awkward. If you relax, gesture naturally, and engage with the other person, the conversation flows. A portrait works the same way â€” the photographer's job is to make the subject relax and then capture the natural moment.

Misconception to correct.
"The subject needs to be naturally photogenic." No. A good photographer can make almost anyone look good by controlling the light, the pose and the moment. Photogenic means "photographed well" â€ and that is the photographer's work, not the subject's gift.

F.2 Photographing products â€ the business image

The idea.
A product photograph is a photograph of an item for sale â€ for a WhatsApp Business catalogue, a Jiji listing, an Instagram post or a flyer. A good product photo shows the product clearly, makes it looks appealing, and gives the buyer confidence to purchase. A poor product photo â€ dark, blurry, cluttered â€ makes the buyer walk away.

The four elements of a good product photo (teach these and return to them all session):

Element	What it means	How to get it right
Surface	What the product sits on	A clean, plain surface â€ a white bedsheet, a wooden table, a piece of cardboard. No clutter.
Background	What is behind the product	A plain, uncluttered background â€ a wall, a sheet hung up, a blurred background. Nothing distracting.
Light	How the product is lit	Soft, even light â€ window light or open shade. No harsh shadows. Reflector (white card) to fill shadows.
Angle	Where the camera is positioned	Eye level or slightly above. Show the product's best side. For food, shoot from above (flat lay) or at 45 degrees.

Building a product scene â€ step by step:

1. **Choose the surface.** Find a clean, plain surface â€ a table, a bed, a piece of cardboard. Cover it with a white sheet, a plain cloth or a piece of paper if needed. The surface should be clean and uncluttered.

product, use a dark background.

3. **Position the product.** Place the product on the surface. Make sure it is clean â€" wipe off dust, fingerprints, smudges. Arrange it at its best angle â€" the side that shows the product's shape, label or detail.
4. **Set the light.** Place the product near a window (soft light) or in open shade. If one side of the product is in shadow, use a white card or reflector on the shadow side to bounce light back. This "fills" the shadows and makes the product look evenly lit.
5. **Compose the photo.** Use the rule of thirds â€" place the product on a grid intersection. Use the 5-step sharpness routine. Take several frames. Check the result by zooming in.

Managing reflections:

- Shiny products (glass, metal, polished surfaces) create reflections â€" the camera, the photographer, the room.
- To reduce reflections: shoot from a slight angle, not straight on. Use soft light (window light, not direct sun). Place a white card on the opposite side of the product to fill in the shadow and balance the reflection.
- To eliminate reflections on glass: place a black card or cloth behind the product (not visible to the camera) to create a clean, dark background behind the glass.

Worked example â€" photographing a shoe:

- Weak: A shoe on a cluttered floor, in a dim corner, with other shoes and objects around it. The shoe is dark, the background is messy, the photo is blurry. The buyer cannot see the shoe clearly.
- Strong: The same shoe, on a white sheet near a window, with a white card bouncing light onto the shadow side. The shoe is sharp, well-lit, and the background is clean. The buyer can see every detail â€" the colour, the texture, the sole. This photo makes the buyer want to purchase.

Real-life comparison.
A product photo is like a shop window display. A good shop window is clean, well-lit, and shows the product at its best â€" with nothing distracting from it. A poor shop window is cluttered, dim, and shows the product buried among other items. Your job as a product photographer is to create a clean, well-lit "shop window" for every product.

Misconception to correct.
"I need a photo studio and professional lighting to take good product photos." No. A window, a white sheet and a cardboard reflector are enough to produce professional-quality product photos. The principles matter more than the equipment.

F.3 Photographing events â€" the moment

The idea.
An event is a gathering where things happen â€" a birthday party, a church service, a naming ceremony, a wedding, a shop opening, a graduation. Event photography means capturing the key moments of the event â€" the smiles, the actions, the emotions â€" sharply and well-lit, while staying unobtrusive.

The three challenges of event photography (teach these and return to them all session):

Challenge	What it means	How to handle it
Changing light	The light changes â€" indoors to outdoors, bright to dim, one side of the room to the other	Check the light constantly. Adjust exposure as you move. Use HDR for high-contrast scenes. Be ready to shoot in any light.
Moving subjects	People move â€" walking, talking, dancing, hugging	Use the 5-step sharpness routine. Take many frames. Capture the moment, not just the pose. Be ready â€" anticipate what will happen next.
Staying unobtrusive	You are part of the event but should not dominate it	Do not block people's view. Do not use flash (unless necessary and permitted). Move quietly. Be respectful. Photograph people with their knowledge and consent.

The five key moments to capture at any event:

2. **The greeting** â€" people arriving, shaking hands, hugging, greeting each other. These photos capture the welcome and the community.
3. **The main action** â€" the key moment: cutting the cake, handing over a gift, the first dance, the speech, the performance. This is the moment everyone remembers.
4. **The emotion** â€" the reactions: laughter, tears, surprise, joy. These photos capture the feeling of the event.
5. **The detail** â€" the small things: the decorations, the food, the flowers, the dress, the invitations. These photos complete the story.

How to work an event like a professional:

1. **Arrive early.** Get there before the event starts. Scout the location â€" find the best light, the best angles, the spots where the key moments will happen.
2. **Plan your shots.** Think about the five key moments. Where will the cake be cut? Where will the speeches happen? Where will people gather? Position yourself near those spots.
3. **Stay ready.** Keep your camera on. Keep your finger near the shutter. Anticipate what will happen next. The best moments are often unexpected â€" a child running, a spontaneous laugh, a sudden embrace.
4. **Take many frames.** Events are unpredictable. Take many photos of every moment. One frame will be sharp, one will capture the right expression, one will be perfect.
5. **Be respectful.** Do not block the view. Do not use flash if it will disturb people. Do not photograph anyone who has asked not to be photographed. Consent is just as important at events as in the studio.

Light at events:

- Indoor events often have mixed light â€" overhead lights, windows, sometimes coloured lights. Check the white balance (the colour of the light) and adjust if needed.
- Outdoor events may have changing light â€" sun moving behind clouds, shade moving. Check the exposure constantly.
- If the light is very dim, use a higher ISO (on phones, this is automatic) or use a tripod or steady surface to avoid blur. Do not use flash unless it is necessary and permitted â€" flash can be harsh and distracting.

Worked example â€" a birthday party:

- Weak: Photos of people standing awkwardly, with the cake not visible, in harsh flash light, with the subject's eyes closed. The photos look like an afterthought.
- Strong: Photos of the decorations being set up, guests arriving and greeting each other, the cake being cut (with the knife visible and the candles lit), the birthday person's reaction (joy, surprise), the food on the table, and a group photo of everyone smiling. These photos tell the complete story of the event.

Real-life comparison.
Event photography is like being a storyteller. A good storyteller does not just tell you what happened â€" they show you the moments, the emotions, the details. Your photos are the story of the event. The client is not just buying photos â€" they are buying the memory.

Misconception to correct.
"Event photography means taking hundreds of photos and hoping some are good." No. A good event photographer plans, anticipates and captures the key moments deliberately. Taking many frames is part of it â€" but the frames are taken with intention, not randomly.

F.4 Consent and respect â€" the photographer's responsibility

The idea.
Photography is a profession built on trust. Before you photograph a person â€" in a portrait, at an event, in a public place â€" you must ask for their permission. This is not just politeness â€" it is a professional and ethical obligation.

The consent rule (read this aloud and make sure every learner understands):

- **Ask first.** Before you photograph any person, ask: "May I take your photo?" If they say yes, proceed. If they say no, put the camera down â€" no argument, no exceptions.

- **Show respect.** If someone is uncomfortable, stop. If someone asks you to delete a photo, delete it. If someone does not want to be photographed at an event, do not photograph them.
- **Use a consent form.** For any person photographed for practice, portfolio or client use, have them sign a simple consent form. This protects both you and the subject.

The consent form (simple version):

```
CONSENT TO BE PHOTOGRAPHED

I, _____ (name), agree to be photographed by
_____ (photographer's name) on _____ (date).

I understand that the photographs may be used for:
[ ] Practice and learning
[ ] Portfolio
[ ] Client/business use
[ ] Social media

I give my permission freely and can ask for the photos to be deleted at any time.

Signature: _____
Date: _____

For subjects under 18:
Parent/Guardian name: _____
Parent/Guardian signature: _____
Date: _____
```

Why consent matters:

- It is respectful. People have the right to control how their image is used.
- It is professional. A photographer who asks consent is trusted. A photographer who does not is avoided.
- It is legal. In Nigeria, using someone's image without permission â€" especially for commercial purposes â€" can create legal problems.
- It builds your reputation. Clients hire photographers they trust. Trust starts with consent.

Misconception to correct.
"If I am in a public place, I can photograph anyone." Not exactly. You can photograph public scenes and buildings, but photographing identifiable people â€" especially for commercial use â€" requires consent. When in doubt, ask.

F.5 Summary of the lecture

- A good portrait has three elements: light, pose and expression. Put the subject at ease, use soft light, give direction, and capture the moment.
- A good product photo has four elements: surface, background, light and angle. Build a clean scene, use soft light, and compose deliberately.
- Event photography has three challenges: changing light, moving subjects and staying unobtrusive. Capture the five key moments: preparation, greeting, main action, emotion and detail.
- Consent is mandatory: ask first, get parent/guardian consent for under-18s, use a consent form, and respect people's wishes.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Clean lens] --> D[Sharp photo]
    B[Steady hands] --> D
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A willing colleague or mannequin for the portrait.
- A simple product (a shoe, a bag, a plate of food) and a plain surface (white sheet, table).
- A white card or reflector.
- A consent form (signed by the colleague before the demo).
- A simulated event setup: a person pouring a drink or cutting a cake.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" the portrait (5 minutes)

Say:
"I am going to photograph Adaeze. Watch how I set up the light, direct the pose and capture the moment."

Step 1 â€" Light:
Position Adaeze near a window. "Soft light from the window, falling on her face. She is not facing the window directly â€" she is at a 45-degree angle. This gives depth to her face."

Step 2 â€" Background:
Check the background. "Clean wall behind her. Nothing distracting."

Step 3 â€" Pose:
"Adaeze, turn your body slightly to the left. Rest your hand on the table. Now turn your face toward the light â€" yes, like that. Perfect."

Step 4 â€" Direction:
"Now look out the window for a moment â€" just naturally. â€¦ Now look back at me. â€¦ Tell me about your work â€" what do you do? â€¦ [Adaeze talks and laughs]"

Step 5 â€" Capture:
Take several photos while Adaeze talks. Show the best one on the projector. "See â€" she is relaxed, the light is soft on her face, her hands are doing something natural, and she is laughing. That is a portrait."

Say:
"The difference between a snapshot and a portrait is not the camera â€" it is the time you take to make the person comfortable. Talk to them, give them something to do, and capture the moment when they forget about the camera."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" the product scene (5 minutes)

Say:
"Now I am going to photograph this shoe for a WhatsApp Business catalogue. Watch how I build the scene."

Step 1 â€" Surface:
Lay a white sheet on the table. "Clean, plain surface. No clutter."

Step 2 â€" Background:
Hang a white sheet behind the table. "Plain background. Nothing distracting."

Step 3 â€" Product:
Place the shoe on the sheet. Wipe it clean. "The shoe is clean â€" no dust, no smudges. I am placing it at a 45-degree angle so you can see the shape and the label."

Step 4 â€" Light:
Position the shoe near a window. "Soft light from the window. One side is in shadow â€" I am going to fill it with a white card." Place a white card on the shadow side. "The card bounces light back onto the shadow side. Now the shoe is evenly lit."

Step 5 â€" Compose:

Step 6 â€” Capture:
Take several photos. Show the best one. "Sharp, well-lit, clean background. This photo makes the buyer want to purchase."

Say:
"A product photo is not just a photo of a product â€” it is a sales tool. The cleaner the scene, the more professional the product looks, and the more confident the buyer feels."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€” the event moment (4 minutes)

Say:
"Now a simulated event. Adaeze is going to pour a drink. Watch how I capture the moment."

Step 1 â€” Anticipate:
"I know she is going to pour. I am positioning myself where I can see the action clearly â€” not too close, not too far."

Step 2 â€” Light:
"The light is coming from the side. I am checking the exposure â€” it looks good."

Step 3 â€” Capture:
Adaeze pours the drink. Take several photos in quick succession. "I took five frames. One will be perfect â€” the liquid mid-pour, the expression on her face, the glass filling up."

Step 4 â€” Review:
Show the best frame. "Sharp, well-lit, the action is clear. That is the moment."

Say:
"Event photography is about anticipation. You cannot control the moment â€” but you can be ready for it. Position yourself, check the light, and take many frames."

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "What is the difference between a snapshot and a portrait?" (Time, communication, light, pose.)
- "Why did I use a white card on the shadow side of the shoe?" (To fill the shadows â€” to bounce light back.)
- "Why did I take five frames of the pour?" (One will be perfect â€” the others may be blurry or the expression may be wrong.)
- "What is the most important thing about photographing people?" (Consent and respect.)
- "Can you take good product photos without a studio?" (Yes â€” a window, a sheet and a card are enough.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective:
With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner produces a portrait, a product shot and an event shot, completing the foundations folder.

Starting materials:
Learner's own phone; a classmate who has agreed to be photographed (with signed consent form); a simple product (a shoe, a bag, a bottle, a book); a plain surface and background; a white card or reflector; the printed worksheets.

Procedure â€” Part 1: Portrait (6 minutes)

1. Ask a classmate to be your subject. Explain what you are doing. Have them sign the consent form.
2. Position your subject near a window or in open shade. Check the light on their face.
3. Direct the pose: turn the body slightly, give the hands something to do, angle the face toward the light.
4. Talk to your subject. Make them comfortable. Take at least five photos.
5. Review the photos. Pick the strongest one. Tick the Portrait Checklist.

Procedure â€” Part 2: Product (6 minutes)

3. Set the light: near a window or in open shade. Use a white card to fill shadows.
4. Compose using the rule of thirds. Use the 5-step sharpness routine. Take at least five photos.
5. Review the photos. Pick the strongest one. Fill in the Product Scene Planner.

Procedure â€" Part 3: Event (6 minutes)

1. Work in pairs. One person is the "event" â€" they will perform a simple action (pouring a drink, opening a book, handing over an item). The other is the photographer.
2. The photographer positions themselves, checks the light, and anticipates the action.
3. The "event" person performs the action. The photographer takes at least five photos in quick succession.
4. Review the photos. Pick the strongest one. Fill in the Event Moment Log.
5. Swap roles and repeat.

Expected result:
One portrait, one product shot and one event shot, each with a completed worksheet.

Points to pause and predict:

- After the portrait: "Is your subject comfortable? If not, what could you do to make them more relaxed?"
- After the product: "Is the background clean? Is the product well-lit? Would a buyer want to purchase from this photo?"
- After the event: "Did you capture the action clearly? Is the photo sharp? Did you take enough frames?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner's subject looks stiff â†' Suggest giving the hands something to do, or asking the subject to talk about something they enjoy.
- Product photo has harsh shadows â†' Have them use the white card to fill the shadow side.
- Event photo is blurry â†' Check if the subject moved too fast. Suggest taking more frames, or asking the subject to move more slowly.
- Learner has not obtained consent â†' Stop the exercise. Remind them of the consent rule. No consent, no photo.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Portrait taken â€" subject comfortable, well-lit, sharp
- ☐ Consent form signed for the portrait subject
- ☐ Product shot taken â€" clean scene, well-lit, sharp
- ☐ Event shot taken â€" action captured sharply
- ☐ Portrait Checklist completed
- ☐ Product Scene Planner completed
- ☐ Event Moment Log completed
- ☐ All three photos saved in the foundations folder

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task:
Complete the foundations folder â€" a 12-image set covering composition, light and subjects.

Setup:
You have already taken photos in Sessions 1, 2 and 3. Now you organise and complete your foundations folder â€" the 12-image set that forms the raw material of your capstone portfolio.

Requirements:

1. Review all the photos you have taken so far in the course.
2. Select and organise **12 images** into three groups.

- **4 subject images** â€” one portrait, one product, one event, and one additional image of your choice.

3. For each image, write one sentence in your workbook: "*This image shows _____ because _____.*"
4. Ensure every image of a person has a signed consent form.
5. Organise all 12 images in your `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname` folder in a subfolder named `Foundations-Folder`.

Constraints:

- Use only photos you have taken yourself during this course.
- Do not use filters or editing â€” these are raw images.
- Every image must be sharp and correctly exposed.
- Every image of a person must have consent.

Time allowance:
15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- 12 images organised into three groups of four.
- Each image has a written description.
- All images are sharp and correctly exposed.
- All consent forms are completed.
- The folder is properly named and organised.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: If you are missing images for a specific category, take them now â€” you have 15 minutes.
- Hint 2: Review your existing photos before taking new ones. You may already have usable images.
- Hint 3: The "additional image of your choice" can be anything â€” a landscape, a detail shot, a creative composition. Choose something you are proud of.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€” do not show learners):

A strong foundations folder contains:

- **Composition:** Four images, each clearly demonstrating one technique. The rule of thirds image has the subject on a grid intersection. The framing image has a natural frame. The leading lines image has lines leading to the subject. The symmetry/perspective image is balanced or deep.
- **Light study:** Four images of the same subject in four different lights â€” window light, open shade, direct light and backlight. The differences between the images are visible.
- **Subjects:** A portrait (comfortable subject, soft light, clean background), a product shot (clean scene, well-lit), an event shot (action captured sharply) and one additional image.
- Written descriptions: Accurate and specific. "This image shows the rule of thirds because the subject is placed on the right vertical grid line, with space on the left."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- 12 images present and organised (3)
- Each group has four images (2)
- Images are sharp and correctly exposed (2)
- Written descriptions are accurate (2)
- Consent forms completed for all people photographed (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation.

but she has never taken a product photo before. She asks her nephew, *Chinedu*, who has a smartphone, to take some photos.

Relevant facts.

- Chinedu has a recent smartphone with a good camera.
- He has never studied photography â€" he just points and shoots.
- Mama Nkechi's products are in plastic containers and glass jars, with handwritten labels.
- The photos are taken in her kitchen, under fluorescent lights, with a cluttered background (pots, pans, ingredients).
- The photos are dark, the labels are hard to read, and the products look unappealing.

Decision point.
What should Chinedu do differently to produce photos that will help Mama Nkechi's business?

Possible approaches.

1. Take the photos in the same way but use a brighter flash.
2. Learn to build a clean product scene â€" use natural light, a clean surface, a plain background, and compose deliberately.
3. Ask a professional photographer to take the photos for Mama Nkechi.

Recommended solution.
Approach 2. Chinedu's phone is already capable of good product photos. His problem is the scene â€" cluttered background, poor light, no composition. By moving the products near a window, using a clean surface and background, and composing with the rule of thirds, he can produce photos that make Mama Nkechi's products look professional and appealing.

Specific fixes for Chinedu:

- Move the products near a window (soft, natural light).
- Use a clean, plain surface â€" a white sheet or a clean table.
- Use a plain background â€" a wall or a sheet hung up.
- Wipe the containers clean â€" remove smudges and fingerprints.
- Position the products at their best angle â€" labels facing the camera.
- Use the rule of thirds â€" place the product on a grid intersection.
- Take several frames and pick the sharpest.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (brighter flash) makes the photo brighter but does not fix the cluttered background or the unflattering light. Flash creates harsh shadows and makes the products look worse.
- Approach 2 is free, takes a few hours to learn, and the skill stays with Chinedu forever. He can photograph every new product himself.
- Approach 3 works but costs money every time. Mama Nkechi has many products; hiring a photographer for each one is not sustainable.

Professional connection.
Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices is the running example for the capstone portfolio (Track A â€" Product). The skills Chinedu learns today â€" building a clean product scene, using natural light, composing deliberately â€" are exactly the skills he will use for the capstone. This is not just a class exercise; this is real preparation for a real photo job.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide.

K.1 Stiff, awkward portraits

Symptoms:

you give them something to do." **Corrective steps:** Talk to the subject. Give direction â€" "turn slightly, rest your hand on the table, look out the window." Take photos while the subject is relaxed and engaged. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject looks natural and comfortable in the photo. **How to prevent recurrence:** Always talk to your subject. Never shoot in silence.

K.2 Harsh light on the subject's face

Symptoms:
Dark shadows under the eyes, nose and chin. The subject is squinting. **Likely cause:** Photographing in direct midday sun or under a harsh overhead light. **How to investigate:** Check the direction of the shadows. If they are directly under the subject, the light is overhead. **Corrective steps:** Move the subject into open shade or near a window. Use a reflector to fill shadows if needed. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject's face is evenly lit, no squinting. **How to prevent recurrence:** Always check the light before shooting. Avoid harsh overhead light.

K.3 Cluttered product backgrounds

Symptoms:
The product is lost among other objects â€" pots, pans, tools, clutter. **Likely cause:** The photographer did not clean up the scene before shooting. **How to investigate:** Look at the photo â€" can you identify the product immediately? **Corrective steps:** Remove everything from the scene except the product and the surface. Use a plain background. **How to confirm resolved:** The product is the clear focus of the photo. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before every product shot, scan the entire frame and remove distractions.

K.4 Blurry event photos

Symptoms:
The action is blurred â€" the subject is smeared or the whole photo is soft. **Likely cause:** The subject moved during the exposure, or the camera was not steady. **How to investigate:** Is the background sharp but the subject blurry? If so, the subject moved. Is everything blurry? If so, the camera moved. **Corrective steps:** For moving subjects, take many frames and pick the sharpest. For camera shake, hold the phone steadier or use a surface. **How to confirm resolved:** The action is captured sharply. **How to prevent recurrence:** At events, always take many frames. Hold the phone steady.

K.5 Not obtaining consent

Symptoms:
The photographer takes photos of people without asking. **Likely cause:** The photographer does not understand the consent rule or feels awkward asking. **How to investigate:** Ask the photographer: "Did you ask permission before taking that photo?" **Corrective steps:** Stop the exercise. Remind the learner of the consent rule. No consent, no photo. Have them ask the subject and sign the consent form. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject has given permission and signed the form. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make consent the first step of every portrait or event shoot. Never skip it.

K.6 Product photos that do not show the product clearly

Symptoms:
The product is too dark, the label is unreadable, or the angle hides the product's best features. **Likely cause:** Poor light, poor angle, or a dirty product. **How to investigate:** Look at the photo â€" can you see the product clearly? Can you read the label? **Corrective steps:** Move the product to better light. Clean the product. Change the angle to show the product's best side. **How to confirm resolved:** The product is clearly visible, well-lit, and the label is readable. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before every product shot, check the light, clean the product, and choose the best angle.

K.7 Missing the key moment at events

Symptoms:
The photographer captures the setup and the aftermath but misses the main action â€" the cake cutting, the handshake, the speech. **Likely cause:** The photographer was not paying attention or was not positioned correctly. **How to investigate:** Ask the photographer: "Where were you standing? Were you ready when the moment happened?" **Corrective steps:** Position yourself near where the key moment will happen. Anticipate what will come next. Keep your finger near the shutter. **How to confirm**

Distinguish likely vs confirmed:
A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" look at the actual photo, ask the photographer what they did, and confirm the cause before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title:
"My Foundations Folder â€" 12 Images"

Purpose:
To organise and complete the 12-image foundations folder that forms the raw material of the capstone portfolio. This folder demonstrates your ability to apply sharpness, composition, light and subject skills.

Realistic scenario.
You are building your photography portfolio. Your capstone â€" a themed photo shoot for a Port Harcourt client â€" will draw on the skills and images you have developed in Sessions 1â€"3. The foundations folder is your proof that you can deliver.

Detailed instructions:

1. Review all photos taken during Sessions 1, 2 and 3.
2. Select and organise **12 images** into three groups:
   - **4 composition images** â€" one for each technique (rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry/perspective).
   - **4 light study images** â€" the same subject in four different lighting conditions.
   - **4 subject images** â€" one portrait, one product, one event, and one additional image of your choice.
3. For each image, write one sentence: "*This image shows _____ because _____.*"
4. Ensure every image of a person has a signed consent form.
5. Organise all 12 images in your `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname` folder in a subfolder named `Foundations-Folder`.
6. Write a short reflection (3â€"5 sentences): "*The strongest image in my folder is _____ because _____. The image I am least happy with is _____ because _____. Next time I would _____.*"

Required deliverables:

- A folder with 12 images organised into three groups.
- 12 written descriptions (one per image).
- Signed consent forms for all people photographed.
- A short written reflection.

Submission format:
Share the folder with the instructor (via WhatsApp, Google Drive or a USB stick) or bring your phone to Session 4 and show the folder.

Deadline:
Before Session 4.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
12 images present and organised	2	All 12 images in the correct groups
Composition images demonstrate techniques	2	Each image clearly shows the named technique
Light study shows variety	2	Four genuinely different lighting conditions
Subject images are strong	2	Portrait, product and event shots are sharp, well-lit and intentional

Written descriptions and reflection	2	Accurate descriptions and thoughtful reflection

Common mistakes to avoid:
missing images; images that do not demonstrate the named technique; blurry or poorly exposed images; missing consent forms; no reflection.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong foundations folder contains:

- **Composition:** Four images, each clearly demonstrating one technique. The rule of thirds image has the subject on a grid intersection. The framing image has a natural frame. The leading lines image has lines leading to the subject. The symmetry/perspective image is balanced or deep.
- **Light study:** Four images of the same subject in four different lights â€" window light, open shade, direct light and backlight. The differences between the images are visible.
- **Subjects:** A portrait (comfortable subject, soft light, clean background), a product shot (clean scene, well-lit), an event shot (action captured sharply) and one additional image.
- Written descriptions: Accurate and specific.
- Reflection: Thoughtful and honest â€" identifies strengths and areas for improvement.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer.
What are the three things that make a good portrait? Explain one of them.

Q2. Multiple choice.
You are photographing a product for a WhatsApp Business catalogue. The product is on a cluttered table under a fluorescent light. What is the single most important thing you should do first? a) Use a beauty filter to make the product look better. b) Move the product to a window or shaded area with better light. c) Take the photo from a higher angle. d) Use the flash to brighten the product.

Q3. Explain in your own words.
What are the four elements of a good product photo?

Q4. Practical identification.
A portrait photo shows the subject with dark shadows under the eyes and nose, and the subject is squinting. What is the problem, and how would you fix it?

Q5. Matching.
Match each event moment to its description: **preparation, greeting, main action, emotion, detail.** a) The cake being cut, the speech, the first dance b) The decorations, the food, the flowers, the invitations c) People arriving, shaking hands, hugging d) Setting up, decorating, arranging food, people arriving e) Laughter, tears, surprise, joy

Q6. Scenario.
You are photographing a classmate's portrait. They look stiff and uncomfortable. What are three things you could do to make them more comfortable and get a better photo?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1.
The three things that make a good portrait are: light (soft, flattering light on the face), pose (natural body position, hands doing something) and expression (genuine emotion, not a forced smile). Explanation of any one: e.g., light means using soft, directional light â€" window light or open shade â€" so the face is evenly lit without harsh shadows.

A2.

The four elements of a good product photo are: surface (clean, plain surface), background (plain, uncluttered background), light (soft, even light â€" window light or open shade) and angle (eye level or slightly above, showing the product's best side).

A4.
The problem is harsh overhead light â€" the light is coming from directly above, creating shadows under the eyes and nose, and causing squinting. Fix: move the subject into open shade or near a window with soft, directional light.

A5.
preparation = (d); greeting = (c); main action = (a); emotion = (e); detail = (b).

A6.
Three things: (1) Talk to the subject â€" ask about their day, their work, their interests. (2) Give direction, not orders â€" "turn slightly, rest your hand on the table, look out the window." (3) Give the hands something to do â€" hold a cup, rest on a surface, cross arms loosely. (Also acceptable: show them the photos as you go, make them laugh, take photos while they are engaged in conversation.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary.
Today you learned to photograph the three subjects that earn money: people, products and events. For portraits, you learned that a good portrait has three elements â€" light, pose and expression â€" and that the most important skill is making the subject comfortable. For products, you learned that a good product photo has four elements â€" surface, background, light and angle â€" and that building a clean scene is the key. For events, you learned that the three challenges are changing light, moving subjects and staying unobtrusive, and that the five key moments are preparation, greeting, main action, emotion and detail. You also learned that consent is mandatory â€" ask first, get parent/guardian consent for under-18s, and use a consent form. You completed your foundations folder â€" 12 images that form the raw material of your capstone portfolio.

Five important takeaways:

1. A good portrait = light + pose + expression. Make the subject comfortable.
2. A good product photo = surface + background + light + angle. Build a clean scene.
3. Event photography = changing light + moving subjects + staying unobtrusive. Capture the five key moments.
4. Consent is mandatory â€" ask first, always.
5. The foundations folder (12 images) is the raw material of your capstone portfolio.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I make a subject feel comfortable and capture a natural expression?
- Can I build a clean product scene with good light?
- Can I capture a key moment at an event sharply?
- Can I explain the consent rule and use a consent form?
- Can I organise my work into a foundations folder?
- Can I look at my own photos and identify what is strong and what needs improvement?

Connection to the next session.
You now have the raw material â€" sharp, well-led, well-composed photos of people, products and events. But raw photos are not finished photos. Next session we move to Week 2 â€" Module 2: "Process and Deliver." You will learn to edit your photos in Snapseed or Lightroom Mobile â€" cropping, straightening, correcting exposure, adjusting colour, removing blemishes, and batch-editing a set for consistency. You will learn what editing can fix, what it cannot fix, and what must never be faked. This is where your photos go from good to professional.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner captures the key moment at an event by anticipating and taking many frames.
- Learner asks for consent before photographing any person.
- Learner organises their work into a foundations folder with accurate descriptions.
- Learner can explain why a photo works or does not work.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "A good portrait depends on the subject being photogenic." â†' No â€" the photographer creates the conditions.
- "I need a studio for good product photos." â†' No â€" a window, a sheet and a card are enough.
- "Event photography is just taking lots of photos." â†' No â€" it is planning, anticipating and capturing key moments deliberately.
- "Consent is optional if I am in a public place." â†' No â€" consent is mandatory for identifiable people, especially for commercial use.
- "Flash fixes bad light." â†' No â€" flash creates harsh shadows and makes photos look worse. Find good light instead.
- "One photo is enough." â†' No â€" always take many frames. One will be perfect.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Portrait practice:** Photograph the same person three times â€" once without talking, once with direction, once while they are engaged in conversation. Compare the results.
2. **Product scene building:** Photograph the same product in three different scenes â€" cluttered, acceptable, clean. Compare the results.
3. **Event anticipation:** At a class event, predict what will happen next and be ready to capture it. Take five frames of the predicted moment.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a printed step-by-step guide for each subject (portrait, product, event). Pair the learner with a confident learner for the practical.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full lecture, demonstration, guided practical and assignment.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to photograph a subject in a way that tells a story â€" a portrait that shows the person's personality, a product shot that shows the product in use, or an event sequence (3â€"5 images) that tells the story of a moment from beginning to end. They should also write a short artist's statement explaining their choices.

Timing guidance.
The priority is learners photographing all three subjects (Section H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the lecture's event photography section to the key points â€" the three challenges and the five moments â€" and protect the practical time. A learner who leaves without a portrait, a product shot and an event shot has no foundations folder and no material for the capstone.

END OF SESSION 3

Next: Session 4 â€" Basic Photo Editing.

SESSION 4 â€" BASIC PHOTO EDITING

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" PHOTOGRAPHY

SESSION 4 â€" BASIC PHOTO EDITING

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	4 of 6
Session title	Basic Photo Editing
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: "Process and Deliver"
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (practical, software-focused)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"3 â€" the learner should have a set of raw photos (the foundations folder) and basic smartphone ability. No prior editing experience assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Sessions 1â€"3 you learned to shoot sharp, well-lit, well-composed photos. Now you learn to edit them â€" to crop, straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, remove blemishes and batch-edit a set for consistency. Editing is where good photos become professional.
Preparation before class	Academy computers with internet access (for downloading apps if needed); the instructor's phone or computer connected to the projector for live editing demonstration; Snapseed installed on the instructor's device (primary editor); Lightroom Mobile installed as a secondary option; a sample set of raw photos (product, portrait, event) for the demonstration; the "Edit Decision Log" (Section H) printed per learner; a deliberately over-edited sample image for the "honest editing" discussion.

Instructor note on tone:
This session must balance skill with ethics. Learners are excited about editing â€" they want to make their photos look amazing. Channel that excitement into honest, disciplined editing. The message is: "Do less, but do it well." Editing should enhance the photo, not transform it into something it is not.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Import and organise** photos into a working folder for editing.
2. **Crop and straighten** a photo to improve composition and remove distractions.
3. **Correct exposure** â€" brighten dark photos, recover highlights, and balance the overall brightness.
4. **Adjust colour temperature and saturation** â€" make colours natural and appealing, not artificial.
5. **Perform basic retouching and blemish removal** â€" clean up small distractions without destroying natural skin texture.
6. **Batch-edit a set** of photos so they have a consistent look â€" matching white balance, contrast and colour.
7. **State clearly** what editing can fix, what it cannot fix, and what must never be faked.

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a working camera and the foundations folder of raw photos.
- Academy computers (optional) for learners who prefer editing on a larger screen.
- Instructor's phone or computer connected to a projector for live editing demonstration.

Software

- **Snapseed** (free, primary editor) â€" available on Android and iOS. Download from Google Play Store or Apple App Store.
- **Lightroom Mobile** (free tier, secondary editor) â€" available on Android and iOS. Used for the batch editing demonstration.
- No paid software required. No subscription required.

Accounts

- None required for Snapseed. A free Adobe account is needed for Lightroom Mobile (optional).

Sample files

- **A sample set of raw photos** (product, portrait, event) for the instructor demonstration â€" taken by the instructor or sourced from free/royalty-free images.
- **A deliberately over-edited sample image** â€" a photo with extreme saturation, heavy smoothing, replaced sky, or obvious fakery â€" for the "honest editing" discussion.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 4.1 â€" "Edit Decision Log" (a table: photo name, problem, edit applied, result).
- Worksheet 4.2 â€" "Before and After Comparison" (a table: photo, what I changed, why, honest editing check).

Tools

- A whiteboard and markers for drawing the editing workflow diagram.

Internet

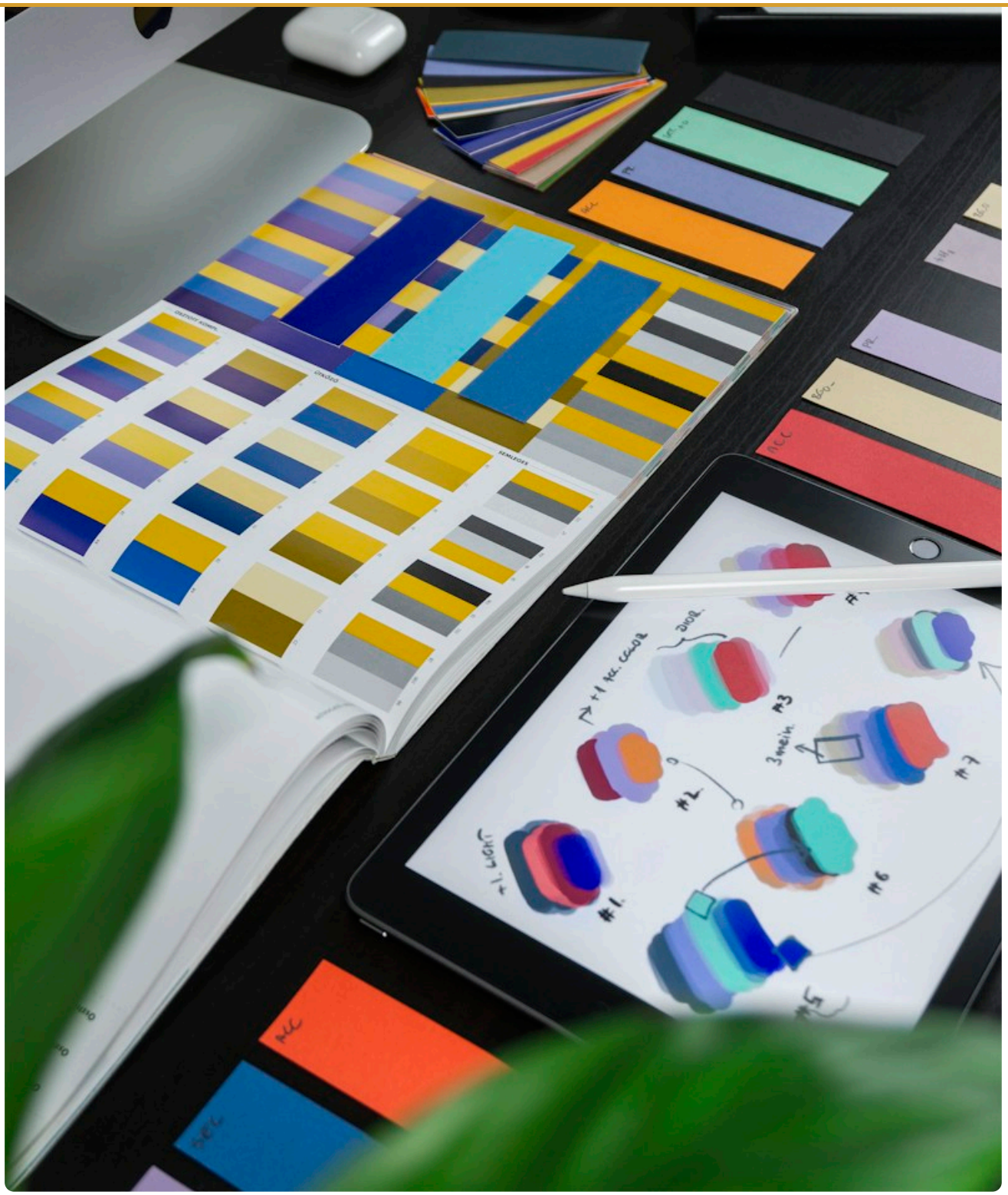
- Required for downloading Snapseed and Lightroom Mobile (if not already installed). Not required for the editing itself â€" both apps work offline once installed.

Alternative for learners who lack a capable phone

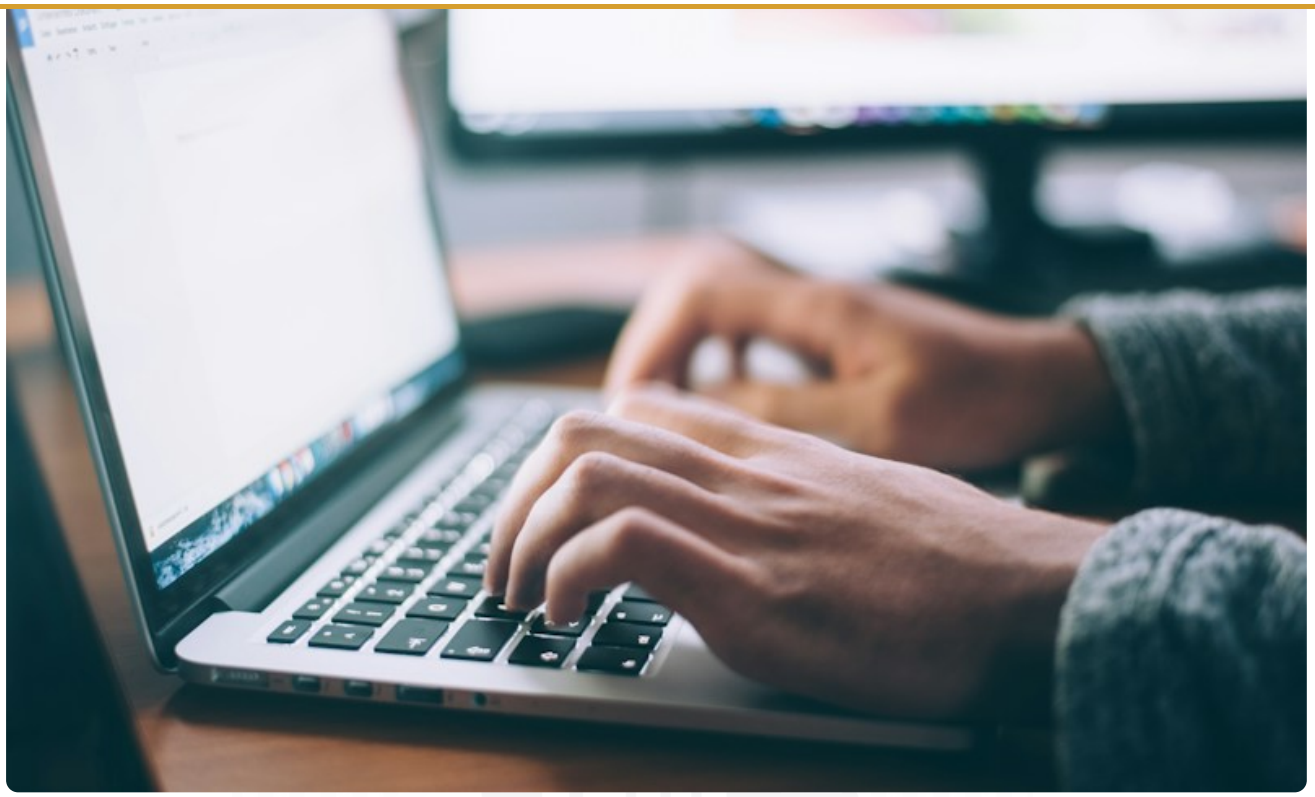
- Any smartphone can run Snapseed and Lightroom Mobile. A learner without a phone may use an academy computer with a web-based editor (e.g., Photopea â€" free, browser-based) or pair with a classmate. They must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

Ethics note:
Editing must be honest. Do not change a product's true appearance, fake a background, reshape a body beyond normal correction, or edit in a way that lies to a client or viewer. Editing cleans up a photograph; it does not manufacture a false one.

Suggested visuals:



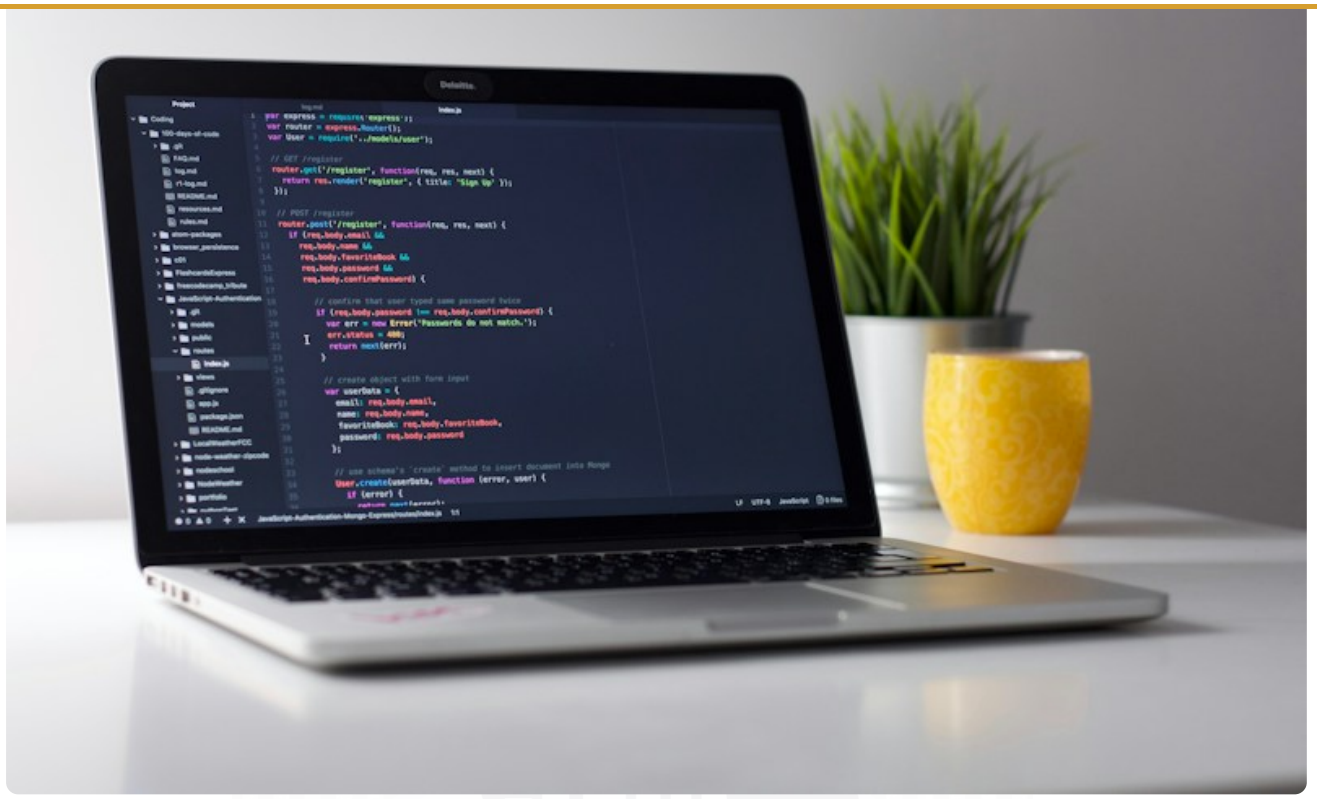
- â€" editing on screen



- â€" adjusting light and colour



- â€" a tidy editing workspace



- â€" editing photos on a laptop



- â€" selecting the strongest frames

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup:
On the projector, show two versions of the same photo:

- **Photo A (raw):** A portrait of a person, slightly crooked, a bit dark, with a small distraction in the background (a trash can, a stray object). The photo is good but not great.
- **Photo B (edited):** The same portrait, straightened, brightened, the distraction removed, the colours natural and warm. The photo looks professional.

What the instructor says:

> *by a professional. The difference is not the camera â€“ it is the editing. Hands up â€“ which photo would you use for a business profile? â€¦ The edited one, almost everyone. Now tell me: what is different about the edited photo?"*

Expected learner response:
Learners will say things like "it is brighter," "it is straight," "the background is cleaner," "the colours look better," "it looks professional." Accept all answers and write the key phrases on the board: **straight, bright, clean, natural, professional.**

Then reveal the lesson:
Say clearly:

> *"Editing is not cheating. Editing is part of photography. A raw photo is like a rough draft â€" it has potential, but it needs work. Today you learn to edit your photos in Snapseed â€" a free app you can download today. You will learn to crop, straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, remove distractions and batch-edit a set. But you will also learn the most important rule: edit honestly. Do less, but do it well."*

Why this opener works:
It uses the same photo in both versions, proving that editing â€" not the camera â€" makes the difference. It introduces the key editing skills before any technical explanation, and it sets the ethical tone from the start.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1:
"What are the five quality words for a good photograph?"

- Expected answer: Clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose.
- Common gap: Learners may forget one or two. Clarify: "Clarity = sharp. Light = correctly exposed. Composition = intentional arrangement. Moment = right instant. Purpose = does the job."

Question 2:
"What is the 5-step sharpness routine?"

- Expected answer: Steady hold, tap to focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames.
- Common gap: Learners may remember the steps but not the order. Clarify: "Steady, focus, exposure, background, frames."

Question 3:
"What are the four natural light conditions, and which ones are flattering?"

- Expected answer: Golden hour (flattering), window light (flattering), open shade (flattering), harsh midday sun (unflattering).
- Common gap: Learners may say "more light is better." Clarify: "Soft, indirect light is flattering. Direct, harsh light creates shadows and squinting."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have learned to shoot well â€" sharp, correctly exposed, well-composed photos in good light. But even the best photographers edit their photos. A raw photo is a starting point, not a finished product. Today you learn to edit â€" to take your good photos and make them great. But you also learn the limits: editing can fix small problems, not big ones. And editing must always be honest."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the five quality words, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing them on the board before continuing.

F.1 What editing is and why it matters

The idea.
Editing is the process of adjusting a photo after it has been taken â€" improving the composition, correcting the exposure, adjusting the colour and removing distractions. It is the second half of photography: shooting is capturing the image; editing is refining it.

Plain-English definition.
Editing is making deliberate changes to a photo to improve it â€" to make it sharper, brighter, cleaner and more appealing, while keeping it honest and true to the original scene.

Why it matters.
Even the best photographers edit their photos. A raw photo straight from the camera is rarely perfect â€" it may be slightly crooked, slightly dark, slightly off-colour, or have a small distraction in the background. Editing fixes these small problems and makes the photo look professional. For business, a well-edited photo makes the product or person look more appealing â€" which means more sales.

What editing can fix:

- Cropping â€" removing distractions at the edges of the frame, improving composition.
- Straightening â€" fixing a tilted horizon or a crooked building.
- Exposure â€" brightening a dark photo, recovering detail in bright areas.
- Colour â€" adjusting the warmth or coolness of the photo, making colours natural.
- Distractions â€" removing small objects (a trash can, a stray wire, a blemish).
- Sharpness â€" enhancing detail slightly (but cannot fix a blurry photo).

What editing cannot fix:

- A blurry subject â€" if the subject is out of focus, editing cannot make it sharp.
- Poor composition â€" if the subject is lost in a cluttered scene, cropping can help but cannot completely rescue the photo.
- Bad light â€" if the light is harsh or the subject is a silhouette, editing can improve it slightly but cannot transform it.
- A missed moment â€" if the subject blinked or the action is over, editing cannot bring it back.

What editing must never do (the honest editing rules):

- Do not change a product's true appearance â€" do not make a faded product look new, or a small product look large.
- Do not fake a background â€" do not replace the sky, add elements that were not there, or remove people.
- Do not reshape a body beyond normal correction â€" do not slim a person, enlarge eyes, or alter facial features.
- Do not mislead the viewer â€" if a client or viewer would be deceived by the edit, do not do it.

Real-life comparison.
Editing is like grooming. A person can shower, comb their hair, wear clean clothes and look their best â€" but they are still the same person. Editing does the same for a photo: it cleans up the presentation without changing the reality. But just as you cannot make a short person tall with grooming, you cannot make a blurry photo sharp with editing.

Misconception to correct.
"Editing is cheating â€" real photographers do not edit." False. Almost all professional photographs are edited â€" from magazine covers to wedding photos to product catalogues. The question is not whether to edit, but how to edit honestly.

F.2 The editing workflow â€" the order that matters

The idea.
Editing is not random â€" it follows a logical order. Each step builds on the previous one. If you edit in the wrong order, you may undo your own work or create problems.

The CEA Editing Workflow (teach this order and return to it all session):

1. Crop and straighten	Remove distractions at the edges, fix tilted lines	Do this first â€“ once you crop, you see the final composition and can judge the rest accurately
2. Correct exposure	Brighten dark areas, recover bright areas, balance overall brightness	Do this after cropping â€” the exposure needs of the final composition may differ from the original
3. Adjust colour	Set white balance (warmth/coolness), adjust saturation (colour intensity)	Do this after exposure â€” colour looks different at different brightness levels
4. Retouch	Remove blemishes, small distractions, dust spots	Do this last â€” retouching is detail work, and you want to see the final exposure and colour first
5. Sharpen (optional)	Enhance detail slightly	Do this last â€” sharpening after all other adjustments ensures you sharpen the final image

Why this order matters:
If you adjust colour before cropping, you may waste time adjusting colour in areas you later crop away. If you retouch before correcting exposure, you may not see all the blemishes in the dark areas. The workflow saves time and produces better results.

Real-life comparison.
The editing workflow is like building a house. You do not paint the walls before you build them. You build the structure (crop and straighten), then install the electrical (exposure), then paint (colour), then add the finishing touches (retouch), then polish (sharpen). Each step depends on the one before it.

Misconception to correct.
"I can just use an auto-fix button and be done." Auto-fix is a starting point, not a finished product. It may improve the photo slightly, but it cannot make the decisions that make a photo look professional. Learn the workflow â€” it takes only a little longer and produces much better results.

F.3 Cropping and straightening

The idea.
Cropping means cutting away parts of the photo â€” usually the edges â€” to improve the composition. Straightening means rotating the photo slightly to fix tilted lines â€” a crooked horizon, a leaning building, a slanted table.

When to crop:

- To remove distractions at the edges â€” a trash can, a stray object, a person's arm, empty space.
- To improve the composition â€” move the subject to a grid intersection, create more space in the direction the subject is facing.
- To change the aspect ratio â€” make the photo square (1:1) for Instagram, or wider (16:9) for a banner.

When not to crop:

- Do not crop so tightly that you lose important context â€” a portrait needs some space around the subject, a product shot needs some breathing room.
- Do not crop to fix a blurry photo â€” cropping a blurry photo makes it smaller and blurrier, not sharper.

How to crop in Snapseed:

1. Open the photo in Snapseed.
2. Tap **Tools** > **Crop**.
3. Choose an aspect ratio (Free, 1:1, 4:3, 16:9, etc.) or drag the corners freely.
4. Drag the frame to position the subject where you want it.
5. Tap the checkmark to apply.

How to straighten in Snapseed:

1. Open the photo in Snapseed.

4. Tap the checkmark to apply.

Worked example:

- Raw: A portrait of a person, slightly tilted, with a trash can in the bottom left corner and too much empty space above the person's head.
- Edited: Cropped to remove the trash can and the empty space, straightened so the background lines are horizontal, with the person's eyes on the top third line. The photo looks intentional and professional.

Real-life comparison.
Cropping is like framing a picture for the wall. You choose the best part of the image and cut away the rest. A good crop makes the subject stand out and removes anything that distracts.

Common mistake.
Cropping too aggressively â€" cutting so much that the photo becomes a tiny, pixelated mess. Always check the resolution after cropping. If the photo looks soft or pixelated, you have cropped too much.

F.4 Correcting exposure

The idea.
Exposure correction means adjusting the brightness of the photo â€" making dark areas brighter, bright areas darker, and the overall image balanced. The goal is a photo where you can see detail in both the shadows and the highlights â€" not too dark, not too bright.

The three exposure adjustments (teach these and return to them all session):

Adjustment	What it does	When to use it
Brightness	Makes the whole photo brighter or darker	Use first â€" to set the overall brightness
Highlights	Adjusts only the brightest areas of the photo	Use to recover detail in bright areas (a bright sky, a window)
Shadows	Adjusts only the darkest areas of the photo	Use to brighten dark areas (a face in shadow, a dark corner)

How to correct exposure in Snapseed:

1. Open the photo in Snapseed.
2. Tap **Tools** > **Tune Image**.
3. Swipe up or down to choose Brightness, Highlights or Shadows.
4. Swipe left or right to adjust.
5. Tap the checkmark to apply.

The exposure correction workflow:

1. First, adjust **Brightness** to set the overall level.
2. Then, adjust **Highlights** to recover detail in bright areas.
3. Then, adjust **Shadows** to brighten dark areas.
4. Check the result â€" is the subject clearly visible? Are there any pure white or pure black areas with no detail?

Worked example:

- Raw: A portrait where the person's face is slightly dark (in shadow) and the background is slightly bright.
- Edited: Brightness increased slightly, Shadows increased to brighten the face, Highlights decreased slightly to recover detail in the background. The result is a balanced photo where both the face and the background have visible detail.

Real-life comparison.
Exposure correction is like adjusting the lights in a room. If the room is too dim, you turn up the brightness. If one corner is too dark, you add a lamp (shadows). If one area is too bright, you dim it (highlights). The goal is even, comfortable light

Over-correcting â€" brightening a dark photo so much that it looks washed out and unnatural. Small adjustments are usually better than large ones. If the photo needs a huge exposure correction, it was probably badly exposed in the camera â€" prevention is better than cure.

F.5 Adjusting colour â€" white balance and saturation

The idea.
Colour adjustment means making the colours in the photo look natural and appealing. Two adjustments matter for beginners: white balance (the warmth or coolness of the photo) and saturation (the intensity of the colours).

White balance:

- Every light source has a colour â€" sunlight is warm (golden), shade is cool (blue), fluorescent light is greenish, incandescent light is orange.
- White balance adjusts the photo so that white objects look white â€" not blue, not orange, not green.
- If the photo looks too warm (too orange/yellow), cool it down. If it looks too cool (too blue), warm it up.
- In Snapseed: **Tools** > **White Balance** â€" adjust the temperature slider.

Saturation:

- Saturation controls how intense the colours are.
- Low saturation = muted, subtle colours. High saturation = vivid, intense colours.
- The goal is natural, appealing colours â€" not oversaturated, cartoonish colours.
- In Snapseed: **Tools** > **Tune Image** > **Saturation** â€" adjust the slider.

The colour adjustment workflow:

1. First, set the **white balance** â€" make the colours look natural.
2. Then, adjust **saturation** â€" make the colours appealing but not artificial.
3. Check the result â€" do the colours look like the real scene, or do they look fake?

Worked example:

- Raw: A product photo taken under fluorescent light â€" the product looks greenish and unnatural.
- Edited: White balance adjusted to remove the green cast, saturation increased slightly to make the product's colours pop. The result is a photo where the product looks natural and appealing.

Real-life comparison.
White balance is like choosing the right light bulb. A warm bulb makes a room feel cozy, a cool bulb makes it feel clean. You choose the bulb that fits the mood. In photography, you choose the white balance that makes the colours look true to the scene.

Common mistake.
Oversaturation â€" cranking the saturation so high that the colours look cartoonish and unnatural. A little saturation goes a long way. The goal is to make the photo look like a better version of reality, not a different reality.

F.6 Retouching and blemish removal

The idea.
Retouching means removing small distractions and imperfections â€" blemishes on skin, dust spots on a product, a stray object in the background. The goal is to clean up the photo without changing the subject's appearance.

What retouching can do:

- Remove a pimple or blemish on skin (while keeping natural skin texture).
- Remove a dust spot or smudge on a product.

What retouching must not do:

- Do not smooth skin so much that it looks plastic â€" keep natural texture.
- Do not remove wrinkles, scars or moles that are part of the person's identity.
- Do not remove or add elements that change the story of the photo.
- Do not reshape the body or face.

How to retouch in Snapseed:

1. Open the photo in Snapseed.
2. Tap **Tools** > **Healing**.
3. Zoom in on the blemish or distraction.
4. Tap or brush over the area you want to remove.
5. Snapseed automatically fills the area with surrounding texture.
6. Tap the checkmark to apply.

The retouching rule (say this slowly):

> *"Retouch to clean up, not to change. Remove the pimple, not the person. Remove the dust spot, not the detail. Keep the texture, keep the truth."*

Worked example:

- Raw: A portrait with a small pimple on the person's forehead and a dust spot on their shirt.
- Edited: The pimple and dust spot are removed using the Healing tool. The skin still has natural texture â€" it does not look airbrushed. The person looks like themselves, just cleaned up.

Real-life comparison.
Retouching is like cleaning a window. You remove the dust and smudges so you can see through clearly â€" but you do not change what is on the other side of the glass. Retouching removes distractions so the subject stands out â€" but it does not change the subject.

Common mistake.
Over-retouching â€" smoothing skin so much that it looks like plastic, or removing so much that the person looks like a different person. The goal is a clean, natural look â€" not an artificial one.

F.7 Batch editing â€" making a set consistent

The idea.
When you have a set of photos â€" for a product catalogue, a portfolio, or a client delivery â€" they should look like they belong together. They should have the same white balance, the same contrast, the same overall feel. Batch editing means applying the same edits to multiple photos so they look consistent.

Why consistency matters:

- A set of product photos with different colours and brightness looks unprofessional â€" like they were taken by different people.
- A portfolio with inconsistent edits looks careless â€" like the photographer did not pay attention.
- A client expects a cohesive set â€" photos that look like they came from the same shoot.

How to batch edit in Snapseed:

1. Edit one photo in the set â€" crop, exposure, colour, retouch.
2. Tap the **Stack** icon (three stacked squares) in the top right.
3. Tap **Copy edits** â€" this saves the edits you made.

6. Review the result â€" make small adjustments if needed (each photo may need slight tweaks).
7. Repeat for all photos in the set.

How to batch edit in Lightroom Mobile (alternative):

1. Edit one photo in the set.
2. Tap the three dots (â€¦) > **Copy settings**.
3. Select the other photos in the set.
4. Tap **Paste settings** â€" the same edits are applied to all selected photos.
5. Review each photo and make small adjustments if needed.

The batch editing rule:

> *"Copy the edits, paste them, then review each photo individually. Batch editing gets you 90% of the way â€" the last 10% is checking each photo and making small adjustments."*

Worked example:

- A set of five product photos for Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices. Each photo was taken in the same light, but small differences in angle and distance mean the exposure and colour vary slightly.
- The first photo is edited â€" white balance set, exposure corrected, saturation adjusted. The edits are copied and pasted to the other four photos. Each photo is reviewed and small adjustments are made. The result is a set of five photos that look like they came from the same shoot â€" consistent, professional, ready for the client.

Real-life comparison.
Batch editing is like making a batch of garri. You mix the ingredients once, then pour into individual cups. Each cup is slightly different â€" a bit more here, a bit less there â€" but they all taste the same. Batch editing does the same for photos: one set of edits, applied to all, with small individual adjustments.

Common mistake.
Pasting edits without reviewing â€" assuming the same edits work perfectly for every photo. Each photo is different â€" different angle, different light, different distance. Always review and adjust.

F.8 The honest editing line â€" what must never be faked

The idea.
Editing is a tool for improvement, not deception. There is a line between honest editing (cleaning up the photo) and dishonest editing (changing the reality). Every photographer must know where that line is.

The honest editing rules (read these aloud and make sure every learner understands):

Rule	What it means	Example
Do not change a product's true appearance	Do not make a faded product look new, or a small product look large	Do not use editing to make a scratched phone case look brand new
Do not fake a background	Do not replace the sky, add elements that were not there, or remove people	Do not add a beach background to a product photo taken in a kitchen
Do not reshape a body beyond normal correction	Do not slim a person, enlarge eyes, or alter facial features	Do not use editing to make a person look thinner than they are
Do not mislead the viewer	If a client or viewer would be deceived by the edit, do not do it	Do not edit a photo to make a small shop look like a large store

Why these rules matter:

- They protect the photographer â€” a photographer who is caught faking edits loses their reputation and their business.
- They protect the profession â€” photography is built on trust. Dishonest editing destroys that trust.

The over-edited photo (show this on the projector):

- A photo with extreme saturation (colours look cartoonish), heavy skin smoothing (skin looks plastic), a replaced sky (the sky is clearly fake), and a reshaped body (the person looks unnaturally thin).
- Ask the class: "What is wrong with this photo?" They should identify the fakery.
- Say: "This is what happens when editing crosses the line. The photo looks fake, the person looks fake, and the viewer feels deceived. This is not editing â€” this is lying."

Real-life comparison.
Honest editing is like putting on makeup. A little makeup can enhance your natural features and make you look your best. But so much makeup that you look like a different person is not enhancement â€” it is disguise. The goal is to look like the best version of yourself, not a different person.

Misconception to correct.
"If the client wants it, I should do it." No. A client may ask for dishonest edits â€” a faked background, a reshaped body, a changed product. The professional photographer explains why the edit is dishonest and offers an honest alternative. If the client insists, the photographer walks away. Honesty is not negotiable.

F.9 Summary of the lecture

- Editing is the second half of photography â€” refining the raw photo into a finished image.
- The editing workflow: crop and straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, retouch, sharpen.
- Cropping removes distractions and improves composition. Straightening fixes tilted lines.
- Exposure correction balances brightness â€” brightness, highlights and shadows.
- Colour adjustment makes colours natural â€” white balance and saturation.
- Retouching removes small distractions â€” blemishes, dust spots, stray objects.
- Batch editing makes a set consistent â€” copy edits, paste, review each photo.
- The honest editing line: do not change a product's appearance, fake a background, reshape a body, or mislead the viewer.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Shoot] --> B[Import] --> C[Edit exposure] --> D[Adjust color] --> E[Crop & straighten] --> F[Export]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- Snapseed installed on the instructor's phone, connected to the projector.
- A sample raw photo â€” a portrait that is slightly crooked, slightly dark, with a small distraction in the background.
- A sample set of three product photos for the batch editing demonstration.
- A deliberately over-edited photo for the honest editing discussion.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” the full edit workflow (8 minutes)

Say:
"I am going to edit this portrait from start to finish. Watch each step and tell me what I am doing."

Step 1 â€” Crop and straighten:

straighten the horizon."

- Crop the photo, rotate slightly to straighten. Tap the checkmark.
- "Now the composition is cleaner and the lines are straight."

Step 2 â€" Correct exposure:

- Tap **Tools** > **Tune Image**.
- "The face is a little dark. I am going to increase the brightness slightly, then increase the shadows to brighten the face."
- Adjust brightness, then shadows. Tap the checkmark.
- "Now the face is clearly visible."

Step 3 â€" Adjust colour:

- Tap **Tools** > **White Balance**.
- "The photo looks a little cool â€" a bit blue. I am going to warm it up slightly."
- Adjust the temperature slider. Tap the checkmark.
- "Now the colours look natural and warm."

Step 4 â€" Retouch:

- Tap **Tools** > **Healing**.
- "There is a small blemish on the person's cheek. I am going to remove it."
- Zoom in, tap the blemish. Tap the checkmark.
- "The blemish is gone, but the skin still has natural texture. That is the goal."

Step 5 â€" Review:

- Show the before and after side by side.
- "Same person, same moment. But the edited version is cleaner, brighter, warmer and more professional. That is what editing does â€" it refines, it does not transform."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" batch editing (4 minutes)

Say:
"Now I am going to make these three product photos consistent. They were taken in the same light, but small differences mean they do not look like a set."

Step 1:
Edit the first photo â€" white balance, exposure, saturation. "This is my reference edit."

Step 2:
Tap the **Stack** icon > **Copy edits**.

Step 3:
Open the second photo. Tap the **Stack** icon > **Paste edits**. "The same edits are applied."

Step 4:
Review the second photo. "It looks good, but the exposure is slightly different because the angle is different. I am going to adjust the brightness slightly."

Step 5:
Repeat for the third photo.

Say:
"Three photos, one look. They belong together now. That is batch editing â€" copy, paste, review, adjust."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" the honest editing line (3 minutes)

Show the over-edited photo.

"The colours are too strong," "the skin looks fake," "the sky is not real," "the person looks different."

Say:
"Exactly. This is what happens when editing crosses the line. The photo looks fake, and the viewer feels deceived. Remember: edit to enhance, not to deceive. Do less, but do it well."

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "Why do we crop first, not last?" (Because the final composition determines what else needs adjusting.)
- "What is the difference between white balance and saturation?" (White balance is warmth/coolness; saturation is colour intensity.)
- "Why do we retouch last?" (Because we want to see the final exposure and colour before removing blemishes.)
- "Can editing fix a blurry photo?" (No â€” editing cannot create detail that was not captured.)
- "What is the most important rule of editing?" (Be honest. Do not deceive.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective:
With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner edits one photo using the full workflow and batch-edits a set of three photos.

Starting materials:
Learner's own phone with Snapseed installed; a raw photo from their foundations folder; a set of three photos (product, portrait or event) for batch editing; the printed Edit Decision Log.

Procedure â€” Part 1: Full edit workflow (10 minutes)

The instructor calls out each step. Learners follow on their own phones. Instructor walks the room.

1. Open Snapseed. Import a raw photo from your foundations folder.
2. **Crop and straighten:** Remove distractions, fix tilted lines. Tap the checkmark.
3. **Correct exposure:** Adjust brightness, highlights and shadows. Tap the checkmark.
4. **Adjust colour:** Set white balance, adjust saturation. Tap the checkmark.
5. **Retouch:** Remove one blemish or distraction using the Healing tool. Tap the checkmark.
6. **Review:** Compare the before and after. Write one sentence in the Edit Decision Log: "I changed _____ because _____."
7. **Save:** Export the edited photo to your gallery.

Procedure â€” Part 2: Batch editing (8 minutes)

8. Choose three photos from your foundations folder â€” they should be from the same shoot or subject.
9. Edit the first photo using the workflow above. This is your reference edit.
10. Tap the **Stack** icon > **Copy edits**.
11. Open the second photo. Tap the **Stack** icon > **Paste edits**. Review and adjust if needed.
12. Open the third photo. Tap the **Stack** icon > **Paste edits**. Review and adjust if needed.
13. Compare all three photos. Do they look like a set? If not, make small adjustments.
14. Write one sentence in the Edit Decision Log: "The set looks consistent because _____."

Expected result:
One fully edited photo and a set of three batch-edited photos, each with a written description.

Points to pause and predict:

- After cropping: "Does the composition feel better? Is the subject where you want it?"
- After exposure correction: "Can you see detail in both the bright and dark areas?"
- After batch editing: "Do the three photos look like they belong together? If not, what is different?"

- Over-edited photo â†' Ask: "Does this look like the real scene, or does it look fake?" Guide them to reduce the adjustments.
- Batch edits look inconsistent â†' Check if the photos were taken in different light. If so, they may need more individual adjustment.
- Learner wants to use a beauty filter â†' Remind them of the honest editing rules. Beauty filters that reshape the face are not allowed.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ One photo edited using the full workflow (crop, exposure, colour, retouch)
- ☐ Edit Decision Log completed for the single photo
- ☐ Three photos batch-edited for consistency
- ☐ Edit Decision Log completed for the set
- ☐ All edits are honest â€" no faked backgrounds, no reshaped bodies, no changed products
- ☐ All edited photos saved to the gallery

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task:
Edit a set of five photos for a fictional client â€" Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices.

Scenario.
Mama Nkechi needs a set of five product photos for her WhatsApp Business catalogue. She has given you five raw photos of her products (soup containers, spice jars, pepper soup base). The photos are usable but need editing â€" they are slightly crooked, slightly dark, and the colours are inconsistent.

Requirements:

1. Edit all five photos using the full workflow: crop and straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, retouch.
2. Batch-edit the set so all five photos have a consistent look â€" matching white balance, contrast and colour.
3. For each photo, write one sentence in the Edit Decision Log: "I changed _____ because _____."
4. Ensure all edits are honest â€" do not change the products' appearance, do not fake backgrounds, do not mislead the viewer.
5. Save all five edited photos in a folder named `MamaNkechi-Edited`.

Constraints:

- Use only Snapseed or Lightroom Mobile â€" no paid software.
- Do not use beauty filters or any filter that changes the products' appearance.
- The set must look like it came from the same shoot â€" consistent, professional, ready for the client.

Time allowance:
15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Five photos edited using the full workflow.
- The set looks consistent â€" matching white balance, contrast and colour.
- All edits are honest and professional.
- Edit Decision Log completed for all five photos.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: Edit the first photo completely, then copy the edits to the other four. Review each one and make small adjustments.
- Hint 2: If the colours look inconsistent, check the white balance first â€" this is usually the cause.
- Hint 3: If a photo looks over-edited, reduce the adjustments. Small changes are usually better.

- **Photo 1 (soup container):** Cropped to remove distractions, straightened, exposure corrected (shadows increased to brighten the label), white balance set to warm (to make the soup look appetising), saturation increased slightly. The label is readable, the soup looks warm and appealing.
- **Photo 2 (spice jar):** Same edits applied via batch. Small adjustment to exposure because the angle is different. The spice colours look rich and natural.
- **Photo 3 (pepper soup base):** Same edits applied via batch. Small adjustment to white balance because the light was slightly different. The product looks consistent with the others.
- **Photo 4 (product in use â€" a bowl of soup):** Same edits applied via batch. The soup looks warm and appetising, the colours are natural.
- **Photo 5 (group shot of all products):** Same edits applied via batch. All products look consistent â€" same white balance, same warmth, same overall feel.

The set looks like it came from the same shoot â€" professional, consistent, ready for Mama Nkechi's WhatsApp Business catalogue.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- All five photos edited using the full workflow (3)
- The set looks consistent (3)
- All edits are honest and professional (2)
- Edit Decision Log completed (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation.
Blessing is a photographer in Port Harcourt. She was hired to photograph a small restaurant's menu items for their Instagram page. She took the photos, edited them in Snapseed, and delivered them. The restaurant owner was happy â€" the photos looked professional and the food looked appetising. But then a customer visited the restaurant, ordered a dish, and posted a photo of the real dish next to Blessing's photo. The real dish looked nothing like the photo â€" the portion was smaller, the colours were duller, and the presentation was different. The customer accused the restaurant of false advertising.

Relevant facts.

- Blessing edited the photos honestly â€" she did not change the food's appearance or fake anything.
- But she increased the saturation significantly, making the colours look more vivid than reality.
- She used a slight blur on the background to make the food stand out â€" this is a common and acceptable technique.
- She did not tell the restaurant owner that she had increased the saturation.

Decision point.
Did Blessing do something wrong? If so, what?

Possible approaches.

1. Blessing did nothing wrong â€" all photographers edit their photos, and the restaurant owner approved the final images.
2. Blessing should have been more careful with the saturation â€" the colours should look natural, not exaggerated.
3. Blessing should have told the restaurant owner what edits she made, so the owner could decide if they were acceptable.

Recommended solution.
Approaches 2 and 3. Blessing's editing crossed the line from enhancement to exaggeration. The saturation was increased so much that the food looked different from reality. While she did not fake anything, she changed the food's appearance enough to mislead the customer. The lesson: edit to make the photo look like the best version of reality â€" not a different reality. And always communicate with the client about significant edits.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 2 is the minimum â€" the colours should look natural, not exaggerated. Small adjustments are usually better.
- Approach 3 is the professional standard â€" the client should know what edits were made and have the right to approve or request changes.

Professional connection.
This case study illustrates the honest editing line in practice. Editing is a tool for improvement, not deception. A photographer who edits honestly â€" enhancing the photo without changing the reality â€" builds trust with clients and viewers. A photographer who edits dishonestly â€" exaggerating, faking, or misleading â€" loses that trust. The honest editing line is not just an ethical rule â€" it is a business strategy.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide.

K.1 Over-editing â€" colours look cartoonish

Symptoms:
The photo looks unnatural â€" colours are too vivid, skin looks plastic, the overall image looks fake. **Likely cause:** Saturation increased too much, or skin smoothing applied too heavily. **How to investigate:** Compare the edited photo to the original. Does the edited version look like a better version of reality, or a different reality? **Corrective steps:** Reduce the saturation. Reduce the skin smoothing. Aim for natural, appealing colours â€" not artificial ones. **How to confirm resolved:** The photo looks like a better version of the original, not a different image. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make small adjustments. Step back and look at the photo after each edit. If it looks too much, reduce it.

K.2 Cropping too aggressively

Symptoms:
The photo is very small, pixelated, or has lost important context. **Likely cause:** Cropping so much that the resolution is too low, or cutting away important parts of the scene. **How to investigate:** Check the photo's resolution after cropping. Is it still high enough for the intended use? **Corrective steps:** Crop less. If you need a tighter crop, take the photo from closer next time â€" do not rely on cropping to fix a distant subject. **How to confirm resolved:** The photo is sharp and has sufficient resolution. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before cropping, ask: "Do I need this much crop? Can I achieve the same result by moving closer?"

K.3 Inconsistent batch edits

Symptoms:
The set of photos looks mismatched â€" different colours, different brightness, different overall feel. **Likely cause:** The photos were taken in different light, and the batch edits were pasted without reviewing each photo individually. **How to investigate:** Compare the photos side by side. Are the colours and brightness consistent? **Corrective steps:** Review each photo individually. Make small adjustments to white balance, exposure and saturation as needed. **How to confirm resolved:** All photos in the set look like they came from the same shoot. **How to prevent recurrence:** After pasting batch edits, always review each photo and adjust.

K.4 Over-retouching â€" skin looks plastic

Symptoms:
The person's skin looks unnaturally smooth â€" like plastic or airbrushed. **Likely cause:** The Healing tool or a smoothing filter was applied too heavily. **How to investigate:** Zoom in on the skin. Can you see natural texture â€" pores, fine lines, skin grain? **Corrective steps:** Reduce the retouching. Keep natural skin texture. Remove blemishes, not texture. **How to confirm resolved:** The skin looks clean but natural â€" like the person, not a mannequin. **How to prevent recurrence:** Use the Healing tool sparingly. Remove the blemish, not the skin.

K.5 Editing a blurry photo

Symptoms:

that editing cannot fix a blurry photo. Use the photo only if the blur is minor and the composition is strong. Otherwise, discard it and retake. **How to confirm resolved:** The photographer stops trying to fix the unfixable and focuses on prevention â€" better focus technique, faster shutter, or a steadier hold. **How to prevent recurrence:** Always focus-check in the camera. Take sharp photos from the start.

K.6 Faking edits â€" changing reality

Symptoms:
The edited photo shows something that was not in the original â€" a replaced sky, a removed person, a reshaped body, a changed product. **Likely cause:** The photographer used editing to deceive â€" to make the photo look like something it is not. **How to investigate:** Compare the edited photo to the original. Are there elements that were not in the original? **Corrective steps:** Undo the faked edits. Edit honestly â€" enhance, do not deceive. **How to confirm resolved:** The edited photo is a better version of the original, not a different image. **How to prevent recurrence:** Follow the honest editing rules. If an edit would mislead the viewer, do not do it.

K.7 Not saving the edited photo

Symptoms:
The learner edits the photo but forgets to export or save it. The edits are lost. **Likely cause:** The learner does not know how to save the edited photo in Snapseed. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner to show you the edited photo in their gallery. If it is not there, they did not save it. **Corrective steps:** Show them how to export: Tap **Export** > **Save** (saves a copy) or **Export** > **Save a copy** (keeps the original). **How to confirm resolved:** The edited photo is in the gallery. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make saving the final step of every edit. Always export before closing the app.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed:
A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" look at the actual photo, compare it to the original, and confirm the cause before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title:
"Edit a Set, Not a Single â€" My Five-Image Edited Set"

Purpose:
To practise the full editing workflow and batch editing on a set of five photos, producing a consistent, professional set that forms the editing style for the capstone portfolio.

Realistic scenario.
You are preparing a set of product photos for Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices â€" the running example for the capstone portfolio (Track A â€" Product). Mama Nkechi has given you five raw photos of her products. Your job is to edit them into a consistent, professional set for her WhatsApp Business catalogue.

Detailed instructions:

1. Choose five photos from your foundations folder â€" they should be of the same subject or from the same shoot (e.g., five product photos, five portraits, or five event photos).
2. Edit the first photo using the full workflow: crop and straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, retouch.
3. Copy the edits from the first photo and paste them to the other four.
4. Review each photo individually. Make small adjustments as needed â€" each photo may need slight tweaks.
5. For each photo, write one sentence in your Edit Decision Log: "I changed _____ because _____."
6. Ensure all edits are honest â€" do not change the subject's appearance, do not fake backgrounds, do not mislead the viewer.
7. Save all five edited photos in a folder named `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname/Edited-Set`.
8. Write a short reflection (3â€"5 sentences): *"The edit I am most proud of is _____ because _____. The hardest part of editing was _____. Next time I would _____."*

- An Edit Decision Log with five entries.
- A short written reflection.

Submission format:
Share the folder with the instructor (via WhatsApp, Google Drive or a USB stick) or bring your phone to Session 5 and show the folder.

Deadline:
Before Session 5.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Full workflow applied	2	All five photos edited: crop, exposure, colour, retouch
Consistency of the set	3	All five photos look like they belong together
Honest editing	2	No faked backgrounds, no reshaped bodies, no changed products
Edit Decision Log	2	Accurate descriptions of changes and reasons
Reflection	1	Thoughtful and honest

Common mistakes to avoid:
over-editing; inconsistent batch edits; faking edits; not saving the edited photos; not completing the Edit Decision Log.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong edited set contains:

- Five photos, each edited using the full workflow.
- The set looks consistent â€" matching white balance, contrast and colour.
- All edits are honest â€" the photos look like better versions of the originals, not different images.
- The Edit Decision Log is accurate and specific.
- The reflection is thoughtful â€" identifies strengths and areas for improvement.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer.
What is the editing workflow? Name the steps in order.

Q2. Multiple choice.
You are editing a portrait. The person's face is slightly dark and the background is slightly bright. What should you adjust first? a) Saturation b) Shadows c) White balance d) Crop

Q3. Explain in your own words.
What is the difference between white balance and saturation?

Q4. Practical identification.
A classmate's edited photo has skin that looks like plastic â€" unnaturally smooth, with no texture. What is the problem, and how would you fix it?

Q5. Matching.
Match each editing term to what it does: **crop, straighten, exposure, retouch.** a) Removes distractions at the edges of the frame b) Fixes tilted lines c) Adjusts brightness â€" brightens dark areas, recovers bright areas d) Removes blemishes and small distractions

the most likely reason, and what should you do?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q6)

A1.
The editing workflow is: (1) Crop and straighten, (2) Correct exposure, (3) Adjust colour (white balance and saturation), (4) Retouch (remove blemishes and distractions), (5) Sharpen (optional). Each step builds on the previous one.

A2.
(b) Shadows. The face is dark, so you should increase the shadows to brighten it. (You might also decrease the highlights to recover detail in the bright background.)

A3.
White balance adjusts the warmth or coolness of the photo â€” making colours look natural (not too orange, not too blue). Saturation adjusts the intensity of the colours â€” making them more vivid or more muted. White balance is about colour accuracy; saturation is about colour intensity.

A4.
The problem is over-retouching â€” the skin has been smoothed so much that it looks unnatural. Fix: reduce the retouching. Keep natural skin texture. Remove blemishes, not texture.

A5.
crop = (a); straighten = (b); exposure = (c); retouch = (d).

A6.
The most likely reason is that the photos were taken in slightly different light or from slightly different angles, so the same edits do not work perfectly for every photo. What to do: review each photo individually and make small adjustments to white balance, exposure and saturation as needed. Batch editing gets you most of the way â€” the last step is individual review.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary.
Today you learned that editing is the second half of photography â€” refining the raw photo into a finished image. You learned the editing workflow: crop and straighten first, then correct exposure, then adjust colour, then retouch, then sharpen. You learned that cropping removes distractions and improves composition. You learned that exposure correction balances brightness â€” brightness, highlights and shadows. You learned that colour adjustment makes colours natural â€” white balance and saturation. You learned that retouching removes small distractions â€” blemishes, dust spots â€” while keeping natural texture. You learned that batch editing makes a set consistent â€” copy edits, paste, review each photo. And you learned the most important rule: edit honestly. Do not change a product's appearance, fake a background, reshape a body, or mislead the viewer. Do less, but do it well.

Five important takeaways:

1. The editing workflow: crop, exposure, colour, retouch, sharpen â€” in that order.
2. Editing can fix small problems â€” cropping, exposure, colour, blemishes â€” not big ones.
3. Batch editing makes a set consistent â€” copy, paste, review, adjust.
4. The honest editing line: enhance, do not deceive.
5. Do less, but do it well â€” small, honest edits produce professional results.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I edit a photo using the full workflow without looking at my notes?
- Can I explain the difference between white balance and saturation?
- Can I batch-edit a set of photos so they look consistent?
- Can I retouch a blemish without destroying natural skin texture?

Connection to the next session.

You now have the skills to shoot and edit professional-quality photos. Next session we turn to the business side: building a portfolio, pricing your work in naira, and working with clients. You will learn to select your strongest images, assemble a cohesive portfolio in Canva, build a package price list, and run a client workflow from brief to delivery. You will also learn about consent and releases â€" the legal and ethical foundation of professional photography. A timed simulation from a short client brief will test everything you have learned so far.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner follows the editing workflow in the correct order without being reminded.
- Learner makes small, honest edits â€" not over-edited, not faked.
- Learner batch-edits a set and reviews each photo individually.
- Learner can explain the honest editing rules and why they matter.
- Learner saves edited photos and organises them properly.
- Learner can look at an edited photo and identify over-editing or dishonest edits.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Editing is cheating." â†' No â€" editing is part of photography. The question is how to edit honestly.
- "More editing is better." â†' No â€" do less, but do it well. Small, honest edits produce professional results.
- "I can fix anything in editing." â†' No â€" editing cannot fix a blurry photo, poor composition, or bad light.
- "Batch editing means I do not need to review each photo." â†' No â€" always review and adjust individually.
- "The client wants it, so I should do it." â†' No â€" honesty is not negotiable. Offer an honest alternative.
- "Beauty filters are fine for business photos." â†' No â€" beauty filters that reshape the face are misleading and unprofessional.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Workflow drill:** Give the learner a raw photo and have them edit it step by step, naming each step as they go. Review the result together.
2. **Before-and-after comparison:** Have the learner edit a photo, then show the original and the edited version side by side. Ask: "What did you change? Why? Is it honest?"
3. **Over-editing identification:** Show three edited photos â€" one honest, one over-edited, one faked. Have the learner identify which is which and explain why.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a printed step-by-step guide for the editing workflow with screenshots. Pair the learner with a confident learner for the practical.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full lecture, demonstration, guided practical and assignment.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to edit a photo for a specific purpose â€" a product photo for a catalogue, a portrait for a business profile, or an event photo for a newsletter â€" and write a short artist's statement explaining their editing choices and why they are honest. They should also research and present one advanced editing technique not covered in the session (e.g., selective editing, curves, or split toning).

Timing guidance.

The priority is learners editing photos using the full workflow (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the lecture's batch editing section to the key points â€" copy, paste, review â€" and protect the practical time. A learner who leaves without editing a photo and batch-editing a set has no editing skill and no material for the capstone.

END OF SESSION 4

CYBER
ELIAS
ACADEMY

SESSION 5 â€" BUILDING A PORTFOLIO AND PRICING PHOTOGRAPHY

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" PHOTOGRAPHY

SESSION 5 â€" BUILDING A PORTFOLIO AND PRICING PHOTOGRAPHY

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	5 of 6
Session title	Building a Portfolio and Pricing Photography
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: "Process and Deliver"
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (practical, business-focused)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"4 â€" the learner should have a foundations folder of raw photos, an edited set, and the ability to shoot and edit to a usable standard. No prior business or pricing knowledge assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Sessions 1â€"4 you learned to shoot and edit professional-quality photos. Now you learn to select your strongest work, assemble a cohesive portfolio, price your services in naira, and work with clients professionally. This session prepares you for the capstone â€" the themed photo shoot and mini portfolio.
Preparation before class	Academy computers with internet access and Canva installed or accessible; the instructor's computer connected to the projector for live Canva demonstration; a sample portfolio (printed or projected) showing a strong and a weak portfolio; a sample price list for a fictional Port Harcourt photographer; printed consent and release forms; the "Portfolio Selection Sheet" (Section H) printed per learner; a short fictional client brief for the timed simulation.

Instructor note on tone:
This session is about professionalism and business. Many learners are creative but uncomfortable with the business side â€" pricing, talking about money, presenting their work. Create a supportive, practical atmosphere. Emphasise that pricing is not greedy â€" it is fair. Presenting your work is not arrogance â€" it is professionalism. The goal is to help learners see themselves as professionals, not hobbyists.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Select** the strongest images from their body of work, using clear quality criteria.
2. **Sequence** a portfolio so it flows as a cohesive set â€" not just a collection of individual photos.
3. **Assemble** a first portfolio page in Canva, with a title, images and brief descriptions.
4. **Build a package price list** in naira with at least three packages, each with clear deliverables.
5. **Describe a client workflow** from brief to delivery: brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with their foundations folder and edited set.
- Academy computers with internet access for Canva.
- Instructor's computer connected to a projector for live Canva demonstration.

Software

- **Canva** (free tier) â€" available at canva.com or as a mobile app. Used for assembling the portfolio.
- No paid software required. No subscription required.

Accounts

- A free Canva account (email sign-up) â€" learners should create this before or during the session.

Sample files

- **A sample portfolio** (printed or projected) â€" one strong portfolio (cohesive, well-sequenced, professional) and one weak portfolio (random order, inconsistent quality, no flow).
- **A sample price list** for a fictional Port Harcourt photographer â€" showing three packages with clear deliverables in naira.
- **Consent and release forms** (printed per learner).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 5.1 â€" "Portfolio Selection Sheet" (a table: image, quality rating, reason for selection/rejection).
- Worksheet 5.2 â€" "Package Price List Template" (a table: package name, what is included, price in naira).
- Worksheet 5.3 â€" "Client Workflow Sheet" (a table: step, what happens, who is responsible).

Tools

- A whiteboard and markers for drawing the client workflow diagram.

Internet

- Required for Canva. Not required for the rest of the session.

Alternative for learners who lack a computer or internet

- A learner without computer access may use the Canva mobile app on their phone, or assemble a printed portfolio with printed photos and handwritten descriptions. They must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

Ethics note:
Consent and releases are not optional. Before using any person's image in a portfolio or for commercial purposes, obtain written consent. For under-18s, obtain parent/guardian consent. This is a legal and ethical obligation.

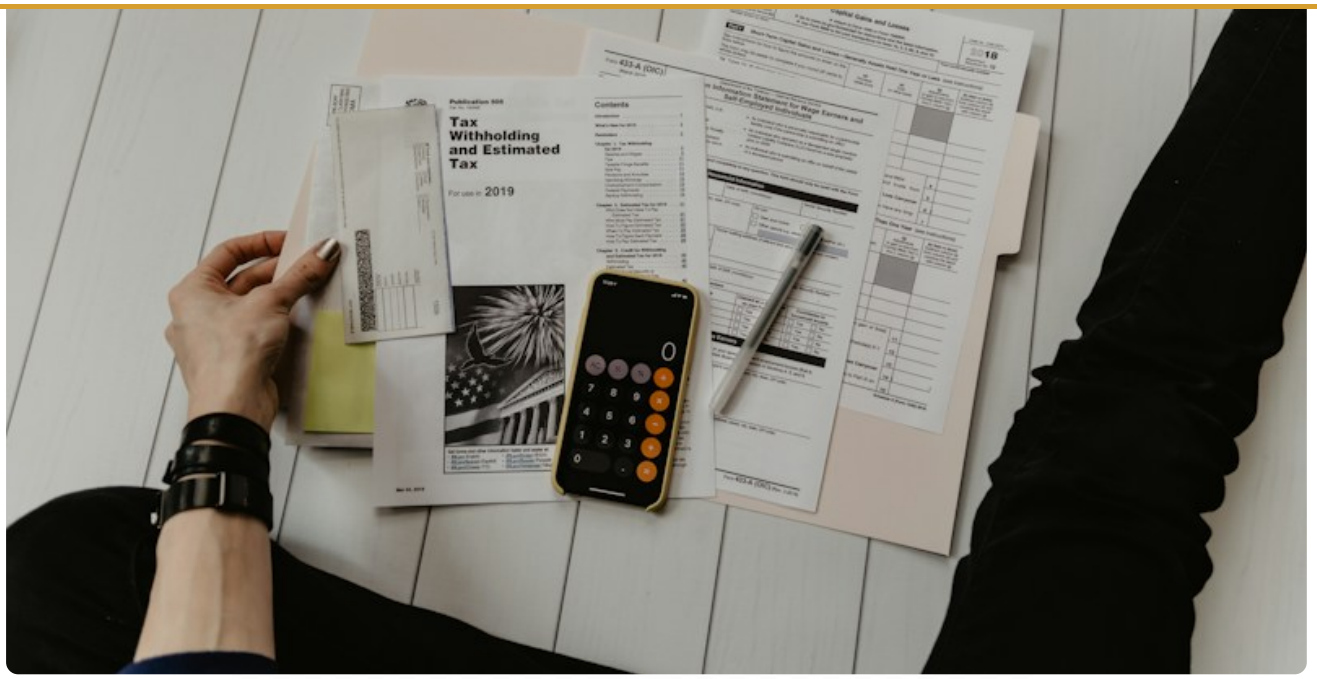
Suggested visuals:



- â€" assembling the portfolio



- â€" building it in Canva



- â€" pricing packages in naira



- â€" showing a portfolio to a client



- â€" building the portfolio online

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup:
On the projector, show two portfolios:

- **Portfolio A (strong):** A set of five product photos for a fictional food business. The photos are consistent â€" same style, same light, same background. They are sequenced to tell a story: the ingredients, the preparation, the finished dish, the packaging, the happy customer. The portfolio has a title, the photographer's name, and a brief description of each photo.
- **Portfolio B (weak):** A set of ten photos â€" some product shots, some portraits, some landscapes, some event photos. They are in random order, with different styles and quality levels. There is no title, no description, no flow.

What the instructor says:

> *"Two portfolios. Both contain good photos. But one looks like a professional photographer made it, and one looks like someone just dumped all their photos in a folder. Hands up â€" which portfolio would you hire? â€¦ Portfolio A, almost everyone. Now tell me: what is different about Portfolio A?"*

Expected learner response:
Learners will say things like "it looks organised," "the photos match," "it tells a story," "it has a title," "it looks professional," "it is not mixed up." Accept all answers and write the key phrases on the board: **consistent, organised, story, title, professional, flow.**

Then reveal the lesson:
Say clearly:

> *"A portfolio is not 'all my best photos.' It is the right photos in the right order, telling the right story. Today you learn to select your strongest work, sequence it so it flows, and assemble it in Canva. You also learn to price your work in naira â€" because photography is a skill, and skills have value. And you learn to work with clients professionally â€" from the first*

Why this opener works:
It uses two portfolios with the same quality of photos but very different presentation, proving that selection and sequencing â€" not just photo quality â€" make the difference. It introduces the business side of photography before any technical explanation.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1:
"What is the editing workflow? Name the steps in order."

- Expected answer: Crop and straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, retouch, sharpen.
- Common gap: Learners may forget the order. Clarify: "Crop first, then exposure, then colour, then retouch, then sharpen."

Question 2:
"What are the honest editing rules? Name two."

- Expected answer: Do not change a product's true appearance; do not fake a background; do not reshape a body beyond normal correction; do not mislead the viewer.
- Common gap: Learners may remember one rule but not others. Clarify: "Enhance, do not deceive. If a client or viewer would be misled, do not do it."

Question 3:
"What is batch editing, and why does it matter?"

- Expected answer: Batch editing means applying the same edits to multiple photos so they look consistent. It matters because a set of photos should look like they belong together â€" not like they were taken by different people.
- Common gap: Learners may think batch editing means pasting edits without reviewing. Clarify: "Copy, paste, review each photo, adjust. Batch editing gets you 90% of the way â€" the last 10% is individual review."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You can shoot and edit professional-quality photos. But a photographer is not just a person who takes photos â€" a photographer is a professional who delivers a product to a client. Today you learn the professional side: selecting your best work, building a portfolio, pricing your services, and working with clients. This is where your skill becomes a business."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the editing workflow, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing it on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What a portfolio is and why it matters

The idea.
A portfolio is a curated collection of your best work, presented in a way that shows your skill, your style and your professionalism. It is not a dump of every photo you have ever taken â€" it is a deliberate selection of your strongest images, sequenced to tell a story.

Plain-English definition.
A portfolio is a small, carefully chosen set of your best photographs, organised to show a potential client what you can do. It is your professional face â€" the first thing a client sees when they consider hiring you.

Why it matters:

- It builds trust. A professional portfolio makes a client feel confident hiring you.
- It wins work. A strong portfolio is the difference between getting hired and being passed over.

The three rules of a strong portfolio (teach these and return to them all session):

Rule	What it means	Why it matters
1. Select ruthlessly	Include only your strongest images â€" not every photo you like	A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio. Quality over quantity.
2. Sequence for flow	Arrange the photos so they tell a story â€" not random order	A portfolio that flows feels professional. A random collection feels careless.
3. Show consistency	The photos should look like they belong together â€" same style, same quality	Consistency shows you can deliver a reliable standard. Inconsistency shows you cannot.

What a portfolio is NOT:

- It is not "all my best photos." It is the *right* photos â€" the ones that show your skill and style for the work you want to do.
- It is not a random collection. It is a curated, sequenced set.
- It is not a place for experiments. It is a professional presentation â€" save experiments for your personal work.

Real-life comparison.
A portfolio is like a job resume. A resume is not a list of everything you have ever done â€" it is a curated selection of your most relevant experience, presented clearly and professionally. A portfolio does the same for your photography: it shows the client the best of what you can do, in a way that makes them want to hire you.

Misconception to correct.
"I need to have hundreds of photos before I can build a portfolio." No. A strong portfolio can be five photos. A weak portfolio is weak even with five hundred. Quality and curation matter more than quantity.

F.2 Selecting your best work

The idea.
Selecting your best work is the most important skill in building a portfolio. It requires honesty â€" you must be able to look at your own photos and say "this one is not good enough." This is hard, because you have an emotional attachment to your photos. But a professional learns to select ruthlessly.

The selection criteria (teach these and return to them all session):

Criterion	What to ask yourself	Why it matters
Sharpness	Is the subject sharp? Can I see the detail when I zoom in?	A blurry photo is unusable â€" no exceptions.
Exposure	Is the photo correctly exposed â€" not too dark, not too bright?	A poorly exposed photo looks amateur.
Composition	Is the composition intentional? Does the photo look like someone made choices?	A poorly composed photo looks accidental.
Light	Is the light flattering? Does the subject look their best?	Bad light ruins an otherwise good photo.
Moment	Does the photo capture the right instant? Does it feel alive?	A missed moment is a missed opportunity.
Honesty	Is the photo honestly edited? Does it look like the real scene?	A dishonest photo destroys trust.

2. Review each photo against the six criteria.
3. Rate each photo: **Strong** (meets all criteria), **Acceptable** (meets most criteria), **Weak** (fails one or more criteria).
4. Select only the **Strong** photos for your portfolio. If you do not have enough Strong photos, shoot more â€" do not lower your standard.
5. Aim for 5â€"8 photos for a mini portfolio. Quality over quantity.

The ruthless selection rule (say this slowly):

> *"If a photo is not Strong, it does not go in the portfolio. Not 'almost Strong.' Not 'good enough.' Strong. A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio."*

Real-life comparison.
Selecting your best work is like a chef choosing ingredients for a signature dish. The chef does not use every ingredient in the kitchen â€" they choose the best, the freshest, the most flavourful. A portfolio is your signature dish â€" use only your best ingredients.

Common mistake.
Including a photo because you like the memory, not because the photo is strong. A photo of a beautiful sunset that is slightly blurry does not belong in your portfolio â€" no matter how much you enjoyed the sunset. The portfolio is about the photo, not the memory.

F.3 Sequencing a portfolio â€" telling a story

The idea.
A portfolio is not just a collection of strong photos â€" it is a sequence that tells a story. The order matters. A well-sequenced portfolio flows naturally, building from one photo to the next, creating a cohesive experience for the viewer.

The sequencing principles (teach these and return to them all session):

Principle	What it means	Example
1. Start strong	Your first photo should be your strongest â€" it sets the impression	Open with your most impactful image
2. Build gradually	Move from strong to strongest â€" build the story	Start with a wide shot, move to details, end with the hero shot
3. Create contrast	Vary the photos â€" different angles, different scales, different moods	Do not put three similar photos next to each other
4. End strong	Your last photo should be memorable â€" it is what the viewer remembers	Close with your most emotional or impactful image
5. Keep it consistent	All photos should look like they belong together â€" same style, same quality	Do not mix heavily edited and unedited photos

The story arc for a product portfolio:

1. **The hero shot** â€" the product at its best, the first impression.
2. **The detail shot** â€" a close-up of the product's texture, label or key feature.
3. **The context shot** â€" the product in use or in its environment.
4. **The variety shot** â€" showing the range of products or options.
5. **The closing shot** â€" a memorable image that leaves a lasting impression.

The story arc for a portrait portfolio:

3. **The detail shot** â€" hands, eyes, or a meaningful object.
4. **The emotion shot** â€" a genuine laugh, a thoughtful look, a moment of joy.
5. **The closing shot** â€" a strong, memorable portrait that captures the person's essence.

Real-life comparison.
Sequencing a portfolio is like telling a story. A good story has a beginning (the hook), a middle (the development) and an end (the resolution). A portfolio does the same â€" it draws the viewer in, builds interest, and leaves a lasting impression.

Common mistake.
Putting all your strongest photos at the beginning and letting the quality drop off at the end. The viewer remembers the last photo most â€" make it count.

F.4 Building a portfolio in Canva

The idea.
Canva is a free, browser-based design tool that makes it easy to assemble a professional-looking portfolio. You do not need design experience â€" Canva provides templates, drag-and-drop editing and professional layouts.

How to build a portfolio page in Canva:

1. **Create a free account** at canva.com (or download the Canva app).
2. **Choose a template** â€" search for "portfolio" or "photo gallery" in the template library. Choose a clean, simple template â€" do not choose anything too busy or colourful.
3. **Add a title** â€" your name, the course name and the date. Example: "Chinedu Okafor â€" CEA Photography â€" October 2026."
4. **Add your photos** â€" drag and drop your selected photos into the template. Arrange them in your sequenced order.
5. **Add brief descriptions** â€" under each photo, add one sentence explaining what the photo shows and why it is in the portfolio. Example: "Product shot â€" Mama Nkechi's pepper soup base. Natural window light, rule of thirds composition."
6. **Review and adjust** â€" check the layout, the spacing, the alignment. Make sure everything looks clean and professional.
7. **Export** â€" download the portfolio as a PDF or PNG. This is your portfolio file.

The portfolio page checklist:

- ☐ Title with your name, course and date
- ☐ 5â€"8 photos, sequenced for flow
- ☐ Brief description under each photo
- ☐ Clean, professional layout
- ☐ Consistent style across all photos
- ☐ Exported as a PDF or PNG

Real-life comparison.
Building a portfolio in Canva is like arranging a shop window. You choose the best products, arrange them in a pleasing order, add clear labels, and make sure everything looks clean and professional. Canva is your shop window â€" make it inviting.

Common mistake.
Using a template that is too busy or colourful â€" the template competes with your photos for attention. Choose a clean, simple template that lets your photos stand out.

F.5 Pricing your photography â€" packages in naira

The idea.
Pricing is one of the hardest parts of photography â€" especially for beginners. You do not want to charge too little (you devalue your work) or too much (you price yourself out of the market). The solution is to build clear packages with defined deliverables, so the client knows exactly what they are getting for their money.

Model	What it means	When to use it
Per hour	You charge for the time you spend shooting	Good for events, where the time is the main variable
Per package	You charge a fixed price for a defined set of deliverables	Good for portraits and products, where the deliverables are clear

The package pricing model (recommended for beginners):

A package is a fixed price for a clear set of deliverables. The client knows what they are getting, and you know what you are delivering. This removes ambiguity and builds trust.

Three sample packages for a product photographer in Port Harcourt:

Package	What is included	Price (example)
Basic	5 edited product photos, 1 background option, 3-day delivery	â,¦15,000
Standard	10 edited product photos, 2 background options, 2-day delivery, 1 revision round	â,¦30,000
Premium	20 edited product photos, 3 background options, 1-day delivery, 2 revision rounds, social media captions	â,¦60,000

Three sample packages for a portrait photographer in Port Harcourt:

Package	What is included	Price (example)
Basic	30-minute shoot, 5 edited photos, 1 location, 3-day delivery	â,¦10,000
Standard	1-hour shoot, 10 edited photos, 2 locations, 2-day delivery, 1 revision round	â,¦25,000
Premium	2-hour shoot, 20 edited photos, 3 locations, 1-day delivery, 2 revision rounds, printed photos	â,¦50,000

How to set your prices:

1. **Research the market** â€" what do other photographers in Port Harcourt charge? Ask around, check social media, look at competitor pricing.
2. **Calculate your costs** â€" your time, transport, editing time, any props or materials.
3. **Set a fair price** â€" not so little that you lose money, not so much that you price yourself out. As a beginner, you may charge less than an experienced photographer â€" but do not work for free.
4. **Offer packages** â€" packages make it easy for the client to say yes. They know what they are getting, and you know what you are delivering.
5. **Be transparent** â€" state your prices clearly. Do not hide them or make the client guess.

The pricing rules (teach these and return to them all session):

- **Never work for free** (except for practice or an agreed favour). Free work devalues your skill and sets an expectation that your work is worth nothing.
- **State your prices clearly** â€" do not be vague or apologistic. Your skill has value.
- **Deliver what you promise** â€" if you say 10 photos, deliver 10 photos. If you say 3-day delivery, deliver in 3 days.
- **Revise your prices as you grow** â€" as your skill and reputation grow, your prices should grow too.

Real-life comparison.
Pricing is like a market trader setting prices for her goods. She knows her costs, she knows what the market will bear, and she sets a fair price. She does not give her goods away for free, and she does not charge so much that no one buys. A photographer does the same â€" set a fair price for a clear deliverable.

Misconception to correct.

charge fairly later.

F.6 The client workflow â€" from brief to delivery

The idea.
A professional photographer does not just take photos â€" they manage a process. The client workflow is the step-by-step process from the first conversation to the final delivery. It ensures nothing is missed, the client knows what to expect, and the work is delivered professionally.

The six-step client workflow (teach these and return to them all session):

Step	What happens	Who is responsible
1. Brief	The client explains what they need â€" the purpose, the subject, the style, the deadline	Client provides, photographer listens and asks questions
2. Quote	The photographer provides a price based on the brief â€" a package price or an hourly rate	Photographer
3. Shoot	The photographer plans and executes the shoot â€" location, light, composition, consent	Photographer
4. Edit	The photographer edits the photos â€" crop, exposure, colour, retouch, batch edit	Photographer
5. Deliver	The photographer delivers the final photos â€" in the agreed format, by the agreed deadline	Photographer
6. Follow-up	The photographer checks that the client is happy, asks for feedback, and requests a testimonial or referral if appropriate	Photographer

The brief â€" the most important step:
The brief is the foundation of the entire job. A clear brief means a clear delivery. A vague brief means a confused client and a missed expectation.

The brief should answer these questions:

- What is the purpose of the photos? (Product catalogue, portrait, event coverage, social media?)
- What is the subject? (A specific product, a person, an event?)
- What style do you want? (Clean and minimal, warm and natural, dramatic?)
- How many photos do you need?
- What is the deadline?
- What is the budget?
- Are there any specific requirements? (Background, props, locations, consent?)

The quote â€" clear and professional:

- State the package or price clearly.
- State what is included â€" number of photos, delivery time, revision rounds.
- State what is not included â€" extra photos, rush delivery, additional locations.
- State the payment terms â€" deposit (e.g., 50% before the shoot), balance on delivery.

The shoot â€" planned and professional:

- Arrive on time.
- Check the light, the background, the composition.
- Obtain consent from any person photographed.
- Take more photos than needed â€" you can always edit down.

- Batch-edit for consistency.
- Review each photo individually.

The delivery â€” on time and in the agreed format:

- Deliver the photos in the agreed format (JPEG, PNG, PDF).
- Deliver by the agreed deadline.
- Include a brief note explaining what was delivered and how to use the photos.

The follow-up â€” build the relationship:

- Check that the client is happy.
- Ask for feedback â€” what went well, what could be improved.
- If the client is happy, ask for a testimonial or a referral.
- Stay in touch â€ a past client is the best source of future work.

Real-life comparison.
The client workflow is like a restaurant experience. The brief is the customer telling the waiter what they want. The quote is the menu price. The shoot is the kitchen preparing the meal. The edit is the chef plating the dish. The delivery is the waiter serving the meal. The follow-up is the manager asking if everything was satisfactory. A good restaurant manages all six steps â€ a good photographer does the same.

Common mistake.
Skipping the brief â€ just showing up and shooting without understanding what the client wants. This leads to missed expectations, wasted time and an unhappy client. Always start with a clear brief.

F.7 Consent and releases â€ the legal and ethical foundation

The idea.
Before you photograph a person â€ for practice, portfolio or client use â€ you must obtain their consent. Before you use a person's image commercially, you must obtain a release. This is not just politeness â€ it is a legal and ethical obligation.

The difference between consent and a release:

Document	What it is	When you need it
Consent form	The person agrees to be photographed	Before you take the photo
Model release	The person agrees to let you use their image	Before you use the image (portfolio, client work, social media)

The consent form (simple version):

```
CONSENT TO BE PHOTOGRAPHED

I, _____ (name), agree to be photographed by
_____ (photographer's name) on _____ (date).

I understand that the photographs may be used for:
[ ] Practice and learning
[ ] Portfolio
[ ] Client/business use
[ ] Social media

I give my permission freely and can ask for the photos to be deleted at any time.

Signature: _____
Date: _____
```

```
Date: _____________________
```

The model release (simple version):

```
MODEL RELEASE

I, _____________________ (name), give _____________________ (photographer's name)
permission to use my photograph for:
[ ] Portfolio
[ ] Client/business use
[ ] Social media
[ ] Other: _____________________

I understand that:
- I am giving this permission freely.
- I can withdraw this permission at any time by contacting the photographer.
- I will not receive payment for the use of my image (unless otherwise agreed in writing).

Signature: _____________________
Date: _____________________

For subjects under 18:
Parent/Guardian name: _____________________
Parent/Guardian signature: _____________________
Date: _____________________
```

Why consent and releases matter:

- They are respectful. People have the right to control how their image is used.
- They are professional. A photographer who obtains consent and releases is trusted. One who does not is avoided.
- They are legal. In Nigeria, using someone's image without permission â€" especially for commercial purposes â€" can create legal problems.
- They protect both parties. The photographer has proof of permission. The subject has the right to withdraw permission.

Misconception to correct.
"If I am in a public place, I do not need consent." Not exactly. You can photograph public scenes and buildings, but photographing identifiable people â€" especially for commercial use â€" requires consent. When in doubt, ask.

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- A portfolio is a curated collection of your best work, sequenced to tell a story.
- Select ruthlessly â€" only Strong photos go in the portfolio.
- Sequence for flow â€" start strong, build gradually, end strong, keep it consistent.
- Build the portfolio in Canva â€" clean template, title, photos, descriptions, export as PDF.
- Price your work in packages â€" clear deliverables, fair prices in naira.
- Follow the client workflow â€" brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.
- Obtain consent and releases â€" before photographing and before using images.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Best 20 photos] --> B[Portfolio website] --> C[Set package prices] --> D[Get first client]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

- A set of sample photos (product or portrait) for the portfolio demonstration.
- A sample price list and client workflow sheet.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” selecting and sequencing (4 minutes)

Say:
"I have 12 photos from a product shoot. I am going to select the strongest five and sequence them for a portfolio."

Step 1:
Show all 12 photos quickly. "I am going to rate each one: Strong, Acceptable or Weak."

Step 2:
Rate each photo out loud. "This one is Strong â€” sharp, well-lit, good composition. This one is Acceptable â€— slightly dark. This one is Weak â€— blurry."

Step 3:
Select the five Strong photos. "These are my five. Quality over quantity."

Step 4:
Sequence them. "I will start with the hero shot â€— the product at its best. Then a detail shot. Then a context shot. Then a variety shot. Then a closing shot â€— something memorable."

Say:
"Selection is the hardest part. You have to be honest with yourself. But a portfolio with five Strong photos is better than a portfolio with ten mixed photos."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€— building the portfolio in Canva (6 minutes)

Say:
"Now I am going to assemble the portfolio in Canva. Watch each step."

Step 1:
Open Canva. Search for a "portfolio" template. Choose a clean, simple one.

Step 2:
Add a title. "Chinedu Okafor â€— CEA Photography â€— October 2026."

Step 3:
Drag and drop the five selected photos into the template. Arrange them in the sequenced order.

Step 4:
Add brief descriptions under each photo. "Product shot â€— Mama Nkechi's pepper soup base. Natural window light, rule of thirds composition."

Step 5:
Review the layout. Adjust spacing and alignment.

Step 6:
Export as a PDF.

Say:
"A portfolio is your professional face. It should be clean, organised and easy to read. The photos are the star â€— the layout should support them, not compete with them."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€— pricing and workflow (4 minutes)

Say:
"Now I am going to show you a price list and a client workflow. These are the business tools every photographer needs."

Show the sample price list.

Show the client workflow sheet.
"Six steps: brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up. The brief is the most important â€” if you do not understand what the client wants, you cannot deliver it. The follow-up is the most forgotten â€” but it is how you build long-term relationships."

Say:
"Pricing is not greedy â€” it is fair. You have a skill, and skills have value. Present your prices clearly, deliver what you promise, and follow up to make sure the client is happy. That is professionalism."

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Why do we select only Strong photos?" (A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio.)
- "Why does the first photo matter most?" (It sets the impression â€” start strong.)
- "Why use packages instead of hourly rates?" (Packages are clear â€” the client knows what they are getting.)
- "What is the most important step in the client workflow?" (The brief â€” if you do not understand the need, you cannot deliver.)
- "Why do we need a model release?" (To use someone's image commercially, you need their written permission.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective:
With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner selects and sequences a set of photos, builds a first portfolio page in Canva, and creates a price list and client workflow sheet.

Starting materials:
Learner's own phone or academy computer; Canva account (free); the learner's foundations folder and edited set; the printed worksheets.

Procedure â€” Part 1: Selection and sequencing (6 minutes)

1. Gather all your photos from the course â€” foundations folder, edited set, any other photos.
2. Review each photo against the six criteria: sharpness, exposure, composition, light, moment, honesty.
3. Rate each photo: Strong, Acceptable or Weak.
4. Select 5â€“8 Strong photos for your portfolio.
5. Sequence them: start strong, build gradually, end strong, keep it consistent.
6. Write your selection and sequencing decisions in the Portfolio Selection Sheet.

Procedure â€” Part 2: Building the portfolio in Canva (8 minutes)

7. Open Canva. Search for a portfolio template. Choose a clean, simple one.
8. Add a title: your name, course name, date.
9. Add your selected photos in the sequenced order.
10. Add a brief description under each photo.
11. Review and adjust the layout.
12. Export as a PDF.

Procedure â€” Part 3: Price list and workflow (4 minutes)

13. Create a price list with at least three packages. Use the Package Price List Template. Set fair prices in naira.
14. Complete the Client Workflow Sheet â€” the six steps from brief to follow-up.
15. Write one sentence: "My pricing philosophy is _____."

Expected result:
A portfolio page (PDF), a price list with three packages, and a completed client workflow sheet.

Points to pause and predict:

- After Canva: "Is your layout clean? Do the photos stand out?"
- After pricing: "Are your prices fair â€" not too low, not too high?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner includes too many photos â†' Remind them: "Quality over quantity. 5â€"8 photos."
- Learner's portfolio has no flow â†' Ask: "What story does your portfolio tell? Does it start strong and end strong?"
- Learner's Canva layout is too busy â†' Suggest a simpler template. "The photos are the star."
- Learner's prices are too low â†' Ask: "What is your time worth? Do not undervalue your skill."
- Learner's prices are too high â†' Ask: "What do other photographers in Port Harcourt charge? Research the market."

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ 5â€"8 Strong photos selected
- ☐ Photos sequenced for flow
- ☐ Portfolio Selection Sheet completed
- ☐ Portfolio page built in Canva and exported as PDF
- ☐ Price list with three packages created
- ☐ Client Workflow Sheet completed
- ☐ Pricing philosophy stated

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task:
Complete a timed simulation â€" plan, shoot, edit and present a delivery-ready set from a short client brief.

Scenario.
You have been hired by *Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices* (the running capstone example) to photograph five product photos for her WhatsApp Business catalogue. You have 15 minutes to complete the entire job â€" from brief to delivery.

The brief (read this carefully):

- **Client:** Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices
- **Purpose:** WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram
- **Subject:** Five products â€" pepper soup base, dried fish, spice mix, palm oil, and a bowl of finished soup
- **Style:** Clean, appetising, natural light, consistent look
- **Deliverables:** Five edited photos, consistent style, delivered as JPEG files
- **Deadline:** 15 minutes from now

Requirements:

1. **Plan (2 minutes):** Read the brief. Plan your shoot â€" which products, what order, what light, what background. Write a quick shot list.
2. **Shoot (6 minutes):** Photograph the five products. Use the 5-step sharpness routine. Use natural light. Compose deliberately. Take several frames of each product.
3. **Edit (5 minutes):** Edit the five photos using the workflow. Batch-edit for consistency. Save as JPEG.
4. **Present (2 minutes):** Present your five photos to the class (or to a partner). Explain your choices â€" light, composition, editing.

Constraints:

- Use only the built-in camera app and Snapseed â€" no paid software.
- All edits must be honest â€" do not change the products' appearance.
- The five photos must look consistent â€" same style, same light, same overall feel.

15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Five photos delivered within 15 minutes.
- All photos are sharp, correctly exposed and well-composed.
- The set looks consistent â€" like it came from the same shoot.
- All edits are honest.
- The learner can explain their choices.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: Plan before you shoot. Know which products, what order, what light.
- Hint 2: Use the same light and background for all five photos â€" this ensures consistency.
- Hint 3: Edit the first photo completely, then copy the edits to the other four. Review each one.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

A strong simulation delivery contains:

- **Five photos:** Pepper soup base, dried fish, spice mix, palm oil, and a bowl of finished soup.
- **Consistent style:** All photographed in the same light (window light or open shade), same background (plain surface), same angle (45 degrees or eye level).
- **Sharp and correctly exposed:** All five photos are sharp on the product, correctly exposed.
- **Honest edits:** Cropped, exposure corrected, colour adjusted, batch-edited for consistency. No faked backgrounds, no changed products.
- **Presentation:** The learner explains their choices â€" "I used window light for soft, flattering light. I placed each product on a grid intersection. I batch-edited for consistency."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Five photos delivered within 15 minutes (2)
- All photos sharp and correctly exposed (2)
- The set looks consistent (2)
- All edits are honest (2)
- Presentation explains choices clearly (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation.
Emeka is a beginner photographer in Port Harcourt. He has been shooting for a few months and has a collection of photos he is proud of. He wants to start charging for his work, but he does not know how to present himself or price his services. He posts his photos on Instagram with the caption "DM for prices" and waits for clients. After three months, he has had only two enquiries and no bookings.

Relevant facts.

- Emeka has no portfolio â€" just individual Instagram posts.
- He has no price list â€" he tells people to "DM for prices."
- He has no client workflow â€" he does not know how to handle a brief, quote or delivery.
- He has no consent forms â€" he photographs people without asking.
- His photos are actually good â€" sharp, well-lit, well-composed.

Decision point.
What is the main reason Emeka is not getting clients?

2. Emeka needs to present himself professionally â€" a portfolio, a price list, a clear workflow.
3. Emeka needs to post more often on Instagram â€" consistency on social media is the key.

Recommended solution.
Approach 2. Emeka's photos are good â€" his problem is presentation. A potential client who sees individual Instagram posts with "DM for prices" does not know what Emeka offers, what it costs, or what to expect. A professional portfolio, a clear price list and a defined workflow make it easy for a client to say yes.

Specific fixes for Emeka:

- Build a portfolio: Select his strongest 5â€"8 photos, sequence them, assemble them in Canva.
- Create a price list: Three packages with clear deliverables in naira.
- Define a client workflow: Brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.
- Obtain consent: Ask before photographing people, use consent forms.
- Present clearly: Instead of "DM for prices," post his portfolio and price list. Let the work speak.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is unnecessary â€" Emeka's photos are already good. Better photos will not fix a presentation problem.
- Approach 2 addresses the actual gap â€" presentation and professionalism. It is free (Canva is free, pricing is just a document) and immediately makes Emeka look professional.
- Approach 3 is partially true â€" consistency on social media matters â€" but without a portfolio and price list, more posts will not convert followers into clients.

Professional connection.
This case study illustrates the difference between a hobbyist and a professional. A hobbyist takes photos and posts them. A professional presents their work, prices their services and manages the client relationship. The skill is the same â€" the presentation is what makes the difference. Emeka has the skill; he needs the presentation.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide.

K.1 Including too many photos in the portfolio

Symptoms:
The portfolio has 15, 20 or 30 photos â€" it feels overwhelming and unfocused. **Likely cause:** The learner is emotionally attached to their photos and cannot bear to leave any out. **How to investigate:** Count the photos. Is the number between 5 and 8? If not, it is too many. **Corrective steps:** Reduce to 5â€"8 photos. Select only the Strong ones. Quality over quantity. **How to confirm resolved:** The portfolio has 5â€"8 Strong photos. **How to prevent recurrence:** Set a limit before you start. "I will select exactly 7 photos. No more."

K.2 Portfolio with no flow â€" random order

Symptoms:
The photos are in no particular order â€" a product shot, then a portrait, then a landscape, then another product shot. **Likely cause:** The learner selected strong photos but did not think about sequencing. **How to investigate:** Look at the portfolio â€" does it tell a story? Does it flow naturally from one photo to the next? **Corrective steps:** Sequence the photos: start strong, build gradually, end strong, create contrast, keep it consistent. **How to confirm resolved:** The portfolio flows naturally â€" it tells a story. **How to prevent recurrence:** Before finalising the portfolio, ask: "What story does this tell? Does it start strong and end strong?"

K.3 Pricing too low â€" devaluing the work

Symptoms:

the market rate for similar work in Port Harcourt. **Corrective steps:** Research the market. Calculate costs. Set a fair price â€" less than an experienced photographer, perhaps, but not a fraction of the market rate. **How to confirm resolved:** The prices are fair â€" not too low, not too high. **How to prevent recurrence:** Remember: your skill has value. Free or near-free work devalues your skill and sets an expectation that your work is worth nothing.

K.4 Pricing too high â€" pricing yourself out

Symptoms:
The learner charges â‚¦100,000 for a basic product shoot â€" far above the market rate for a beginner. **Likely cause:** The learner does not understand the market, or is trying to charge experienced-photographer rates as a beginner. **How to investigate:** Compare the learner's prices to the market rate for a beginner in Port Harcourt. **Corrective steps:** Research the market. As a beginner, charge less than an experienced photographer. Build your reputation, then raise your prices. **How to confirm resolved:** The prices are competitive â€" fair for a beginner. **How to prevent recurrence:** Start with fair beginner prices. Raise them as your skill and reputation grow.

K.5 Skipping the brief â€" shooting without understanding

Symptoms:
The learner shows up to a shoot without knowing what the client wants â€" the purpose, the subject, the style, the deadline. **Likely cause:** The learner did not ask for a brief, or did not listen to the client's answers. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner: "What did the client ask for? What is the purpose? What is the deadline?" **Corrective steps:** Always start with a brief. Ask the client: What is the purpose? What is the subject? What style? How many photos? What is the deadline? What is the budget? **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can state the client's needs clearly. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make the brief the first step of every job. Never skip it.

K.6 Not obtaining consent or releases

Symptoms:
The learner photographs people without asking, or uses images in a portfolio without a release. **Likely cause:** The learner does not understand the consent and release requirements. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner: "Did you ask permission before photographing that person? Do you have a signed release?" **Corrective steps:** Stop. Obtain consent before photographing. Obtain a release before using the image. Use the printed forms. **How to confirm resolved:** Consent and release forms are signed and filed. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make consent the first step of every portrait or event shoot. Make releases the first step of every portfolio or client use.

K.7 Not following up after delivery

Symptoms:
The learner delivers the photos and never contacts the client again. **Likely cause:** The learner does not know that follow-up is part of the professional workflow. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner: "Did you check that the client was happy? Did you ask for feedback?" **Corrective steps:** After delivery, follow up. Check that the client is happy. Ask for feedback. If the client is happy, ask for a testimonial or referral. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has a follow-up process. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make follow-up the final step of every job. A past client is the best source of future work.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed:
A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€" look at the actual portfolio, price list or workflow, and confirm the cause before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title:
"My Price List and Client Workflow Sheet"

Purpose:
To create a professional price list with three packages in naira and a client workflow sheet that defines the process from brief to delivery. These are the business tools you will use for the capstone and for your first paying clients.

understand and a workflow that ensures you deliver professionally every time. Your first potential client is Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices â€" the running capstone example.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Create a price list** with at least three packages. Use the Package Price List Template. For each package, state:
   - Package name (Basic, Standard, Premium)
   - What is included (number of photos, delivery time, revision rounds, any extras)
   - Price in naira (â‚¦)
2. **Set fair prices.** Research what other photographers in Port Harcourt charge. As a beginner, charge less than an experienced photographer â€" but do not work for free.
3. **Complete the Client Workflow Sheet.** For each of the six steps (brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up), state:
   - What happens in this step
   - Who is responsible
   - What the client should expect
4. **Write a short pricing philosophy** (3â€"5 sentences): "I believe photographers should charge fairly because _____. My prices are fair because _____. As my skill grows, my prices will _____."
5. **Prepare a consent form and a model release.** Use the printed templates. Fill in your name and the date. These are ready for your first client.

Required deliverables:

- A price list with three packages in naira.
- A completed Client Workflow Sheet.
- A short pricing philosophy.
- A prepared consent form and model release.

Submission format:
Save as `Pricing_YourName.docx` (or `.pdf`) and upload to `/Photography/Week2/Pricing/`. You may also bring a printed copy to Session 6.

Deadline:
Before Session 6.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Three packages with clear deliverables	3	Each package has a name, clear inclusions and a price
Prices are fair (in naira)	2	Not too low, not too high â€" fair for a beginner
Client Workflow Sheet completed	2	All six steps described clearly
Pricing philosophy	2	Thoughtful and honest
Consent and release forms prepared	1	Ready for use

Common mistakes to avoid:
pricing too low (devaluing your work); pricing too high (pricing yourself out); vague deliverables ("some photos" instead of "10 edited photos"); skipping the workflow steps; not preparing consent forms.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong submission contains:

- **Price list:** Three packages â€" Basic (5 photos, â‚¦15,000), Standard (10 photos, â‚¦30,000), Premium (20 photos, â‚¦60,000). Each with clear deliverables.

time), follow-up (photographer checks satisfaction).

- **Pricing philosophy:** "I believe photographers should charge fairly because our skill, time and equipment have value. My prices are fair because I researched the market and set prices that reflect my beginner level. As my skill grows, my prices will grow too."
- **Consent and release forms:** Prepared with the photographer's name and date, ready for signatures.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer.
What is a portfolio, and what are the three rules of a strong portfolio?

Q2. Multiple choice.
You are building a portfolio and you have 20 photos you like. How many should you include? a) All 20 â€" more is better b) 10 â€" a nice round number c) 5â€"8 â€" only the strongest, quality over quantity d) 3 â€" keep it very short

Q3. Explain in your own words.
What is the difference between a consent form and a model release?

Q4. Practical identification.
A classmate's portfolio has photos in random order â€" a product shot, then a portrait, then a landscape, then another product shot. What is the problem, and how would you fix it?

Q5. Matching.
Match each step of the client workflow to what happens: **brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.** a) The photographer delivers the final photos b) The client explains what they need c) The photographer checks that the client is happy d) The photographer provides a price e) The photographer takes the photos f) The photographer edits the photos

Q6. Scenario.
You are a beginner photographer. A client asks you to photograph 10 product photos. You are not sure what to charge. What are three things you should do to set a fair price?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1.
A portfolio is a curated collection of your best work, sequenced to tell a story. The three rules of a strong portfolio are: (1) Select ruthlessly â€" only Strong photos go in. (2) Sequence for flow â€" start strong, build gradually, end strong. (3) Show consistency â€" all photos should look like they belong together.

A2.
(c) 5â€"8 â€" only the strongest, quality over quantity. A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio.

A3.
A consent form is signed before the photo is taken â€" the person agrees to be photographed. A model release is signed before the image is used â€" the person agrees to let you use their image (for portfolio, client work or social media). Consent is for the shoot; the release is for the use.

A4.
The problem is lack of sequencing â€" the portfolio has no flow, no story. Fix: sequence the photos deliberately â€" start strong, build gradually, end strong, create contrast, keep it consistent. Arrange them to tell a story.

A5.
brief = (b); quote = (d); shoot = (e); edit = (f); deliver = (a); follow-up = (c).

A6.

beginner, charge less than an experienced photographer â€“ but do not work for free.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary.
Today you learned that a portfolio is not "all my best photos" â€” it is the right photos in the right order, telling the right story. You learned to select ruthlessly (only Strong photos), sequence for flow (start strong, build gradually, end strong) and show consistency (all photos belong together). You learned to build a portfolio in Canva â€” a clean template, a title, your photos and brief descriptions. You learned to price your work in packages â€” clear deliverables, fair prices in naira. You learned the client workflow â€” brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up. And you learned that consent and releases are not optional â€” they are the legal and ethical foundation of professional photography. You completed a timed simulation â€” planning, shooting, editing and presenting a delivery-ready set in 15 minutes.

Five important takeaways:

1. A portfolio is the right photos in the right order â€” select ruthlessly, sequence for flow, show consistency.
2. Build your portfolio in Canva â€” clean, professional, exported as a PDF.
3. Price your work in packages â€” clear deliverables, fair prices in naira, never work for free.
4. Follow the client workflow â€” brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.
5. Obtain consent and releases â€” before photographing and before using images.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I select my strongest photos and explain why they are strong?
- Can I sequence a portfolio so it tells a story?
- Can I build a portfolio page in Canva?
- Can I create a price list with three packages in naira?
- Can I describe the six steps of the client workflow?
- Can I explain the difference between consent and a release?
- Can I complete a timed simulation â€” plan, shoot, edit and present in 15 minutes?

Connection to the next session.
This is it â€” the capstone. Everything you have learned in Sessions 1â€“5 comes together in Session 6. You will take your chosen brief â€” a product set for Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices or a portrait set for Ms. Amaka â€” plan the shoot with a shot list, shoot it, select the strongest frames, edit the set consistently, assemble a mini portfolio and present it in a short talk. Peers and the instructor will give structured feedback. This is your proof of skill â€” the deliverable that earns your CEA Certificate in Photography.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner selects Strong photos and rejects Weak ones without hesitation.
- Learner sequences a portfolio with a clear story â€” start strong, end strong.
- Learner builds a clean, professional portfolio in Canva.
- Learner creates a price list with clear packages and fair prices in naira.
- Learner describes the client workflow accurately and completely.
- Learner obtains consent and releases before photographing and using images.
- Learner completes the timed simulation within the time limit.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "A portfolio should have as many photos as possible." â€” No â€“ quality over quantity. 5â€“8 Strong photos.

client's needs.

- "Consent is only needed for commercial work." â†' No â€" consent is needed before photographing any person, always.
- "Follow-up is optional." â†' No â€" follow-up builds relationships and generates referrals.
- "I do not need a price list â€" I will just negotiate." â†' No â€" a clear price list makes it easy for the client to say yes.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Selection drill:** Give the learner 20 photos and have them select the strongest 5. Review together â€" are they truly the strongest?
2. **Sequencing drill:** Give the learner 5 photos and have them sequence them for flow. Review â€" does it start strong and end strong?
3. **Pricing research:** Have the learner research three photographers in Port Harcourt and compare their prices. Discuss what is fair for a beginner.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a partially completed portfolio template in Canva with the photos already inserted â€" the learner adds descriptions and adjusts the layout. Provide a price list with the packages already named â€" the learner fills in the deliverables and prices.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full lecture, demonstration, guided practical, simulation and assignment.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to build a complete portfolio (not just one page) with a title page, an about page, a services page and a contact page. They should also create a second price list for a different type of photography (e.g., if they did products, they do portraits) and write a short marketing plan â€" how they will find their first three clients.

Timing guidance.

The priority is learners building a portfolio, creating a price list and completing the simulation (Sections H, I and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the lecture's pricing section to the key points â€" packages, fair prices, never free â€" and protect the practical and simulation time. A learner who leaves without a portfolio, a price list and a completed simulation has no business foundation for the capstone.

END OF SESSION 5

Next: Session 6 â€" Capstone: Photo Shoot and Portfolio.

SESSION 6 â€" CAPSTONE: PHOTO SHOOT AND PORTFOLIO

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" PHOTOGRAPHY

SESSION 6 â€" CAPSTONE: PHOTO SHOOT AND PORTFOLIO

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	6 of 6
Session title	Capstone: Photo Shoot and Portfolio
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: "Process and Deliver"
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (practical, capstone assessment)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"5 â€" the learner should have a foundations folder, an edited set, a portfolio page, a price list and a client workflow sheet. All shooting, editing, composition, lighting and business skills are assumed.
Connection to previous work	This is the final session and the capstone assessment. Everything learned in Sessions 1â€"5 comes together: the learner plans, shoots, edits, assembles and presents a themed photo set for a fictional Port Harcourt client. This is the deliverable that earns the CEA Certificate in Photography.
Preparation before class	The two fictional client briefs (Track A â€" Product: Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices; Track B â€" Portrait: Ms. Amaka) printed per learner; academy computers with Canva and internet access; the instructor's computer connected to the projector; printed capstone assessment rubrics; a timer for the presentation segment; consent forms for any person photographed; a simple product set (soup containers, spice jars, food items) or a portrait setup (a chair, a window, a plain background) depending on the learners' chosen tracks.

Instructor note on tone:
This session is a celebration and an assessment. The learners have worked hard for two weeks â€" today they prove what they can do. Create an atmosphere of pride and professionalism. The presentations should feel like a mini graduation â€" each learner stands, presents their work, and receives structured feedback. Be warm, be specific, be honest. The goal is for every learner to leave feeling like a photographer.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Take a brief** and translate it into a one-page brief and shot plan (client need, concept, shot list, light plan, location).
2. **Shoot a themed set** of at least 5 finished images (up to 8), applying all shooting skills: sharpness, composition, light, moment and consent.
3. **Select the strongest frames** honestly and edit the set consistently using the editing workflow.
4. **Assemble a mini portfolio** in Canva with a title page, the edited set, and a contact sheet of selects.

6. **Present and defend the work** in a short talk: the brief, light, compositions, edits, consent obtained and what they would do differently.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with a working camera.
- Academy computers with Canva and internet access.
- Instructor's computer connected to the projector.
- A phone tripod or improvised stand.
- A white card or reflector.
- A simple product set or portrait setup (depending on the learners' chosen tracks).

Software

- The phone's built-in camera app.
- Snapseed or Lightroom Mobile (for editing).
- Canva (free tier, for assembling the portfolio).

Accounts

- A free Canva account.

Sample files

- **The two fictional client briefs** (Track A and Track B) printed per learner.
- **The capstone assessment rubric** printed per learner (for peer feedback).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 6.1 â€" "Brief and Shot Plan" (a form: client need, concept, shot list, light plan, location).
- Worksheet 6.2 â€" "Presentation Notes" (a form: brief, light, compositions, edits, consent, what I would do differently).

Tools

- A timer for the presentation segment.
- A whiteboard and markers.

Internet

- Required for Canva. Not required for shooting or editing.

Alternative for learners who lack a capable phone

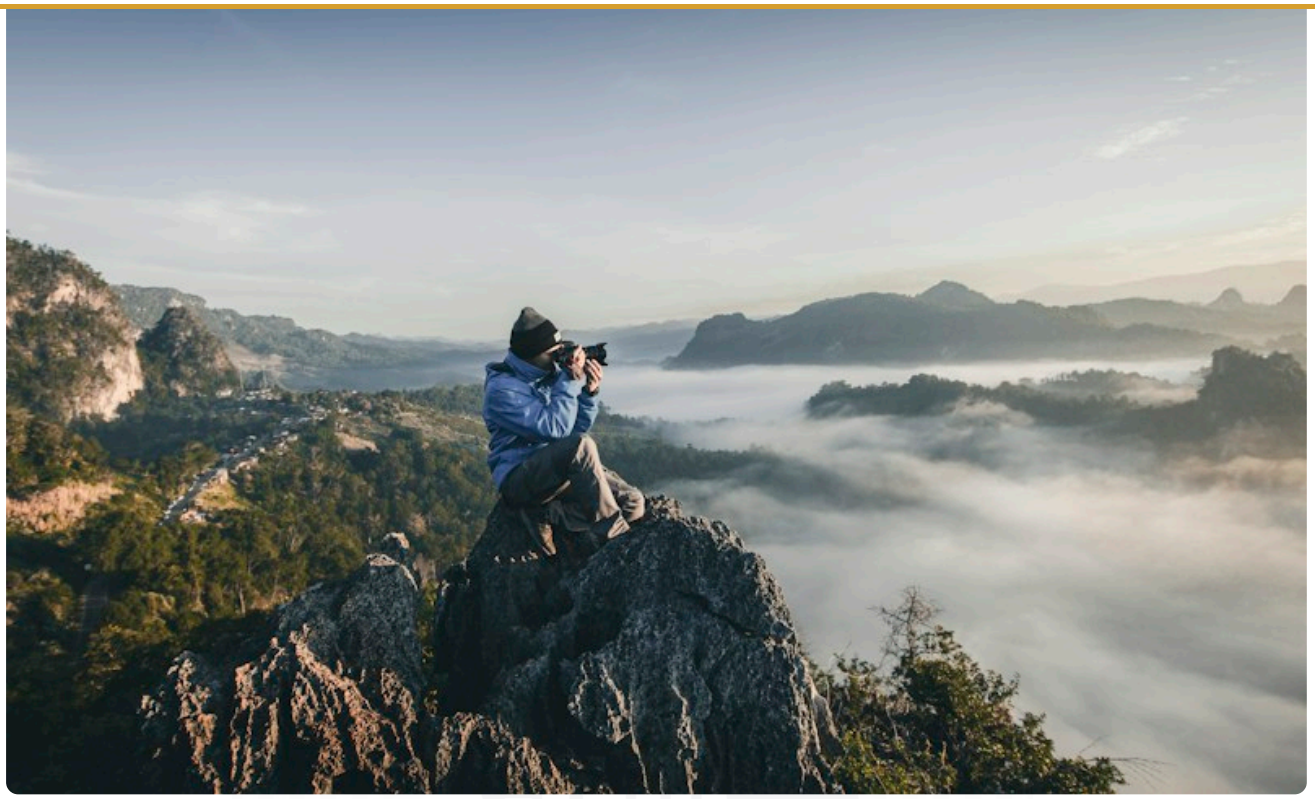
- Any phone with a working camera works. A learner without a phone may pair with a classmate, use an academy phone or use an academy computer with a webcam. They must tell the instructor at the start so support can be arranged.

Consent and safety note:
Before photographing any person â€" including classmates â€" ask for their permission first and have them sign the consent form. If someone says no, put the camera down. No exceptions. For the portrait track, the subject must be an adult, or if under 18, a parent/guardian must sign the consent form before the shutter is pressed.

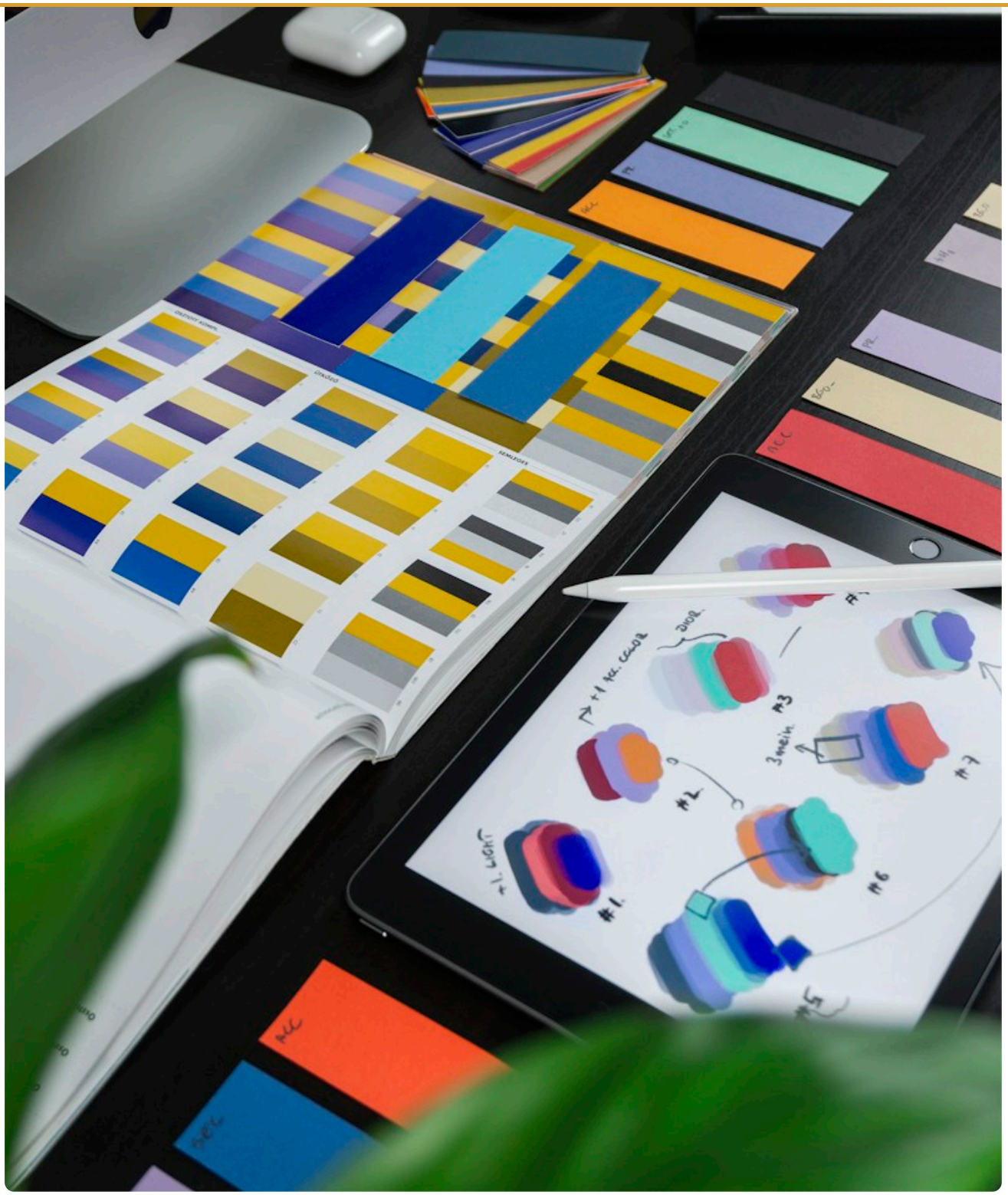
Suggested visuals:



- â€" the capstone shoot



- â€" applying composition and light



- â€" finishing the portfolio



- â€" the capstone shoot in progress



- â€" assembling the final portfolio

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup:

On the projector, show a single photograph â€" a strong, professional product shot or portrait. Do not explain it. Just show it.

What the instructor says:

details. Where is the light coming from? How is the subject composed? Is it sharp? What mood does it create? What would you do differently? You have two minutes to study it. Then we will discuss."

After two minutes, ask the class to call out what they notice.
Write their observations on the board. They should identify: light direction, composition (rule of thirds, framing, leading lines), sharpness, exposure, colour, mood, background, moment.

Then reveal the lesson:
Say clearly:

> *"Everything you just said â€" light, composition, sharpness, mood â€" that is what you have learned in five sessions. Today you prove it. This is your capstone: a themed photo shoot for a fictional Port Harcourt client. You will plan it, shoot it, edit it, assemble it and present it. This is not an exam â€" it is a demonstration of everything you can do. By the end of this session, you will have a mini portfolio and a presentation. That is your proof of skill â€" the deliverable that earns your CEA Certificate in Photography."*

Why this opener works:
It activates everything the learners have studied â€" light, composition, sharpness, mood â€" and frames the capstone as a demonstration of skill, not a test. It builds confidence before the work begins.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1:
"What are the five quality words for a good photograph?"

- Expected answer: Clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose.
- Common gap: Learners may forget one or two. Clarify: "Clarity = sharp. Light = correctly exposed. Composition = intentional arrangement. Moment = right instant. Purpose = does the job."

Question 2:
"What is the editing workflow? Name the steps in order."

- Expected answer: Crop and straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, retouch, sharpen.
- Common gap: Learners may forget the order. Clarify: "Crop first, then exposure, then colour, then retouch, then sharpen."

Question 3:
"What are the six steps of the client workflow?"

- Expected answer: Brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.
- Common gap: Learners may forget follow-up. Clarify: "Brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up. Follow-up is the most forgotten â€" but it is how you build relationships."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have all the skills. Today you use them all. The capstone is not about learning something new â€" it is about proving what you already know. Plan carefully, shoot deliberately, edit honestly, present confidently. This is your moment."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the five quality words or the editing workflow, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing them on the board before continuing.

F.1 The capstone â€” what it is and what it requires

The idea.
The capstone is the final project of the course â€” a themed photo shoot for a fictional Port Harcourt client, planned, shot, edited and presented as a mini portfolio. It is the deliverable that earns the CEA Certificate in Photography. It is not an exam â€” it is a demonstration of everything you have learned.

The two tracks (the learner chooses one):

Track A â€” Product: Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices

- Mama Nkechi is a fictional small food business in Port Harcourt.
- She needs a clean, appetising, consistent set of product images for her WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram.
- The products: pepper soup base, dried fish, spice mix, palm oil, and a bowl of finished soup.
- The style: clean, natural light, consistent look, honest editing.
- The deliverable: 5â€“8 edited product photos, assembled as a mini portfolio.

Track B â€” Portrait: Ms. Amaka

- Ms. Amaka is a fictional Port Harcourt entrepreneur.
- She needs a small set of professional, natural portraits for her business profile and social pages.
- She is an adult. For any real person under 18 photographed for practice instead, written parent/guardian consent is mandatory before the shutter is pressed.
- The style: natural light, clean background, genuine expression, honest editing.
- The deliverable: 5â€“8 edited portraits, assembled as a mini portfolio.

The required components of the capstone:

Component	What it is	Why it matters
1. Brief and shot plan	A one-page document: client need, concept, shot list, light plan, location	Shows you planned deliberately, not randomly
2. Themed set (5â€“8 images)	The finished photos, edited consistently	The core deliverable â€” the proof of skill
3. Contact sheet of selects	A grid of the raw selects before editing	Shows your selection process â€” you chose the strongest
4. Consent evidence	Signed consent for every identifiable person, or a note that no identifiable third parties appear	Legal and ethical requirement
5. Mini portfolio (Canva)	A PDF or grid with a title page (name, course, date, client)	Professional presentation
6. Presentation	A short talk defending the work	Shows you can explain your choices â€” the mark of a professional

What success looks like:

- The set is sharp, well-lit, honestly edited and clearly usable by the client.
- The images hang together as one body of work â€” consistent, cohesive, professional.
- Every consent requirement is met.
- The learner can explain every decision â€” where they stood, where the light came from, what they cropped, what they refused to fake.
- It need not be studio-perfect â€” only honest, complete, entry-level professional work.

Real-life comparison.

cooked, honestly prepared meal that shows you have learned the craft. The capstone is your meal. Cook it with care.

Misconception to correct.

"The capstone needs to be perfect." No. The capstone needs to be honest, complete and entry-level professional. It is not about perfection â€" it is about demonstrating that you can plan, shoot, edit, assemble and present a themed photo set. A learner who delivers an honest, complete set has passed â€" even if the photos are not magazine-cover quality.

F.2 The brief and shot plan â€" thinking before shooting

The idea.

The brief and shot plan is the foundation of the capstone. It is a one-page document that forces you to think before you shoot: What does the client need? What is the concept? What shots will I take? What light will I use? Where will I shoot? A clear plan means a clear delivery.

The brief and shot plan template:

```
BRIEF AND SHOT PLAN

Photographer: _____________________
Client: _____________________
Track: [ ] Product (Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices)
       [ ] Portrait (Ms. Amaka)
Date: _____________________

1. CLIENT NEED
What does the client need these photos for?
_____________________________________________
What is the purpose? (Catalogue, profile, social media?)
_____________________________________________

2. CONCEPT
What is the overall look and feel?
_____________________________________________
What style? (Clean, warm, natural, dramatic?)
_____________________________________________

3. SHOT LIST
What specific shots will I take?
1. _____________________________________________
2. _____________________________________________
3. _____________________________________________
4. _____________________________________________
5. _____________________________________________
6. _____________________________________________
7. _____________________________________________
8. _____________________________________________

4. LIGHT PLAN
Where will the light come from? (Window, open shade, golden hour?)
_____________________________________________
What time of day? _____________
Do I need a reflector? [ ] Yes [ ] No

5. LOCATION
Where will I shoot?
_____________________________________________
Do I need permission to shoot there? [ ] Yes [ ] No

6. CONSENT
Who will be photographed? _____________
Have they signed a consent form? [ ] Yes [ ] No
If under 18, has a parent/guardian signed? [ ] Yes [ ] No
```

- It shows the client (and the instructor) that you are professional â€” you do not just point and shoot.
- It gives you a checklist â€” you can tick off each shot as you complete it.
- It is the first component of the capstone â€ without it, the rest is incomplete.

Real-life comparison.
The brief and shot plan is like a building blueprint. A builder does not start laying bricks without a plan â€ the plan ensures the building is sound, the rooms are the right size, and nothing is missing. The brief and shot plan does the same for your photo shoot â€ it ensures the set is complete, the shots are deliberate, and nothing is forgotten.

Common mistake.
Skipping the plan and just shooting. This leads to missed shots, inconsistent style and a set that does not hang together. Always plan first.

F.3 Shooting the capstone set â€ applying everything

The idea.
The capstone shoot is where everything comes together. You apply all the skills you have learned: sharpness, composition, light, moment, consent. The goal is a set of 5â€"8 photos that are sharp, well-lit, well-composed, honestly edited and consistent.

The shooting checklist (use this for every shot):

- ☐ **Consent obtained** â€ signed form for every person photographed
- ☐ **Light checked** â€ direction, softness, colour
- ☐ **Background checked** â€ clean, uncluttered, appropriate
- ☐ **Composition planned** â€ rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry
- ☐ **Sharpness routine** â€ steady, focus, exposure, background, frames
- ☐ **Several frames taken** â€ at least 3 per shot
- ☐ **Focus checked** â€ zoom in to confirm sharpness
- ☐ **Moment captured** â€ the right expression, the right action

Shooting tips for the capstone:

1. **Start with the plan.** Review your shot list. Know what you are going to shoot before you start.
2. **Check the light first.** Before you position the subject or product, check the light. Is it soft? Is it flattering? Is it coming from the right direction?
3. **Build the scene.** For products: clean surface, plain background, product positioned at its best angle. For portraits: clean background, subject positioned in good light.
4. **Shoot the plan.** Work through your shot list systematically. Do not skip shots.
5. **Take more than you need.** If your plan says 5 shots, take 8. You can always edit down.
6. **Review as you go.** After each shot, check the photo. Is it sharp? Is it well-lit? Is the composition right? If not, adjust and retake.
7. **Stay honest.** Do not use filters. Do not fake anything. Shoot what is real.

Real-life comparison.
Shooting the capstone is like performing a piece of music you have practised. You know the notes, the rhythm, the dynamics. Now you perform it â€ not perfectly, but with skill and feeling. The performance is the proof of practice.

Common mistake.
Rushing through the shoot to get it over with. The capstone is not a race. Take your time. Check each shot. The quality of the shoot determines the quality of the portfolio.

F.4 Selecting and editing the set

where the editing workflow and batch editing skills come in.

The selection process:

1. Review all the raw photos from the shoot.
2. Rate each photo: Strong, Acceptable or Weak.
3. Select 5â€"8 Strong photos for the final set.
4. Create a contact sheet â€" a grid of the selected photos before editing. This shows your selection process.
5. Edit the selected photos using the workflow: crop, exposure, colour, retouch, sharpen.
6. Batch-edit for consistency â€" copy the edits from the first photo, paste to the others, review each one individually.
7. Export the final set as JPEG files.

The editing rules for the capstone:

- Edit honestly. Do not change the product's appearance. Do not fake a background. Do not reshape a body.
- Edit consistently. All photos in the set should look like they belong together.
- Edit to enhance, not to transform. The goal is a better version of reality, not a different reality.

Real-life comparison.
Selecting and editing is like editing a film. The director shoots hours of footage, then selects the best scenes and edits them into a coherent story. You do the same â€" you select the best frames and edit them into a cohesive set.

Common mistake.
Including a photo because you like the memory, not because it is strong. The capstone set should contain only Strong photos â€" no exceptions.

F.5 Assembling the mini portfolio in Canva

The idea.
The mini portfolio is the final presentation of the capstone â€" a professional document that shows the client (and the instructor) what you can do. It is assembled in Canva and exported as a PDF.

The mini portfolio structure:

Page	What it contains
Title page	Your name, course name, date, client name
The set	5â€"8 edited photos, sequenced for flow, with brief descriptions
Contact sheet	A grid of the raw selects before editing
Consent note	A statement that consent was obtained for all identifiable people, or that no identifiable third parties appear

How to assemble the mini portfolio in Canva:

1. Open Canva. Choose a clean, simple portfolio template.
2. **Title page:** Add your name, "CEA Photography â€" Capstone," the date, and the client name.
3. **The set:** Add your 5â€"8 edited photos in the sequenced order. Add a brief description under each photo.
4. **Contact sheet:** Add a grid of your raw selects (before editing). Label it "Contact Sheet â€" Selects."
5. **Consent note:** Add a page with a statement: "Consent was obtained for all identifiable people in this set. Signed consent forms are available on request." Or: "No identifiable third parties appear in this set."
6. **Review and export:** Check the layout, spacing and alignment. Export as a PDF.

Real-life comparison.
The mini portfolio is like a book. The title page is the cover. The set is the chapters. The contact sheet is the appendix. The consent note is the legal page. A good book is well-organised, easy to read and professionally presented. Your mini portfolio

Rushing the portfolio assembly. The portfolio is the client's first impression of your work â€” take the time to make it clean and professional.

F.6 The presentation â€” defending your work

The idea.
The presentation is the final component of the capstone â€” a short talk where you explain your work and defend your choices. This is where you show that you are not just a person who takes photos, but a professional who understands what they did and why.

The presentation structure (3â€“5 minutes per learner):

Section	What to say
1. The brief	Who is the client? What did they need? What was the purpose?
2. The plan	What was your concept? What shots did you plan? What light did you use?
3. The shoot	Where did you shoot? What challenges did you face? How did you handle them?
4. The edits	What did you change? Why? How did you keep it honest?
5. The consent	Who did you photograph? How did you obtain consent?
6. What I would do differently	What did you learn? What would you improve next time?

The presentation rules:

- Be honest. If something did not go well, say so. Honesty is a sign of professionalism.
- Be specific. Do not say "I took some photos." Say "I positioned the product near a window for soft, directional light and used the rule of thirds to place it on a grid intersection."
- Be confident. You have worked hard for two weeks. Own your work.
- Be open to feedback. The audience will give feedback â€” receive it gracefully.

Real-life comparison.
The presentation is like a job interview. You are not just showing your work â€” you are explaining your thinking, your process and your professionalism. The interviewer (the client, the instructor) is judging not just the photos, but the photographer â€” can you think, can you plan, can you explain, can you learn?

Common mistake.
Being vague. "I took some photos and edited them" is not a presentation. Be specific â€” explain every choice, every challenge, every decision.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- The capstone is a themed photo shoot for a fictional Port Harcourt client, planned, shot, edited and presented as a mini portfolio.
- Two tracks: Product (Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices) or Portrait (Ms. Amaka).
- Six required components: brief and shot plan, themed set (5â€“8 images), contact sheet, consent evidence, mini portfolio (Canva), presentation.
- Plan first â€” the brief and shot plan is the foundation.
- Shoot deliberately â€” apply all skills: sharpness, composition, light, moment, consent.
- Select and edit honestly â€” only Strong photos, consistent edits, no fakery.
- Assemble professionally â€” clean Canva portfolio, exported as PDF.
- Present confidently â€” explain every choice, be honest, be open to feedback.

```
flowchart LR
    A[Plan shoot] --> B[Shoot 30+ frames] --> C[Select best 5] --> D[Edit] --> E[Portfolio ready]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A completed brief and shot plan (for Track A or B).
- A set of raw photos from a sample shoot.
- A completed mini portfolio in Canva.
- A sample presentation.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” the brief and shot plan (3 minutes)

Say:
"This is my brief and shot plan for Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices. Watch how I think before I shoot."

Show the completed brief and shot plan. Walk through each section:

- Client need: "Mama Nkechi needs product photos for her WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram."
- Concept: "Clean, appetising, natural light, consistent look."
- Shot list: "Eight shots â€” hero shot, detail shots, context shots, variety shots."
- Light plan: "Window light, morning, reflector for fill."
- Location: "Her kitchen, near the window."
- Consent: "No people in the final set â€— products only."

Say:
"A plan is not paperwork â€— it is thinking. It forces you to make decisions before you shoot, so you do not waste time and miss shots."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€— selecting and editing (5 minutes)

Say:
"I have 20 raw photos from the shoot. Now I select the strongest and edit them consistently."

Step 1:
Show all 20 photos quickly. Rate each one. "This one is Strong â€— sharp, well-lit. This one is Weak â€— blurry. This one is Acceptable â€— slightly dark."

Step 2:
Select the strongest 6. "These are my six. Quality over quantity."

Step 3:
Create a contact sheet â€— a grid of the 6 selected photos before editing.

Step 4:
Edit the first photo using the workflow. "Crop, exposure, colour, retouch, sharpen."

Step 5:
Copy the edits, paste to the other five. Review each one. "This one needs a small exposure adjustment â€— the angle is different."

Step 6:
Show the final set. "Six photos, consistent style, honest edits. This is the set."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€— assembling the portfolio (4 minutes)

Step 1:
Open Canva. Choose a clean template.

Step 2:
Add the title page. "Chinedu Okafor â€" CEA Photography â€" Capstone â€" October 2026 â€" Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices."

Step 3:
Add the six edited photos in sequence. Add brief descriptions.

Step 4:
Add the contact sheet.

Step 5:
Add the consent note. "No identifiable third parties appear in this set."

Step 6:
Export as a PDF.

Say:
"The portfolio is the client's first impression. It should be clean, organised and professional."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" the presentation (3 minutes)

Say:
"Now I present my work. Watch how I explain my choices."

Give a 3-minute presentation following the structure:

- The brief: "Mama Nkechi needs product photos for her catalogue."
- The plan: "Clean, natural light, consistent look."
- The shoot: "I photographed in her kitchen, near the window, in the morning."
- The edits: "I cropped, corrected exposure, adjusted colour, batch-edited for consistency."
- The consent: "No people in the final set â€" products only."
- What I would do differently: "Next time I would use a tripod for even sharper shots and experiment with more angles."

Say:
"The presentation is not just showing photos â€" it is showing your thinking. Be specific, be honest, be confident."

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Why is the brief and shot plan important?" (It forces you to think before you shoot.)
- "Why select only Strong photos?" (A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio.)
- "Why batch-edit?" (For consistency â€" the set should look like it belongs together.)
- "Why is the presentation important?" (It shows you can explain your choices â€" the mark of a professional.)
- "What is the most important rule of the capstone?" (Be honest. Do not fake anything.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective:
With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner completes the brief and shot plan, shoots a themed set, selects and edits the photos, and assembles a mini portfolio.

Starting materials:
Learner's own phone; the chosen track brief; a product set or portrait setup; Canva on an academy computer or phone; the printed worksheets.

Procedure â€" Part 1: Brief and shot plan (4 minutes)

3. Review your plan with the instructor or a partner.

Procedure â€" Part 2: Shoot the set (8 minutes)

4. Set up your scene: products on a clean surface near a window, or a portrait subject in good light.
5. Obtain consent from any person photographed. Sign the consent form.
6. Work through your shot list. For each shot, use the shooting checklist.
7. Take at least 3 frames per shot. Review as you go.
8. Aim for 5â€"8 Strong photos.

Procedure â€" Part 3: Select and edit (4 minutes)

9. Review all raw photos. Rate each one: Strong, Acceptable or Weak.
10. Select 5â€"8 Strong photos. Create a contact sheet.
11. Edit the first photo using the workflow. Copy edits to the others. Review each one.
12. Export the final set as JPEG files.

Procedure â€" Part 4: Assemble the portfolio (2 minutes)

13. Open Canva. Choose a clean template.
14. Add the title page, the edited set, the contact sheet and the consent note.
15. Export as a PDF.

Expected result:
A completed brief and shot plan, a set of 5â€"8 edited photos, a contact sheet, a mini portfolio (PDF) and a completed consent form.

Points to pause and predict:

- After the plan: "Is your plan clear? Do you know what you are going to shoot?"
- After the shoot: "Do you have enough Strong photos? If not, shoot more."
- After editing: "Does your set look consistent? Are all edits honest?"
- After the portfolio: "Is your portfolio clean and professional?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner's plan is vague â†' Help them be specific. "What exact shots? What exact light?"
- Learner's photos are inconsistent â†' Check if they used the same light and background. Batch-edit for consistency.
- Learner's edits are dishonest â†' Remind them of the honest editing rules. "Enhance, do not deceive."
- Learner has not obtained consent â†' Stop. No consent, no photo.
- Learner's portfolio is incomplete â†' Help them prioritise. "Title page, set, consent note â€" the minimum."

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Brief and shot plan completed
- ☐ Consent obtained and documented
- ☐ 5â€"8 Strong photos shot
- ☐ Contact sheet created
- ☐ Set edited consistently and honestly
- ☐ Mini portfolio assembled in Canva and exported as PDF
- ☐ Presentation notes prepared

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task:

You have completed your shoot, edits and portfolio. Now you prepare your presentation and deliver it to the class.

Requirements:

1. **Prepare your presentation (5 minutes):** Use the Presentation Notes worksheet. Plan what you will say for each section: brief, plan, shoot, edits, consent, what I would do differently.
2. **Deliver your presentation (3â€“5 minutes per learner):** Stand, present your portfolio on the projector, and explain your choices. Be specific, be honest, be confident.
3. **Receive feedback (2 minutes per learner):** The audience (peers and instructor) gives structured feedback using the capstone assessment rubric.

Constraints:

- Your presentation must be 3â€“5 minutes. Not shorter, not longer.
- You must use the Presentation Notes worksheet â€” do not speak from memory alone.
- You must show your portfolio on the projector â€” the audience needs to see your work.
- You must be honest â€” if something did not go well, say so.

Time allowance:
15 minutes (for preparation and the first round of presentations).

Success criteria:

- Presentation is 3â€“5 minutes.
- All six sections are covered: brief, plan, shoot, edits, consent, what I would do differently.
- The portfolio is shown on the projector.
- The learner is specific, honest and confident.
- The learner receives and acknowledges feedback.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: Use your Presentation Notes worksheet as a guide â€” do not memorise, just refer to it.
- Hint 2: Be specific. Instead of "I took some photos," say "I positioned the product near a window for soft light."
- Hint 3: If you are nervous, remember â€” you have worked hard for two weeks. You know your work. Own it.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model presentation â€” do not show learners):

A strong presentation follows this structure:

- **Brief:** "My client is Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices. She needs product photos for her WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram."
- **Plan:** "My concept was clean, appetising, natural light. I planned eight shots â€” hero, detail, context and variety."
- **Shoot:** "I photographed in her kitchen, near the window, in the morning. The light was soft and directional. I used a white card to fill shadows."
- **Edits:** "I cropped, corrected exposure, adjusted colour and batch-edited for consistency. All edits are honest â€” I did not change the products' appearance."
- **Consent:** "No people in the final set â€” products only."
- **What I would do differently:** "Next time I would use a tripod for even sharper shots and experiment with more angles."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- All six sections covered (3)
- Specific and honest (3)
- Portfolio shown on projector (2)
- Confident delivery (2)

Situation.

Chinedu has just completed the CEA Photography course. He has his capstone portfolio â€" a set of product photos for Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices. He is ready to find his first paying client. He posts his portfolio on Instagram with the caption "Photographer available for bookings. DM for prices." After one week, he has had 15 likes but no enquiries.

Relevant facts.

- Chinedu's portfolio is strong â€" sharp, well-lit, consistent, professional.
- He has a price list â€" three packages in naira.
- He has a client workflow â€" brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.
- He has consent forms ready.
- But he does not know how to reach potential clients.

Decision point.

What should Chinedu do to find his first paying client?

Possible approaches.

1. Post more often on Instagram â€" consistency on social media is the key.
2. Reach out directly to small businesses in Port Harcourt â€" offer his services in person or by phone.
3. Lower his prices significantly â€" charge less than the competition to attract clients.

Recommended solution.

Approach 2. Chinedu's portfolio is strong â€" his problem is visibility, not quality. Posting more on Instagram may help eventually, but the fastest way to find a first client is to reach out directly. Small businesses in Port Harcourt â€" food vendors, tailors, salons, shops â€" need product photos. Chinedu can visit them, show his portfolio on his phone, and offer his services. A face-to-face conversation with a strong portfolio is more powerful than an Instagram post.

Specific steps for Chinedu:

1. Identify 10 small businesses in his area that need product photos.
2. Visit each one â€" introduce himself, show his portfolio on his phone, explain his packages.
3. Offer a fair price â€" his Basic package (5 photos for â‚¦15,000) is an easy entry point.
4. Follow up â€" if the business is not ready now, check back in a week.
5. Deliver excellently â€" his first client is his most important marketing tool. A happy client refers others.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (post more) is passive â€" it may work eventually, but it is slow and uncertain.
- Approach 2 (reach out directly) is active â€" it requires courage, but it is the fastest way to find a first client.
- Approach 3 (lower prices) is unnecessary â€" Chinedu's prices are already fair. Lowering them further devalues his work and sets an expectation that his skill is cheap.

Professional connection.

This case study illustrates the transition from student to professional. Chinedu has the skill â€" now he needs the client. The transition requires courage (reaching out), professionalism (a strong portfolio and clear pricing) and persistence (following up). The first client is the hardest â€" but once Chinedu delivers excellent work, the referrals will come.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live troubleshooting guide.

K.1 Skipping the brief and shot plan

Symptoms:

The learner starts shooting without a plan â€" no clear concept, no shot list, no light plan. **Likely cause:** The learner is eager to shoot and does not see the value of planning. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner: "What is your concept? What shots are you

prevent recurrence: Make the brief and shot plan the first step of every shoot. No plan, no shoot.

K.2 Inconsistent set â€” photos do not belong together

Symptoms:
The set of photos looks like they came from different shoots â€” different light, different background, different style. **Likely cause:** The learner did not use the same light and background for all photos, or did not batch-edit for consistency. **How to investigate:** Compare the photos side by side. Are the colours, brightness and style consistent? **Corrective steps:** Re-shoot using the same light and background. Batch-edit for consistency. Review each photo individually. **How to confirm resolved:** All photos in the set look like they belong together. **How to prevent recurrence:** For a themed set, use the same light, background and editing style throughout.

K.3 Dishonest edits â€” changing reality

Symptoms:
The edited photos show something that was not in the original â€” a replaced sky, a removed person, a reshaped body, a changed product. **Likely cause:** The learner used editing to deceive â€” to make the photo look like something it is not. **How to investigate:** Compare the edited photos to the originals. Are there elements that were not in the original? **Corrective steps:** Undo the dishonest edits. Edit honestly â€” enhance, do not deceive. **How to confirm resolved:** The edited photos are better versions of the originals, not different images. **How to prevent recurrence:** Follow the honest editing rules. If an edit would mislead the viewer, do not do it.

K.4 Missing consent

Symptoms:
The learner has photographed people without obtaining consent, or has not documented consent. **Likely cause:** The learner does not understand the consent requirement, or feels awkward asking. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner: "Did you ask permission before photographing that person? Do you have a signed consent form?" **Corrective steps:** Stop. Obtain consent. If the photo has already been taken, ask the subject now. If they say no, delete the photo. **How to confirm resolved:** Consent is obtained and documented for every person photographed. **How to prevent recurrence:** Make consent the first step of every portrait or event shoot. No consent, no photo.

K.5 Incomplete portfolio â€” missing components

Symptoms:
The mini portfolio is missing one or more required components â€” no title page, no contact sheet, no consent note. **Likely cause:** The learner ran out of time or did not understand the requirements. **How to investigate:** Check the portfolio against the six required components. Which are missing? **Corrective steps:** Add the missing components. Prioritise: title page, set, consent note â€” the minimum. **How to confirm resolved:** All six components are present. **How to prevent recurrence:** Use the portfolio checklist. Review before submitting.

K.6 Vague presentation â€” cannot explain choices

Symptoms:
The learner says "I took some photos and edited them" â€” no specifics, no explanation of choices. **Likely cause:** The learner did not prepare the presentation or does not understand the importance of explaining choices. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner: "Why did you choose that light? Why did you crop that way? What did you refuse to fake?" **Corrective steps:** Help the learner prepare. Use the Presentation Notes worksheet. Practice the presentation. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can explain every choice specifically and honestly. **How to prevent recurrence:** The presentation is a required component â€” prepare it as carefully as the photos.

K.7 Rushing the shoot â€” not enough Strong photos

Symptoms:
The learner has only 2â€“3 Strong photos â€” not enough for a 5â€–8 photo set. **Likely cause:** The learner rushed through the shoot, did not take enough frames, or did not review as they went. **How to investigate:** Count the Strong photos. If fewer than 5, the shoot was insufficient. **Corrective steps:** Re-shoot. Take more frames. Review as you go. Use the shooting checklist. **How**

Distinguish likely vs confirmed:
A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it â€” look at the actual photos, portfolio and presentation, and confirm the cause before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title:
"My Capstone Mini Portfolio and Presentation"

Purpose:
To complete the capstone â€” the themed photo shoot and mini portfolio that earns the CEA Certificate in Photography. This is the final deliverable of the course.

Realistic scenario.
You are a graduate of the CEA Photography course. Your capstone is your proof of skill â€” the portfolio you will show to potential clients, use to win work, and keep as the first item in your professional portfolio.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Complete the brief and shot plan** (Worksheet 6.1). Fill in every section.
2. **Shoot your themed set** â€” 5â€“8 photos for your chosen track (Product or Portrait). Use the shooting checklist. Obtain consent.
3. **Select and edit the set** â€” select the strongest photos, create a contact sheet, edit consistently and honestly.
4. **Assemble the mini portfolio in Canva** â€” title page, the set, contact sheet, consent note. Export as a PDF.
5. **Prepare your presentation** (Worksheet 6.2) â€” plan what you will say for each section.
6. **Deliver your presentation** â€” 3â€“5 minutes, specific, honest, confident.

Required deliverables:

- A completed brief and shot plan.
- A set of 5â€“8 edited photos (JPEG files).
- A contact sheet of selects.
- A mini portfolio (PDF) assembled in Canva.
- A completed consent form (or a note that no identifiable third parties appear).
- A completed Presentation Notes worksheet.

Submission format:
Share the portfolio PDF and the photo folder with the instructor (via WhatsApp, Google Drive or a USB stick). Deliver the presentation in class.

Deadline:
Before the end of Session 6.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Brief and shot plan completed	1	All sections filled in clearly
Themed set (5â€“8 images)	2	Sharp, well-lit, well-composed, consistent
Honest editing	2	No faked backgrounds, no changed products, no reshaped bodies
Mini portfolio assembled	2	Clean, professional, all components present
Consent documented	1	Signed forms or note that no third parties appear

Presentation	2	Specific, honest, confident, covers all six sections

Common mistakes to avoid:
skipping the plan; inconsistent set; dishonest edits; missing consent; incomplete portfolio; vague presentation.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong capstone contains:

- **Brief and shot plan:** Complete, specific, thoughtful. Clear concept, shot list, light plan, location, consent plan.
- **Themed set:** 5â€“8 photos, all Strong â€” sharp, well-lit, well-composed, consistent style, honest edits.
- **Contact sheet:** A grid of the raw selects before editing â€” shows the selection process.
- **Mini portfolio:** Clean Canva layout â€” title page, sequenced set with descriptions, contact sheet, consent note. Exported as PDF.
- **Consent:** Signed forms for all people photographed, or a clear note that no identifiable third parties appear.
- **Presentation:** 3â€“5 minutes, covers all six sections â€” brief, plan, shoot, edits, consent, what I would do differently. Specific, honest, confident.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer.
What is the capstone, and what are the six required components?

Q2. Multiple choice.
You are shooting your capstone product set. You have planned 8 shots but after shooting you only have 4 Strong photos. What should you do? a) Use the 4 Strong photos and fill the set with Acceptable photos. b) Re-shoot to get more Strong photos â€" the set needs 5â€“8 Strong images. c) Lower your standard â€" 4 photos is enough for a beginner. d) Use editing to make the Acceptable photos look Strong.

Q3. Explain in your own words.
Why is the brief and shot plan important? What happens if you skip it?

Q4. Practical identification.
A classmate's capstone portfolio has photos with different light, different backgrounds and different colour temperatures. What is the problem, and how would you fix it?

Q5. Matching.
Match each capstone component to what it is: **brief and shot plan, themed set, contact sheet, consent evidence, mini portfolio, presentation.** a) A short talk defending the work b) A one-page document: client need, concept, shot list, light plan c) A grid of the raw selects before editing d) Signed consent forms or a note that no third parties appear e) 5â€“8 edited photos, consistent style f) A PDF assembled in Canva with a title page

Q6. Scenario.
You are delivering your capstone presentation. You are nervous and not sure what to say. What are three things you can do to prepare and deliver a strong presentation?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q6)

A1.
The capstone is the final project of the course â€" a themed photo shoot for a fictional Port Harcourt client, planned, shot, edited and presented as a mini portfolio. The six required components are: (1) brief and shot plan, (2) themed set (5â€–8 images), (3) contact sheet of selects, (4) consent evidence, (5) mini portfolio in Canva, (6) presentation.

A2.

A3.

The brief and shot plan is important because it forces you to think before you shoot â€" what does the client need, what is the concept, what shots will you take, what light will you use. If you skip it, you waste time, miss shots, and produce an inconsistent set.

A4.

The problem is inconsistency â€" the photos do not look like they belong together. Fix: re-shoot using the same light and background for all photos. Batch-edit for consistency. Review each photo individually.

A5.

brief and shot plan = (b); themed set = (e); contact sheet = (c); consent evidence = (d); mini portfolio = (f); presentation = (a).

A6.

Three things: (1) Use the Presentation Notes worksheet â€" plan what you will say for each section. (2) Be specific â€" instead of "I took some photos," say "I positioned the product near a window for soft light." (3) Remember â€" you have worked hard for two weeks. You know your work. Own it. (Also acceptable: practice with a partner, take a deep breath before you start, focus on being honest rather than perfect.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary.

Today you completed your capstone â€" the final project of the CEA Photography course. You chose a track (Product or Portrait), planned your shoot with a brief and shot plan, shot a themed set of 5â€"8 photos, selected the strongest frames, edited them consistently and honestly, assembled a mini portfolio in Canva, and presented your work in a short talk. You applied everything you have learned in five sessions: sharpness, composition, light, moment, editing, pricing, client workflow, consent and presentation. This is your proof of skill â€" the deliverable that earns your CEA Certificate in Photography.

Five important takeaways:

1. The capstone is a complete photo job â€" planned, shot, edited, assembled and presented.
2. Plan first â€" the brief and shot plan is the foundation of a successful shoot.
3. Shoot deliberately â€" apply all skills: sharpness, composition, light, moment, consent.
4. Edit honestly â€" enhance, do not deceive. Consistency is key.
5. Present confidently â€" explain every choice, be honest, be open to feedback.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I plan a photo shoot with a clear brief and shot list?
- Can I shoot a themed set of 5â€"8 Strong photos?
- Can I select the strongest frames and edit them consistently and honestly?
- Can I assemble a professional mini portfolio in Canva?
- Can I obtain and document consent for every person I photograph?
- Can I present my work and explain my choices confidently?
- Can I describe the client workflow from brief to follow-up?
- Can I price my work fairly in naira?

Connection to the future.

You are now a graduate of the CEA Photography course. You have the skills to plan, shoot, edit, price and present professional-quality photographs. Your capstone portfolio is the first item in your professional portfolio â€" use it to win your first clients. Continue to practise, continue to learn, and continue to build your portfolio. "From Zero to Expert, Together" â€" you are no longer zero. You are an entry-level photographer with a foundation to build on. The journey continues.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

- Learner shoots a consistent set â€" same light, same background, same style.
- Learner selects only Strong photos and edits them honestly.
- Learner assembles a clean, professional mini portfolio in Canva.
- Learner obtains and documents consent for every person photographed.
- Learner presents confidently â€" explains every choice specifically and honestly.
- Learner receives feedback gracefully and responds thoughtfully.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "The capstone needs to be perfect." â†' No â€" it needs to be honest, complete and entry-level professional.
- "I can skip the plan and just shoot." â†' No â€" the plan is the foundation. No plan, no shoot.
- "I can fill the set with Acceptable photos." â†' No â€" only Strong photos. Quality over quantity.
- "I can fake edits to make the photos look better." â†' No â€" honest editing is non-negotiable.
- "Consent is not needed for the capstone." â†' No â€" consent is always required for identifiable people.
- "The presentation is just showing photos." â†' No â€" it is explaining your thinking. Be specific.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Plan review:** Have the learner complete the brief and shot plan, then review it together. Is it specific? Is it complete?
2. **Consistency check:** Have the learner shoot three photos of the same subject in the same light. Review â€" are they consistent?
3. **Presentation practice:** Have the learner practise the presentation with a partner. Give feedback on specificity and confidence.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a partially completed brief and shot plan â€" the learner fills in the shot list and light plan. Provide a shooting checklist with every step spelled out. Pair the learner with a confident learner for the shoot.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full lecture, demonstration, guided practical, presentation and assignment.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to shoot both tracks (Product and Portrait) and assemble two mini portfolios. They should also write a short marketing plan â€" how they will find their first three paying clients â€" and present it to the class.

Timing guidance.
The priority is learners completing the capstone â€" shooting, editing, assembling and presenting (Sections H, I and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the lecture's brief and shot plan section to the key points â€" client need, concept, shot list, light plan â€" and protect the practical and presentation time. A learner who leaves without a completed capstone has not earned the certificate.

END OF SESSION 6

Congratulations â€" you have completed the CEA Photography course. From Zero to Expert, Together.

PART 3

Learner Workbook

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY

LEARNER WORKBOOK

Cyber Elias Academy
24/26 Ebony Road, Port Harcourt, Rivers State, Nigeria *From Zero to Expert, Together*

Course:
Photography (Short Course) **Duration:** 2 weeks | **Sessions:** 6 | **Session length:** 105 minutes | **Fee:** ₦30,000

WELCOME TO THE COURSE

Photography is not about having the most expensive camera. It is about learning to

see
, **shoot**, **edit** and **deliver** photographs that are sharp, well-lit, well-composed and usable — for a small business, a church, an event, a personal brand or a first paying client.

This course starts with the phone in your pocket and the free apps you can download today. You will learn professional *habits* — observing light, composing with intention, focusing correctly, editing honestly, delivering professionally — that transfer to any camera later.

At the end of the course you will complete a

capstone project
: a themed photo shoot planned, shot, edited and presented as a mini portfolio for a fictional Port Harcourt client. This is the kind of work an entry-level photographer does: take a brief, plan a shoot, photograph the subject, edit the set, and deliver a professional portfolio.

Our motto — From Zero to Expert, Together.
"Zero" means no assumed knowledge of cameras, exposure or editing. "Together" means you will work in pairs and groups, model for each other and learn in a supportive, in-person classroom. "Expert" means a confident *entry-level photographer* who can complete a small photo job from brief to delivery — not a professional with a studio after two weeks.

HOW TO USE THIS WORKBOOK

This workbook is your companion for all six sessions. It contains, in plain English:

- Short **summaries** of the key ideas from every session, for quick revision.
- **Worked examples** you can copy and adapt.
- The **guided practical steps** the class will do together.
- **Independent exercise briefs** for solo practice.
- **Assignment briefs** (what to do, what to submit, when).
- **Checklists** so you never forget a step.
- **Self-reflection questions** for each session.
- A **portfolio checklist** and the **capstone requirements**.
- A **revision question bank** (questions only — no answers here; answers are discussed in class).
- A **glossary** of every photography term you meet.

it.

Two golden rules for the whole course:

1. **Ask first. Edit honestly. Claim only what you can do.** You ask permission before photographing any person. You edit to enhance, not to deceive. You never claim to be more experienced than you are.
2. **Practise with your hands.** Photography is a skill. Reading is not enough — do the practical each session and keep the checklists.

WHAT YOU WILL BE ABLE TO DO (LEARNING OUTCOMES LO1–LO8)

By the end of this course you will be able to:

- **LO1 — Explain photographic fundamentals.** Explain what makes a good photograph; describe the exposure triangle in simplified terms and diagnose an image as dark, bright, blurry or flat; explain phone vs dedicated camera; explain megapixels, focus and basic camera settings (S1).
- **LO2 — Control the camera for a sharp, correct exposure.** Set up a phone camera (grid, resolution, HDR, timer), tap to focus, lock focus and exposure, adjust brightness deliberately, and produce a correctly exposed sharp image without filters or beautification (S1).
- **LO3 — Compose with intention.** Apply the rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry and perspective to a live subject, and explain why one composition is stronger than another (S2).
- **LO4 — Use natural light well.** Identify and use golden hour, window light and open shade; position a subject to avoid harsh shadows and backlight; choose a time or spot that flatters the subject (S2).
- **LO5 — Photograph people, products and events.** Direct a simple portrait pose for a sharp, well-lit portrait; build a clean product scene for a usable listing image; work an event or simulated event to capture key moments sharply (S3).
- **LO6 — Edit photographs honestly and consistently.** Import and crop/straighten, correct exposure and colour, perform basic retouching and blemish removal, batch-edit a set for consistency, and state the limits of honest editing (S4).
- **LO7 — Build a portfolio, price work and work with clients.** Select the best images, assemble a cohesive mini portfolio, build a package price in naira, describe a client workflow from brief to delivery, and use consent and release forms correctly (S5).
- **LO8 — Deliver a complete themed photo job.** Take a brief, write a shot plan, shoot a themed set, edit it consistently, assemble it as a mini portfolio and present and defend the choices (S6).

Assessed skills you will prove:
practicals (15%), assignments (15%), knowledge checks (15%), a simulation (15%), the capstone portfolio (30%), a viva/demo (5%), and attendance (5%). **Pass mark 50% and you must also pass the capstone.** Grades: A = 80+, B = 65–79, C = 50–64, D = 40–49, F = below 40.

YOUR SAFETY AND ETHICS RULES (READ TWICE)

1. **Consent before every photograph of a person.** Ask first, every time. If someone says no, put the camera down — no argument, no exceptions. Class practice uses classmates who have agreed to participate.
2. **Parent or guardian consent for anyone under 18.** A signature from a parent or guardian is required before a person under 18 is photographed for practice, portfolio or client use. Without it, do not shoot.
3. **Respect public places and privacy.** In markets, churches, streets and events, be unobtrusive, follow the rules of the location, and never photograph people in private moments or in ways that could humiliate them.
4. **No misleading edits.** Do not change a product's true appearance, fake a background, reshape a body beyond normal correction, or edit in a way that lies to a client or viewer. Editing cleans up a photograph; it does not manufacture a false one.
5. **Honesty about skills and work.** Never claim to be more experienced than you are, never present stock or someone else's image as your own, and never promise results you cannot deliver. If unsure, say so and check with the instructor.

7. **Report, don't exploit.** If you take an image that harms or embarrasses someone, stop using it and tell the person or the instructor. Do not spread it.
8. **Consequences.** Breaking these rules is a serious breach of academy conduct and may end your participation in the course.

> ***Say it with us:***
> *Ask first. Edit honestly. Claim only what you can do.*

WEEK 1 — SEE AND SHOOT (Foundations)

Theme of the week: learn to control your camera, compose with intention and use light deliberately.

SESSION 1 — Photography Foundations

Plain-English objectives.
By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Explain in your own words what makes a good photograph, using five key words: clarity, light, composition, moment and purpose.
- Describe the exposure triangle in simplified terms — aperture, shutter speed and ISO — and explain why an image comes out dark, bright or blurry.
- Distinguish between a phone camera and a dedicated camera, explaining what each is good for and what megapixels actually tell you.
- Explain how focus works on a phone and demonstrate tap-to-focus, focus lock and focus check.
- Set up a phone camera sensibly: grid lines on, high resolution, HDR deliberate, beauty filters off.
- Produce a sharp, correctly exposed photograph of a real subject using tap-to-focus, exposure adjustment and a steady hold, without any filter or beautification.

Lesson summary (revise from here).

- A good photograph has five qualities: **clarity** (the subject is sharp), **light** (correctly exposed — not too dark, not too bright), **composition** (intentional arrangement), **moment** (the right instant) and **purpose** (does the job it was meant to do).
- The **exposure triangle** is three camera settings that control how bright or dark your photo is:
  - **Aperture** — how wide the lens opening is (like a window: a big window lets in more light).
  - **Shutter speed** — how long the shutter stays open (like blinking: a slow blink collects more light).
  - **ISO** — how sensitive the sensor is to light (like turning up the volume on a quiet radio).
- On a phone, you influence the exposure through **tap-to-focus** and the **exposure slider**. Tapping a dark area brightens the photo; tapping a bright area darkens it.
- A **phone camera** is always with you, costs nothing extra and is capable of excellent photographs. A **dedicated camera** (DSLR/mirrorless) has a bigger lens, a larger sensor and more manual control — but it is bulky and expensive (₦300,000–₦1,500,000+). The principles matter more than the price tag.
- **Megapixels** tell you how large you can print or how much you can crop — not how good the photo looks. A 12-megapixel photo from a good phone is more than enough for WhatsApp Business, Instagram and most small-business uses.
- **Focus** on a phone is automatic — but you control it deliberately:
  1. **Tap to focus** — tap the subject on the screen; a focus square appears.
  2. **Lock focus and exposure** — press and hold the focus square for 2–3 seconds (iPhone) or tap the lock icon (Android).
  3. **Focus check** — after taking the photo, zoom in on the subject. Is it sharp? If not, the photo is not usable.
- **Camera setup checklist** (run through this before every shoot):

- ☐ HDR is set appropriately (on for high contrast, off for movement)
- ☐ Beauty filters are OFF
- ☐ Lens is clean (wipe with a soft cloth)
- ☐ Storage has at least 500 MB free

- The **5-step sharpness routine** (use this every time you shoot):
  1. **Hold the phone steady** — both hands, elbows tucked, lean on a wall or rest on a surface.
  2. **Tap to focus** on the subject — wait half a second.
  3. **Check the exposure** — adjust the slider if needed.
  4. **Check the background** — remove distractions.
  5. **Take several frames** — at least 3 photos of the same scene.

Worked example — diagnosing an image (do this with the instructor).

#	What you see	Diagnosis	Why
1	A photo of a person against a bright window — the face is dark, almost invisible	Dark	The camera exposed for the bright window, not the person
2	A photo where the whole image looks smeared	Blurry (camera shake)	The photographer's hands moved during the exposure
3	A photo where the subject is blurry but the background is sharp	Blurry (focus error)	The camera focused on the background, not the subject
4	A photo that looks pale, colours faded, bright areas pure white	Bright (over-exposed)	Too much light reached the sensor

Guided practical (with the instructor).

1. The instructor shows the class the five quality words and the exposure triangle diagram. Write the five words on the cover of this workbook.
2. Together, open your camera app. Find and turn on **grid lines**. Set **resolution to the highest available**. Turn **off beauty filters**.
3. Choose a subject — a classmate (ask their permission first), your bag, a plant or any object.
4. Run the **5-step sharpness routine**: steady hold, tap to focus, check exposure, check background, take three frames.
5. **Focus check** — open each photo in your gallery and pinch to zoom in on the subject. Is it sharp? If not, repeat.
6. Repeat for a second subject and a third subject.

Independent exercise (do on your own).
Photograph the same subject in three different lighting situations: (1) near a window or in open shade, (2) in a dim corner or against a bright background, (3) in direct bright sun. For each photo, label it: is it **dark, bright, blurry or flat**? Write one sentence explaining why you think it came out that way.

Assignment 1 — due before Session 2.
Complete the **"Focus and Exposure Drills — My First Nine"** assignment:

1. Find **three different subjects** in your home or neighbourhood: one person (with their permission), one product (a shoe, a bag, a plate of food), and one scene (a street view, a garden, a room).
2. For each subject, use the **5-step sharpness routine** and take **at least three photos**.
3. Review all photos. Delete the blurry or poorly exposed ones. Keep only the sharp, correctly exposed ones.
4. From your keeps, select the **best three photos** (one per subject).
5. For each of the three, write one sentence: *"This photo is sharp and correctly exposed because I _____."*
6. Organise your nine photos in a folder named `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname`.

Submission checklist for Assignment 1:

- [ ] My name and the session number
- [ ] Every photo of a person has consent

Self-reflection.

1. What is one thing I learned today that I did not know this morning?
2. Before this session, did I ever tap to focus on my phone? What do I do differently now?
3. When is the last time I took a photo that came out blurry or dark? What would I do differently now?

SESSION 2 — Composition and Lighting

Plain-English objectives.
By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Apply the rule of thirds to a live subject, placing the subject on the grid intersection rather than dead centre, and explain why this is stronger.
- Use framing — shooting through a natural frame (a doorway, window, tree branches) to add depth and focus attention on the subject.
- Identify and use leading lines — paths, edges, walls, railings that draw the viewer's eye toward the subject.
- Recognise and use symmetry and perspective — balanced compositions for formal effect, and converging lines to create depth.
- Identify golden hour, window light and open shade as flattering natural light, and explain why harsh midday sun and backlight are unflattering.
- Produce a four-image composition series (one image per technique) and a four-image light study (same subject in four different lighting conditions), each image visibly demonstrating the named technique.

Lesson summary (revise from here).

- **Composition** is how you arrange everything inside the frame — the subject, the background, the empty space, the lines, the shapes. It is the difference between pointing a camera and *making* a photograph.
- **The four composition techniques:**
    1. **Rule of thirds** — do not put the subject in the centre. Place it on one of the four grid intersections (the "power points"). Leave space in the direction the subject is looking.
    2. **Framing** — use elements in the scene to create a frame within the frame: a doorway, window, tree branches, an archway. The frame draws the eye inward and adds depth.
    3. **Leading lines** — use lines in the scene (paths, roads, walls, railings, rivers, shadows) to lead the viewer's eye toward the subject. Check: do the lines lead to the subject, or somewhere else?
    4. **Symmetry and perspective** — symmetry means balance (both sides mirror each other); perspective means using depth and converging lines to create a three-dimensional feeling.
- **Light** is the raw material of photography. The three qualities of light:
    - **Direction** — where the light comes from (front, side, top, behind).
    - **Softness** — how spread out the light is (soft or hard).
    - **Colour** — the warmth or coolness of the light (warm, cool, neutral).
- **The four natural light conditions:**
    1. **Golden hour** — the hour after sunrise and the hour before sunset. Warm, golden, soft, directional light. The best light of the day. In Port Harcourt: roughly 6:00–7:00 AM and 5:30–6:30 PM.
    2. **Window light** — soft, directional light coming from one side. The easiest indoor light. Place the subject near the window, facing it or at a 45-degree angle.
    3. **Open shade** — soft, even, cool light in a shaded area. The safest outdoor light. Place the subject in the shade of a tree or building, with a bright, open area in front of them.

- **Backlight** — light coming from behind the subject, toward the camera. The subject becomes a silhouette. Fix: move the subject so the light comes from the front or side, or tap the subject and brighten the exposure.

Worked example — composition techniques (do this with the instructor).

Technique	What to do	What it looks like
Rule of thirds	Place the subject on a grid intersection, not dead centre	The subject is off-centre, with space around it
Framing	Shoot through a natural frame (doorway, window, branches)	The subject is surrounded by a natural border
Leading lines	Position yourself so lines lead toward the subject	Lines draw the eye from the foreground to the subject
Symmetry / perspective	Centre the subject for symmetry; use converging lines for depth	The photo feels balanced or immersive

Guided practical (with the instructor).

1. The instructor shows the four composition techniques on the projector. Together, identify each technique in the sample photos.
2. **Rule of thirds:** Find a subject. Turn on grid lines. Place the subject on one of the four grid intersections. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
3. **Framing:** Find a natural frame — a doorway, a window, a gap between two objects. Shoot through the frame. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
4. **Leading lines:** Find or create leading lines — the edge of a table, a row of books, a corridor. Position yourself so the lines lead to the subject. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
5. **Symmetry or perspective:** Find a symmetrical scene or a perspective scene. Compose for symmetry or depth. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
6. For each photo, write one line in your workbook: "*Technique:* _____. *What I did:* _____."

Independent exercise (do on your own).
Complete the **light study** — photograph the same subject in four different lighting conditions: (1) near a window, (2) in open shade, (3) in direct bright light, (4) with a bright background behind it (backlight). For each photo, label the light: is it **soft or hard**, **warm or cool**, **flattering or unflattering**? Write one sentence explaining what you see.

Assignment 2 — due before Session 3.
Complete the **"Composition and Light Series — My Eight"** assignment:

1. Find **one subject** that can stay still for several photos: a bottle, a cup, a bag, a plant, or a classmate who has agreed.
2. **Composition series (4 photos):** Photograph the subject using each of the four techniques: rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry or perspective.
3. **Light study (4 photos):** Photograph the same subject in four different lighting conditions: near a window, in open shade, in direct bright light, with a bright background behind it.
4. For each of the eight photos, write one sentence: "*Technique/Light:* _____. *What I did:* _____."
5. Organise all eight photos in your `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname` folder in a subfolder named `Week1-Composition-Light`.

Submission checklist for Assignment 2:

- ☐ Eight photos (four composition, four light study)
- ☐ Eight written sentences (one per photo)
- ☐ My name and the session number
- ☐ Every photo of a person has consent

2. Before this session, did I ever think about where the light was coming from? What do I do differently now?
3. Can I name the four natural light conditions? Which one is my favourite to shoot in?

SESSION 3 — Shooting People, Products and Events

Plain-English objectives.
By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Put a subject at ease before photographing them, using simple communication and direction.
- Direct a simple portrait pose — position the subject's body, hands and face for a natural, flattering result.
- Produce a sharp, well-lit portrait using natural light, the rule of thirds and the 5-step sharpness routine.
- Build a clean product scene — choose a surface, manage the background, control reflections and light the product flatteringly.
- Produce a usable product image suitable for a WhatsApp Business catalogue or Jiji listing.
- Work a simulated event — capture key moments sharply, adapt to changing light and stay unobtrusive.
- Confirm consent for every person photographed, using a printed consent form.

Lesson summary (revise from here).

- A good **portrait** has three elements:
    1. **Light** — soft, directional light on the face (window light or open shade). Never harsh midday sun. Never backlight.
    2. **Pose** — turn the body slightly (30–45 degrees), give the hands something to do, angle the face toward the light.
    3. **Expression** — talk to the subject, make them laugh, capture a genuine moment. Take many frames — the best expression is often between poses.
- **Putting the subject at ease** (the most important portrait skill):
    1. Introduce yourself. Tell the person your name and what you are doing.
    2. Explain what you need. "I'm going to ask you to stand near this window and just be yourself."
    3. Give direction, not orders. "Why don't you lean against the wall and look out the window for a moment?"
    4. Talk while you shoot. Ask about their day, their work, their family.
    5. Show them the result. "Look — that one is beautiful."
- A good **product photo** has four elements:
    1. **Surface** — a clean, plain surface (white bedsheet, wooden table, cardboard).
    2. **Background** — a plain, uncluttered background (wall, sheet hung up, blurred background).
    3. **Light** — soft, even light (window light or open shade). Use a white card to fill shadows.
    4. **Angle** — eye level or slightly above. Show the product's best side. For food, shoot from above (flat lay) or at 45 degrees.
- **Building a product scene — step by step:**
    1. Choose the surface — clean, plain, uncluttered.
    2. Set the background — plain, complementary to the product.
    3. Position the product — clean it, arrange it at its best angle.
    4. Set the light — near a window or in open shade. Use a white card to fill shadows.
    5. Compose the photo — rule of thirds, 5-step sharpness routine, take several frames.
- **Event photography** has three challenges:
    1. **Changing light** — check the light constantly, adjust exposure as you move.
    2. **Moving subjects** — use the 5-step sharpness routine, take many frames, anticipate what will happen next.
    3. **Staying unobtrusive** — do not block people's view, do not use flash unless necessary, be respectful.

2. The greeting — people arriving, shaking hands, hugging.
3. The main action — cutting the cake, handing over a gift, the speech.
4. The emotion — laughter, tears, surprise, joy.
5. The detail — decorations, food, flowers, the dress, invitations.

- **Consent is mandatory.** Ask first. Get parent/guardian consent for under-18s. Use a consent form. Respect people's wishes.

Worked example — the portrait checklist (use this every time you photograph a person).

Element	What to check	Tick
Light	Soft, directional light on the face? No harsh shadows?	[ ]
Pose	Body turned slightly? Hands doing something?	[ ]
Expression	Genuine emotion? Not a forced smile?	[ ]
Background	Clean, uncluttered? Nothing growing out of the head?	[ ]
Focus	Sharp on the eyes?	[ ]
Consent	Permission obtained? Form signed?	[ ]

Guided practical (with the instructor).

1. **Portrait:** Ask a classmate to be your subject. Have them sign the consent form. Position them near a window or in open shade. Direct the pose: turn the body slightly, give the hands something to do, angle the face toward the light. Talk to your subject. Take at least five photos. Review and pick the strongest.
2. **Product:** Choose a product — your bag, a bottle, a book, a shoe. Build the scene: clean surface, plain background, product at its best angle. Set the light: near a window or in open shade. Use a white card to fill shadows. Compose using the rule of thirds. Take at least five photos. Review and pick the strongest.
3. **Event:** Work in pairs. One person performs a simple action (pouring a drink, opening a book, handing over an item). The other is the photographer. Position yourself, check the light, anticipate the action. Take at least five photos in quick succession. Review and pick the strongest. Swap roles and repeat.

Independent exercise (do on your own).
Complete the **foundations folder** — a 12-image set covering composition, light and subjects:

1. Review all the photos you have taken so far in the course.
2. Select and organise **12 images** into three groups:
   - **4 composition images** — one for each technique.
   - **4 light study images** — the same subject in four different lighting conditions.
   - **4 subject images** — one portrait, one product, one event, and one additional image of your choice.
3. For each image, write one sentence: "*This image shows _____ because _____.*"
4. Ensure every image of a person has a signed consent form.
5. Organise all 12 images in your `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname` folder in a subfolder named `Foundations-Folder`.

Assignment 3 — due before Session 4.
Complete the **"My Foundations Folder — 12 Images"** assignment (described above). Also write a short reflection (3–5 sentences): "*The strongest image in my folder is _____ because _____. The image I am least happy with is _____ because _____. Next time I would _____.*"

Submission checklist for Assignment 3:

- [ ] 12 images organised into three groups of four
- [ ] 12 written descriptions (one per image)
- [ ] Signed consent forms for all people photographed

Self-reflection.

1. Which of the three subjects (people, products, events) was easiest for me? Which was hardest? Why?
2. Before this session, did I ever ask someone's permission before photographing them? What do I do differently now?
3. Can I name the five key moments to capture at any event?

WEEK 2 — PROCESS AND DELIVER

Theme of the week: turn raw shots into a set a client would pay for — and learn to charge fairly for it.

SESSION 4 — Basic Photo Editing

Plain-English objectives.
By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Import and organise photos into a working folder for editing.
- Crop and straighten a photo to improve composition and remove distractions.
- Correct exposure — brighten dark photos, recover highlights, and balance the overall brightness.
- Adjust colour temperature and saturation — make colours natural and appealing, not artificial.
- Perform basic retouching and blemish removal — clean up small distractions without destroying natural skin texture.
- Batch-edit a set of photos so they have a consistent look — matching white balance, contrast and colour.
- State clearly what editing can fix, what it cannot fix, and what must never be faked.

Lesson summary (revise from here).

- **Editing** is the second half of photography. A raw photo is like a rough draft — it has potential, but it needs work. Editing fixes small problems and makes the photo look professional.
- **The CEA Editing Workflow** (follow this order every time):
    1. **Crop and straighten** — remove distractions, fix tilted lines. Do this first.
    2. **Correct exposure** — adjust brightness, highlights and shadows. Do this after cropping.
    3. **Adjust colour** — set white balance (warmth/coolness), adjust saturation (colour intensity). Do this after exposure.
    4. **Retouch** — remove blemishes, dust spots, small distractions. Do this last.
    5. **Sharpen (optional)** — enhance detail slightly. Do this last.
- **What editing can fix:** cropping, straightening, exposure, colour, small distractions, slight sharpening.
- **What editing cannot fix:** a blurry subject, poor composition, bad light, a missed moment.
- **What editing must never do (the honest editing rules):**
    - Do not change a product's true appearance.
    - Do not fake a background.
    - Do not reshape a body beyond normal correction.
    - Do not mislead the viewer.
- **Batch editing** means applying the same edits to multiple photos so they look consistent. Copy the edits from the first photo, paste to the others, then review each one individually and make small adjustments.

Worked example — the editing workflow in Snapseed (do this with the instructor).

Step	What you do	Why
1. Crop and straighten	Tools > Crop. Remove distractions, fix tilted lines.	Do this first — once you crop, you see the final composition

2. Correct exposure	Tools > Tune Image. Adjust Brightness, Highlights, Shadows.	Do this after cropping — the exposure needs may differ
3. Adjust colour	Tools > White Balance (temperature), Tune Image > Saturation.	Do this after exposure — colour looks different at different brightness
4. Retouch	Tools > Healing. Zoom in, tap the blemish.	Do this last — you want to see the final exposure and colour first
5. Review	Compare before and after. Does it look like a better version of reality?	If it looks fake, reduce the adjustments

Guided practical (with the instructor).

1. Open Snapseed on your phone. Import a raw photo from your foundations folder.
2. **Crop and straighten:** Remove distractions, fix tilted lines. Tap the checkmark.
3. **Correct exposure:** Adjust brightness, highlights and shadows. Tap the checkmark.
4. **Adjust colour:** Set white balance, adjust saturation. Tap the checkmark.
5. **Retouch:** Remove one blemish or distraction using the Healing tool. Tap the checkmark.
6. **Review:** Compare the before and after. Write one sentence: *"I changed _____ because _____."*
7. **Save:** Export the edited photo to your gallery.
8. **Batch editing:** Choose three photos from your foundations folder. Edit the first photo. Tap the Stack icon > Copy edits. Open the second photo. Tap the Stack icon > Paste edits. Review and adjust. Repeat for the third photo. Compare all three — do they look like a set?

Independent exercise (do on your own).
Edit a set of five photos for a fictional client — Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices. Edit all five photos using the full workflow. Batch-edit the set so all five photos have a consistent look. For each photo, write one sentence: *"I changed _____ because _____."* Ensure all edits are honest. Save all five edited photos in a folder named `MamaNkechi-Edited`.

Assignment 4 — due before Session 5.
Complete the **"Edit a Set, Not a Single — My Five-Image Edited Set"** assignment:

1. Choose five photos from your foundations folder — they should be of the same subject or from the same shoot.
2. Edit the first photo using the full workflow: crop and straighten, correct exposure, adjust colour, retouch.
3. Copy the edits from the first photo and paste them to the other four.
4. Review each photo individually. Make small adjustments as needed.
5. For each photo, write one sentence: *"I changed _____ because _____."*
6. Ensure all edits are honest — do not change the subject's appearance, do not fake backgrounds, do not mislead the viewer.
7. Save all five edited photos in a folder named `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname/Edited-Set`.
8. Write a short reflection (3–5 sentences): *"The edit I am most proud of is _____ because _____. The hardest part of editing was _____. Next time I would _____."*

Submission checklist for Assignment 4:

- ☐ Five edited photos
- ☐ An Edit Decision Log with five entries
- ☐ A short written reflection
- ☐ All edits are honest
- ☐ My name and the session number

Self-reflection.

1. What is the hardest part of the editing workflow for me? Why?
2. Before this session, did I ever edit my photos? What do I do differently now?
3. Can I explain the difference between honest editing and dishonest editing? Give one example of each.

Plain-English objectives.

By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Select the strongest images from your body of work, using clear quality criteria.
- Sequence a portfolio so it flows as a cohesive set — not just a collection of individual photos.
- Assemble a first portfolio page in Canva, with a title, images and brief descriptions.
- Build a package price list in naira with at least three packages, each with clear deliverables.
- Describe a client workflow from brief to delivery: brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up.
- Use consent and release forms correctly, including parent/guardian consent for under-18s.
- Complete a timed simulation — plan, shoot, edit and present a delivery-ready set from a short client brief.

Lesson summary (revise from here).

- A **portfolio** is a curated collection of your best work, presented in a way that shows your skill, your style and your professionalism. It is not a dump of every photo you have ever taken.
- **The three rules of a strong portfolio:**
  1. **Select ruthlessly** — include only your strongest images. A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio.
  2. **Sequence for flow** — arrange the photos so they tell a story. Start strong, build gradually, end strong, keep it consistent.
  3. **Show consistency** — the photos should look like they belong together.
- **The selection criteria** (rate each photo Strong, Acceptable or Weak):
  - **Sharpness** — is the subject sharp?
  - **Exposure** — is the photo correctly exposed?
  - **Composition** — is the composition intentional?
  - **Light** — is the light flattering?
  - **Moment** — does the photo capture the right instant?
  - **Honesty** — is the photo honestly edited?
- **Pricing your photography:**
  - **Per hour** — charge for the time you spend shooting (good for events).
  - **Per package** — charge a fixed price for a defined set of deliverables (good for portraits and products).
  - **Three sample packages for a product photographer in Port Harcourt:**
    - **Basic** — 5 edited product photos, 1 background option, 3-day delivery — ₦15,000
    - **Standard** — 10 edited product photos, 2 background options, 2-day delivery, 1 revision round — ₦30,000
    - **Premium** — 20 edited product photos, 3 background options, 1-day delivery, 2 revision rounds, social media captions — ₦60,000
  - **Three sample packages for a portrait photographer in Port Harcourt:**
    - **Basic** — 30-minute shoot, 5 edited photos, 1 location, 3-day delivery — ₦10,000
    - **Standard** — 1-hour shoot, 10 edited photos, 2 locations, 2-day delivery, 1 revision round — ₦25,000
    - **Premium** — 2-hour shoot, 20 edited photos, 3 locations, 1-day delivery, 2 revision rounds, printed photos — ₦50,000
- **The six-step client workflow:**
  1. **Brief** — the client explains what they need.
  2. **Quote** — the photographer provides a price.
  3. **Shoot** — the photographer plans and executes the shoot.
  4. **Edit** — the photographer edits the photos.
  5. **Deliver** — the photographer delivers the final photos.

- **Consent form** — the person agrees to be photographed (before you take the photo).
- **Model release** — the person agrees to let you use their image (before you use the image).
- For under-18s, a parent or guardian must sign.

Worked example — the portfolio selection sheet (do this with the instructor).

#	Image	Sharp?	Exposed?	Composed?	Well-lit?	Right moment?	Honest?	Rating
1	Product shot — hero	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Strong
2	Product shot — detail	Yes	Slightly dark	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Acceptable
3	Product shot — context	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Strong
4	Portrait — establishing	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Strong
5	Portrait — emotion	Slightly blurry	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Weak

Guided practical (with the instructor).

1. **Selection and sequencing:** Gather all your photos from the course. Review each photo against the six criteria. Rate each photo: Strong, Acceptable or Weak. Select 5–8 Strong photos. Sequence them: start strong, build gradually, end strong, keep it consistent.
2. **Building the portfolio in Canva:** Open Canva. Search for a portfolio template. Choose a clean, simple one. Add a title: your name, course name, date. Add your selected photos in the sequenced order. Add a brief description under each photo. Review and adjust the layout. Export as a PDF.
3. **Price list and workflow:** Create a price list with at least three packages. Set fair prices in naira. Complete the Client Workflow Sheet — the six steps from brief to follow-up. Write one sentence: *"My pricing philosophy is _____."*

Independent exercise (do on your own).
Complete a **timed simulation** — plan, shoot, edit and present a delivery-ready set from a short client brief:

- **Client:** Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices
- **Purpose:** WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram
- **Subject:** Five products — pepper soup base, dried fish, spice mix, palm oil, and a bowl of finished soup
- **Style:** Clean, appetising, natural light, consistent look
- **Deliverables:** Five edited photos, consistent style, delivered as JPEG files
- **Deadline:** 15 minutes from now

Assignment 5 — due before Session 6.
Complete the **"My Price List and Client Workflow Sheet"** assignment:

1. **Create a price list** with at least three packages. For each package, state: package name, what is included, price in naira.
2. **Set fair prices.** Research what other photographers in Port Harcourt charge. As a beginner, charge less than an experienced photographer — but do not work for free.
3. **Complete the Client Workflow Sheet.** For each of the six steps, state: what happens, who is responsible, what the client should expect.
4. **Write a short pricing philosophy** (3–5 sentences): *"I believe photographers should charge fairly because _____. My prices are fair because _____. As my skill grows, my prices will _____."*
5. **Prepare a consent form and a model release.** Use the printed templates. Fill in your name and the date.

- [ ] A completed Client Workflow Sheet
- [ ] A short pricing philosophy
- [ ] A prepared consent form and model release
- [ ] My name and the session number

Self-reflection.

1. How many photos did I rate Strong? Was it hard to leave out the Acceptable ones? Why?
2. What is my pricing philosophy? Do I believe my skill has value?
3. Before this session, did I ever think about a client workflow? What do I do differently now?

SESSION 6 — Capstone: Photo Shoot and Portfolio

Plain-English objectives.
By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Take a brief and translate it into a one-page brief and shot plan (client need, concept, shot list, light plan, location).
- Shoot a themed set of at least 5 finished images (up to 8), applying all shooting skills: sharpness, composition, light, moment and consent.
- Select the strongest frames honestly and edit the set consistently using the editing workflow.
- Assemble a mini portfolio in Canva with a title page, the edited set, and a contact sheet of selects.
- Obtain and document consent — signed consent for every identifiable person in the final set (parent/guardian for under-18s), or a note that no identifiable third parties appear.
- Present and defend the work in a short talk: the brief, light, compositions, edits, consent obtained and what they would do differently.

Lesson summary (revise from here).

- The **capstone** is the final project of the course — a themed photo shoot for a fictional Port Harcourt client, planned, shot, edited and presented as a mini portfolio. It is the deliverable that earns the CEA Certificate in Photography.
- **The two tracks (you choose one):**
  - **Track A — Product: Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices.** A fictional small food business in Port Harcourt. She needs a clean, appetising, consistent set of product images for her WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram. Products: pepper soup base, dried fish, spice mix, palm oil, and a bowl of finished soup.
  - **Track B — Portrait: Ms. Amaka.** A fictional Port Harcourt entrepreneur. She needs a small set of professional, natural portraits for her business profile and social pages. She is an adult. For any real person under 18 photographed for practice instead, written parent/guardian consent is mandatory.
- **The six required components of the capstone:**
  1. **Brief and shot plan** — a one-page document: client need, concept, shot list, light plan, location.
  2. **Themed set (5–8 images)** — the finished photos, edited consistently.
  3. **Contact sheet of selects** — a grid of the raw selects before editing.
  4. **Consent evidence** — signed consent for every identifiable person, or a note that no identifiable third parties appear.
  5. **Mini portfolio (Canva)** — a PDF or grid with a title page (name, course, date, client).
  6. **Presentation** — a short talk defending the work.
- **The presentation structure (3–5 minutes):**
  1. The brief — who is the client? What did they need?
  2. The plan — what was your concept? What shots did you plan?
  3. The shoot — where did you shoot? What challenges did you face?
  4. The edits — what did you change? Why? How did you keep it honest?

Worked example — the brief and shot plan (do this with the instructor).

```
BRIEF AND SHOT PLAN

Photographer: _____________________
Client: _____________________
Track: [ ] Product (Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices)
       [ ] Portrait (Ms. Amaka)
Date: _____________________

1. CLIENT NEED
What does the client need these photos for?
_____________________________________________
What is the purpose? (Catalogue, profile, social media?)
_____________________________________________

2. CONCEPT
What is the overall look and feel?
_____________________________________________
What style? (Clean, warm, natural, dramatic?)
_____________________________________________

3. SHOT LIST
What specific shots will I take?
1. _____________________________________________
2. _____________________________________________
3. _____________________________________________
4. _____________________________________________
5. _____________________________________________
6. _____________________________________________
7. _____________________________________________
8. _____________________________________________

4. LIGHT PLAN
Where will the light come from? (Window, open shade, golden hour?)
_____________________________________________
What time of day? _____________
Do I need a reflector? [ ] Yes [ ] No

5. LOCATION
Where will I shoot?
_____________________________________________
Do I need permission to shoot there? [ ] Yes [ ] No

6. CONSENT
Who will be photographed? _____________
Have they signed a consent form? [ ] Yes [ ] No
If under 18, has a parent/guardian signed? [ ] Yes [ ] No
```

Guided practical (with the instructor).

1. **Brief and shot plan (4 minutes):** Choose your track. Complete the Brief and Shot Plan worksheet. Fill in every section. Review your plan with the instructor or a partner.
2. **Shoot the set (8 minutes):** Set up your scene. Obtain consent from any person photographed. Work through your shot list. For each shot, use the shooting checklist. Take at least 3 frames per shot. Review as you go. Aim for 5–8 Strong photos.
3. **Select and edit (4 minutes):** Review all raw photos. Rate each one: Strong, Acceptable or Weak. Select 5–8 Strong photos. Create a contact sheet. Edit the first photo using the workflow. Copy edits to the others. Review each one. Export the final set as JPEG files.
4. **Assemble the portfolio (2 minutes):** Open Canva. Choose a clean template. Add the title page, the edited set, the contact sheet and the consent note. Export as a PDF.

Independent exercise (do on your own).

2. **Deliver your presentation (3–5 minutes):** Stand, present your portfolio on the projector, and explain your choices. Be specific, be honest, be confident.
3. **Receive feedback (2 minutes):** The audience gives structured feedback.

Assignment 6 — due before the end of Session 6.
Complete the **"My Capstone Mini Portfolio and Presentation"** assignment:

1. Complete the brief and shot plan.
2. Shoot your themed set — 5–8 photos for your chosen track.
3. Select and edit the set — select the strongest photos, create a contact sheet, edit consistently and honestly.
4. Assemble the mini portfolio in Canva — title page, the set, contact sheet, consent note. Export as a PDF.
5. Prepare your presentation — plan what you will say for each section.
6. Deliver your presentation — 3–5 minutes, specific, honest, confident.

Submission checklist for Assignment 6:

- ☐ A completed brief and shot plan
- ☐ A set of 5–8 edited photos (JPEG files)
- ☐ A contact sheet of selects
- ☐ A mini portfolio (PDF) assembled in Canva
- ☐ A completed consent form (or a note that no identifiable third parties appear)
- ☐ A completed Presentation Notes worksheet
- ☐ My name and the session number

Self-reflection.

1. What am I most proud of in my capstone portfolio? Why?
2. What was the hardest part of the capstone? How did I handle it?
3. What have I learned about myself as a photographer in these two weeks?

REVISION QUESTION BANK

(Questions only — answers are discussed in class. Do not look for answers here.)

Session 1 — Photography Foundations

1. In your own words, what makes a good photograph? Name the five quality words and explain one of them.
2. Your photo of a person against a bright window comes out with the person very dark. What is the most likely reason?
3. What is the exposure triangle? Name the three parts and explain what happens when one of them is set wrong.
4. A classmate's photo is blurry — the whole image looks smeared. What are the two most likely causes, and how would you fix each one?
5. Match each term to its plain-English meaning: aperture, shutter speed, ISO.
6. You are photographing a friend's product for her WhatsApp Business. The photo comes out sharp but the product is too dark. What are two things you could do to fix this?

Session 2 — Composition and Lighting

1. What is composition, and why does it matter?
2. You are photographing a person who is looking toward the left side of the frame. According to the rule of thirds, where should you place the person?
3. What is framing in photography? Give one example of a natural frame.
4. A photo has a bright window behind the subject, and the subject is very dark — almost a silhouette. What is this problem called, and what are two ways to fix it?

fluorescent light, in the middle of the afternoon. What are three things you could do to make the photo look better?

Session 3 — Shooting People, Products and Events

1. What are the three things that make a good portrait? Explain one of them.
2. You are photographing a product for a WhatsApp Business catalogue. The product is on a cluttered table under a fluorescent light. What is the single most important thing you should do first?
3. What are the four elements of a good product photo?
4. A portrait photo shows the subject with dark shadows under the eyes and nose, and the subject is squinting. What is the problem, and how would you fix it?
5. Match each event moment to its description: preparation, greeting, main action, emotion, detail.
6. You are photographing a classmate's portrait. They look stiff and uncomfortable. What are three things you could do to make them more comfortable and get a better photo?

Session 4 — Basic Photo Editing

1. What is the editing workflow? Name the steps in order.
2. You are editing a portrait. The person's face is slightly dark and the background is slightly bright. What should you adjust first?
3. What is the difference between white balance and saturation?
4. A classmate's edited photo has skin that looks like plastic — unnaturally smooth, with no texture. What is the problem, and how would you fix it?
5. Match each editing term to what it does: crop, straighten, exposure, retouch.
6. You are editing a set of five product photos. The colours look inconsistent. What is the most likely cause, and how would you fix it?

Session 5 — Building a Portfolio and Pricing Photography

1. What are the three rules of a strong portfolio?
2. You have 12 photos from a shoot. How many should you include in your mini portfolio, and why?
3. What are the six steps of the client workflow?
4. You are a beginner photographer. A client asks you to photograph 10 product photos. You are not sure what to charge. What should you do?
5. What is the difference between a consent form and a model release?
6. You have delivered a set of photos to a client. What should you do next?

Session 6 — Capstone: Photo Shoot and Portfolio

1. What is the capstone, and what are the six required components?
2. You are shooting your capstone product set. You have planned 8 shots but after shooting you only have 4 Strong photos. What should you do?
3. Why is the brief and shot plan important? What happens if you skip it?
4. A classmate's capstone portfolio has photos with different light, different backgrounds and different colour temperatures. What is the problem, and how would you fix it?
5. Match each capstone component to what it is: brief and shot plan, themed set, contact sheet, consent evidence, mini portfolio, presentation.
6. You are delivering your capstone presentation. You are nervous and not sure what to say. What are three things you can do to prepare and deliver a strong presentation?

GLOSSARY

Aperture	How wide the lens opening is — how much light comes in. Like a window: a big window lets in more light.
Backlight	Light coming from behind the subject, toward the camera. The subject becomes a silhouette.
Batch editing	Applying the same edits to multiple photos so they look consistent.
Beauty filter	A camera filter that smooths skin, enlarges eyes or alters facial features. Turn it off for this course.
Brightness	How light or dark the overall photo is.
Clarity	The subject is sharp — you can see the details.
Composition	How you arrange the subject, background and space within the frame.
Consent form	A document the subject signs to agree to be photographed.
Contact sheet	A grid of the raw selects before editing — shows your selection process.
Crop	Cutting away parts of the photo — usually the edges — to improve composition.
Dedicated camera	A DSLR or mirrorless camera — bigger lens, larger sensor, more manual control.
Exposure	How bright or dark the photo is — controlled by aperture, shutter speed and ISO.
Exposure slider	On a phone, a small sun icon or slider that appears after you tap. Slide up to brighten, down to darken.
Focus	The camera's ability to make the subject sharp.
Focus check	After taking the photo, zoom in on the subject. Is it sharp?
Focus lock	Press and hold the focus square to lock focus and exposure.
Framing	Using elements in the scene to create a frame within the frame — a doorway, window, branches.
Golden hour	The hour after sunrise and the hour before sunset. Warm, golden, soft, directional light.
Grid lines	Two horizontal and two vertical lines that divide the screen into nine equal rectangles.
HDR	High Dynamic Range — the camera takes several photos at different brightness levels and combines them.
Highlights	The brightest areas of the photo. Adjust to recover detail in bright areas.
ISO	How sensitive the camera's sensor is to light. Like turning up the volume on a quiet radio.
Leading lines	Lines in the scene — paths, roads, walls, railings — that lead the viewer's eye toward the subject.
Megapixel	One million pixels — tiny dots of colour that make up a digital image. Tells you how large you can print or crop, not how good the photo looks.
Model release	A document the subject signs to agree to let you use their image.
Moment	The photo captures the right instant — the smile, the action, the expression.
Open shade	Soft, even, cool light in a shaded area — under a tree, in a covered walkway.
Purpose	The photo does the job it was meant to do — sell a product, tell a story, capture a memory.
Rule of thirds	Do not put the subject in the centre. Place it on one of the four grid intersections.
Saturation	How intense the colours are. Low = muted, high = vivid.
Shadows	The darkest areas of the photo. Adjust to brighten dark areas.

Sharpness routine	The 5-step routine: steady hold, tap to focus, check exposure, check background, take several frames.
Shutter speed	How long the shutter stays open — how long light is collected. Like blinking: a slow blink collects more light.
Straighten	Rotating the photo slightly to fix tilted lines — a crooked horizon, a leaning building.
Symmetry	Balance — both sides of the photo are similar or identical.
Tap to focus	Tapping the subject on the screen to tell the camera where to focus and how much light to let in.
White balance	Adjusting the photo so that white objects look white — not blue, not orange, not green.

PORTFOLIO CHECKLIST

Use this checklist to make sure your capstone mini portfolio is complete:

- ☐ **Title page** — your name, course name, date, client name
- ☐ **The set** — 5–8 edited photos, sequenced for flow, with brief descriptions
- ☐ **Contact sheet** — a grid of the raw selects before editing
- ☐ **Consent note** — a statement that consent was obtained for all identifiable people, or that no identifiable third parties appear
- ☐ **Clean, professional layout** — the photos are the star, not the template
- ☐ **Consistent style** — all photos look like they belong together
- ☐ **Exported as a PDF**

CAPSTONE REQUIREMENTS

Your capstone is the final deliverable of the course. You must:

1. **Choose a track** — Product (Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices) or Portrait (Ms. Amaka).
2. **Complete the brief and shot plan** — a one-page document with client need, concept, shot list, light plan, location and consent plan.
3. **Shoot a themed set** — 5–8 photos, all Strong (sharp, well-lit, well-composed, honestly edited).
4. **Select and edit the set** — select the strongest photos, create a contact sheet, edit consistently and honestly.
5. **Assemble the mini portfolio in Canva** — title page, the set, contact sheet, consent note. Export as a PDF.
6. **Obtain and document consent** — signed consent for every identifiable person in the final set (parent/guardian for under-18s), or a note that no identifiable third parties appear.
7. **Present and defend the work** — a 3–5 minute talk covering: the brief, the plan, the shoot, the edits, the consent, what you would do differently.

What success looks like:
the set is sharp, well-lit, honestly edited and clearly usable by the client. The images hang together as one body of work. Every consent requirement is met. You can explain every decision. It need not be studio-perfect — only honest, complete, entry-level professional work.

END OF LEARNER WORKBOOK

Cyber Elias Academy — Photography Learner Workbook v1.0, October 2026. From Zero to Expert, Together.

PART 4

Instructor Manual

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY (SHORT COURSE)

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY (SHORT COURSE)

PART 4 — INSTRUCTOR MANUAL

Institution:
Cyber Elias Academy (CEA), 24/26 Ebony Road, Port Harcourt, Rivers State, Nigeria **Motto:** *From Zero to Expert, Together* **Course:** Photography (Short Course) — phone-first, beginner level **Duration:** 2 weeks | **Sessions:** 6 | **3 sessions per week** | **105 minutes per session Course fee:** ₦30,000 **Certificate:** CEA Certificate in Photography — issued on successful completion of a themed shoot planned, shot, edited and presented as a mini portfolio **This manual:** v1.0, October 2026 — for the instructor only. Keep out of learner hands.

> *This manual is the*
>
> ***teaching companion***
> *. It does **not** repeat the lesson text. The full lesson content, answer keys, rubrics and reference solutions live in **Part 2 — Session Materials** (sections A–O), **Part 5 — Practical Lab Pack**, and **Part 6 — Capstone Project**. Learn where each key sits, then use this manual to brief, prepare, time, mark and support your class.*

0. ETHICS AND CONSENT BRIEFING (READ ALOUD AT THE START OF EVERY SESSION)

This is the most important page in the manual. Read this briefing at the start of Session 1 and re-state the short version at the start of every shooting session (S1, S2, S3, S5, S6). Keep the tone firm but calm.

> *"Photography is built on*
>
> ***trust***
> *— trust that you will not embarrass, exploit or mislead anyone. Before we lift a single phone, here are our rules — and we follow them in class and outside it."*

The eight rules (the course's ethics spine):

1. **Consent before every photograph of a person.** Ask first, every time. If someone says no, put the camera down — no argument, no exceptions. Class practice uses classmates who have agreed to participate.
2. **Parent or guardian consent for anyone under 18.** A signature from a parent or guardian is required before a person under 18 is photographed for practice, portfolio or client use. Without it, do not shoot.
3. **Respect public places and privacy.** In markets, churches, streets and events, be unobtrusive, follow the rules of the location, and never photograph people in private moments or in ways that could humiliate them.
4. **No misleading edits.** Do not change a product's true appearance, fake a background, reshape a body beyond normal correction, or edit in a way that lies to a client or viewer. Editing cleans up a photograph; it does not manufacture a false one.
5. **Honesty about skills and work.** Never claim to be more experienced than you are, never present stock or someone else's image as your own, and never promise results you cannot deliver. If unsure, say so and check with the instructor.
6. **Releases and ownership.** Get written permission before using a person's image commercially, and deliver a client's product or brand images as agreed — do not reuse them in your portfolio without permission.

8. **Consequences.** Breaking these rules is a serious breach of academy conduct and may end your participation in the course.

> ***Say it with the class:***
> *"Ask first. Edit honestly. Claim only what you can do."*

Consent paperwork.
Keep the Client Consent Form and Model Release Form (Part 5, Templates 7.8 and 7.9) printed and stocked. For any person photographed in class or for the capstone: form signed **before** the shutter is pressed; for under-18 subjects, the parent/guardian section is mandatory. In the capstone, a portfolio that photographs people without consent, or that contains no consent evidence, **scores zero for the portfolio** (Part 6 rubric §1) regardless of image quality.

Location respect.
If a shoot leaves the classroom (a market, a church, a shop for Assignment 3 or the capstone), the learner must ask the location's owner or usher **before** shooting, and obey their answer. No permission, no shoot — same rule as photographing a person.

Confirmation for you and your learners:
if any class activity appears to require photographing an unconsenting person, faking an edit, or deceiving a client, it is a mistake — stop and re-check this manual and the Part 2 session note.

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1. HOW TO USE THIS MANUAL (and how it relates to Parts 1, 2, 3, 5 and 6)

You have companion documents for every session. Know which does what:

Part	What it is	Who sees it	Where the content lives
Part 1 — Course Design	The master plan: outcomes, week themes, assessment, capstone, ethics (§15)	Instructor	Design document
Part 2 — Session Materials	The **full, complete lesson** for each session in the A–O structure	Instructor (contains keys)	Sessions 1–6
Part 3 — Learner Workbook	The learner's revision and exercise book — **no answers**	Learner	Workbook
Part 4 — This manual	Preparation, timing, marking index, remediation, differentiation, capstone logistics	**Instructor only**	This file
Part 5 — Practical Lab Pack	Practical briefs per session, reusable templates (shot list, consent form, pricing worksheet, checklists)	Instructor (most pages shared with learners)	Lab pack
Part 6 — Capstone	The 30-mark rubric, the 5-mark viva, the model package, the instructor guide	Instructor (+ learner sees rubric)	Rubric + guide

The golden rule:
never invent the lesson on the fly. Open the Part 2 session and teach from sections A–O. This manual tells you *how to prepare* and *where the answers are*, not what the lesson says.

Where the answers live — the sections you will use most:

- **Section G — Instructor Demonstration:** the worked model (thinking aloud) and the demonstration answers.
- **Section H — Guided Practical:** the completion checklist you tick while walking the room.
- **Section I — Independent Class Exercise:** the learner's task **and the instructor answer key / model solution** for it.
- **Section L — Session Assignment:** the take-home task, its **marking rubric**, and an **instructor reference solution**.
- **Section M — Knowledge Check:** the quiz **and the instructor answer key** (Q-by-Q).

Everything a learner must

not

see (keys, reference solutions, capstone model package) is held in Part 2 Sections I/L/M/O, this manual, and Part 6. The Learner Workbook (Part 3) is deliberately **answer-free**.

Suggested first hour of a new intake:

hand out the workbook, have every learner **read and sign the Ethics & Consent agreement** (Design Document §15 / Section 0 above), pair anyone without a capable phone, and run the Session 1 opener.

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2. COURSE-AT-A-GLANCE

Item	Detail
Course title	Photography (Short Course)
Orientation	**Phone-first** — the smartphone is the primary camera; a DSLR is demonstrated if available, never required
Duration	**2 weeks**
Sessions	**6 total (S1–S6)**, **3 per week**, **105 minutes each**
Delivery mode	In-person, instructor-led, hands-on
Level	Beginner (no prior photography knowledge)
Course fee	**₦30,000**
Entry requirements	A smartphone with a working camera; ~2–4 GB free storage or academy computers; free Snapseed or Lightroom Mobile by S4; free Canva account for S5/S6; willingness to follow the consent rules. **No DSLR, laptop or prior knowledge required.**
Tools	Phone camera app; **Snapseed** (primary) or **Lightroom Mobile** (free tier); **Canva** (free tier); academy computers; projector; reflector or white card; improvised stands (books, selfie stick). **No paid subscription, ever.**
Modules	Week 1 — Module 1: "See and Shoot" (S1–S3). Week 2 — Module 2: "Process and Deliver" (S4–S6)
Capstone	Themed photo shoot + mini portfolio for a **fictional** Port Harcourt client — Track A *Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices* (product) or Track B *Ms. Amaka* (portrait)
Certificate	At least **5 of 6 sessions** attended, assignments submitted, **pass the capstone**, **50%+ overall**, and a viva presentation
Verification	cea.ng/certificates/verify

The week arc:

Week 1 **See and Shoot** (S1 foundations; S2 composition and light; S3 people, products, events — closing the 12-image foundations folder). Week 2 **Process and Deliver** (S4 honest editing; S5 portfolio, pricing and the timed simulation; S6 capstone shoot, portfolio and viva).

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3. SESSION TIMING TEMPLATE

3.1 The standard 105-minute breakdown

Every session follows this shape. Week 1 leans heavier on demonstration and guided shooting; Week 2 leans heavier on independent work, editing and presentation.

0–6	**D. Opening activity**	Hook with strong vs weak images of a client story; set the tone.
6–13	**E. Prerequisite review**	Fast oral round-robin; bridge from last session.
13–43	**F. Full lecture notes**	Teach the concept with plain-English definitions, comparisons and misconceptions.
43–58	**G. Instructor demonstration**	Think aloud through the worked model on the projector (live phone camera where possible).
58–76	**H. Guided practical**	Instructor calls steps; learners shoot/edit; instructor walks the room.
76–91	**I. Independent exercise**	Learners work alone; instructor supports at Level 1/2.
91–96	**J. Case study + L. Assignment brief**	Real-world Port Harcourt decision point; set the take-home task and deadline.
96–103	**M. Knowledge check + N. Reflection**	Quiz and recap; learners answer in workbook.
103–105	**Close**	Ethics reminder ("ask first, edit honestly"), next session teaser, phones charged for next class.

Rule of thumb:
if the room is slow, **protect the guided and independent practicals** (and, in S6, the presentations) and compress the lecture/case study. If the room is fast, extend the case study and let learners present their shots on the projector.

3.2 Per-session timing table (all 6 sessions)

#	Title	Key activity (the session's priority)	Protected time
S1	Photography Foundations	Guided: camera setup (grid, resolution, filters off) + **5-step sharpness routine** → nine sharp, correctly exposed frames. Independent: three-lighting-situation diagnosis.	Guided + Independent (33 min)
S2	Composition and Lighting	Guided: shoot one photo per technique (thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry/perspective). Independent: four-image composition series + light study.	Guided + Independent (33 min)
S3	Shooting People, Products and Events	Guided: portrait with signed consent, product scene, simulated event moment. Independent: complete the 12-image **foundations folder**.	Guided + Independent + consent paperwork (33 min)
S4	Basic Photo Editing	Guided: full Snapseed/Lightroom workflow on one photo. Independent: batch-edit a three-then-five image set; discuss the deliberately over-edited sample.	Guided + Independent (33 min)
S5	Building a Portfolio and Pricing Photography	Guided: select, sequence and build a Canva portfolio page; three naira packages; workflow sheet. Independent: **timed simulation** — plan, shoot, edit, present a delivery-ready set from the Mama Nkechi brief.	Simulation block (15 min)
S6	Capstone: Photo Shoot and Portfolio	Guided: brief and shot plan + themed shoot. Independent: **present (3–5 min) + viva (2 min)**.	**Presentations + viva (protect above all)**

S6 caution:
6 sessions of 105 minutes cannot fit 16+ presentations of 5 minutes *plus* the shoot, edit and assembly blocks. For a small class (≤8), run demo + shoot + present inside S6. For a larger class, book 5-minute viva appointments across the final two days (arrange with the admin office) and use S6 for finishing shoots, edits and the first presentation round. Tell learners the viva schedule one session in advance (Capstone Instructor Guide §1).

Universal checklist (every session):

- ☐ Learner phones charged, ≥1 GB free storage; academy phones/backup devices ready for anyone without a capable phone.
- ☐ Instructor phone connected to the **projector / large screen** with the camera app working.
- ☐ Part 2 session open at the right section; lab-pack pages and worksheets printed where needed.
- ☐ **Ethics & Consent briefing** (Section 0) ready; consent forms and model release forms stocked (Part 5, Templates 7.8–7.9).
- ☐ A visible **timer** (phone or projector clock).
- ☐ Whiteboard marker and space for the session's board work (quality words, workflow steps, price bands).
- ☐ Sample files prepared with **academy-owned or free/royalty-free** images only.

Session-specific preparation:

#	Prepare before class
S1	Print the three **"same subject, three results" comparison sets** (Section D) and the **Camera Setup Checklist** per learner. A simple table subject (bottle, notebook, fruit) for the live demo; a person-against-window scenario (willing colleague or a printed portrait). Print the **Ethics & Consent agreement** for signature. Confirm learners can open their camera app.
S2	Learner phones with **grid lines** verified (walk the room early if needed). A window with good natural light, an open-shade spot, a corridor or table edge for leading lines, a doorway for framing. Composition Series worksheet and Light Study worksheet printed. Reflector/white card.
S3	**Sample products** ready: a shoe, bag, bottle, book or phone accessory; a clean surface and plain background; white card. **Consent forms printed and stacked** — no form, no portrait. Simulated event props (pouring a drink, opening a book, handing over an item). Foundations-folder tracker on the board.
S4	**Snapseed and/or Lightroom Mobile installed and opened once** on every class phone (help installs in S3 if needed — free only). A raw photo per learner from their foundations folder. Your **before/after edit examples** and one **deliberately over-edited** sample on the projector. Edit Decision Log worksheet printed. Academy computers on for anyone whose phone cannot run the app.
S5	**Canva accounts** ready (free email sign-up; create in class if missing). Learners' foundations folders and edited sets open. Package Price List template and Client Workflow Sheet printed. The **Mama Nkechi simulation brief** printed per learner. Timer for the 15-minute simulation. Price bands written on the board as *examples only* (e.g., Basic 5 photos ~₦15,000 — never promised income).
S6	The **two fictional client briefs** (Track A / Track B) printed per learner. **Capstone rubric** printed (learners use it for peer feedback). Product set (soup containers, spice jars, food items) or portrait setup (chair, window, plain background) staged by track. Canva on academy computers with internet. Consent forms on every table. Viva timetable booked and posted. Class folder `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname` for submissions. A completed sample portfolio (skeleton only — structure, not filled model) to show.

Printouts bank (keep a master set):
ethics agreement; S1 camera setup checklist; S2 composition and light worksheets; S3 consent forms + portrait/product/event checklists; S4 Edit Decision Log; S5 price list + workflow sheets + simulation brief; S6 track briefs + rubric + Presentation Notes worksheet.

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5. TEACHING NOTES AND ANALOGY BANK

Use the same analogies the learners meet in Part 2 — consistency helps recall. The best ones per session:

- **S1 — Foundations.** A good photograph = **clarity, light, composition, moment, purpose** — five words you return to all course. The exposure triangle is **cooking rice**: aperture = water, shutter = cooking time, ISO = heat; balance all three or the rice is hard or burnt. A phone is a **bicycle**, a DSLR a **car** — the bicycle is always with you. Focus is a **magnifying glass**: place it on the subject. Megapixels are **quantity of detail, not quality of light**. The 5-step sharpness routine is **checking your exam paper** before you submit.

that carries the eye to your subject. Golden hour is the **soft evening light** that flatters everybody — the same light a tailor uses to show fabric colour. Harsh midday sun is a **ceiling bulb shining straight down** — it makes deep shadows under the eyes. Backlight is standing **between the lamp and the person's face** — the face goes dark.

- **S3 — People, products, events.** Directing a subject is **chatting, not commanding** — talk about their work, give hands something to do; the best expression arrives between poses. A product scene is a **shop window**: clean surface, plain background, label to camera. A white card is a **second window** on the shadow side. Event shooting is **cooking with several pots** — watch the light change, anticipate the action, take many frames; the moment is gone if you wait.
- **S4 — Editing.** The editing workflow is **dressing a person, not changing the person**: crop straighten first (tidy up), exposure (light the room), colour (match the cloth), retouch (small spot removal), sharpen (final comb). "Do less, but do it well." An over-edited photo is **too much makeup** — the person is hidden. Editing can fix small problems; it **cannot fix a blurry subject or bad composition** — prevention is the only cure. Honest editing: **enhance, do not deceive.**
- **S5 — Portfolio and pricing.** A portfolio is the **right photos in the right order**, not every photo you like — a trader shows the best goods first. Pricing per package is **selling a bag of goods, not one item at a time**: name it, list what is inside, put the price. The client workflow (brief → quote → shoot → edit → deliver → follow-up) is the **market journey from greeting to after-sales**; follow-up is the after-sales that brings the customer back. The simulation is a **rehearsal before market day**.
- **S6 — Capstone.** The brief and shot plan is a **building blueprint** — no plan, no shoot. The mini portfolio is a **well-organised book**: cover, chapters, appendix, legal page. The presentation is a **job interview about your own work** — be specific, be honest, be confident. The capstone is the **final dish in a cooking course**: the guest expects a well-cooked, honest meal, not a Michelin star.

Delivery habits that lift every session:
define the term, give the comparison, then give the *misconception*. Always ask "**why**" and "**what is the one action that makes this photo work?**" Praise learners who name a quality word aloud — that vocabulary is the course's measuring tape. Keep every example in familiar Port Harcourt life: WhatsApp Business catalogues, Jiji listings, church programmes, birthdays, salons, food vendors.

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6. ANSWER-KEY AND MARKING INDEX

Fast-lookup table.
"Section" = the labelled section inside that Part 2 session file.

Session	Independent-exercise key	Assignment rubric + solution	Knowledge-check key	Model answers / other
S1	Part 2 S1 **§I** (three-lighting-situation diagnosis, marking out of 10)	S1 **§L** ("Focus and Exposure Drills", 10 marks)	S1 **§M** (A1–A6)	S1 **§G** (exposure/focus demos), **§O** misconceptions + remedial; Camera Setup Checklist in §F.5
S2	S2 **§I** (composition + light study, key)	S2 **§L** (Composition and Light Series, 10 marks)	S2 **§M** (key)	S2 **§O**; Lighting Setup Planner in Part 5 Template 7.2
S3	S3 **§I** (foundations folder, key)	S3 **§L** (People/Product/Event set, 10 marks)	S3 **§M** (key)	Consent Form Template 7.8; Posing Guide 7.3; Product Setup Checklist 7.4
S4	S4 **§I** (edited five-image set, key)	S4 **§L** ("Edit a Set, Not a Single", 10 marks)	S4 **§M** (key)	Editing Checklist Template 7.5; over-edited demo sample (your prep)
S5	S5 **§I** (timed simulation, key)	S5 **§L** (Price List + Workflow Sheet, 10 marks)	S5 **§M** (key)	Pricing Worksheet Template 7.7; Portfolio Selection Worksheet 7.6; Model Release 7.9
S6	S6 **§I** (presentation, model structure, session rubric, feedback tone)	S6 **§L** (Capstone, 10-mark rubric + 5 bonus)	S6 **§M** (A1–A6)	**Part 6 rubric** (30+5, pass conditions) + **Capstone**

	marking out of 10)	Part 6 rubric)	**Instructor Guide §3** model package, §6 viva script

Assessment-weight check (must total 100%):
Practicals 15 | Assignments 15 | Knowledge checks 15 | Simulation 15 | Capstone 30 | Viva/demo 5 | Attendance 5.

How to turn raw marks into course percentages (use consistently):

- **Practicals (15%):** tick each learner's guided-practical completion checklist (Section H) in S1–S5; five checklists out of 10 → total out of 50, ×0.30 = 15%.
- **Assignments (15%):** each of Assignments 1–5 marked with the §L rubric out of 10 → total out of 50, ×0.30 = 15%.
- **Knowledge checks (15%):** each session's Section M quiz marked out of 6 → five checks out of 30, ×0.50 = 15%.
- **Simulation (15%):** the S5 timed simulation marked out of 20 (plan 4, shoot 6, edit 5, present 5), ×0.75 = 15%.
- **Capstone (30%):** Part 6 rubric, 30 marks direct. **Viva (5%):** Part 6 rubric, 5 marks direct. **Attendance (5%):** 4+ marks for ≥5/6 sessions with engagement; below 5/6, marks drop accordingly (attendance never replaces competence).

Key answers for the highest-value checkpoints (keep these in your head):

- **S1 (core ideas):** five quality words = clarity, light, composition, moment, purpose; exposure triangle = aperture/shutter/ISO and their plain meanings; person-against-window dark face = camera exposed for the window (fix: tap the subject, slide exposure up); blurry causes = camera shake, subject movement, focus error; **editing cannot fix blur**; megapixels ≠ quality.
- **S2 (core ideas):** rule of thirds = subject on a grid intersection or along a line; framing = natural frame around the subject; leading lines = lines carrying the eye to the subject; golden hour/window light/open shade = soft flattering light; harsh sun and backlight = avoid or fix (move subject, use shade, use a white card).
- **S3 (core ideas):** portrait = consent form first, window/open-shade light, body angled, hands occupied, talk to the subject; product = clean surface, plain background, soft light, white-card fill, label to camera; event = anticipate, many frames, watch changing light. **No consent, no photo.**
- **S4 (core ideas):** workflow order = crop/straighten → exposure → colour → retouch → sharpen (optional); batch edit = copy edits from reference, paste, review each; honest editing = enhance, do not deceive; a blurry subject cannot be fixed; beauty filters off, always.
- **S5 (core ideas):** select only **Strong** photos; sequence = start strong, build, end strong; three packages in naira with clear inclusions; client workflow = brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up; commercial use needs a release; simulation = plan fast, shoot deliberately, edit honestly, present briefly.
- **S6 (core ideas):** six capstone components = brief/shot plan, 5–8 image set, contact sheet, consent evidence, Canva mini portfolio, presentation; consent/ethics statement is a **pass condition**; fictional client on purpose; the honest certificate line = **entry-level photographer**, not a studio professional.

7. ASSESSMENT OVERVIEW

Weighting (total 100%):

Component	Weight	What it covers
Practicals	15%	In-class guided practicals, S1–S5 (completion checklists)
Assignments	15%	Take-home tasks, Assignments 1–5
Knowledge checks	15%	Session quizzes, S1–S6
Simulation	15%	The S5 timed plan→shoot→edit→present drill (Mama Nkechi brief)
Capstone	30%	Full themed shoot + mini portfolio (Part 6 rubric)
Viva / demo	5%	Presentation and question-and-answer

Attendance	5%	Attendance and participation across the 6 sessions

> ***Terminology to use consistently:***
> *the S5 assessment item is the **"timed simulation"**; the S6 assessment item is the **"capstone"** (portfolio 30 + viva 5). Say the same words in class, on worksheets and on mark sheets.*

Grade bands:
A = 80%+; B = 65–79%; C = 50–64%; D = 40–49%; F = below 40%.

Capstone pass rule (the hard gate).
To pass and be certified a learner must:

1. Score **50% or more overall**, **AND**
2. **Pass the capstone** — at least **15/30 on the portfolio** *and* demonstrate the ethics/consent requirement (a portfolio without the consent and ethics statement, or with people photographed without consent, is **zero**), **AND**
3. Attend at least **5 of 6 sessions**, submit assignments satisfactorily, and present in the viva.

Integrity note:
a high quiz or attendance score can **never** replace demonstrated camera competence. The capstone is defended live; a portfolio the learner cannot explain does not pass. Mark against the Part 6 rubric columns, not from memory — record one line of feedback per learner immediately after the viva.

8. COMMON LEARNER MISCONCEPTIONS AND REMEDIATION

Misconception	Correct it with	Remedial exercise
"Good photos need an expensive camera / DSLR."	The phone in the pocket, used well, produces sharp, well-lit, usable photographs. Choices matter more than the price tag.	Re-shoot a weak Assignment 1 subject using only the sharpness routine; compare before/after.
"More megapixels = better photos."	Megapixels = quantity of detail (print size, cropping) — not quality of light. Sensor, lens and choices matter more.	Explain in one sentence why a 12 MP phone beats a 48 MP phone in a dark room.
"If the photo is dark, I will fix it in editing."	Brightening a very dark photo brightens noise too. Get exposure right in camera; editing fixes small problems only.	Diagnose three dark frames; re-shoot each correctly in camera; compare.
"A blurry photo can be sharpened later."	Editing cannot create detail that was not captured. Prevention (steady, focus, frames) is the only cure.	Zoom-in focus-check drill on five frames; identify which are usable.
"Beauty filters make my portraits better."	Filters distort real people and mislead clients. Real skin texture is professional.	Turn filters off; re-shoot a portrait; compare natural vs filtered side by side.
"One photo per shot is enough."	Professionals take several frames and choose. Storage is cheap; the perfect frame rarely comes first.	Take 5 frames of one subject; select and justify the strongest.
"Midday sun is the best light."	Harsh overhead sun makes deep, unflattering shadows. Open shade, window light and golden hour flatter.	Shoot the same subject at harsh noon light and in open shade; compare and label.
"Centred is always best."	The rule of thirds (and other techniques) give intention and energy. Centre is a choice, not	Re-shoot three centred frames using thirds; explain which is stronger and

"Editing can change anything — replace the sky, reshape the body, change the product."	Honest editing: enhance, do not deceive. Misleading edits break trust and may breach the academy rules.	Compare a before/after pair and an over-edited pair; list what is honest and what is not.
"A portfolio is all my best photos."	A portfolio is the right photos in the right order — 5–8 Strong images that flow as a set.	Cut a 12-image set down to 6; sequence and justify every cut.
"I should charge per photo / charge almost nothing."	Package pricing in naira with clear inclusions; research the market; cheap work devalues the skill.	Rebuild a per-photo price into three packages using the Pricing Worksheet.
"Consent is only for client work — class practice is free."	Consent is required for **every** photograph of a person, class or client, adult or under-18 (with guardian).	Permission drill: allowed or not, and why; complete a consent form correctly.
"The capstone must be magazine-perfect."	It must be honest, complete, entry-level professional — sharp, well-lit, consistent, consented, explained.	Walk the rubric bands aloud; grade a sample set together at Competent level.

Likely vs confirmed:
teach learners that a *likely* problem (dark photo, soft focus) becomes *confirmed* only after they check — zoom in, look at the light, ask what they tapped. Diagnose before fixing; that habit is what makes a photographer.

9. DIFFERENTIATION GUIDANCE (LEVEL 1 / 2 / 3)

Every major exercise in Part 2 carries three levels (see each session's Section O). Use them as follows:

- **Level 1 — Supported.** Provide a **partially completed scaffold**: a Camera Setup Checklist with the first two boxes ticked and demonstrated; a shot plan with concept and light plan pre-filled; a portfolio page with the title page already built. Pair the learner with a confident peer and let them swap photographer/model roles. Goal: **complete a correct core**, not everything. Learners who read slowly use the workbook glossary and oral rehearsal for the viva.
- **Level 2 — Standard.** The exercise exactly as written in Part 2. This is the expected standard for most learners.
- **Level 3 — Challenge.** Add a genuine extension: shoot **both capstone tracks** and assemble two mini portfolios; add a **marketing plan** for the first three paying clients and present it; price a job with a **time log** (how many hours, at what rate in naira); sequence a 10-image editorial-style set with a written story line. Challenge extensions must stay inside the ethics rules — never real unconsenting subjects, never dishonest edits.

Digital divide support:
a learner without a capable phone pairs for shooting, uses academy phones for practicals, and may plan, write and present on paper; the capstone deliverable is a PDF — no device ownership is required for the final submission. Pairing never lowers the standard of the work.

10. CAPSTONE EVALUATION INSTRUCTIONS

The capstone:
a **themed photo shoot + mini portfolio** for a **fictional, authorised** Port Harcourt client — Track A *Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices* (product) or Track B *Ms. Amaka* (portrait), or another clearly fictional client agreed with you. It is worth **30 portfolio marks + 5 viva marks** (Part 6 rubric).

1. Brief the learners in S5 (or early S6) with the 10-minute script in the Capstone Instructor Guide §2.
Name the fictional targets; explain why fictional (safe practice, no real client risk); put the six required components on the board; state the **pass condition** (consent and ethics statement is compulsory); enforce consent forms and parent/guardian signatures; warn that only **Strong** photos count; set the folder name `CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname`; point out that the foundations folder, edited set, portfolio page and price list are the raw materials — the capstone is assembly, not a new mountain.

promise), brief and shot plan, themed set of **5–8** edited images, contact sheet of selects, presentation notes.

3. Checkpoint discipline:
Checkpoint A end of S3 (track chosen, shot plan drafted, consent arrangements confirmed); Checkpoint B end of S5 (selects chosen, first consistent edits, portfolio format decided); Checkpoint C in S6 (full set shot, edited, assembled, presentation ready). A learner who misses Checkpoint A is the one to pair and support early.

4. Rubric summary (full detail in Part 6):
Consent & ethics 3; brief & plan 3; technical quality 5; composition 4; lighting 4; edit consistency 4; selection & sequencing 3; completeness 4 → **30**. Viva/demo **5** on one band. Check the ethics/consent pass condition **before** scoring any criterion.

5. Run the viva (about 5 minutes):
sit beside the learner; 3–5 minute presentation (brief, plan, shoot, edits, consent, what I would do differently), then 4–5 questions from the Part 6 viva list. Do not lead them — ask "walk me through how you decided this light/composition" to separate a guess from a reasoned (partial-credit) answer. **The ethics probe is mandatory** (e.g., "A client asks you to make a scratched phone case look brand new in the photo. What do you say?") — a photography graduate must refuse and explain why. Record one line per learner immediately. Use the same **core 4 questions** for everyone and vary the extra one, for fairness.

6. Fair grading:
judge by the criterion columns, not by which track the learner chose. **Evidence beats elegance** — an untidy but honest portfolio outscores a beautiful one with faked edits. Rewarding honesty: reshaped bodies, changed products or faked backgrounds lose marks under consistency/ethics regardless of "professional" looks. When two portfolios are close, **the viva is the tie-breaker**.

7. Zero rule.
Any ethical failure (real person photographed without consent, no consent evidence, dishonest edits presented as real) means **zero for the portfolio**, referral to the course coordinator, and possible failure of the whole course.

Materials ready on viva day:
printed rubric; track briefs for point-at-evidence checks; a copy of each learner's portfolio for annotation; the viva question list; a 5-minute timer; blank consent/model-release forms for last-minute signings.

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11. SAMPLE FEEDBACK COMMENTS

Copy and adapt these; always in plain English.

Strong work:

- "Sharp, well-lit, consistent set with honest edits. Your consent statement was clear and in your own words, and your presentation explained every choice specifically — where the light came from, what you cropped, what you refused to fake. Well done."
- "Your light study shows real control — the window-light frame and the open-shade frame are textbook. In the viva you defended the rule-of-thirds choice with a reason, not a memorised line. That is professional."

Average / solid, with a next step:

- "Good brief and shot plan. Before the viva, tighten two images: one is slightly soft and one has a distracting background. Your editing was honest and consistent — keep that. Re-shoot only the weakest two frames."
- "Your packages are sensible but the ordering needs work: name each package, list exactly what is included, then the price — Basic first as the easy entry point. Add follow-up to your workflow sheet; it is the step everyone forgets."
- "The set is strong overall, but two photos were shot in different light and the colours do not match. Batch-edit from one reference and review each frame individually so the set looks like one shoot."

Weak / needs remediation:

- "Several frames are blurry. Go back to the 5-step sharpness routine: steady with both hands, tap to focus on the subject, check exposure, check background, take at least three frames. Re-shoot the weakest images and zoom in to check before you submit."

marked.

- "You filled the set with Acceptable photos because you ran out of time. A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio. Re-shoot until you have 5–8 Strong frames. The capstone is not a race."
- "Your client asked for a brand-new look on a scratched product and you agreed to fake it. Remember rule four: no misleading edits. Learn to say: 'I can clean and light it honestly — I cannot change what it is.' Resubmit with honest edits."

Viva note:
"Struggled to connect one image to its light choice under questioning, but recovered with the portfolio in front of them. Practise explaining each image in one sentence: subject, light, composition, edit, honest limit."

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12. QUALITY-ASSURANCE CHECKLIST

12.1 Before each session

- ☐ I have opened the correct Part 2 session and read sections A–O.
- ☐ The session-specific preparation from Section 4 is done (phones, sample products, editing apps, printouts, accounts).
- ☐ The **Ethics & Consent briefing** (Section 0) is ready; consent forms are stocked for any session that photographs people.
- ☐ All shooting subjects are consenting classmates, objects, or **fictional** clients — no unconsented people, no misleading edits demonstrated as acceptable.
- ☐ I know where this session's keys are (Section 6 index) before I teach.
- ☐ The projector, timer and board are ready; the 105-minute plan is set; protected time is protected.

12.2 Before grading any piece of work

- ☐ I am marking against the session's rubric in Part 2 **§L** (or the Part 6 capstone rubric) — not from memory.
- ☐ Independent and knowledge-check answers use the keys in **§I and §M**.
- ☐ Practical marks come from the guided-practical completion checklists, ticked in class.
- ☐ Photo submissions pass a **zoom-in sharpness check** and an **exposure check** before marks are awarded.
- ☐ No learner submission contains a person photographed without recorded consent (a submission that does is handled privately and referred, not marked as-is).
- ☐ Assignment totals (out of 10 each), simulation (out of 20), capstone (30) and viva (5) match the course weighting in Section 7.
- ☐ For the capstone: the **consent/ethics pass condition** is checked **before** any criterion is scored.
- ☐ One line of constructive feedback is recorded per learner, immediately.

12.3 Before the course is signed off

- ☐ All learners can state the consent rule and the honest-editing rule unprompted.
- ☐ Each learner has passed the capstone portfolio and presented in the viva.
- ☐ Attendance (≥5/6), assignments, 50%+ overall and the presentation are all recorded.
- ☐ The **class sign-off sheet** records name, capstone folder, portfolio mark, viva mark and signature.
- ☐ Every status is honest: the certificate recognises an **entry-level photographer** — not a studio professional, photojournalist or retoucher.

Cyber Elias Academy — Part 4 Photography Instructor Manual v1.0, October 2026. All capstone clients fictional. Consent before every photograph of a person.

From Zero to Expert, Together — Ask first. Edit honestly. Claim only what you can do.

PART 5

Practical Lab Pack

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY

PRACTICAL LAB PACK

01 — PRACTICAL BRIEFS AND TEMPLATES

Cyber Elias Academy | Photography | October 2026

This pack is the raw material for the practical sessions and the capstone. Everything here is

fictional and made up by the academy for teaching
. No business, person or brief in this pack is real. Use them to practise **shooting**, **editing** and **delivering** — never to deceive or exploit anyone.

> ***Rules when using this pack***
>
> 1. *Do not forward any sample brief to real people as if it were real.*
> 2. *Do not contact any business or person named in a sample.*
> 3. *All shoots use classmates who have agreed to participate, or fictional scenarios.*
> 4. *The lab is honest: we shoot real scenes, edit honestly, and deliver truthfully.*

1. PRACTICAL BRIEF — SESSION 1: PHOTOGRAPHY FOUNDATIONS

Objective:
Set up a phone camera, apply the 5-step sharpness routine and produce three sharp, correctly exposed photographs of a real subject.

Setup:

- Learner's own phone with camera app open.
- A subject in the classroom: a classmate (with consent), a bag, a plant, a book, a water bottle.
- The printed Camera Setup Checklist.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow):

1. Open your camera app. Turn on **grid lines** in your settings.
2. Set **resolution to the highest available**. Check that **beauty filters are off**.
3. Choose your subject. If it is a classmate, ask their permission first.
4. **Step 1 — Steady hold:** Hold the phone with both hands, elbows tucked.
5. **Step 2 — Tap to focus:** Tap your subject on the screen. Wait half a second.
6. **Step 3 — Check exposure:** Is the subject too dark or too bright? Use the exposure slider.
7. **Step 4 — Check background:** Is anything distracting? Move slightly to remove it.
8. **Step 5 — Take three frames:** Take three photos of the same scene.
9. **Focus check:** Open each photo and pinch to zoom in on the subject. Is it sharp?
10. Repeat for a second subject and a third subject.

Expected result:

- Cannot find grid setting → Show them on their phone. iPhone: Settings > Camera > Grid. Android: camera app > settings icon > Grid.
- Photos consistently dark → Check if they are tapping a bright part of the scene. Have them tap the subject directly.
- Photos blurry → Check if they are moving the camera after tapping. Have them hold steady.
- Beauty filter on → Check camera app settings; turn off Beauty/Smooth/Face mode.

Independent exercise:
Photograph the same subject in three different lighting situations (near a window, in a dim corner, in direct bright sun). Label each photo: dark, bright, blurry or flat. Write one sentence explaining why.

---

2. PRACTICAL BRIEF — SESSION 2: COMPOSITION AND LIGHTING

Objective:
Produce a four-image composition series (one photo per technique) and a four-image light study (same subject in four different lighting conditions).

Setup:

- Learner's own phone with grid lines on.
- A subject: a bottle, a cup, a bag, a plant, or a classmate (with consent).
- A window with natural light and a shaded area.

Procedure — Part 1: Composition Series (12 minutes)

1. **Rule of thirds:** Place the subject on one of the four grid intersections. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
2. **Framing:** Find a natural frame — a doorway, a window, a gap between two objects. Shoot through the frame. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
3. **Leading lines:** Find or create leading lines — the edge of a table, a row of books, a corridor. Position yourself so the lines lead to the subject. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.
4. **Symmetry or perspective:** Find a symmetrical scene or a perspective scene. Compose for symmetry or depth. Take three photos. Pick the strongest.

For each photo, write one line: "*Technique:* _____. *What I did:* _____."

Procedure — Part 2: Light Study (6 minutes)

5. Choose one subject that can stay still.
6. Photograph it in four different lighting situations available in or near the classroom.
7. For each photo, write one line: "*Light:* _____. *What I see:* _____."

Expected result:
Four composition photos and four light study photos, each with a written description.

Troubleshooting:

- Cannot find a natural frame → Suggest a doorway, a window, or the gap between two chairs.
- Subject is centred despite trying → Have them look at the grid lines, not just the subject. Move the camera, not the subject.
- Leading lines are not leading anywhere → Ask: "Where do the lines go? Reposition."
- Light study photos look the same → The learner may have photographed in the same light twice. Have them move to a genuinely different lighting situation.

Independent exercise:
Complete the light study — photograph the same subject in four different lighting conditions (near a window, in open shade, in direct bright light, with a bright background behind it). Label each: soft/hard, warm/cool, flattering/unflattering. Write one sentence explaining what you see.

Objective:
Produce a portrait, a product shot and an event shot, each with a completed worksheet.

Setup:

- Learner's own phone.
- A classmate who has agreed to be photographed (with signed consent form).
- A simple product: a shoe, a bag, a bottle, a book.
- A plain surface and background.
- A white card or reflector.
- A simulated event setup: a person pouring a drink, opening a book, handing over an item.

Procedure — Part 1: Portrait (6 minutes)

1. Ask a classmate to be your subject. Have them sign the consent form.
2. Position your subject near a window or in open shade. Check the light on their face.
3. Direct the pose: turn the body slightly, give the hands something to do, angle the face toward the light.
4. Talk to your subject. Make them comfortable. Take at least five photos.
5. Review the photos. Pick the strongest one. Tick the Portrait Checklist.

Procedure — Part 2: Product (6 minutes)

1. Choose a product — your bag, a bottle, a book, a shoe.
2. Build the scene: clean surface, plain background, product positioned at its best angle.
3. Set the light: near a window or in open shade. Use a white card to fill shadows.
4. Compose using the rule of thirds. Use the 5-step sharpness routine. Take at least five photos.
5. Review the photos. Pick the strongest one. Fill in the Product Scene Planner.

Procedure — Part 3: Event (6 minutes)

1. Work in pairs. One person performs a simple action. The other is the photographer.
2. The photographer positions themselves, checks the light, and anticipates the action.
3. The "event" person performs the action. The photographer takes at least five photos in quick succession.
4. Review the photos. Pick the strongest one. Fill in the Event Moment Log.
5. Swap roles and repeat.

Expected result:
One portrait, one product shot and one event shot, each with a completed worksheet.

Troubleshooting:

- Subject looks stiff → Suggest giving the hands something to do, or asking the subject to talk about something they enjoy.
- Product photo has harsh shadows → Have them use the white card to fill the shadow side.
- Event photo is blurry → Check if the subject moved too fast. Suggest taking more frames.
- Learner has not obtained consent → Stop the exercise. No consent, no photo.

Independent exercise:
Complete the foundations folder — a 12-image set covering composition, light and subjects. Organise into three groups of four. Write one sentence per image. Ensure every image of a person has a signed consent form.

---

4. PRACTICAL BRIEF — SESSION 4: BASIC PHOTO EDITING

Objective:
Edit one photo using the full workflow and batch-edit a set of three photos for consistency.

Setup:

- A set of three photos (product, portrait or event) for batch editing.
- The printed Edit Decision Log.

Procedure — Part 1: Full Edit Workflow (10 minutes)

1. Open Snapseed. Import a raw photo from your foundations folder.
2. **Crop and straighten:** Remove distractions, fix tilted lines. Tap the checkmark.
3. **Correct exposure:** Adjust brightness, highlights and shadows. Tap the checkmark.
4. **Adjust colour:** Set white balance, adjust saturation. Tap the checkmark.
5. **Retouch:** Remove one blemish or distraction using the Healing tool. Tap the checkmark.
6. **Review:** Compare the before and after. Write one sentence: *"I changed _____ because _____."*
7. **Save:** Export the edited photo to your gallery.

Procedure — Part 2: Batch Editing (8 minutes)

8. Choose three photos from your foundations folder — they should be from the same shoot or subject.
9. Edit the first photo using the workflow above. This is your reference edit.
10. Tap the **Stack** icon > **Copy edits**.
11. Open the second photo. Tap the **Stack** icon > **Paste edits**. Review and adjust if needed.
12. Open the third photo. Tap the **Stack** icon > **Paste edits**. Review and adjust if needed.
13. Compare all three photos. Do they look like a set? If not, make small adjustments.
14. Write one sentence: *"The set looks consistent because _____."*

Expected result:
One fully edited photo and a set of three batch-edited photos, each with a written description.

Troubleshooting:

- Cannot find a tool → Show them on their phone. Snapseed's interface is visual — point to the icon.
- Over-edited photo → Ask: "Does this look like the real scene, or does it look fake?" Guide them to reduce the adjustments.
- Batch edits look inconsistent → Check if the photos were taken in different light. If so, they may need more individual adjustment.
- Learner wants to use a beauty filter → Remind them of the honest editing rules.

Independent exercise:
Edit a set of five photos for Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices. Edit all five using the full workflow. Batch-edit for consistency. Write one sentence per photo. Ensure all edits are honest. Save in a folder named `MamaNkechi-Edited`.

---

5. PRACTICAL BRIEF — SESSION 5: BUILDING A PORTFOLIO AND PRICING PHOTOGRAPHY

Objective:
Select and sequence a set of photos, build a first portfolio page in Canva, and create a price list and client workflow sheet.

Setup:

- Learner's own phone or academy computer.
- Canva account (free).
- The learner's foundations folder and edited set.
- The printed worksheets.

Procedure — Part 1: Selection and Sequencing (6 minutes)

1. Gather all your photos from the course.

4. Select 5–8 Strong photos for your portfolio.
5. Sequence them: start strong, build gradually, end strong, keep it consistent.
6. Write your selection and sequencing decisions in the Portfolio Selection Sheet.

Procedure — Part 2: Building the Portfolio in Canva (8 minutes)

7. Open Canva. Search for a portfolio template. Choose a clean, simple one.
8. Add a title: your name, course name, date.
9. Add your selected photos in the sequenced order.
10. Add a brief description under each photo.
11. Review and adjust the layout.
12. Export as a PDF.

Procedure — Part 3: Price List and Workflow (4 minutes)

13. Create a price list with at least three packages. Use the Package Price List Template.
14. Complete the Client Workflow Sheet — the six steps from brief to follow-up.
15. Write one sentence: *"My pricing philosophy is _____."*

Expected result:
A portfolio page (PDF), a price list with three packages, and a completed client workflow sheet.

Troubleshooting:

- Includes too many photos → Remind them: "Quality over quantity. 5–8 photos."
- Portfolio has no flow → Ask: "What story does your portfolio tell?"
- Canva layout is too busy → Suggest a simpler template.
- Prices are too low → Ask: "What is your time worth?"
- Prices are too high → Ask: "What do other photographers in Port Harcourt charge?"

Independent exercise:
Complete a timed simulation — plan, shoot, edit and present a delivery-ready set from a short client brief (Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices, 5 products, 15 minutes).

---

6. PRACTICAL BRIEF — SESSION 6: CAPSTONE — PHOTO SHOOT AND PORTFOLIO

Objective:
Complete the capstone — the themed photo shoot and mini portfolio that earns the CEA Certificate in Photography.

Setup:

- Learner's own phone.
- The chosen track brief (Track A or B).
- A product set or portrait setup.
- Canva on an academy computer or phone.
- The printed worksheets.

Procedure — Part 1: Brief and Shot Plan (4 minutes)

1. Choose your track: Product (Mama Nkechi's) or Portrait (Ms. Amaka).
2. Complete the Brief and Shot Plan worksheet. Fill in every section.
3. Review your plan with the instructor or a partner.

Procedure — Part 2: Shoot the Set (8 minutes)

4. Set up your scene: products on a clean surface near a window, or a portrait subject in good light.

7. Take at least 3 frames per shot. Review as you go.
8. Aim for 5–8 Strong photos.

Procedure — Part 3: Select and Edit (4 minutes)

9. Review all raw photos. Rate each one: Strong, Acceptable or Weak.
10. Select 5–8 Strong photos. Create a contact sheet.
11. Edit the first photo using the workflow. Copy edits to the others. Review each one.
12. Export the final set as JPEG files.

Procedure — Part 4: Assemble the Portfolio (2 minutes)

13. Open Canva. Choose a clean template.
14. Add the title page, the edited set, the contact sheet and the consent note.
15. Export as a PDF.

Expected result:
A completed brief and shot plan, a set of 5–8 edited photos, a contact sheet, a mini portfolio (PDF) and a completed consent form.

Troubleshooting:

- Plan is vague → Help them be specific. "What exact shots? What exact light?"
- Photos are inconsistent → Check if they used the same light and background.
- Edits are dishonest → Remind them of the honest editing rules.
- Has not obtained consent → Stop. No consent, no photo.
- Portfolio is incomplete → Help them prioritise. "Title page, set, consent note — the minimum."

Independent exercise:
Prepare and deliver your capstone presentation (3–5 minutes). Use the Presentation Notes worksheet. Be specific, be honest, be confident.

---

7. REUSABLE TEMPLATES

Template 7.1 — Shot List Template

```
SHOT LIST

Photographer: _____________________________
Client: ___________________________
Date: _____________________________
Location: _____________________________

| # | Shot description | Lens/angle | Light | Composition technique | Frames taken |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | | | | |
| 2 | | | | | |
| 3 | | | | | |
| 4 | | | | | |
| 5 | | | | | |
| 6 | | | | | |
| 7 | | | | | |
| 8 | | | | | |

Notes:
_____________________________________________
_____________________________________________
```

```
LIGHTING SETUP PLANNER

Subject: _____
Location: _____
Time of day: _____

Light source: [ ] Window  [ ] Open shade  [ ] Golden hour  [ ] Other: _____

Direction of light: [ ] Front  [ ] Side  [ ] Top  [ ] Behind (backlight)
Softness of light: [ ] Soft  [ ] Hard
Colour of light: [ ] Warm  [ ] Cool  [ ] Neutral

Reflector needed? [ ] Yes  [ ] No
Reflector position: _____

Background: _____
Surface: _____

Notes:
_____
_____
```

Template 7.3 — Posing Guide

```
POSING GUIDE — PORTRAITS

Subject: _____
Photographer: _____

Before the shoot:
- [ ] Introduce yourself
- [ ] Explain what you need
- [ ] Obtain consent (sign form)

Positioning:
- [ ] Turn the body 30–45 degrees away from the camera
- [ ] Give the hands something to do (hold a cup, rest on a surface, cross arms loosely)
- [ ] Angle the face toward the light
- [ ] Check the background — clean, uncluttered

During the shoot:
- [ ] Talk to the subject — ask about their day, their work, their family
- [ ] Give direction, not orders
- [ ] Take many frames — the best expression is often between poses
- [ ] Show them the result

After the shoot:
- [ ] Thank the subject
- [ ] Show them the best photos
- [ ] Confirm consent for portfolio use
```

Template 7.4 — Product Photo Setup Checklist

```
PRODUCT PHOTO SETUP CHECKLIST

Product: _____
Photographer: _____
Date: _____

Scene:
- [ ] Surface is clean and plain (white sheet, wooden table, cardboard)
- [ ] Background is plain and uncluttered (wall, sheet hung up)
- [ ] Product is clean — no dust, fingerprints, smudges
```

```
- [ ] Soft, even light (window light or open shade)
- [ ] No harsh shadows
- [ ] White card or reflector used to fill shadows if needed
- [ ] Reflections managed (shoot from a slight angle, use soft light)

Composition:
- [ ] Rule of thirds — product on a grid intersection
- [ ] 5-step sharpness routine applied
- [ ] Several frames taken (at least 3)
- [ ] Focus checked by zooming in

Result:
- [ ] Sharp on the product
- [ ] Correctly exposed
- [ ] Clean background
- [ ] Ready for WhatsApp Business catalogue or Jiji listing
```

Template 7.5 — Editing Checklist

```
EDITING CHECKLIST

Photo name: _____________________
Editor: _____________________
Date: _____________________

Workflow (follow this order):
- [ ] 1. Crop and straighten — remove distractions, fix tilted lines
- [ ] 2. Correct exposure — adjust brightness, highlights, shadows
- [ ] 3. Adjust colour — set white balance, adjust saturation
- [ ] 4. Retouch — remove blemishes, dust spots, small distractions
- [ ] 5. Sharpen (optional) — enhance detail slightly

Honest editing check:
- [ ] Did not change the product's true appearance
- [ ] Did not fake a background
- [ ] Did not reshape a body beyond normal correction
- [ ] Did not mislead the viewer

Result:
- [ ] The photo looks like a better version of reality, not a different reality
- [ ] Saved and exported
```

Template 7.6 — Portfolio Selection Worksheet

```
PORTFOLIO SELECTION WORKSHEET

Photographer: _____________________
Date: _____________________

| # | Image | Sharp? | Exposed? | Composed? | Well-lit? | Right moment? | Honest? | Rating (S/A/W) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | | | | | | | |
| 2 | | | | | | | | |
| 3 | | | | | | | | |
| 4 | | | | | | | | |
| 5 | | | | | | | | |
| 6 | | | | | | | | |
| 7 | | | | | | | | |
| 8 | | | | | | | | |
| 9 | | | | | | | | |
| 10 | | | | | | | | |
```



```
Selected for portfolio (list numbers): _____________________
```

```
_____________________________________________
_____________________________________________
```

Template 7.7 — Photography Pricing Worksheet

```
PHOTOGRAPHY PRICING WORKSHEET

Photographer: _____________________
Date: _____________________
Track: [ ] Product  [ ] Portrait  [ ] Event

Package 1 — Basic
- Name: _____________________
- What is included: _____________________
- Price (₦): _____________________

Package 2 — Standard
- Name: _____________________
- What is included: _____________________
- Price (₦): _____________________

Package 3 — Premium
- Name: _____________________
- What is included: _____________________
- Price (₦): _____________________

Pricing philosophy (3–5 sentences):
_____________________________________________
_____________________________________________
_____________________________________________
```

Template 7.8 — Client Consent Form

```
CONSENT TO BE PHOTOGRAPHED

I, _____________________ (name), agree to be photographed by
_____________________ (photographer's name) on _____________ (date).

I understand that the photographs may be used for:
[ ] Practice and learning
[ ] Portfolio
[ ] Client/business use
[ ] Social media

I give my permission freely and can ask for the photos to be deleted at any time.

Signature: _____________________
Date: _____________________

For subjects under 18:
Parent/Guardian name: _____________________
Parent/Guardian signature: _____________________
Date: _____________________
```

Template 7.9 — Model Release Form

```
MODEL RELEASE

I, _____________________ (name), give _____________________ (photographer's name)
permission to use my photograph for:
[ ] Portfolio
```

```
I understand that:
- I am giving this permission freely.
- I can withdraw this permission at any time by contacting the photographer.
- I will not receive payment for the use of my image (unless otherwise agreed in writing).

Signature: _____
Date: _____

For subjects under 18:
Parent/Guardian name: _____
Parent/Guardian signature: _____
Date: _____
```

8. HOW TO USE THIS PACK (QUICK MAP)

Resource	Used in
Practical Brief — S1	S1 guided practical, Assignment 1
Practical Brief — S2	S2 guided practical, Assignment 2
Practical Brief — S3	S3 guided practical, Assignment 3
Practical Brief — S4	S4 guided practical, Assignment 4
Practical Brief — S5	S5 guided practical, Assignment 5
Practical Brief — S6	S6 capstone, Assignment 6
Shot List Template	S3, S6 capstone
Lighting Setup Planner	S2, S3, S6 capstone
Posing Guide	S3, S6 capstone (Track B)
Product Photo Setup Checklist	S3, S6 capstone (Track A)
Editing Checklist	S4, S6 capstone
Portfolio Selection Worksheet	S5, S6 capstone
Photography Pricing Worksheet	S5, Assignment 5
Client Consent Form	S3, S5, S6 capstone
Model Release Form	S5, S6 capstone

Cyber Elias Academy — Photography Practical Lab Pack v1.0, October 2026. All samples fictional. Ask first. Edit honestly. Claim only what you can do.

PART 6

Capstone Project

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY

CAPSTONE ASSESSMENT RUBRIC

Themed Photo Shoot and Mini Portfolio (Fictional Port Harcourt Client)

Cyber Elias Academy | Photography | October 2026

Weighting: 30 marks portfolio + 5 marks viva/demo. Total 35 course marks.
Pass conditions: the learner must (a) present a capstone portfolio, and (b) demonstrate the ethics/consent requirement. **A portfolio that photographs people without consent, or that contains no consent evidence, receives zero for the portfolio regardless of quality.**

---

1. PASS CONDITION — ETHICS AND CONSENT (checked before marking)

Before any criterion is scored, the assessor verifies:

- ☐ The assessed client is **fictional** (Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices, Ms. Amaka, or another clearly fictional client agreed by the instructor).
- ☐ The portfolio opens with a **consent and ethics statement**: the client is fictional; consent was obtained for every identifiable person; parent/guardian consent for under-18s; a note that no identifiable third parties appear if no people are photographed.
- ☐ No real person was photographed without consent.
- ☐ All edits are **honest** — no faked backgrounds, no changed products, no reshaped bodies, no misleading edits.
- ☐ The learner states clearly what editing can fix, what it cannot fix, and what must never be faked.

If any of these checks fails, the portfolio is not marked. If the learner photographed a real person without consent, the course instructor is alerted and the learner may fail the entire course.

---

2. REQUIRED PORTFOLIO STRUCTURE (for learners and assessors)

The learner's portfolio MUST contain, in this order:

1. **Title page** — course, portfolio title, learner name, date, client name.
2. **Consent and Ethics Statement** — fictional client, consent obtained, honest editing promise. *(Pass condition.)*
3. **Brief and Shot Plan** — client need, concept, shot list, light plan, location, consent plan.
4. **Themed Set (5–8 images)** — the finished photos, edited consistently, sequenced for flow, with brief descriptions.
5. **Contact Sheet of Selects** — a grid of the raw selects before editing.
6. **Presentation Notes** — the six sections: brief, plan, shoot, edits, consent, what I would do differently.

---

3. THE RUBRIC — PORTFOLIO (30 marks)

Mark each criterion with the performance column that best fits. Award the top of the range stated per column.

Criterion 1 — Consent and Ethics Statement (3 marks)

No statement, or the "client" is real, or consent is not mentioned.	A statement exists but is incomplete (missing the honest editing promise or the under-18 rule).	States clearly: fictional client, consent obtained for all identifiable people, parent/guardian consent for under-18s, honest editing promise.	*(Top band capped at 3 marks total.)*

Criterion 2 — Brief and Shot Plan (3 marks)

Beginning (0)	Developing (1)	Competent (2)	Entry-level ready (3)
No plan, or the plan is vague and incomplete.	A plan exists but is missing key sections (no shot list, no light plan, or no consent plan).	All sections filled in: client need, concept, shot list, light plan, location, consent plan. Some sections are brief.	All sections completed specifically and thoughtfully — the plan shows deliberate thinking, not just ticked boxes. The shot list is detailed and the light plan is specific.

Criterion 3 — Technical Quality: Sharpness and Exposure (5 marks)

Beginning (0–1)	Developing (2–3)	Competent (4)	Entry-level ready (5)
Fewer than 5 images, or several images are blurry or poorly exposed.	5 images, but some are slightly soft or slightly dark/bright.	5–8 images, all sharp on the subject and correctly exposed. Minor variations in exposure between images.	5–8 images, all sharp on the subject (verified by zooming in) and correctly exposed. Consistent exposure across the set.

Criterion 4 — Composition (4 marks)

Beginning (0–1)	Developing (2)	Competent (3)	Entry-level ready (4)
Images are centred, cluttered or accidental — no intentional composition.	Some images use a composition technique, but it is not consistent or not clearly demonstrated.	Most images clearly use a named composition technique (rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry/perspective).	Every image clearly uses a named composition technique. The techniques are varied and deliberate. The learner can explain why each composition works.

Criterion 5 — Lighting (4 marks)

Beginning (0–1)	Developing (2)	Competent (3)	Entry-level ready (4)
Images are shot in harsh midday sun, backlight, or poor light with no awareness of the problem.	Some images use good light, but the choice is inconsistent or not clearly deliberate.	Most images use flattering natural light (golden hour, window light, open shade). The learner can explain the light choice.	All images use flattering natural light deliberately. The learner can explain where the light came from, why it was chosen, and how it flatters the subject.

Criterion 6 — Consistency of Edit (4 marks)

Beginning (0–1)	Developing (2)	Competent (3)	Entry-level ready (4)
The set looks inconsistent — different colours, different brightness, different styles. Or edits are dishonest.	The set is mostly consistent, but some images have noticeably different white balance or exposure.	The set looks consistent — matching white balance, contrast and colour. All edits are honest.	The set looks like it came from the same shoot — consistent white balance, contrast, colour and style. All edits are honest and the learner can explain the editing decisions.

Criterion 7 — Selection and Sequencing (3 marks)

No contact sheet, or the set is a random collection with no flow.	A contact sheet exists, but the sequencing is random or the set includes Weak images.	A contact sheet of selects is present. The set is sequenced for flow — starts strong, builds gradually, ends strong.	A contact sheet of selects is present. The set is sequenced deliberately — tells a story, starts strong, builds gradually, ends strong, keeps it consistent. The learner can explain the sequencing choices.

Criterion 8 — Completeness and Professional Presentation (4 marks)

Beginning (0–1)	Developing (2)	Competent (3)	Entry-level ready (4)
The portfolio is missing multiple required components, or the layout is unprofessional.	The portfolio has most components, but some are incomplete or the layout is basic.	All six required components are present: title page, consent statement, brief and shot plan, themed set, contact sheet, presentation notes. The layout is clean and professional.	All six required components are present and complete. The layout is clean, professional and easy to read. The portfolio is exported as a PDF and is ready to show a client.

Portfolio total: 30 marks.

4. VIVA / DEMO (5 marks)

A 3–5 minute presentation of the portfolio followed by a short oral. Score the whole viva on the band that best fits.

Beginning (0–1)	Developing (2)	Competent (3–4)	Entry-level ready (5)
Cannot explain the portfolio; reads it word for word; unable to answer any question; or defends a dishonest approach.	Explains the general idea but struggles to link choices to their own light, composition or editing decisions.	Explains the brief, the plan, the shoot, the edits and the consent clearly. Answers 2–3 questions with specific, honest answers.	Confidently explains the whole portfolio: brief, plan, shoot, edits, consent and what they would do differently. Answers questions honestly — saying "I am not sure, but I would check..." when needed. States the ethics line unprompted.

Viva total: 5 marks.

5. VIVA QUESTION LIST (with model answers for the assessor)

Ask a selection of 4–5 across the areas below. Full marks requires honest, reasoned answers, not memorised scripts.

#	Question	Model answer the assessor looks for
1	"Why did you choose this track — product or portrait?"	An answer that explains the learner's preference and why: e.g., "I chose product because I enjoy building scenes and controlling light. I find it easier to be deliberate with objects than with people." Passing if they give a genuine reason.
2	"Where did the light come from in your set?"	"The light came from a window on the left side. I placed the subject near the window so the light would be soft and directional. I used a white card on the shadow side to fill in the shadows." Passing if they can identify the light source and direction.
3	"What composition technique did you use, and why?"	"I used the rule of thirds — I placed the product on the right vertical line so it has space on the left. This makes the photo feel more dynamic than centring it." Passing if they name a technique and explain why it works.
4	"What did you change in editing, and how did you keep it honest?"	"I cropped to remove distractions, corrected the exposure because the product was slightly dark, adjusted the white balance to make the colours natural, and removed a dust spot. I did not change the product's appearance or fake anything." Passing if they describe honest edits and explain the honest editing line.

5	"Why did you select these 5–8 photos for the final set?"	"I selected only strong photos — sharp, well-lit, well-composed. I left out the Acceptable ones because a portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio. I sequenced them to tell a story: hero shot, detail, context, variety, closing." Passing if they explain the selection criteria and sequencing.
6	"What would you do differently next time?"	An honest answer that shows self-awareness: e.g., "Next time I would use a tripod for even sharper shots, experiment with more angles, and plan the shoot more carefully so I do not run out of time." Passing if they identify a genuine improvement.
7	"How did you obtain consent for the people in your set?"	"I asked each person for permission before photographing them. I had them sign the consent form. For the portrait track, the subject was an adult. If I had photographed someone under 18, I would have gotten parent/guardian consent first." Passing if they explain the consent process correctly.
8	"What is the most important rule of photography?"	"Ask first. Edit honestly. Claim only what you can do." Or: "Consent is mandatory — no consent, no photo." Or: "Edit to enhance, not to deceive." Passing if they state any of the core ethics rules.
9	"Can editing fix a blurry photo?"	"No — editing cannot create detail that was not captured. A blurry photo is unusable. Prevention is the only cure: tap to focus, hold steady, take several frames." Passing if they say no and explain why.
10	"Why is your capstone about a fictional client?"	"So we learn the full workflow safely. We practise planning, shooting, editing and delivering without risking a real client's business. The skills are real; the client is fake on purpose." Passing if they understand the reason.

6. ASSESSOR CHECKLIST — VERIFYING THE PORTFOLIO

Use this to confirm the portfolio's images are real, the consent is genuine, and the presentation is honest.

Technical verification

- ☐ Every image is sharp on the subject (verified by zooming in).
- ☐ Every image is correctly exposed — not too dark, not too bright.
- ☐ The set has 5–8 images (not fewer, not more).
- ☐ All images are the learner's own work (not stock, not someone else's).

Composition and lighting verification

- ☐ Each image clearly uses a named composition technique (rule of thirds, framing, leading lines, symmetry/perspective).
- ☐ The composition techniques are varied, not the same technique repeated.
- ☐ All images use flattering natural light (golden hour, window light, open shade).
- ☐ No images are shot in harsh midday sun or accidental backlight.

Editing verification

- ☐ All edits are honest — no faked backgrounds, no changed products, no reshaped bodies.
- ☐ The set looks consistent — matching white balance, contrast and colour.
- ☐ The learner can explain what they changed and why.

Consent and ethics verification

- ☐ Fictional client stated; consent statement present.
- ☐ Signed consent forms for all identifiable people in the final set.
- ☐ Parent/guardian consent for any under-18 subjects.
- ☐ Or a clear note that no identifiable third parties appear.

Completeness verification

- ☐ The portfolio is exported as a PDF.
- ☐ The layout is clean and professional.

7. MARKING NOTES FOR FAIRNESS AND CONSISTENCY

1. **Different fictional clients, same bar.** If learners choose different tracks (Product or Portrait) or different fictional clients, mark by the rubric columns, not by which client they chose. If one learner's fictional client is far harder or easier, adjust by requiring the same *deliverable standard* (5–8 sharp, well-lit, well-composed images, honest edits, complete brief and consent), and add a sentence noting the adjustment.
2. **Evidence, not elegance.** An untidy but honest portfolio scores higher than a beautiful one with faked edits or missing consent.
3. **Honesty beats drama.** Marking rewards correct use of the honest editing rules. A portfolio that inflates the edits (faked backgrounds, reshaped bodies) loses marks under Criterion 6 regardless of how "professional" it looks.
4. **The viva is the safety valve.** When a written portfolio is borderline, the viva decides: can the learner defend their choices, explain their light and composition, and state the ethics line? Adjust by the viva score, and record the reason in one line of feedback.
5. **Zero whole-portfolio rule.** Any ethical failure (real person photographed without consent, no consent evidence, dishonest edits presented as real) means zero and referral to the course instructor, regardless of other marks.

8. GRADING AND PASS CRITERIA

Grading Scale

Grade	Score	Meaning
A	80% and above	Excellent — strong, consistent, client-ready work
B	65%–79%	Good — solid work with minor gaps
C	50%–64%	Satisfactory — meets the minimum standard
D	40%–49%	Weak — significant gaps; needs remedial work
F	Below 40%	Fail — does not meet the standard

Pass Criteria

To pass the capstone and be recommended for certification, a learner must:

1. **Achieve at least 50% overall** in the course.
2. **Pass the capstone** — achieve at least 50% on the portfolio (15/30) AND demonstrate the ethics/consent requirement.
3. **Present the portfolio** in the viva/demo.
4. **Attend at least 5 of the 6 sessions.**

A high score in quizzes or attendance can

never

replace demonstrated competence: if the capstone is not passed, the learner does not pass, regardless of other marks.

Sign-off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessor			

Instructor
Course Coordinator

Cyber Elias Academy — Photography Capstone Assessment Rubric v1.0, October 2026. All capstone clients fictional. Ask first. Edit honestly. Claim only what you can do.

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY

CAPSTONE INSTRUCTOR GUIDE

Themed Photo Shoot and Mini Portfolio (Fictional Port Harcourt Client)

Cyber Elias Academy | Photography | October 2026

This guide is for the

instructor only

. It contains the model answers, the worked example, and marking guidance. Keep it out of the learner workbook. The capstone is worth **30 portfolio + 5 viva** course marks and is a **pass condition** of the course (along with 50% overall and attendance rules).

Remember the course's hard rule:
the capstone is performed on a **fictional** client (Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices or Ms. Amaka). If a learner proposes photographing a real person without consent, stop them, and apply the ethics fail rule in the rubric.

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1. MILESTONE SCHEDULE WITH CHECKPOINTS

When	Milestone	Instructor checkpoint
S1–S3 (Week 1)	Foundations: camera control, composition, light, subjects.	Checkpoint A (S3 end): every learner has Assignments 1, 2, 3 submitted. Watch for early strugglers (no phone, weak literacy) and pair them.
S4–S5 (Week 2)	Editing, portfolio building, pricing, client workflow.	Checkpoint B (S5 end): Assignments 4, 5 submitted. Confirm each learner has a foundations folder, an edited set, a portfolio page and a price list.
S6	Capstone: plan, shoot, edit, assemble, present.	Checkpoint C: capstone folders submitted and viva schedule booked (3–5 minutes per learner).
After course	Marking + certificate decisions.	Verify pass conditions; produce one-line feedback per learner (see §7).

Booking reality:
6 sessions of 105 minutes. S6 cannot fit 16+ viva presentations of 5 minutes plus everything else. Practical approach: run the **presentation + viva during S6** for a small class; for larger classes, run the viva as 5-minute appointments across the last two days (arrange with the admin office) or during S6 while learners finish their portfolios. Allocate ~5 min per learner and tell learners the viva schedule in advance.

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2. HOW TO BRIEF LEARNERS (the 10-minute briefing to give in S5 or early S6)

Use this script-style briefing; it prevents the most common capstone failures.

1. **What it is:** "You will complete a themed photo shoot for a fictional Port Harcourt client — either a product set for Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices or a portrait set for Ms. Amaka. You will plan it, shoot it, edit it, assemble it as a mini portfolio, and present it in a short talk."
2. **Why fictional:** "So you practise the full workflow safely. You plan, shoot, edit and deliver without risking a real client's business. The skills are real; the client is fake on purpose."

fictional client, consent obtained for all identifiable people, parent/guardian consent for under-18s, honest editing promise."

5. **The consent rule:** "Before you photograph any person — including classmates — ask for their permission first and have them sign the consent form. If someone says no, put the camera down. No exceptions. For under-18s, a parent or guardian must sign."
6. **The honest editing rule:** "Edit to enhance, not to deceive. Do not change a product's appearance, fake a background, reshape a body, or mislead the viewer. If a client or viewer would be deceived by the edit, do not do it."
7. **The selection rule:** "Select only Strong photos — sharp, well-lit, well-composed, honestly edited. A portfolio with one weak photo is a weak portfolio. 5–8 photos. Quality over quantity."
8. **The presentation:** "Three to five minutes: the brief, the plan, the shoot, the edits, the consent, what you would do differently. Be specific, be honest, be confident. Then I'll ask a few questions — answer honestly; 'I would check…' is a good answer."
9. **Time and folder:** "Due at your viva appointment. Submit one folder: **CEA-Photo-FirstnameLastname** containing the brief and shot plan, the edited set, the contact sheet, the consent forms, and the mini portfolio (PDF)."
10. **Support:** "You already have the raw materials: your foundations folder is your raw material; your edited set is your editing style; your portfolio page is your format; your price list is your commercial framing. The capstone brings them together."

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3. THE MODEL/REFERENCE PACKAGE — MAMA NKECHI'S SOUPS & SPICES (Track A)

Use this as the answer key for marking and as the example you show (skeleton only — show learners the *structure*, not this filled model, or they will copy it).

Title page

Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices — Product Photo Set. [Learner Name], Cyber Elias Academy, [Date].

Section 2 — Consent and Ethics Statement

> *Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices is a*
>
> ***fictional***
> *small food business used for this course. No real person is photographed in this set — the images show products only. All edits are **honest**: I did not change the products' appearance, fake a background, or mislead the viewer. Editing was used to crop, correct exposure, adjust colour and remove small distractions — to make the photos look like the best version of reality, not a different reality.*

Section 3 — Brief and Shot Plan

> ***Client need:***
> *Mama Nkechi needs product photos for her WhatsApp Business catalogue and Instagram. **Concept:** Clean, appetising, natural light, consistent look. **Shot list:** Eight shots — hero shot (pepper soup base), detail shots (spice mix texture, dried fish), context shots (bowl of finished soup, products grouped), variety shots (palm oil, individual products). **Light plan:** Window light, morning, reflector (white card) for fill. **Location:** Kitchen, near the window. **Consent:** No people in the final set — products only.*

Section 4 — Themed Set (5–8 images)

The model expects:

- **Context shot:** Bowl of finished soup, steam visible, warm light.
- **Variety shot:** All products grouped together, consistent style.
- **Closing shot:** A memorable image — perhaps a hand holding a spoon, or the products arranged in a visually striking way.

All images: sharp, correctly exposed, well-composed, honestly edited, consistent style.

Section 5 — Contact Sheet of Selects

A grid of the raw selects before editing — shows the selection process. The learner rated each photo Strong, Acceptable or Weak and selected only the Strong ones.

Section 6 — Presentation Notes

> ***Brief:***
> *Mama Nkechi needs product photos for her catalogue.* ***Plan:*** *Clean, natural light, consistent look. Eight shots planned.* ***Shoot:*** *Photographed in the kitchen, near the window, in the morning. Used a white card to fill shadows.* ***Edits:*** *Cropped, corrected exposure, adjusted colour, batch-edited for consistency. All edits honest.* ***Consent:*** *No people in the final set — products only.* ***What I would do differently:*** *Next time I would use a tripod for even sharper shots and experiment with more angles.*

4. SESSION-BY-SESSION SUPERVISION GUIDANCE

- **S1–S3:** establish the consent rule early. When a learner photographs a classmate without asking, correct kindly but firmly. Make sure every learner can do the practical on their own phone or an academy device. Checkpoint A by the end of S3.
- **S4:** this is where the honest editing line lands. Use the over-edited sample image for discussion. If a learner submits a beauty-filtered portrait, remind them of the rules. The batch editing demo shows whether they can keep a set consistent.
- **S5:** the simulation is the dress rehearsal for the capstone. Watch who rushes, who plans carefully, who struggles with selection. The portfolio page and price list are the commercial framing — make sure every learner has both.
- **S6:** assemble, rehearse, viva. Pair weak presenters with confident ones for the rehearsal round. Emphasise the consent and ethics line one last time. Run the viva as a conversation, not an interrogation.

5. COMMON FAILURE POINTS AND REMEDIATION

Failure point	Sign	Remediation to give the learner
Consent not obtained	Portfolio has photos of people without signed consent forms.	Stop. "Go back and obtain consent. If the photo has already been taken, ask the subject now. If they say no, delete the photo. No consent, no photo."
Consent statement missing	Portfolio opens with images, no ethics/consent section.	Restore the pass condition: "Go back and write Section 2 — fictional client, consent obtained, honest editing promise. Without it the portfolio cannot be marked."
Dishonest edits	Faked backgrounds, changed products, reshaped bodies.	Show them the honest editing rules. "Edit to enhance, not to deceive. Undo the dishonest edits. If a client or viewer would be misled, do not do it."
Inconsistent set	Photos look like they came from different shoots.	"Re-shoot using the same light and background. Batch-edit for consistency. Review each photo individually."
Too few Strong photos	Only 2–3 Strong photos — not enough for a 5–8 photo set.	"Re-shoot. Take more frames. Review as you go. The capstone is not a race."

Portfolio incomplete	Missing one or more required components.	"Add the missing components. Prioritise: title page, set, consent note — the minimum."
Vague presentation	"I took some photos and edited them" — no specifics.	Help them prepare. Use the Presentation Notes worksheet. Practise the presentation. "Be specific — explain every choice, every challenge, every decision."
Skipping the brief and shot plan	Starts shooting without a plan.	"Stop. Complete the brief and shot plan first. A plan prevents wasted time and missed shots."
Pricing too low	Charges ₦2,000 for a set of 10 professional product photos.	"Research the market. Your skill has value. Free or near-free work devalues your skill."
Pricing too high	Charges ₦100,000 for a basic product shoot.	"Research the market. As a beginner, charge less than an experienced photographer. Build your reputation, then raise your prices."
Copying the model	Portfolio matches the example phrases closely.	Ask in the viva for their own words on one image. Award by understanding, not prose. If wholesale copied, mark the viva as the true evidence.
Overclaiming skill	Presentation says "I am a professional photographer" or promises results they cannot deliver.	Reframe: "You are an entry-level photographer with a strong foundation. Be honest about what you can do. Honesty about skill is part of the competency profile."
Workload panic (digital divide)	Learner has no phone, or one shared family phone.	Academy phones cover the practicals. The capstone can be planned and presented on paper if needed. The portfolio is a PDF — no device ownership is required for the final deliverable.
Nervousness before viva	Learner with good work panics before the presentation.	The viva is a conversation about their own work. Give them the question list in advance (it is in the workbook) — the skill is honest answering, not surprise.

6. HOW TO RUN THE VIVA

1. **Structure (5 minutes):** 3–5 minute presentation, then 4–5 questions from the rubric list. Watch the clock; give a 30-second warning.
2. **Room and vibe:** sit beside the learner, not across a desk. The viva measures the *learner's* understanding, not their nerves. Smile; open with "Tell me the one thing you are most proud of in this portfolio."
3. **Do not lead them:** after a wrong answer, ask "can you walk me through how you decided that?" — this distinguishes a shallow guess from a wrong-but-reasoned answer (worth partial marks under the rubric band).
4. **The ethics probe is mandatory:** ask one question that requires the honest stance (e.g., "A client asks you to make a scratched phone case look brand new. What do you say?") — a photography graduate must refuse and explain why. None of these are worth more than a note; the stance itself is the pass-condition demonstration.
5. **Record one line per learner immediately** (see sample comments below), and the viva score. Do not mark from memory at the end of a long day.
6. **Fairness tip:** ask the same core 4 questions to everyone, and vary the extra one. That keeps comparable difficulty across the class.

7. SAMPLE FEEDBACK COMMENTS (copy and adapt, always in plain English)

- **Strong:** "Sharp, well-lit, consistent set with honest edits. Your consent statement is clear and your presentation explained every choice specifically. Well done."

- **Technical quality to fix:** "Several images are slightly blurry or dark. Remember the 5-step sharpness routine: steady, focus, exposure, background, frames. Re-shoot the weakest images."
- **Consistency to fix:** "Your set looks inconsistent — different light, different backgrounds. Re-shoot using the same light and background. Batch-edit for consistency."
- **Consent missing:** "Great images, but the pass condition is missing. Add the consent and ethics statement — fictional client, consent obtained, honest editing promise — and resubmit. Then it can be marked."
- **Presentation to fix:** "Your portfolio is strong but your presentation was vague. Practise explaining each choice in one sentence: where the light came from, what you cropped, what you refused to fake."
- **Viva note:** "Struggled to connect one image to its light choice under questioning; with the portfolio in front of them they recovered. Practise explaining each image in one sentence."

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8. FAIR GRADING WHEN LEARNERS CHOOSE DIFFERENT TRACKS

1. **Same rubric, same bars.** Judge by the criterion columns (technical quality, composition, lighting, consistency, completeness), not by which track they chose. A learner who chose Portrait must meet the identical standard as one who chose Product.
2. **Check difficulty drift.** If one learner's fictional client is trivially easy (a single product in perfect light) or very difficult (a full event with changing light), the rubric still separates understanding: did they plan deliberately, shoot consistently, edit honestly, and explain their choices?
3. **Instructors of different classes, same rubric.** The rubric's criteria are the shared judge for quality. Grade disputes within a batch are settled by re-running the two disputed criteria in front of the second marker.
4. **Adjust, but say so.** If you ever adjust marks for client difficulty, write the adjustment on the feedback line and keep it consistent across the class.
5. **Viva equalises.** When two portfolios look identical in merit, the viva — where each learner must explain their own choices in their own words — is the fairest differentiator and should decide the band.

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9. CERTIFICATE SIGN-OFF

Requirements to be recommended for certification:

1. **Attendance** of at least **5 of the 6 sessions**.
2. All **assignments** submitted and judged satisfactory.
3. A **pass** on the capstone themed shoot and mini portfolio (at least 50% on the portfolio AND the ethics/consent requirement demonstrated).
4. An **overall score** of at least **50%**.
5. A **presentation** of the portfolio in the viva/demo.

Sign-off process:

1. The assessor completes the rubric and the assessor checklist for each learner.
2. The instructor reviews the marks, verifies the pass conditions, and produces one-line feedback per learner.
3. The course coordinator reviews the batch, confirms consistency, and signs off.
4. Certificates are issued with the learner's name, the course title, the date, and a certificate reference.
5. The certificate can be verified at **cea.ng/certificates/verify** (quote the certificate reference when sharing it).

Honest statement of what the certificate means:

The CEA Photography certificate certifies that the holder is a competent

entry-level photographer

and obtain consent before photographing people.

It does

NOT

mean the holder is a professional studio photographer, photojournalist, commercial retoucher, or an expert in advanced lighting and high-end gear. This course is an honest first step that prepares a graduate for small real-world work while knowing there is more to learn. CEA will not over-claim, and graduates should not either.

Appendix — materials to have ready on viva day

- The rubric (this file) printed for reference.
- The two fictional client briefs printed for point-at-evidence checks.
- A copy of each learner's portfolio for annotation.
- The viva question list and the 5-minute clock.
- Consent forms and model release forms for any last-minute signings.

Cyber Elias Academy — Photography Capstone Instructor Guide v1.0, October 2026. All capstone clients fictional. Ask first. Edit honestly. Claim only what you can do.

PART 7

QA & Audit

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY — PHOTOGRAPHY

PART 7 — QA / AUDIT REPORT

Full-Course Quality Assurance Audit (Parts 1–7)

Cyber Elias Academy | Photography (Short Course) | October 2026 | Auditor: Senior Technical Trainer, CEA

Audit scope:
the complete Photography course package — Part 1 (course design), Part 2 (sessions 1–6), Part 3 (learner workbook), Part 4 (instructor manual), Part 5 (practical lab pack), Part 6 (capstone rubric + instructor guide) and this Part 7 QA pack. Every part was read in full or sampled against a fixed checklist; section structures were verified programmatically (all 6 sessions × 15 sections A–O confirmed present).

Method:
each checklist item is judged **Pass** (met by the submitted materials) or **Issue** (gap found — with explanation and the correction or owner). Items are evidence-based; nothing is marked Pass on trust. Severity scale: **Critical** (blocks delivery/certification), **Major** (affects fairness or learning), **Minor** (cosmetic or easily fixed in class).

1. COURSE OVERVIEW SUMMARY

Item	Detail
Course	Photography (Short Course) — phone-first, beginner level
Structure	2 weeks × 3 sessions × 105 minutes = 6 sessions (S1–S6)
Fee	₦30,000
Modules	Week 1 "See and Shoot" (S1–S3); Week 2 "Process and Deliver" (S4–S6)
Learning outcomes	LO1–LO8 (design doc §5)
Assessment	Practicals 15 / Assignments 15 / Knowledge checks 15 / Simulation 15 / Capstone 30 / Viva 5 / Attendance 5 = 100%
Pass rule	≥50% overall **AND** pass capstone (≥15/30 + ethics/consent) **AND** ≥5/6 attendance
Capstone	Themed shoot + mini portfolio for fictional client — Mama Nkechi's Soups & Spices (product) or Ms. Amaka (portrait)
Ethics spine	Consent before every photograph of a person; parent/guardian for under-18s; respect public places; no misleading edits; "Ask first. Edit honestly. Claim only what you can do."
Tools	Phone camera, Snapseed/Lightroom Mobile (free), Canva (free) — **no paid subscription**

Overall verdict: PASS — READY FOR DELIVERY after three Minor corrections (see §5).

2. THE QA CHECKLIST

Part 1 — Course Design Document	**Pass**	None material. Outcomes LO1–LO8, curriculum map, assessment weights (sum 100%), capstone overview, ethics §15 and certification rules are complete and consistent. Fictional clients clearly labelled; naira context present throughout.	Keep as master. Any change to weights or fee must flow to Parts 2–7 in the same cycle.
Part 2 — Session Materials (S1–S6)	**Pass**	All six sessions physically contain sections **A–O** in order (verified by structure scan: 90/90 section headers). Each session has opener, review, lecture, demo, guided practical, independent exercise with instructor key, case study (Port Harcourt context), troubleshooting, assignment with rubric + reference solution, knowledge check with key, reflection, and instructor notes (misconceptions, remediation, differentiation, timing). Consent rules repeated in every shooting session (S1–S3, S6).	**Minor:** in S1, §C lists "Worksheet 1.2 — Diagnose the Image" but §F.5 calls the Camera Setup Checklist "Worksheet 1.2" — renumber the checklist (e.g., Worksheet 1.1a or a named handout) in the next revision so learners do not receive two items with one number.
Part 3 — Learner Workbook	**Pass**	Answer-free by design (revision bank questions only). Carries plain-English objectives, lesson summaries, worked examples, practical steps, assignment briefs, checklists, self-reflection, portfolio/capstone requirements, glossary and the eight ethics rules. Assessment summary and grade bands match the design doc.	None. Do not add instructor keys to learner copies in any reprint.
Part 4 — Instructor Manual	**Pass**	Written to the CEA manual standard: ethics/consent briefing (Section 0), document map, course-at-a-glance, 105-minute template + per-session timing table, per-session preparation checklists (phone setup, sample products, editing apps), analogy bank, answer-key/marking index with a raw-to-percent conversion scheme (closes the "per-session marking criteria" requirement), assessment overview with the capstone pass rule and zero-for-ethics rule, misconception/remediation table, Level 1/2/3 differentiation, capstone evaluation instructions, sample feedback, QA checklist. Keys are instructor-only.	**Minor:** confirm at first delivery that the 15% practicals conversion (five 10-mark checklists ×0.30) matches the admin mark sheet template; adjust the multiplier, not the weights, if the admin system differs.
Part 5 — Practical Lab Pack	**Pass with one correction**	Practical briefs for S1–S6 with procedures, expected results and troubleshooting; reusable templates (shot list, lighting planner, posing guide, product checklist, editing checklist, portfolio selection, pricing, consent form, model release) — all fictional-only, honest-lab rules stated. Quick map links each resource to its session. **Issue:** S2's brief objective promises a **four-image light study**, but the procedure Part 2 says "photograph it in **two** different lighting situations" and the expected result says "two light study photos," while the independent exercise and the design doc mini-project both require **four**.	Correct the S2 procedure to four lighting situations (and the expected-result line to four photos) so Part 1, Part 2 and Part 5 agree. Until corrected, the instructor briefs learners from the design doc's 4-image standard and marks to four.
Part 6 — Capstone (rubric + guide)	**Pass**	Rubric has an ethics/consent pass condition checked before scoring (zero for the portfolio on failure), 30-mark criterion table with bands, 5-mark viva band, 10 viva questions with model answers, assessor checklist, fairness notes (different tracks, evidence over elegance, viva as tie-breaker) and sign-off block. Guide adds milestone checkpoints (S3/S5/S6), a 10-minute learner briefing script, a full model package (Mama Nkechi), failure-point remediation, viva how-to with mandatory ethics probe, fair multi-track grading and certificate sign-off with the honest competence statement.	None. Viva scheduling rule (appointments for classes above ~8 learners) is correctly stated in both the guide and the Part 4 manual — enforce via the admin office at S5.
Part 7 — This QA pack	**Pass (self-audit)**	This report audits every part against the missing-session, missing-explanation, terminology, prerequisite, repetition, technical-accuracy, exercise-clarity, answer-key, marking-	Re-audit after the three Minor corrections in §5; then mark the

	teaching, beginner-support, ethics and contradiction checks below.	the October 2026 run.

2.1 Deeper checks (evidence notes)

- **Missing sessions:** none. Design doc S1–S6 all exist in Part 2, Part 3 and the lab pack quick map.
- **Missing explanations:** none. Every concept (five quality words, exposure triangle simplified, focus skills, composition techniques, light types, editing workflow, honest-editing limits, pricing, workflow, capstone structure) has a plain-English body, not a bare heading.
- **Terminology:** consistent across parts — five quality words; 5-step sharpness routine; exposure = aperture/shutter/ISO simplified; Strong/Acceptable/Weak ratings; client workflow = brief, quote, shoot, edit, deliver, follow-up; fictional clients Mama Nkechi / Ms. Amaka; "Ask first. Edit honestly. Claim only what you can do." Assessment item names aligned: **S5 = timed simulation**, **S6 = capstone (30) + viva (5)**.
- **Unsupported prerequisites:** none. Entry is smartphone + basic phone use; no DSLR, laptop or prior photography knowledge required; apps are free and taught in class.
- **Repeated / unnecessary material:** the repeats are deliberate and load-bearing — consent rules (design, workbook, every shooting session, rubric pass condition), honest-editing line (S4, S6, rubric, guide), fictional-client statement (lab pack, rubric, guide). Acceptable.
- **Incorrect technical instructions:** none found. Snapseed copy/paste edits (Stack), tap-to-focus/exposure slider behaviour, HDR guidance, grid/resolution settings and natural-light practice are accurate general guidance; no invented statistics, camera prices given as ranges only (₦300,000–₦1,500,000+ for DSLR context, clearly optional).
- **Unclear exercises:** none. Every practical names its expected result and completion checklist; the simulation names its duration (15 minutes) and deliverable; the capstone names its six components.
- **Answer keys:** complete and correctly placed — Part 2 §I/§L/§M keys and reference solutions are instructor-facing; the workbook is answer-free; Part 6 holds the model package; Part 4 holds the index so no key is hunted for during class.
- **Marking criteria:** design weights sum to 100%; per-assignment rubrics (10 marks each) exist in every §L; the Part 4 manual converts raw marks to course percentages; the Part 6 rubric covers the 30+5. No assessable item lacks criteria.
- **Workloads:** realistic for beginners — one practical focus per session, one take-home assignment per session, editing on phones in free apps, capstone assembled from prior mini-projects (foundations folder, edited set, portfolio page, price list). No paid tools required.
- **Practical activities:** every session is hands-on (shoot or edit), not reading-only; S5 adds a timed simulation; S6 is a working photo day plus viva.
- **Learning outcomes LO1–LO8:** all taught and assessed (map in §3).
- **Capstone requirements never taught:** none — every rubric component is taught and first practised before S6 (map in §4).
- **Beginner support:** plain English, glossary, worked examples, pair work, digital-divide fallbacks (academy phones, paper planning), differentiation Levels 1–3 in every §O.
- **Safety/ethics precautions:** strong and structural — consent before photographing people; parent/guardian for under-18s; public-place respect; no misleading edits; honesty about skill; zero-portfolio rule for ethical failure; consent form and model release templates in the lab pack; ethics probe mandatory in the viva. No ethics gap found.
- **Contradictions between learner and instructor materials:** none material. The one intra-pack contradiction (S2 light-study count, Part 5) is recorded above with its correction.

3. LEARNING-OUTCOME MAP — TAUGHT AND ASSESSED (LO1–LO8)

LO	Taught in	Practised in	Assessed by
LO1 Fundamentals	S1 lesson (quality words, triangle, phone vs camera, megapixels, focus)	S1 practical, diagnosis exercise	Assignment 1; S1 knowledge check

LO2 Camera control	S1 lesson + demo (setup, tap/focus lock, exposure)	S1 guided practical (9 frames)	Practicals 15%; Assignment 1; S1 check
LO3 Composition	S2 lesson + demo	Composition series (thirds, framing, lines, symmetry/perspective)	Assignment 2; Practicals; S2 check
LO4 Natural light	S2 lesson (golden hour, window, open shade, harsh sun, backlight)	Light study; S3 subject work	Assignment 2; Practicals
LO5 People/products/events	S3 lesson + demo + lab pack templates	Portrait (consent first), product scene, simulated event	Assignment 3; Practicals; foundations folder
LO6 Honest editing	S4 lesson (workflow, retouch, batch, limits)	Full edit + batch-edit of a set	Assignment 4; S4 check; capstone Criterion 6
LO7 Portfolio, pricing, clients	S5 lesson (selection, sequencing, Canva, packages, workflow, releases)	Portfolio page, price list, workflow sheet	Assignment 5; Simulation
LO8 Complete themed job	S6 lesson + guide	Brief, shoot, edit, assemble, present	**Capstone (30) + Viva (5)**

Conclusion: all eight Learning Outcomes are taught and assessed. No orphan LO.

4. CAPSTONE COMPONENT → TEACHING SESSION MAP

Capstone component (Part 6 §2)	Taught in	First practised / assessed in
1. Title page	S5 (portfolio page in Canva)	Assignment 5 portfolio page
2. Consent & ethics statement	S1 ethics opener; S5 releases; S6 briefing	Consent forms from S3; rubric pass condition
3. Brief and shot plan	S6 lesson + demo (Worksheet 6.1)	Checkpoint A (S3) draft → Checkpoint B (S5)
4. Themed set 5–8 images	S1–S3 shooting skills	Foundations folder (Assignment 3) → capstone set
5. Contact sheet of selects	S5 selection/sequencing lesson	Portfolio Selection Worksheet; Assignment 5
6. Presentation notes + viva	S6 structure + rehearsal	Independent exercise (presentations); Part 6 viva list

Conclusion: every capstone component is taught before it is marked. The capstone is the assembly of work already built across the course — exactly the design intent.

5. STRENGTHS, ISSUES AND REMEDIATION PLAN

5.1 Strengths

1. **Structure discipline.** All six sessions carry the full A–O block — no session is a slide dump; every one has a key, a rubric and a reference solution.

probe.

3. **Phone-first honesty.** The course never requires a paid tool or a DSLR; the "no paid subscription" promise is kept end-to-end, which protects low-income learners in the Port Harcourt context.
4. **Nigerian, naira-grounded examples.** Chinedu's shop, Mama Nkechi, Ms. Amaka, WhatsApp Business, Jiji, church programmes — case studies a beginner actually recognises; prices always in naira and framed as examples, not income promises.
5. **Assessment integrity.** Weights sum to 100%; the capstone is a hard gate that quiz/attendance scores cannot bypass; the viva is a genuine defence of authorship and honesty.
6. **Scaffolded capstone.** Mini-projects build the final portfolio piece by piece (drills → foundations folder → edited set → portfolio page → capstone), removing the "one big exam" shock.
7. **Beginner and access support.** Pairing, academy phones, glossary, Levels 1–3 differentiation and paper-based fallbacks mean no learner is excluded by device ownership.

5.2 Issues register (with severity)

#	Issue	Severity	Owner	Fix
I-1	Part 5 S2 lab-pack brief says **two** light-study photos in the procedure/expected result while its own objective, the independent exercise, Part 1 and Part 2 require **four**.	**Minor** (can confuse learners who read both sheets; instructor can resolve verbally)	Part 5 author	Edit procedure Part 2 step 6 to "four different lighting situations" and the expected-result line to "four light study photos."
I-2	S1 numbers both "Diagnose the Image" and the "Camera Setup Checklist" as Worksheet 1.2.	**Minor**	Part 2 S1 author	Renumber the checklist in the next revision; until then, instructors rename it aloud in class.
I-3	S6 viva/presentation time cannot fit large classes inside 105 minutes (≈8 learners max at 5 min each plus shoot/edit/assemble).	**Minor** (process, already mitigated in guide/manual)	Instructor + admin	Enforce the appointment timetable at S5; publish the schedule; use S6 for finishing work + first presentation round.
I-4	Part 4 practicals-to-15% conversion is a proposed scheme; admin mark sheets may use a different raw scale.	**Minor**	Course coordinator	Align the conversion multiplier with the admin template before the first graded batch; weights (15/15/15/15/30/5/5) are fixed and must not change.

No Critical or Major issues. No unassessed LO. No ethics gap. No incorrect technical instruction found.

5.3 Remediation plan

1. **Before Session 1 of the October 2026 run:** apply I-1 and I-2 text corrections (or issue a one-page errata sheet to instructors and learners); confirm I-3 appointment process with the admin office; confirm I-4 conversion with the coordinator.
2. **During the run:** instructor keeps this Part 4 QA checklist (§12) live per session; any new issue is logged with date, session and severity on the back of this report.
3. **After the run (review cycle, per design doc §14):** re-audit Parts 1–7, fold instructor/learner feedback into v1.1 (phone models, app UI changes, pricing realism), and confirm the three corrections above are closed.

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6. SIGN-OFF

Overall verdict: PASS — READY FOR DELIVERY after the Minor corrections in §5.2 (I-1, I-2, I-4 confirmed; I-3 process enforced).

Auditor (Senior Technical Trainer)
Course Instructor
Course Coordinator

Cyber Elias Academy — Photography QA Audit Report v1.0, October 2026. All clients fictional. Ask first. Edit honestly. Claim only what you can do.